

Japanese, Step by Step, Sign by Sign

A gentle introduction to contemporary standard Japanese,
one sign and one word at a time

Adhithya Rajasekaran

Starter edition — forty-four short lessons in eight cumulative
chapters.

Copyright © Adhithya Rajasekaran. Licensed under Creative Commons
Attribution-ShareAlike 4.0 International (CC BY-SA 4.0). Japanese is set
in Noto Sans JP (SIL Open Font License).

How to use this starter edition

Begin with no assumed Japanese. Each section takes one small expression, teaches only the writing that expression needs, explains where the word came from, and ends with a short retrieval prompt. There is no kana chart to memorise first.

Japanese uses three writing systems at the same time, and an ordinary sentence can contain all three. *Hiragana* carries much of the grammar, *kanji* carry many content words, and *katakana* commonly marks words borrowed from outside. This edition introduces them in that order. Every load-bearing sign gets its own short lesson before a word asks you to decode it.

Two habits are worth forming immediately. First, count beats: every kana carries one mora, and vowel length matters. Second, expect a kanji to have several readings. This book therefore teaches one sign, one relevant reading, and one useful word at a time rather than pretending a character has one fixed sound.

Romanization stands beside the Japanese here and will fade in later editions. Where a lesson is teaching beat count it also spells a word out beat by beat, because the macron in *arigatō* hides exactly what is being taught.

A note on what this book does not claim. Japanese shares no ancestor with English, so there is no family of English cousin words to hang new vocabulary on — and none is invented here. What Japanese does have is a real borrowed layer from Chinese, shared with Mandarin and Korean, an internal etymology of its own, and a handful of genuine loans from Portuguese, Dutch, German, and English. Those are used. Nothing else is.

Contents

How to use this starter edition	iii
1 Two Answers, Sign by Sign	1
1.1 i	1
1.2 ha	2
1.3 hai	3
1.4 e	4
1.5 hai	5
1.6 iie	7
2 A Daytime Greeting, One Sign at a Time	9
2.1 ko	9
2.2 n	10
2.3 ni	11
2.4 chi	12
2.5 wani	13
2.6 wa	13
2.7 konnichiwa	15
2.8 konnichiwa	16
3 Plain Thanks, One Sign at a Time	19
3.1 a	19
3.2 ri	20
3.3 ka	21
3.4 dakuten	22
3.5 to	23
3.6 u	24
3.7 arigatou	25
3.8 arigatō	26

4	Polite Thanks, Three More Signs	29
4.1	sa	29
4.2	ma	30
4.3	su	31
4.4	arigatō gozaimasu	32
4.5	Practice	34
5	Nihongo, Built in Small Blocks	37
5.1	nichi	37
5.2	hon	38
5.3	gen	39
5.4	go	40
5.5	kuchi	40
5.6	go	41
5.7	nihongo	42
6	Coffee in Katakana, Three Shapes	45
6.1	ko	45
6.2	chōonpu	46
6.3	hi	47
6.4	kōhī	48
7	The Doorway Exchange	51
7.1	Practice	51
8	One Goodbye, Sign by Sign	53
8.1	sayōnara	53
8.2	yo	54
8.3	na	55
8.4	ra	56
8.5	sayōnara	57
8.6	Practice	57
9	One More Time, Please	59
9.1	sumimasen	59
9.2	mi	60
9.3	me	61
9.4	yoku	62
9.5	ku	63
9.6	wakarimasen	64

9.7	do	64
9.8	mō	65
9.9	mo	66
9.10	ichido	67
9.11	onagai shimasu	67
9.12	mō ichido, onagai shimasu	68
10	A Little More Slowly	71
10.1	se	71
10.2	o	72
10.3	ne	73
10.4	sukoshi	74
10.5	shi	74
10.6	yukkuri	76
10.7	yu	76
10.8	itte kudasai	77
10.9	mō sukoshi	78
10.10	wakarimashita	78
10.11	koko	79
10.12	mō sukoshi, yukkuri itte kudasai	80
11	Seven Body Words, No New Guessing	81
11.1	small tsu	81
11.2	te	83
11.3	ta	84
11.4	da	85
11.5	te	85
11.6	mimi	86
11.7	kuchi	86
11.8	ashi	87
11.9	hana	88
11.10	kao	88
11.11	me	89
11.12	te, mimi, kuchi, ashi, hana, kao, me	89
12	Seven More Body Words, Spaced on Purpose	91
12.1	Practice	91
12.2	atama	92
12.3	kami	92
12.4	Practice	93

12.5	ha	93
12.6	kata	93
12.7	Practice	94
12.8	onaka	94
12.9	senaka	94
12.10	Practice	95
12.11	koshi	95
12.12	Practice	96
12.13	Practice	96
12.14	Practice	96
12.15	Practice	96
12.16	Practice	97
12.17	Practice	97
12.18	Practice	97
12.19	Practice	97
12.20	atama, kami, ha, kata, onaka, senaka	97
13	Nine Family Words Through One New Kana	99
13.1	tsu	99
13.2	Practice	100
13.3	chichi	101
13.4	haha	101
13.5	ani	101
13.6	ane	102
13.7	otooto	102
13.8	imooto	103
13.9	otto	103
13.10	tsuma	104
13.11	kodomo	104
13.12	Practice	104
13.13	Practice	105
13.14	Practice	105
13.15	Practice	105
13.16	Practice	106
13.17	Practice	106
14	Five Numbers, No New Signs	109
14.1	ichi	109
14.2	go	110
14.3	ni	111

14.4	san	111
14.5	yon	112
14.6	Practice	113
15	The Two Signs the Rest of the Run Cost	115
15.1	nana	115
15.2	hachi	116
15.3	ku	117
15.4	ro	118
15.5	roku	120
15.6	small yu	121
15.7	jū	122
15.8	Practice	123
16	The Other Way to Count	125
16.1	hi	125
16.2	hitotsu	127
16.3	fu	127
16.4	futatsu	129
16.5	mittsu	130
16.6	yottsu	130
16.7	itsutsu	131
16.8	Practice	132
17	The Other Five, and Where the Count Stops	135
17.1	mu	135
17.2	muttsu	137
17.3	nanatsu	137
17.4	ya	138
17.5	yattsu	140
17.6	no	140
17.7	kokonotsu	142
17.8	tō	143
17.9	Practice	143
18	A Counter for the Shape of the Thing	145
18.1	-tsu	145
18.2	-nin	147
18.3	hitori futari	148
18.4	Practice	149

18.5	ho	150
18.6	-hon	151
18.7	handakuten	153
18.8	ippon	154
18.9	Practice	155
19	Reading — Words, Greetings, and the Cues You Have Only Heard	157
19.1	te, mimi, kuchi, hana, kao, me	157
19.2	hai, iie, konnichiwa, arigatō	158
19.3	wakarimashita, wakarimasen, mō ichido	159
20	Nail, Elbow, Knee, Throat, Chest	161
20.1	tsume	161
20.2	hiji	162
20.3	hiza	162
20.4	nodo	163
20.5	mune	164
21	Bone, Chin, Cheek, Eyebrow, Skin	165
21.1	hone	165
21.2	ago	166
21.3	hoo	166
21.4	mayu	167
21.5	hada	168
22	Sweat, Tears, Voice, Fever, Painful	169
22.1	ase	169
22.2	namida	170
22.3	koe	170
22.4	nettsu	171
22.5	itai	172
23	Medicine, Sleepy, Sad, Fun, Scary	173
23.1	kusuri	173
23.2	nemui	174
23.3	kanashii	174
23.4	tanoshii	175
23.5	kowai	176

24	Pain, Grandfather, Uncle, Son, Daughter	177
24.1	itami	177
24.2	ojiisan	178
24.3	ojisan	178
24.4	musuko	179
24.5	musume	180
25	Friend, Adult, Man, Woman, Teacher	181
25.1	tomodachi	181
25.2	otona	182
25.3	otoko	182
25.4	onna	183
25.5	sensei	184
26	Next door, Companion, To go, To buy, To drink	185
26.1	tonari	185
26.2	nakama	186
26.3	iku	186
26.4	kau	187
26.5	nomu	188
27	To read, To write, To speak, To wait, To meet	189
27.1	yomu	189
27.2	kaku	190
27.3	hanasu	190
27.4	matsu	191
27.5	au	192
28	To use, To sing, To say, To think, To hold	193
28.1	tsukau	193
28.2	utau	194
28.3	iu	194
28.4	omou	195
28.5	motsu	196
29	To stand, To cry, To live, To rest, To enjoy	197
29.1	tatsu	197
29.2	naku	198
29.3	sumu	198
29.4	yasumu	199

	29.5	tanoshimu	200
30		To push, To pull, To look for, To lend, To give back	201
	30.1	osu	201
	30.2	hiku	202
	30.3	sagasu	202
	30.4	kasu	203
	30.5	kaesu	204
31		To take out, To drop, To fix, To move, Rice	205
	31.1	dasu	205
	31.2	otosu	206
	31.3	naosu	206
	31.4	ugoku	207
	31.5	gohan	208
32		Fish, Meat, Egg, Vegetables, Fruit	209
	32.1	sakana	209
	32.2	niku	210
	32.3	tamago	210
	32.4	yasai	211
	32.5	kudamono	212
33		Apple, Mandarin orange, Strawberry, Peach, Pear	213
	33.1	ringo	213
	33.2	mikan	214
	33.3	ichigo	214
	33.4	momo	215
	33.5	nashi	216
34		Watermelon, White radish, Carrot, Tofu, Salt	217
	34.1	suika	217
	34.2	daikon	218
	34.3	ninjin	218
	34.4	toufu	219
	34.5	shio	220
35		Sugar, Udon noodles, Sushi, Breakfast, Sweets	221
	35.1	satou	221
	35.2	udon	222
	35.3	sushi	222

35.4	asagohan	223
35.5	okashi	224
36	Seaweed, Japanese plum, Chestnut, Beans, Uncooked rice	225
36.1	nori	225
36.2	ume	226
36.3	kuri	226
36.4	mame	227
36.5	kome	228
37	Home, Window, Chair, Desk, Roof	229
37.1	uchi	229
37.2	mado	230
37.3	isu	230
37.4	tsukue	231
37.5	yane	232
37.6	(dialogue)	232
37.7	(dialogue)	233
38	Floor, Mirror, Futon, Chopsticks, Kitchen	235
38.1	yuka	235
38.2	kagami	236
38.3	futon	236
38.4	hashi	237
38.5	daidokoro	238
39	Garden, Bath, Tatami mat, Shelf, Box	239
39.1	niwa	239
39.2	ofuro	240
39.3	tatami	240
39.4	tana	241
39.5	hako	242
40	Umbrella, School, Homework, Problem, Answer	243
40.1	kasa	243
40.2	gakkou	244
40.3	shukudai	244
40.4	mondai	245
40.5	kotae	246

41	Letter, Time, Name, Money, Mountain	247
41.1	tegami	247
41.2	jikan	248
41.3	namae	248
41.4	okane	249
41.5	yama	250
42	River, Sea, Grass, Forest, Stone	251
42.1	kawa	251
42.2	umi	252
42.3	kusa	252
42.4	mori	253
42.5	ishi	254
43	Sand, Rice field, Star, Cloud, Sun	255
43.1	sunā	255
43.2	tanbo	256
43.3	hoshi	256
43.4	kumo	257
43.5	taiyou	258
44	Island, Wave, Soil, Seed, Rain	259
44.1	shima	259
44.2	nami	260
44.3	tsuchi	260
44.4	tane	261
44.5	ame	262
45	Cat, Horse, Cow, Bird, Bear	263
45.1	neko	263
45.2	uma	264
45.3	ushi	264
45.4	tori	265
45.5	kuma	266
46	Insect, Ant, Pigeon, Sheep, Deer	267
46.1	mushi	267
46.2	ari	268
46.3	hato	268
46.4	hitsuji	269

	46.5	shika	270
47		Crab, Octopus, Squid, Turtle, Wolf	271
	47.1	kani	271
	47.2	tako	272
	47.3	ika	272
	47.4	kame	273
	47.5	ookami	274
48		Chicken, Small, Good, Long, Short	275
	48.1	niwatori	275
	48.2	chiisai	276
	48.3	ii	276
	48.4	nagai	277
	48.5	mijikai	278
49		Tall, Low, Cheap, Fast, Easy	279
	49.1	takai	279
	49.2	hikui	280
	49.3	yasui	280
	49.4	hayai	281
	49.5	yasashii	282
50		Sweet, Bitter, Wide, Narrow, Heavy	283
	50.1	amai	283
	50.2	nigai	284
	50.3	hiroi	284
	50.4	semai	285
	50.5	omoi	286
51		Strong, Weak, Beautiful, Blue, Red	287
	51.1	tsuyoi	287
	51.2	yowai	288
	51.3	utsukushii	288
	51.4	aoi	289
	51.5	akai	290
52		White, Black, Green, Thick, Warm	291
	52.1	shiroi	291
	52.2	kuroi	292
	52.3	midori	292

	52.4	futoi	293
	52.5	atatakai	294
53		Cold, Tasty, Hot, Cold, Morning	295
	53.1	tsumetai	295
	53.2	oishii	296
	53.3	atsui	296
	53.4	samui	297
	53.5	asa	298
54		Evening, Tomorrow, Now, Every day, Year	299
	54.1	yuugata	299
	54.2	ashita	300
	54.3	ima	300
	54.4	mainichi	301
	54.5	toshi	302
	54.6	(dialogue)	302
	54.7	(dialogue)	303
55		Minute, Summer, Winter, Always, Still	305
	55.1	fun	305
	55.2	natsu	306
	55.3	fuyu	306
	55.4	itsumo	307
	55.5	mada	308
56		After, Before, Above, Inside, Left	309
	56.1	ato	309
	56.2	mae	310
	56.3	ue	310
	56.4	naka	311
	56.5	hidari	312
57		Near, Far, Town, Road, Shop	313
	57.1	chikai	313
	57.2	tooi	314
	57.3	machi	314
	57.4	michi	315
	57.5	mise	316

58	Underground, Park, Country, Clothes, Shoes	317
58.1	chika	317
58.2	kouen	318
58.3	kuni	318
58.4	fuku	319
58.5	kutsu	320
59	Hat, Socks, Glasses, Thirty, Thousand	321
59.1	boushi	321
59.2	kutsushita	322
59.3	megane	322
59.4	sanjuu	323
59.5	sen	324
60	Ten thousand, Twelve, Aubergine, Song, Branch	325
60.1	man	325
60.2	juuni	326
60.3	nasu	326
60.4	uta	327
60.5	eda	328
61	Thread, Needle, Comb, String, Rope	329
61.1	ito	329
61.2	hari	330
61.3	kushi	330
61.4	himo	331
61.5	tsuna	332
62	Luggage, Ship, Sound, Colour, Shape	333
62.1	nimotsu	333
62.2	fune	334
62.3	oto	334
62.4	iro	335
62.5	katashi	336
63	Dream, Festival, West, East, South	337
63.1	yume	337
63.2	matsuri	338
63.3	nishi	338
63.4	higashi	339

	63.5	minami	340
64		Powder, Sesame, Sea urchin, Sardine, Flavour	341
	64.1	kona	341
	64.2	goma	342
	64.3	uni	342
	64.4	iwashi	343
	64.5	aji	344
65		Carp, Cicada, Dragonfly, Potato, Burdock root	345
	65.1	koi	345
	65.2	semi	346
	65.3	tonbo	346
	65.4	imo	347
	65.5	gobou	348
66		Basket, Spinning top, Raft, Flute, Drum	349
	66.1	kago	349
	66.2	koma	350
	66.3	ikada	350
	66.4	fue	351
	66.5	taiko	352
67		Hand fan, Folding fan, Charcoal, Well, Beach	353
	67.1	uchiwa	353
	67.2	sensu	354
	67.3	sumi	354
	67.4	ido	355
	67.5	hama	356
68		Hill, Valley, Countryside, Harbour, Setting sun	357
	68.1	oka	357
	68.2	tani	358
	68.3	inaka	358
	68.4	minato	359
	68.5	yuuhi	360
69		Rainbow, Thunder, Frost, Ice, Summer holidays	361
	69.1	niji	361
	69.2	kaminari	362
	69.3	shimo	362

69.4	koori	363
69.5	natsuyasumi	364
70	Rice cake, Natto, Fish-paste tube, Chick, Wing	365
70.1	mochi	365
70.2	nattou	366
70.3	chikuwa	367
70.4	hiyoko	367
70.5	hane	368
71	Horn, Hole, Rice plant, Nephew, Niece	369
71.1	tsuno	369
71.2	ana	370
71.3	ine	370
71.4	oi	371
71.5	mei	372
71.6	(dialogue)	372
71.7	(dialogue)	373
	Pronunciation & Writing Reference	375
	Glossary	377
	Review Questions	403
	Answer Key	435
	Sources for this starter edition	475
	Index	477

Chapter 1

Two Answers, Sign by Sign

Modes: 👁 eyes (2) ✍ pen (4) 🔄 Hands-free start: none of the 6 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can write the three hiragana signs in はい and いいえ, read both answers without romanization, and say each with even mora timing.

A yes-or-no choice using only three signs the learner has already traced, copied, recalled, and read.

1.1 い — two strokes, one beat

You already know the rule that makes this writing system easy: **one sign, one beat**. Not one letter one sound, and not one sign one word — one sign, one **mora**, the even beat Japanese counts time in.

What you have not had yet is a single sign taught on its own. Here is the first.

Script — the shape

い

Two strokes, both falling, the left one long and the right one short:

1. the **left** stroke — start high, come down, and hook gently to the right at the bottom
2. the **right** stroke — a short downward tick, higher up and clear of the first

It is read **i**, the vowel of English *machine* — short, tight, never the *eye* of English *bite*.

Where the shape came from, and why it does not help you. Every hiragana sign began as a Chinese character written fast and cursively until it wore smooth. But those characters were chosen **for their sound**, not their meaning, so unlike a Chinese component there is nothing inside い to decode. The shape is a signature you learn, not a structure you read. This book will tell you when a shape carries information and when it does not, and this is the second kind.

Your turn

- *Trace it:* follow the visible い once — long stroke first, then the short tick
- *Say it:* **i**, one clean beat

Keep the model visible and stop after one traced sign. Copying without the model comes later; today your hand is only learning the direction of two strokes.

Before you move on

How many beats does one hiragana sign take? (**One.**)

Source: Unicode Hiragana chart; stroke order per *Hitsujun Shido no Tebiki* (Japanese Ministry of Education, 1958).

1.2 は — three strokes

Write the two-stroke sign you met a moment ago. Long stroke, short tick.

Script — the shape

は

Three strokes. Look at it as a tall left post with a loop tied on its right.

1. the **vertical**, down the left side, with the smallest flick left at the foot
2. a **short horizontal** crossing that vertical near the top, on its right

3. the **loop** — down from the right of that crossbar, round to the left, and back up to close

Read **ha**, breathed rather than hard: the *h* of English *hat*, then the open *a* of *father*.

It has a second reading, and you have already used it. Keep that in your pocket for now — this sign is doing two jobs in Japanese, and the second one is what makes the greeting look misspelled to a beginner. It gets its own lesson, after you have met the sign it *sounds* like.

Your turn

- *Copy:* keep は visible and write it once — vertical, crossbar, loop
- *Say it:* **ha**, one beat, breath not force

Look back at the model between strokes if you need to. This is one guided copy, not a memory test.

Your turn — review pulse

Say ? and tap its one mora before adding another sign.

Before you move on

Which stroke of は is written first? (The **vertical** on the left.)

Source: Unicode Hiragana chart; stroke order per *Hitsujun Shido no Tebiki* (Japanese Ministry of Education, 1958).

1.3 Two signs, side by side — and a word appears

Both signs are yours. Look at them for five seconds:

はい

Cover the model. Write the two signs in that order and say each beat as you finish it. Uncover the model, compare once, and repair at most one stroke. This short look-hide-write-check cycle is the whole delayed-copy step.

Script — no new sign at all

Now write them touching:

は + い → はい

ha then **i**. Two beats, even, neither one stressed. You can now decode the sequence *hai*. The word lesson after the next sign attaches its useful meaning.

Nothing new was introduced in this lesson. No stroke, no sound, no word. What changed is where the word now lives: you are no longer recalling a shape you were shown, you are **reading** it — assembling it out of two pieces you can write from memory and sound out in order.

That is the whole method for this writing system, and it does not get harder. It gets longer. A word of five signs is five signs you already own, in a row.

Your turn

- *Read it:* はい — sound each sign in turn, do not recall the word whole
- *Write it:* はい — five strokes in total, three then two

Before you move on

How many new strokes did you have to learn in this lesson? (**None.**)
Source: Unicode Hiragana chart.

1.4 え — two strokes, and a second word for free

Read the word for *yes* off the page, sign by sign, out loud.

Script — the shape

え

Two strokes, and the second one does most of the work:

1. a **short tick** at the top, on its own, clear of everything below

2. the **body** — across to the right, back down and left in a flat zigzag, then out to the lower right in one continuous movement

Read **e**, the vowel of English *bed* — short, and never the *ay* of *day*.

What you've built

Three signs are now yours, and they spell more than one word. Put two of them together with the one you just learned:

い | い | え

i-i-e. Three beats — and note that the first sign is written **twice**, because Japanese counts two full beats there. The next lesson attaches its meaning. For now, the whole task is decoding three known signs in order.

Your turn

- Cover the printed え. Have a partner or recording say **e** once. If you are working alone, read the romanized cue *e*, cover it, and continue.
- *Write from the heard or romanized cue:* え — tick first, then the body in one movement
- *Read it:* い | い | え — three beats, and do not shorten the doubled sign

Uncover the model only after your one transcription attempt. Compare, repair one stroke if needed, and stop.

Before you move on

Why is the first sign of that word written twice? (Because it is **two beats**, not one held longer.)

Source: Unicode Hiragana chart; stroke order per *Hitsujun Shido no Tebiki* (Japanese Ministry of Education, 1958).

1.5 はい — yes, in two equal beats

Nothing is assumed yet. Begin with the shortest useful answer in the language, and with the first of its three writing systems.

Script — two signs, two beats

はい — は *ha* + い *i*

Japanese runs left to right. はい is written with two signs of **hiragana**, the everyday script. A hiragana sign is not a letter. It is one whole beat — a **mora** — and normally a consonant and a vowel already fused into one shape. There is no separate *h* to write, because は already is *ha*.

Five vowels, and they stay pure: *a* as in father, *i* as in machine, then *u*, *e*, *o*. So はい is *ha-i*, two beats of the same length, and not the single gliding sound of English “high.”

The word, taken apart

はい means **yes**, and also “here you are,” “I am listening,” and “present.” Its origin is genuinely unsettled: some accounts tie it to an older word *hai*, “a bow”; others treat it as an old interjection. Neither is proven, so hold it as an open question rather than a fact. The rare kanji sometimes used in that proposal can wait until a later reading chapter.

Say plainly what is true here. Japanese shares no ancestor with English, so no cousin word is waiting in your vocabulary to hold はい in place. What this track offers instead is the writing itself, built up one sign at a time, and — later — the real family Japanese does have, through the characters it borrowed.

Your turn

- *Say it:* はい — *ha-i*, two even beats] [REPEAT x2
- *Read it:* は, then い, left to right
- *Answer:* your name is called → はい

Before you move on

How many beats does はい hold? (Two.) Which sign carries *ha*? (は.)

Source: Wiktionary: はい.

1.6 いいえ — no, and why the extra beat matters

Say はい once and count its two beats out loud. This lesson adds the opposite answer, and one fact about beats that Japanese will never let go of.

Script — one new sign, three beats

いいえ — い *i* + い *i* + え *e*

Only え *e* is new; い you already read in はい. Written out, the word is three signs, so it is three beats: *i-i-e*. The first two are the same sign twice, which is exactly how Japanese writes a long vowel in hiragana — by writing the vowel again.

Beat count is not decoration. いえ (two beats) means **house**. いいえ (three beats) means **no**. Nothing else distinguishes them. Hold the first *i* for two beats and the word lands; clip it and you have said “house.”

The word, taken apart

いいえ is the plain **no** — and, just as often, a modest “**not at all**” used to wave away thanks or a compliment. That second use is the common one in daily speech, which is worth knowing before you meet it as an answer to **thank you** at the end of this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* いいえ — *i-i-e*, three even beats] [REPEAT x2
- *Contrast:* いえ house, いいえ no
- *Choose:* agree → はい; decline → いいえ

Your turn — review pulse

Say ??, then write ? once from memory before learning the contrasting answer.

Before you move on

Which single sign is new here? (え.) What changes when the long *i* is cut short? (The word becomes いえ, house.)

Source: Wiktionary: いいえ.

Chapter 2

A Daytime Greeting, One Sign at a Time

Modes: 👁 eyes (2) ✍ pen (6) ⇄ **Hands-free start:** none of the 8 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can write the five distinct signs in こんにちは, read them in order, and remember why final は is pronounced wa.

A one-line daytime greeting whose five signs were each taught before the learner reads it.

2.1 こ — two strokes, and the greeting begins

The two-stroke sign read *e* — tick, then body. Write it once.

Script — the shape

こ

The simplest sign you have met. Two short horizontal strokes, stacked, the lower one longer and slightly curved:

1. the **upper** stroke, short, curving down a little at its right end
2. the **lower** stroke, wider, sweeping right and lifting slightly

Read **ko**: a clean *k*, then the *o* of English *more* shortened.

Nothing joins them. The gap between the two strokes is part of the shape — close it and you have a different sign.

Your turn

- *Write it:* コ — upper stroke, then the longer lower one, and leave the gap
- *Say it:* **ko**, one beat

Your turn — review pulse

Say ??? and tap all three morae before writing the new sign.

Before you move on

Which of the two strokes is longer? (The **lower** one.)

Source: Unicode Hiragana chart; stroke order per *Hitsujun Shido no Tebiki* (Japanese Ministry of Education, 1958).

2.2 ㇿ — one stroke, one beat, no vowel

Two stacked strokes with a gap. Write the sign read *ko*.

Script — the shape, and the exception

ㇿ

One stroke. Start with a small tick down-left, then sweep down, round to the right and up in a single unbroken movement, finishing with a rise.

Now the part that matters more than the shape. Every sign you have met so far is a consonant plus a vowel, or a vowel alone. **This one is a consonant with no vowel at all** — and it still takes a **full beat**, exactly as long as any other sign.

That is why Japanese counts morae rather than syllables, and it is the clearest evidence you will get. An English speaker hears the *n* at the end of a word as a tail on the vowel before it. Japanese does not. It is its own beat, held its own length, and shortening it is one of the most audible foreign-accent tells there is.

Your turn

- *Write it:* ㇿ — one continuous stroke, no lifts
- *Say it:* hold it for a full beat, as long as any other sign takes

Your turn — review pulse

Cover the model and write ?? from its two known signs.

Before you move on

If this sign has no vowel, how long is it held? (**A full beat** — the same as every other sign.)

Source: Unicode Hiragana chart; stroke order per *Hitsujun Shido no Tebiki* (Japanese Ministry of Education, 1958).

2.3 に — three strokes, and a shape you half know

Write the three-stroke sign read *ha*. Vertical, crossbar, loop.

Script — the shape

に

Three strokes, and **the first one you have already practised**:

1. the **vertical** down the left, with the same small flick left at the foot as the sign read *ha*
2. a **short horizontal** to its right, upper area
3. a **longer horizontal** below it, sweeping right

Read **ni**: the *n* of *knee*, then the tight *i* you learned first.

This is the first time two signs share a visible part, and it is worth naming, because it is nearly the last. Hiragana is not built from recombining components the way Chinese characters are — these two happen to have worn down to similar left-hand posts, not because they mean or sound anything alike. Treat the resemblance as a **handwriting** convenience, not as a clue. Reading information into it is the mistake this book keeps warning you off.

Your turn

- *Write it*: に — vertical, short bar, long bar
- *Notice*: write it beside は and compare only the left post

Your turn — review pulse

Before the new sign, write ? once and then ? once from memory.

Before you move on

Which stroke of this sign comes first? (The **vertical**.)

Source: Unicode Hiragana chart; stroke order per *Hitsujun Shido no Tebiki* (Japanese Ministry of Education, 1958).

2.4 ち — two strokes, four roman letters, one beat

Three strokes: vertical, short bar, long bar. Write the sign read *ni*.

Script — the shape

ち

Two strokes:

1. a **short horizontal** across the top
2. the **body** — down from the middle of that bar, curving left, then round into a full belly to the right and up

Read **chi**: the *ch* of English *cheese*, then the tight *i*.

Count what just happened. One sign. One beat. **Four roman letters** to describe it. The romanization is a pronunciation aid written for people who do not read the script yet — it is not a smaller version of the writing system, and the number of letters in it tells you nothing about the number of beats in the word.

This is the moment the roman spelling starts costing you more than it pays, and it is why the signs are worth the effort.

Your turn

- *Write it:* ち — top bar, then the body in one movement
- *Say it:* **chi**, one beat — as long as any other sign, no longer

Before you move on

Does the number of roman letters tell you how long a sign is held?
(No.)

Source: Unicode Hiragana chart; stroke order per *Hitsujun Shido no Tebiki* (Japanese Ministry of Education, 1958).

2.5 わに (wani) — a crocodile

Before the new word: say the last thing you learned, once, out loud.

You'll want to know: わに

わに — *wani* — “a crocodile”.

Say it: *wani*. Look at its shape as you say it: the lessons that follow take pieces of it, わ, and write each one on its own.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *wani*
- *wani*, and what it means

Before you move on

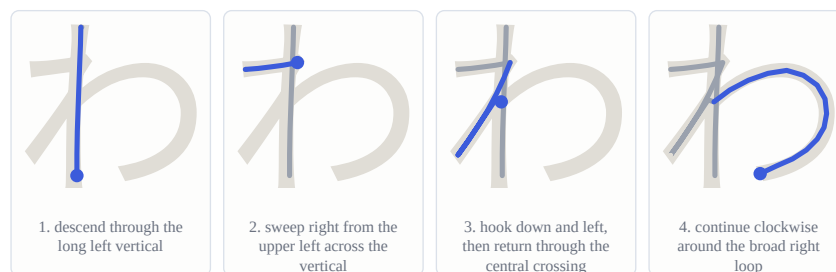
What is “a crocodile”? (わに, *wani*.)

2.6 わ — the sign for *wa*, and the trap beside it

Write the three-stroke sign read *ha*: vertical, crossbar, loop.

Script — the shape

How it is written — 2 strokes · 1 pen lift · 4 movements



Stroke order after Sirgazil, Hiragana ㇰ stroke order animation.gif, hiragana ㇰ 30 frames, 3.0 seconds (Wikimedia Commons, 1 October 2009)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How わ is written, stroke by stroke

わ

Two strokes:

1. the **vertical** on the left, with the small flick at the foot
2. the **body** — a short bar right from the top, then down, round to the left in a loop, and out to the lower right with a curl

Read **wa**: like English *wa* in *wander*, one beat.

What you've built — and the trap

Here is the thing this sign exists in this lesson to protect you from. The daytime greeting **sounds** like it ends in *wa*. **It is not written with this sign.** It ends with the sign read *ha* — the one you learned early and were told was holding a second job.

That second job is grammatical: は is also Japanese's topic marker, and **as a topic marker it is pronounced wa**. The greeting is a frozen fragment of a longer sentence, and it kept the marker's spelling along with the marker's sound.

So the rule you need is not about sound at all:

- わ is the sign for the mora *wa* inside ordinary words.
- は read as *wa* means you are looking at the topic marker, or at something that used to contain one.

Getting this backwards is the single most common beginner spelling error in Japanese, and it is the reason this book taught you the sign for *wa* **after** you already knew the greeting — so the shape could arrive with its warning attached rather than be quietly assumed.

Your turn

- *Write it:* わ, then は beside it — two signs, one shared sound, different jobs
- *Decide:* hearing *wa* at the end of the daytime greeting, which sign do you write?

Your turn — review pulse

Say ??? again, keeping the two opening morae distinct.

Before you move on

Which of the two is a fact about **grammar** rather than about sound? (The one where は is read *wa*.)

Source: Unicode Hiragana chart; stroke order per *Hitsujun Shido no Tebiki* (Japanese Ministry of Education, 1958).

2.7 Five signs in a row — and the greeting is readable

Four signs, one after another, from memory. Say each beat as you finish writing it:

こ ん に ち

Script — the assembly

Add the fifth — the one that is read *wa* because it is a topic marker — and the greeting is on the page:

こ + ん + に + ち + は → こんにちは

ko-n-ni-chi-wa. Five signs, **five beats**, all even. Say it against a steady tap and you will hear that the second beat, the one with no vowel, takes exactly as long as the four around it.

No new stroke appears here. You have decoded five pieces you can each write from memory, in order, including the one that sounds like something other than its name. The next lesson attaches the daytime-greeting meaning to the line.

What you've built

Eight signs, taught one at a time, and with them you can now decode three whole sequences off the page. Two already carry useful answers; the five-sign sequence gets its daytime-greeting job in the next lesson. Hiragana has forty-six basic signs. You hold **eight**. The rest arrive the same way, one per lesson, and the words they unlock arrive free — because a word in this script is never more than the signs you already own, in a row.

Your turn

- *Read it:* こんにちは — sound each sign in turn; do not recall it whole
- *Write it:* the greeting, then say it once at speaking pace

Your turn — review pulse

Write ? once, then set it beside ? and name which one closes the greeting.

Before you move on

How many of the greeting's five signs were new in this lesson?

(None.)

Source: Unicode Hiragana chart.

2.8 こんにちは — hello, and a sign that lies about its sound

Retrieve はい and the sign は. You are about to meet は again in the daytime greeting — where it is not pronounced *ha*.

Script — five familiar signs

こんにちは — こ *ko* + ん *n* + に *ni* + ち *chi* + は

You have written every sign separately. こ, に, and ち each carry a consonant and vowel. ん is the exception: a bare consonant with a full beat of its own. Read five signs in five beats: *ko-n-ni-chi-wa*. Do not swallow ん.

Grammar Lens — the sign は, read *wa*

The last sign is は, which you learned as *ha*. Here it is read **wa**. Here は is the **topic particle**, roughly “as for ____.” It keeps an older spelling. Carry one small rule forward: read は as *ha* inside a word and as *wa* when it is the particle.

Why it’s said this way

こんにちは is the daytime greeting. It began as an unfinished sentence: *konnichi wa...*, “as for today ...” The rest fell away and the topic marker stayed.

The older phrase is often written with two kanji for “this day.” You do not need to decode those yet. This chapter keeps the whole greeting in the hiragana signs you have already learned.

Your turn

- *Say it:* こんにちは — *ko-n-ni-chi-wa*, five beats] [REPEAT x2
- *Decide:* は in はい → *ha*; は ending the greeting → *wa*
- *Greet:* someone at midday → こんにちは

Your turn — review pulse

Write ? from memory and give it one full mora.

Before you move on

Which sign takes a beat without a vowel? (ん.) Why does the greeting end in a particle? (It is the opening of a sentence nobody finishes any more.)

Source: Wiktionary: こんにちは.

Chapter 3

Plain Thanks, One Sign at a Time

Modes: 👁 eyes (1) ✍ pen (7) 🔄 Hands-free start: none of the 8 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can write and read ありがとう,
build が with the dakuten, and say the five morae without swallowing
the long final vowel.

*A plain thank-you read only after every distinct hiragana sign and the
dakuten have their own small step.*

3.1 あ — three strokes, and the thank-you begins

Write こんにちは from memory. Five signs, all yours.

This chapter builds the five-sign plain thank-you from the page
up. Its meaning arrives only after every sign is yours, so this
first lesson asks for one shape: あ.

Script — the shape

あ

Three strokes, and the third is the one that gives beginners trouble:

1. a short **horizontal**, near the top
2. a **vertical** crossing it, leaning slightly left as it falls
3. a **loop** that starts at the upper right, sweeps down and left across
the vertical, curls round at the bottom, and finishes pointing right

The loop is one continuous movement, not a circle drawn separately. Start it, cross what you have already written, and come back out.

Read **a**: the *a* of English *father*, kept short. One beat.

Your turn

- *Write it*: あ — horizontal, vertical, then the loop in one movement
- *Say it*: **a**, one beat, short

Your turn — review pulse

Give the daytime greeting, then write ? from memory.

Before you move on

Is the loop drawn as a separate circle, or in one movement? (**One movement**, crossing what you have already written.)

Source: Unicode Hiragana chart

3.2 り — two strokes, and a tap rather than an r

Write あ. Horizontal, vertical, loop.

Script — the shape

り

Two strokes, drawn left to right, and they never touch:

1. a **short left stroke**, curving gently down and to the right
2. a **long right descender**, starting higher, falling much further, and hooking left at the very bottom

The gap between them is the shape. So is the difference in length — the right stroke should fall roughly twice as far as the left.

Now the sound, and it is worth a moment. **Japanese r is not the English r**. It is a single **tap** of the tongue against the ridge behind the teeth — very close to the *r* of Spanish *pero*, and not far from the *dd* in an American saying *ladder*. Your tongue touches once and releases.

If you say an English *r* here you will be understood and you will sound foreign in a way that one minute of practice fixes.

Your turn

- *Write it:* り — short left stroke, then the long right descender. Leave the gap.
- *Say it:* り — one tap, not an English r
- *Say it:* り, then り — the first two signs of the word

Your turn — review pulse

Write り from memory before tracing り.

Before you move on

Which of り's two strokes falls further? (The **right** one, by about double.)

Source: Unicode Hiragana chart

3.3 か — three strokes, and a shape you will reuse

Write り. Short left, long right, gap between.

Script — the shape

か

Three strokes:

1. a **hooked left stroke** — down, curving right at the foot into a small hook
2. a **short vertical**, crossing the first stroke near its top and falling to the right of it
3. a **short dot**, up at the right, slanting down-right

Read **ka**: a clean *k*, then the short *a* of か. One beat.

Remember this shape more carefully than the others. **You are about to get a second sign out of it for free** — か is the base of が, and the difference between them is two small marks rather than a new character to learn.

Your turn

- *Write it:* か — hooked stroke, vertical, then the dot at the right
- *Say it:* **ka**, one beat

Your turn — review pulse

Write ?, then write the different sign that closes ????? and explain its particle reading.

Before you move on

Which stroke is written last? (The **dot**, at the upper right.)
Source: Unicode Hiragana chart

3.4 ` — two ticks, and every sign you know doubles

Write か. Then write こ, from Chapter 2.

Script — the mark

Here is the best bargain in the Japanese writing system.

Two short strokes, slanting down-right, written at the **upper right** of a sign:

`

It is called the **dakuten**, and it does one job: it **voices** the consonant. Voicing is what separates English *k* from *g*, or *s* from *z* — the same mouth position, with the vocal cords switched on.

So:

か *ka* → が *ga*

こ *ko* → ご *go*

No new shape. The sign underneath is exactly the one you already write; the marks sit above and to the right of it, small, and clear of the strokes.

This is worth pausing on, because it changes the size of the job in front of you. Hiragana has forty-six signs. Learning the dakuten does not add signs — it **doubles the ones you already have**, at the price of two ticks. Every *k* you know becomes a *g*, every *s* a *z*, every *t* a *d*, every *h* a *b*.

You have now met four signs that take it – は, こ, ち and か – and two of them are in the word this chapter is building.

Your turn

- Write it: か, then add the two ticks to make か[゛]. Say both.
- Write it: こ, then こ[゛]
- Say it: **ka** / **ga**, then **ko** / **go** — the same mouth, voice off and on

Your turn — review pulse

Write ????? from its five signs before adding any voice marks.

Before you move on

Does か[゛] need a new shape learned? (**No** — it is か plus two ticks.)
Source: Unicode Hiragana chart

3.5 と — two strokes, and they never meet

Write か[゛]. Then say what the two ticks did to it.

Script — the shape

と

Two strokes, and like り they stay apart:

1. a **short stroke** at the upper left, little more than a tick leaning down-right
2. a **long sweeping stroke** starting above and to the right of it, falling down and left, then curving out to the right at the bottom

The second stroke does the work. It should look like a single confident sweep, not a corner — the change of direction is a curve, not a bend.

Read **to**: a clean *t*, then the *o* of *more*, shortened. One beat.

Your turn

- *Write it:* と — the small tick, then the long sweep. Do not join them.
- *Say it:* **a, ri, ga, to** — four beats, and the word is nearly yours

Your turn — review pulse

Say the daytime greeting once without looking.

Before you move on

Which stroke is longer? (The **second**, the sweep.)

Source: Unicode Hiragana chart

3.6 う — two strokes, and a vowel that stretches

Write と. Tick, then sweep, no join.

Script — the shape

う

Two strokes, the simplest pair in this chapter:

1. a **short tick** at the top, roughly horizontal
2. a **wide curve** beneath it, falling from the upper left, bellying right, and tapering away to the lower left

Read **u**: close to the *oo* of *food* but shorter, and with the lips much less rounded than an English speaker expects. Do not push them forward.

What you've built — and what this sign does after と

Something happens when う follows と, and it is the reason the written word and the spoken word look like they disagree.

The five-sign sequence you are building ends と + う — *to* then *u*, which reads as five beats. But the final two signs are heard as a long **o**:

written: a-ri-ga-to-u

spoken: a-ri-ga-**too**

う after an o-sound does not add a syllable. It holds the one before it for a second beat. The beat is still there — Japanese counts it, and dropping it makes the word sound clipped and wrong — but it is the same vowel continuing, not a new one. Katakana will later receive a separate one-stroke length mark for the same job. Here the only written cue is the う you have just learned.

Your turn

- *Write it:* う — the tick, then the wide curve
- *Say it:* **to**, then **too** — one beat, then two, same vowel

Before you move on

Is the extra beat optional? (**No** — Japanese counts it, and dropping it sounds clipped.)

Source: Unicode Hiragana chart

3.7 ありがとう — no new sign, and a whole word

Write あ, り and か in a row. Then add the two ticks to the last one.

Script — the assembly

Here is the word you have been saying since Chapter 1:

ありがとう

Nothing in it is new. Take it sign by sign:

- あ — *a*, the three-stroke sign with the loop
- り — *ri*, short left, long right, tapped
- が — *ga*, which is か with the dakuten
- と — *to*, tick and sweep
- う — *u*, which here holds the *o* before it for a second beat

Five signs, five beats, and you can write every one.

That is the whole point of the last five lessons. In Chapter 1 this word was a sound you copied and a romanization you leaned on. It is now something you can read off a shop sign, and — more to the point — something you could write on a note without being able to say a single sentence of Japanese.

Read it slowly, once per sign, then at speed: *a-ri-ga-to-o*.

Your turn

- *Read it:* ありがとう — name each sign before you say the word
- *Write it:* ありがとう — all five, in order, without looking above
- *Say it:* **arigatou** — five beats, the last two one long o

Before you move on

How many signs did you have to learn for this word? (**Five** — but one of them was free, because が is か with two ticks.)

Source: Unicode Hiragana chart

3.8 ありがとう — thanks, from “this hardly ever happens”

Back to hiragana. Five signs are coming, and one small mark that unlocks a whole second row of sounds.

And one word from before: say *wani* and what it means.

Script — five signs and two small strokes

ありがとう — あ *a* + り *ri* + が *ga* + と *to* + う

あ *a*, り *ri*, と *to* and う *u* are ordinary hiragana. が is the new idea: it is the sign か *ka* with two short strokes added at the top right. That mark is the **dakuten**, and it voices the consonant — the same two strokes turn *ka* into *ga*, *sa* into *za*, *ta* into *da*, *ha* into *ba*. One mark, learned once, doubles how much of the script you can read.

The final う does not sound like *u* here. After と it stretches the *o*, so the word ends *-tō* and holds five beats: *a-ri-ga-to-o*. Hiragana lengthens a

vowel here by writing another vowel sign. Katakana will get its own tiny length lesson later.

The word, taken apart

The older form combines *aru*, “to exist,” with *katashi*, “difficult.” *Arigatashi* therefore meant literally “**hard to exist**” — that is, rare. Rare became precious, precious became grateful, and by the Edo period the word had settled into plain thanks. The *k* of *katashi* softened to *g* inside the compound, which is the same voicing the dakuten writes. Its historical kanji spelling can wait until those signs receive their own lessons.

So the memory hook is inside the word, not inside English: saying **ありがとう** is saying *this was not a thing that had to happen*. No English cousin exists, and inventing one would be worse than admitting that.

Your turn

- *Say it:* **ありがとう** — *a-ri-ga-to-o*, five beats] [REPEAT x2
- *Build:* か plus the dakuten → が
- *Connect:* *arigatashi* “hard to exist” → rare → precious → thanks

Your turn — review pulse

Write ? once from memory, then add the two dakuten strokes.

Before you move on

What did *arigatashi* mean literally? (Hard to exist.) What does the last う do? (It lengthens the *o*.)

Source: Wiktionary: **ありがとう**.

Chapter 4

Polite Thanks, Three More Signs

Modes: 👁 eyes (2) ✍ pen (3) 🗣 Hands-free start: none of the 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can add ございます to a known thank-you, read every sign, and choose the polite form for someone outside my close circle.

A short casual-versus-polite choice with every sign taught and the register decision checked independently.

4.1 さ — two strokes, and the ticks work here too

Write ありがとう. All five signs, no help.

Script — the shape

さ

Three strokes:

1. a short **horizontal**, near the top
2. a **short curving stroke** below it, falling down and left
3. a **separate small curve** at the foot, opening left — **not joined** to the stroke above it

Watch that gap. Most printed fonts join the second and third strokes into one continuous descender, so the さ you see on a screen looks like two

strokes. By hand it is three, and the break is real. Keep the handwritten gap even when a printed font closes it.

Read **sa**: a clean *s*, then the short *a*. One beat.

And now the bargain again — さ takes the dakuten:

さ *sa* → ざ *za*

Same mouth, voice switched on, two ticks at the upper right. That is the third voiced sign you have got for free. It will return in the polite ending ahead.

Your turn

- *Write it:* さ — horizontal, the short curve, then the detached foot curve
- *Write it:* ざ — the same, with two ticks
- *Say it:* **sa** / **za**

Your turn — review pulse

Say ?????, add the dakuten to ?, and recall how ?hard to exist? became thanks.

Before you move on

How many signs have the two ticks given you so far? (**Three** — が, ご and ざ.)

Source: Unicode Hiragana chart

4.2 ま — three strokes, and a loop you have drawn before

Write さ, then ざ.

Script — the shape

ま

Three strokes, and the order is top-down as always:

1. an **upper horizontal**, short
2. a **lower horizontal**, a little wider, below and parallel to it
3. a **looping vertical** that crosses both, falls, and curls left at the bottom

The third stroke is the same movement you learned on あ — down through what you have written, then a small loop at the foot. If あ's loop is comfortable, this one is already yours.

Read **ma**: as in English *mother*, shortened. One beat.

Your turn

- *Write it:* ま — two horizontals, then the looping vertical through them
- *Say it:* **ma**, one beat

Your turn — review pulse

Write ? from memory before tracing ?.

Before you move on

Which earlier sign uses the same looping last stroke? (あ.)
Source: Unicode Hiragana chart

4.3 す — two strokes, and a vowel you barely hear

Write ま. Two horizontals, then the loop.

Script — the shape

す

Two strokes:

1. a short **horizontal**, near the top

2. a **vertical** crossing it, falling, and finishing in a loop that closes back on itself before tailing away

The loop in す is tighter than ま's — it comes back and crosses its own line.

Read **su**: an *s*, then the *u* you met in う.

Why it's said this way

At the end of a word, and especially in ございます, that final *u* is usually **devoiced** — the mouth makes the shape, the beat is counted, but the vocal cords never switch on. What a listener hears is closer to *-mass* than *-masu*.

This is not sloppiness or fast speech. It is what standard Tokyo Japanese does, and saying a full clear *u* there is one of the most recognisable marks of a learner reading off a page.

The sign is still written. The beat is still counted. Only the voice drops out.

Your turn

- *Write it*: す — horizontal, then the vertical with its closing loop
- *Say it*: **su**, then the same with the voice off — a whispered ending

Your turn — review pulse

Write ? from memory before tracing ?.

Before you move on

Is the beat dropped along with the voice? (**No** — the beat is still counted.)

Source: Unicode Hiragana chart

4.4 ありがとうございます — politeness you cannot leave out

Say ありがとう once and rebuild が from か. This lesson adds the ending that makes it usable with a stranger, a shopkeeper, or a boss.

Script — five more signs, two of them dakuten

ございます — ご *go* + ざ *za* + い *i* + ま *ma* + す *su*

Two of the five are dakuten forms you can already build: ご is こ with the two strokes, and ざ is さ *sa* with them. い you have read since はい. Only ま *ma* and す *su* are genuinely new.

The whole phrase is ten beats — *a-ri-ga-to-o go-za-i-ma-su* — and the final す is normally said with the *u* barely voiced, close to a plain *s*.

Grammar Lens — politeness is grammar here, not word choice

ございます is a verb. It is the polite descendant of *aru*, “to be” — the same verb that sits inside ありがとう. The historical route runs *aru* to *gozaru* to ございます, where the ending -ます is the general politeness marker Japanese attaches to verbs.

That is the difference this chapter has to name. In many languages politeness is a choice between two words for “you.” Japanese instead marks it on the **predicate**, and every sentence has one, so every sentence is marked. There is no neutral setting: ありがとう to a friend and ありがとうございます to a stranger are not two styles of the same form, they are two different grammatical levels, and choosing wrongly is heard immediately.

At the far end of the system, even the verb can be replaced: ordinary *iu*, “to say,” has the respectful form *ossharu* and the humble form *mōsu*. Same act, three verbs, chosen by who is doing what to whom. That is **keigo**, and this lesson is only its front door. Their spellings belong in later, separately taught script lessons.

Your turn

- *Say it:* ありがとうございます — ten beats, final *su* light] [REPEAT x2
- *Choose:* a close friend → ありがとう; a shop assistant → ありがとうございます
- *Build:* こ → ご, さ → ざ

Before you move on

Which verb hides inside *ございます*? (*aru*, “to be.”) Can a Japanese sentence avoid marking politeness? (No — the predicate always carries a level.)

Source: Wiktionary: *ございます*.

4.5 Practice — the whole thank-you, off the page

Write *ありがとう*. Five signs, no help.

Script — the second half

ございます

Five more signs, and **again nothing here is new**:

- *こ* — *こ* from Chapter 2, with the dakuten
- *ざ* — *さ* from this chapter, with the dakuten
- *い* — from Chapter 2
- *ま* — from this chapter
- *す* — from this chapter, its *u* devoiced

Two of the five are signs you already had, wearing two ticks.

Why it's said this way

ありがとう on its own is warm and ordinary — friends, family, a shopkeeper you know. *ありがとうございます* is the same thanks in polite form, and it is what you want for a stranger, a colleague, anyone serving you.

The difference is not strength. Adding *ございます* does not mean you are *more* grateful; it means you are being **more formal about it**. Getting that wrong in either direction is the commonest register mistake a beginner makes.

If you are unsure which to use, use the long one. Being slightly too polite in Japanese costs you nothing.

The exchange

Two voices, and every sign on the page is one you can write:

A: こんにちは

B: こんにちは

A: ありがとうございます

B: はい

What you've built this chapter

Eight new signs and one mark. The mark is the part worth remembering:

- **eight shapes** — ありがとうさます
- **one mark** — 〃, which turned か into が, こ into ご, さ into ざ

Ten signs in ありがとうございます, and only eight of them cost you a shape. The dakuten is the first thing in this book that made the job *smaller* the further you went into it, and it keeps doing that: every *k*, *s*, *t* and *h* sign you ever learn arrives with a voiced twin already attached.

Your turn

- *Read it:* ありがとうございます — name each of the ten signs, then say it
- *Write it:* ございます — five signs, two of them with ticks
- *Say it:* arigatou gozaimasu — and let the final u go quiet

Your turn — review pulse

Give plain thanks, then polite thanks. Name the dakuten and the ?hard to exist? memory hook.

Before you move on

Which form would you use with a stranger — the short one or the long one? (The **long** one; being slightly too polite costs nothing.)

Source: Unicode Hiragana chart

Chapter 5

Nihongo, Built in Small Blocks

Modes: 👁 eyes (1) ✍ pen (6) 🔄 Hands-free start: none of the 7 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can write 日 and 本, assemble 語 from three practised components, and read 日本語 as nihongo.

Three kanji read as one known word after the simple signs and the complex sign's components were taught separately.

5.1 日 — one sun, four strokes

Say *ni-chi*: two even beats. Today you attach those beats to one kanji, but you write only one new shape.

Script — build the sun

日

Write four strokes:

1. the left side, down
2. the top and right side as one turning stroke
3. the short middle line, left to right
4. the bottom line, left to right

The middle line touches both sides. Keep the shape taller than it is wide.

Here it is read *nichi*. It carries the broad idea **sun/day**. Kanji can have more than one reading; this lesson asks for only the reading in the word ahead.

Your turn

- *Trace it:* 日 — side, corner, middle, bottom
- *Write it:* 日 once from memory
- *Say it:* **nichi**, two beats

Your turn — review pulse

Read ????? once and write its base sign ? without a model.

Before you move on

Which line sits inside the box? (The **middle horizontal** line.)

Source: KanjiVG stroke-order data.

5.2 本 — a tree with its root marked

Write 日 once. Read it *nichi* here.

Script — five strokes

本

Write the large tree first, then mark its base:

1. top horizontal
2. centre vertical, down through it
3. left-falling branch
4. right-falling branch
5. short horizontal across the lower stem

That last stroke is the memory hook: it points to the **root**, so the sign came to mean **origin**. In the word ahead, read it *hon*, one beat ending in *n*.

Your turn

- *Trace it:* 本 — cross, two branches, root mark
- *Write it:* 本 once without looking
- *Say it:* **hon**, one beat

Your turn — review pulse

Write ? once from memory before beginning the new kanji.

Before you move on

Which stroke comes last? (The short **root mark**.)
Source: KanjiVG stroke-order data.

5.3 言 — build the speech side first

Write 本 and point to its short root mark. Now set it aside.

Script — one component, not a whole word yet

言

This is the **speech** component. Write it as a small top mark, three horizontal lines, then a three-stroke box. Keep the horizontals distinct and the box narrow.

Do not memorise a vocabulary word for it today. Its job is visual: when it sits on the left, it signals that the larger kanji has something to do with words or speech. The next two tiny lessons build the right side.

Your turn

- *Trace it:* 言 slowly, top to bottom
- *Cover and write:* 言 once
- *Point to:* the small box at the bottom

Your turn — review pulse

Write ? once from memory before building the speech component.

Before you move on

Where will this component sit in the larger sign? (On the **left**.)
Source: KanjiVG stroke-order data.

5.4 五 — four strokes for the sound side

Trace 𠄎 once. Say “speech side.”

Script — the top-right piece

五

Write four strokes: top horizontal; a short vertical and turn; a second horizontal; then the long bottom horizontal. Keep the shape wider than tall.

This sign means **five** on its own. Here, you only need its second job: it helps cue the sound *go* inside the larger kanji that is coming.

Your turn

- *Trace it:* 五 — top, turn, middle, bottom
- *Write it:* 五 once from memory
- *Say it:* **go**, one beat

Before you move on

Which line is longest? (The **bottom** line.)
Source: KanjiVG stroke-order data.

5.5 口 — close a box in three strokes

Write 口 once. Leave a little space below it with your finger.

Script — the lower-right piece

口

Write three strokes:

1. left side, down
2. top and right side as one turning stroke
3. bottom, left to right, closing the box

It is the picture-sign for a **mouth**. In the larger kanji ahead, it sits under 五. Today the whole job is one small square.

Your turn

- *Trace it:* □ — side, corner, close
- *Write it:* □ once from memory
- *Stack:* point below 五, where □ will go

Your turn — review pulse

Read ????? from memory before drawing the new box component.

Before you move on

Which stroke closes the box? (The **bottom** stroke.)
Source: KanjiVG stroke-order data.

5.6 語 — assemble; do not memorise fourteen loose strokes

Point left and picture 言. Point upper-right and picture 五.
Point lower-right and picture 口. Those are all the pieces.

Script — three known blocks become one sign

語

Build it in blocks:

1. write 言, narrow, on the left
2. write 五 in the upper-right
3. write 口 directly under 五

Read the whole sign *go*, one beat. It means **language** here. There are fourteen strokes, but there are not fourteen new decisions: you already practised every block separately.

Your turn

- *Trace it:* 語 by naming the blocks — speech, five, mouth
- *Cover and build:* 言 + 五 + 口
- *Read it:* **go** — language

Before you move on

Which component fills the left side? (言, the speech component.)
Source: KanjiVG stroke-order data.

5.7 日本語 — three characters, and no single sound each

Say こんにちは (*konnichiwa*). Now write 日, 本, and 語 once each. This lesson joins those three already-practised kanji to name the language.

Script — kanji, and the readings problem

日本語 — *ni* + *hon* + *go*

These are **kanji**: characters borrowed from Chinese, each carrying a meaning rather than a sound. 日 is sun or day. 本 is origin or root. 語 is language. So 日本 is “sun-origin” — the country the sun rises from — and 日本語 is its language.

Now the fact that makes kanji unlike any letter you have learned. A kanji does not have *a* sound. 日 is read *niichi*, *jitsu*, *hi*, *bi*, or *ka*, depending on the word it stands in — and in 日本 it is shortened again, to *ni*. There is no sensible way to teach “the sound of 日.” What a lesson can teach is the **word**: you learn 日本語 as *nihongo*, and the reading of each character comes along with it.

Two families of readings explain the spread. The **on** reading is Japan’s version of the Chinese pronunciation, imported with the character. The

kun reading is a native Japanese word written with a borrowed character that already meant the same thing. 日本語 uses the imported reading family throughout. The older spelling behind the greeting is irregular even by those standards, so it remains postponed rather than becoming an unexplained decoding test.

The word, taken apart

Here the cousin web finally works — just not toward English. The on-readings *nichi*, *hon*, *go* are borrowings of Middle Chinese, so 日本語 has genuine relatives: Mandarin writes the same three characters and says *Rìběnyǔ*; Korean borrowed the same compound as *ilbon-eo*. Same characters, related imported sounds, one meaning, three languages. That is a real, checkable connection, and it is the honest replacement for the Latin roots that anchor a European language. English has no share in it.

Your turn

- *Say it:* 日本語 — *ni-ho-n-go*, four beats] [REPEAT x2
- *Name:* 日 sun or day; 本 origin; 語 language
- *Connect:* Mandarin *Rìběnyǔ*, Korean *ilbon-eo*, same three characters

Your turn — review pulse

Build ? once from ?, ?, and ? before joining the full word.

Before you move on

What does 日本 mean literally? (Sun-origin.) Does 日 have one pronunciation? (No — the word it appears in chooses one.)

Source: Wiktionary: 日本語.

Chapter 6

Coffee in Katakana, Three Shapes

Modes: 👁 eyes (1) ✍ pen (3) 🖐 Hands-free start: none of the 4 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can write コ, ー, and ヒ, read コーヒー as four morae, and explain that the long mark holds the preceding vowel.

A borrowed word made from only three distinct katakana shapes, each taught before the full word appears.

6.1 コ — same sound, a new script

Read 日本語 once. Now switch jobs: the next word came from abroad, so Japanese normally writes it in katakana.

Script — two angular strokes

コ

Write two strokes:

1. top horizontal, then turn down at the right
2. bottom horizontal, left to right

Read it *ko*, the same mora as hiragana こ. The sound is not new. Only the script is new: katakana is angular and commonly marks borrowed words.

Your turn

- *Trace it:* コ — top-and-side, then bottom
- *Write it:* コ once from memory
- *Contrast:* こ is hiragana; コ is katakana; both say *ko*

Your turn — review pulse

Trace ? once. Then recall why Japanese kanji readings connect to Chinese without giving each sign one fixed sound.

Before you move on

Does コ introduce a new sound? (**No** — only a new written shape.)
Source: Unicode Katakana chart.

6.2 — — one line, one extra beat

Write コ and say *ko*. Hold its vowel once: *ko-o*.

Script — length lives on the page

コ—

Write one horizontal stroke after the katakana sign. This mark is the **chōonpu**, the long-vowel mark. It does not have a sound by itself. It tells you to hold the vowel before it for one more mora.

So コ is *ko*, while コ— is *kō*: two beats, *ko-o*. Keep the line centred and about as wide as the sign before it.

Your turn

- *Write it:* コ, then —
- *Tap:* *ko* — one; hold *o* — two
- *Read it:* コ— as **kō**, not *ko*

Your turn — review pulse

Write ? once from memory, then return to the one-stroke length mark.

Before you move on

How many extra beats does **—** add? (**One.**)
Source: Unicode Katakana chart.

6.3 ㇏ — two strokes complete the inventory

Write ㇏— and tap its two beats: *ko-o*.

Script — the last new shape

㇏

Write two strokes:

1. a short stroke from right toward left
2. a longer vertical stroke that turns and sweeps right at the bottom

Read it *hi*, one mora. Japanese *h* is light; keep the vowel clean, like the *ee* in *machine* but short.

Now every distinct sign in the word ahead is known: ㇏, —, and ㇏.

Your turn

- *Trace it:* ㇏ — short top, long bent body
- *Write it:* ㇏ once from memory
- *Build:* ㇏ + — + ㇏ + —

Your turn — review pulse

Write ? once from memory before switching back to katakana.

Before you move on

Which stroke bends to the right? (The **second**, longer stroke.)
Source: Unicode Katakana chart.

6.4 コーヒー — the third system, and a word that really is a cousin

Recall how hiragana writes a long vowel: it writes the vowel twice, as in いいえ. Katakana does it differently, and this word shows how.

Script — katakana, the borrowed-word script

コーヒー — コ *ko* + ィ + ヒ *hi* + ー

This is **katakana**, the third system, and it is a full twin of hiragana: the same beats, the same five vowels, different shapes. Its job is different too. Katakana marks a word as coming from outside — borrowed vocabulary, foreign names, sound effects, scientific terms.

The two scripts are siblings by origin as well as by sound. Hiragana came from whole Chinese characters written in flowing cursive; katakana came from *fragments* of characters, shorthand that monks scribbled beside a text to remember how to read it. ㇿ and ㇿ even trace back to the same character, which is why they still look alike.

ー is the *chōonpu*, the long-vowel bar. It holds the previous vowel for one more beat, and it belongs to katakana almost exclusively. So コーヒー is four beats: *ko-o-hi-i*.

The word, taken apart

コーヒー is **coffee**, and it entered Japanese from Dutch *koffie* through the Nagasaki trade. Dutch had it from Turkish *kahve*, and Turkish from Arabic *qahwa* — which is exactly where English *coffee* comes from as well.

So this word genuinely is a cousin of one you already own. Notice what kind of cousin: not an inherited relative, but the same borrowed object arriving from the same Arabic source by two different roads. That is the honest shape of most Japanese–English overlap. Other passengers on those roads include *pan*, “bread,” from Portuguese *pão*, and *arubaito*, “a part-time job,” from German *Arbeit*. Their katakana signs can wait for their own one-sign lessons.

Your turn

- Say it: コーヒー — *ko-o-hi-i*, four beats] [REPEAT x2

- *Trace it:* Arabic *qahwa* → Turkish *kahve* → Dutch *koffie* → コーヒー
- *Decide:* a borrowed word is written in katakana, not hiragana

Before you move on

Which script signals a borrowed word? (Katakana.) How many beats does コーヒー hold? (Four.)

Source: Wiktionary: コーヒー.

Chapter 7

The Doorway Exchange

Modes: ⇄ voice (1) ⇄ Hands-free start: all 1 lesson.

By the end of this chapter: I can greet, name the language, answer yes or no, and thank someone politely while listening, speaking, reading, and writing independently.

A six-line doorway exchange using only words and signs already taught in the preceding six chapters.

7.1 Practice — one daytime exchange, three scripts

Before reading on, retrieve three answers: the daytime greeting, the short yes, and the short no. Nothing new is added here.

The exchange — every line already learned

A: こんにちは。 — *Konnichiwa.* B: こんにちは。 — *Konnichiwa.* A: 日本語? — *Nihongo?* B: はい。 — *Hai.* A: ありがとうございます。 — *Arigatō gozaimasu.* B: いいえ。 — *Iie.*

Three lines of hiragana, one of kanji, and no word that has not been taught. Japanese lets a bare noun with a rising tone stand as a question, so 日本語 with the voice lifted is a complete and natural way to ask “Japanese, then?” — and はい answers it. B’s closing いいえ is the modest “not at all” that waves thanks away.

An ordinary Japanese page mixes systems: hiragana carries much of the grammar, kanji carries many content words, and katakana commonly carries borrowings. The six earlier chapters introduced those systems separately; this payoff is where they finally work together.

Your turn

1. **Listen:** hear one line with no text and identify greeting, language, answer, or thanks.
2. **Speak:** take B's part while the other lines are read aloud.
3. **Read:** run both voices from Japanese only, with the romanization covered.
4. **Write:** hear 日本語, wait ten seconds, and write the three kanji with no visible model.

Score the four actions separately. A fluent spoken line cannot cover a missing kanji in writing, and recognition cannot cover an unanswered spoken cue.

Your turn — review pulse

From memory, write ??, ???, ?????, ?????, ???, and ?????. Circle the dakuten and say why the borrowed word uses katakana.

Before you move on

Run the exchange once from memory. If a line stalls, return to that one lesson rather than rereading the chapter.

Chapter 8

One Goodbye, Sign by Sign

Modes: ⇄ voice (2) ✍ pen (4) ⇄ Hands-free start: first 1 of 6 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can hear and say sayōnara on five morae, write its three new hiragana signs, and read and write the complete farewell independently.

A context-dependent farewell whose sound and meaning arrive before three separately taught new signs and whose payoff scores all four skills.

8.1 Hear *sayōnara* — one way to say goodbye

Write katakana □, give the daytime greeting, then run one doorway exchange aloud. Close the text before the new expression begins.

What to know first

sa-yō-na-ra — **goodbye**, at a parting

Hear five morae: *sa / yo / o / na / ra*. The held *ō* occupies two beats, just as the final long vowel did in *arigatō*. Listen twice. Tap five even beats, then say the expression once. Its writing waits for the next four tiny sessions.

This is **one** Japanese farewell, not a universal line for every departure. Relationship and situation can call for other expressions; those will receive their own lessons rather than being smuggled into this one.

Your turn

Choose the parting cue rather than the meeting cue. Say *sayōnara* on five beats, then stop before trying to spell it.

Before you move on

Say the five beats once with no writing visible.

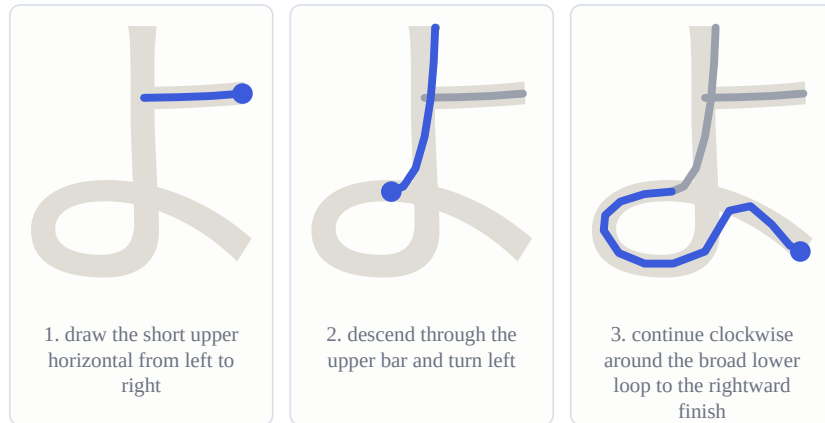
Sources: Japan Foundation Marugoto A1 vocabulary and Japan Foundation Irodori Starter lesson 1.

8.2 よ — the second sound gets a shape

Read *ありがとう*, then point to *ー* in *コーヒー* and say what it does. Tap *sayōnara* on five beats. Today adds one shape only.

Script — one sign

How it is written — 2 strokes · 1 pen lift · 3 movements



Stroke order after Sirgazil, Hiragana ㇰ stroke order animation.gif, hiragana ㇰ, 26 frames, 2.6 seconds (Wikimedia Commons, 1 October 2009; corrected first-stroke direction 4 January 2012)

This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How よ is written, stroke by stroke

よ — *yo*

Keep the printed sign visible. Notice the short upper mark, then the longer line that falls, turns, and loops at the lower right. Finger-trace the whole route slowly. Say *yo* only after the finger stops.

Your turn

- *Trace it:* よ, once with the model visible
- *Copy:* よ, once beside the model
- *Say it:* yo, one mora

Before you move on

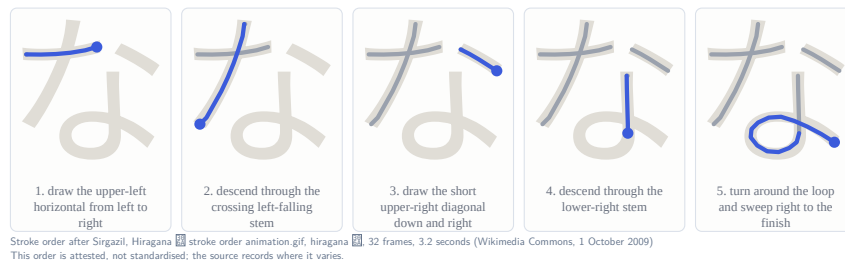
Cover the model, wait five seconds, and write よ once.
Source: Unicode Hiragana chart.

8.3 な — one sign for *na*

Write よ from memory. Say why *arigatō* once meant “hard to exist,” then point to the dakuten in が. One new hiragana sign follows.

Script — one sign

How it is written — 4 strokes · 3 pen lifts · 5 movements



How な is written, stroke by stroke

な — *na*

Keep な visible. Find its compact left side first, then the separate right side with the small crossing mark and low loop. Trace each part without rushing; the two sides must not collapse into one blob.

Your turn

- *Copy:* な, with the model visible
- *Check:* compact left side; open right side
- *Say it:* na, one mora

Before you move on

Look away, say *na*, and write な once.
Source: Unicode Hiragana chart.

8.4 ら — the last new shape

Write よ and な from memory, then write katakana ヒ and say why コーヒー uses katakana. Do not force the new hiragana into that borrowed-word script.

Script — one sign

ら — *ra*

Keep ら visible. It begins with a short top mark. The lower stroke starts separately, descends, bends right, and opens rather than closing into a circle. Japanese *r* is a light tongue tap; one careful tap is enough here.

Your turn

Look at ら for five seconds. Cover it, wait five seconds, and write it once. Uncover only to compare the open lower curve.

Before you move on

Read the sign once, then stop.
Source: Unicode Hiragana chart.

8.5 さようなら — assemble what the hand already knows

Run the doorway exchange once, write ま, then say the farewell on five beats. Write よ, な, and ら separately.

Script — join five known signs

さ | よ | う | な | ら

sa / yo / o / na / ra

The five signs are all known. さ and う return from the thank-you chapters; よ, な, and ら are the three new shapes. In this word, よう carries the held *yō*: the written う owns the extra beat.

Your turn

1. Point and read: さ | よ | う | な | ら.
2. Cover the romanization and read さようなら.
3. Cover everything, wait ten seconds, and write the five signs.

Before you move on

Circle う and tap the beat it contributes.

Source: Japan Foundation Marugoto A1 vocabulary.

8.6 Practice — meet, thank, then part

Write す, then give the daytime greeting and plain thanks. Those two social jobs are already secure. The new third job is leaving.

What to know first

さようなら。

Use this line for the parting situation practised here. Japanese has other exit formulae for other relationships and settings; success means choosing and producing this taught farewell, not claiming that it fits every goodbye.

Your turn

1. **Listen:** hear *konnichiwa* or *sayōnara* and identify meeting or parting.
2. **Speak:** answer a parting cue with *sayōnara* on five morae.
3. **Read:** cover the romanization and read さようなら sign by sign.
4. **Write:** hear the word, wait ten seconds, and write all five signs.

Score the four actions separately. A remembered sound cannot cover missing writing, and a copied form cannot cover a missing spoken response.

Before you move on

Stop after one accurate four-skill pass. Speed and alternate farewells come later.

Sources: Japan Foundation Marugoto A1 vocabulary and Japan Foundation Irodori Starter lesson 1.

Chapter 9

One More Time, Please

Modes: ⇄ voice (7) ✍ pen (5) ⇄ Hands-free start: first 1 of 12 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say that I do not understand, politely ask for one repetition, read and write the earned block もういちど, and write five new hiragana forms without a chart.

A spoken repair assembled from independently learned pieces, with decoding and dictation limited to the signs the learner has actually earned.

9.1 すみません — open the repair gently

Hear the farewell in your mind, say it, read さようなら, and write it once. Now imagine that the other person has spoken and you missed it. Do not guess; open a repair.

What to know first

すみません。 — *su-mi-ma-se-n* — excuse me; I am sorry

Five morae, each given room. This polite expression can apologise, attract attention, or soften the request that follows. Here it means: “Excuse me — I need help with what was just said.”

Its shape is useful, not a literal translation burden. It is related to *sumu*, “to be settled or finished,” in a polite negative form: the small social debt is not yet settled. Keep the practical job first.

Your turn

- *Hear:* *sumimasen* → point to **repair**, not **farewell**
- *Say it:* *su / mi / ma / se / n* [REPEAT x2]
- *Choose:* you missed a word → すみません

The Japanese spelling is exposure for now. The next two lessons isolate its two new signs before either becomes load-bearing.

Before you move on

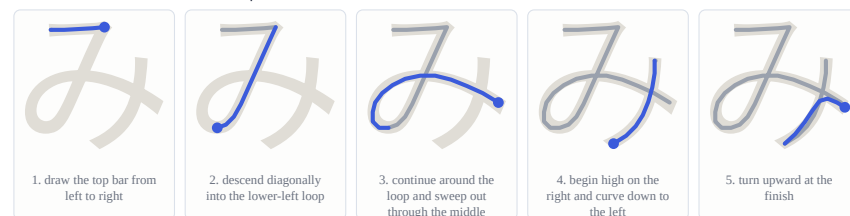
Say it once, then stop. The request itself comes later.
Source: Japan Foundation Irodori Starter lesson 2, pp. 1–3.

9.2 み — one looped bridge

Say *sumimasen* once, then write known ま and な. The new sign shares the *m* opening but carries a different vowel.

Script — the shape

How it is written — 2 strokes · 1 pen lift · 5 movements



Stroke order after Sirgazil, Hiragana ㇰ stroke order animation.gif, hiragana ㇰ 29 frames, 2.9 seconds (Wikimedia Commons, 1 October 2009)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How み is written, stroke by stroke

み — *mi*

Write it in two strokes. First make the bent left body, ending in a small turn. Then begin at the upper right, sweep down through the middle, and finish by lifting to the right. Say *mi* only when the second stroke ends.

Your turn

1. Trace み once with a finger.
2. Trace it once with a pencil.
3. Point to み inside すみません; do not decode the other signs yet.

Before you move on

Cover the model and air-write the two strokes once.

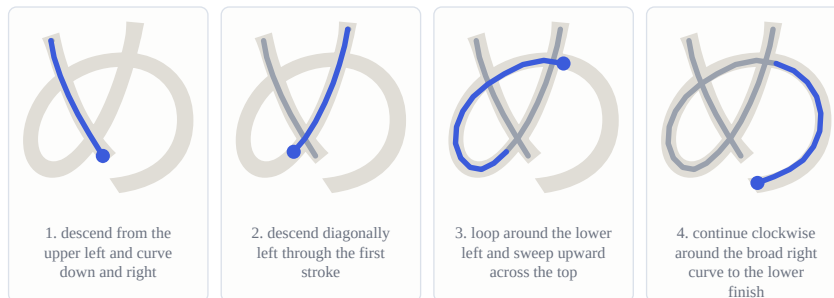
Source: Unicode Hiragana chart; stroke order per *Hitsujun Shido no Tebiki* (Japanese Ministry of Education, 1958).

9.3 め — cross, loop, release

Find み in すみません, then say the five-mora repair opener.

Script — the shape

How it is written — 2 strokes · 1 pen lift · 4 movements



Stroke order after Sirgazil, Hiragana め stroke order animation.gif, hiragana め 32 frames, 3.2 seconds (Wikimedia Commons, 1 October 2009)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How め is written, stroke by stroke

め — me

Two strokes. The short first stroke leans down to the right. The longer second stroke crosses it, curves into an open loop, and releases at the lower right. Keep that final opening visible; do not close it into a circle.

Your turn

- *Copy:* め once with the model visible
- *Read it:* point to み, then め and say *mi*, *me*
- *Find:* circle め inside すみません

Before you move on

Write め once more while saying *me*.

Source: Unicode Hiragana chart; stroke order per *Hitsujun Shido no Tebiki* (Japanese Ministry of Education, 1958).

9.4 よく — how fully?

Say *sumimasen*. Point to み and め inside it.

What to know first

よく — *yo-ku* — well; fully

Two morae. *Yoku* is the adverbial partner of *yoi*, “good.” In the coming line, it says that understanding did not happen **well** or **fully**. It does not itself mean “understand.”

You already write よ. Treat く as visible support for now; its own tiny writing lesson follows.

Your turn

- *Hear:* *yoku* → choose **well/fully**
- *Say it:* *yo / ku* [REPEAT x2]
- *Point to:* known よ, then supported く

Before you move on

Say *yoku* once without adding the rest of the sentence.

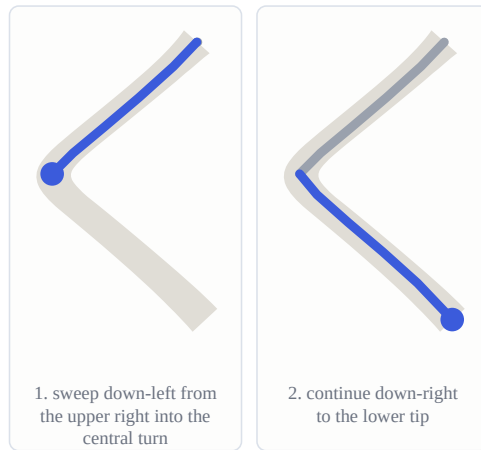
Source: Japan Foundation Irodori Starter lesson 2, p. 1.

9.5 < — one angled stroke

Write known ㇿ and say *yoku*.

Script — the shape

How it is written — one unbroken stroke · 2 moves



Stroke order after Sirgazil, Hiragana ㇿ stroke order animation.gif, hiragana ㇿ, 20 frames, 2.0 seconds (Wikimedia Commons, 8 March 2010)

This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How < is written, stroke by stroke

< — *ku*

One stroke. Begin high on the right, sweep down-left to the point, then turn and sweep down-right. Keep it narrow and open. The turn is part of the same stroke.

Your turn

1. Look at < for five seconds.
2. Hide it and write the one angled stroke.
3. Reveal, check, then join known ㇿ + < → ㇿ<.

Before you move on

Read よく once without romanization.

Source: Unicode Hiragana chart; stroke order per *Hitsujun Shido no Tebiki* (Japanese Ministry of Education, 1958).

9.6 わかりません — I do not understand

Read よく, then open a repair with *sumimasen*.

What to know first

わかりません。 — *wa-ka-ri-ma-se-n* — I do not understand

Six morae. The *wakari*- part carries “understand”; polite **-masen** makes the predicate negative. Japanese often leaves out “I” when the situation already makes the experiencer obvious.

Combine the two known pieces only in sound for now:

yoku wakarimasen — I do not understand well / fully

Your turn

- *Hear: wakarimasen* → choose **does not understand**
- *Say it: wa / ka / ri / ma / se / n*
- *Repair: yoku wakarimasen*

Before you move on

Do not add an invented pronoun. The short Japanese line is complete here.

Source: Japan Foundation Irodori Starter lesson 2, pp. 1–2.

9.7 ど — voice a sign you already own

Write と. Add the two-stroke dakuten beside it. Say *wakari-masen* once as the reason a repetition may be needed.

Script — carry the voicing mark

と *to* + “ → ど *do*

The base shape does not change. Write と first, then add the two short dakuten strokes at the upper right. The mark voices the opening consonant: *t* becomes *d* while the vowel stays *o*.

Your turn

1. Copy と → ど once.
2. Cover the model and write the voiced sign from the heard mora *do*.
3. Read と / ど as *to* / *do* without changing the vowel.

Before you move on

Write ど once more from memory.

Source: Unicode Hiragana chart; voicing pattern and stroke order per *Hitsujun Shido no Tebiki* (Japanese Ministry of Education, 1958).

9.8 もう — one more time begins here

Say *sumimasen, yoku wakarimasen*. Write め and ど once.

What to know first

もう — *mō* — again; one more

Two morae: *mo* / *o*. The macron in *mō* hides the second beat, but the Japanese spelling shows it with final う. In other settings this adverb can mean “already” or “more.” A request for repetition selects “again.”

Your turn

- *Hear*: *mō* in a repair → choose **again**
- *Say it*: *mo* / *o* and tap twice
- *Point to*: も | う; う owns the held second beat

Before you move on

Say it once more, keeping both beats.

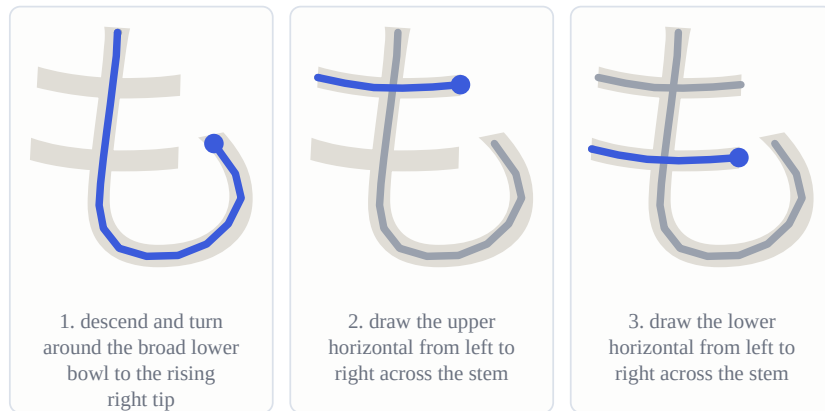
Source: Japan Foundation Irodori Starter lesson 2, pp. 1–3.

9.9 も — two bars, then the curve

Write known う and み, then say *mo* / *o*.

Script — the shape

How it is written — 3 strokes · 2 pen lifts · 3 movements



Stroke order after Sirgazil, Hiragana stroke order animation.gif, hiragana , 28 frames, 2.8 seconds (Wikimedia Commons, 1 October 2009)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How も is written, stroke by stroke

も — *mo*

Three strokes. Draw the central curve first, from the upper left down and around. Then add the upper short horizontal and the lower short horizontal. Both bars cross the central stroke.

Your turn

1. Copy も once.

2. Hide it for ten seconds and write it again.
3. Add known う: もう. Read *mo* / *o*.

Before you move on

Cover the model and write もう once.

Source: Unicode Hiragana chart; stroke order per *Hitsujun Shido no Tebiki* (Japanese Ministry of Education, 1958).

9.10 いちど — one time, all known signs

Write い, ち, and と. Add the dakuten to と and read the result *do*. Write め once as a review pulse.

What to know first

いちど — *i-chi-do* — one time; once

The word is built transparently: *ichi* is “one,” and *do* counts one occurrence. All four visible marks are already yours: い + ち + と + “ ”.

Now join it to the previous word:

もういちど — *mō ichido* — one more time

Your turn

1. Hear *i* / *chi* / *do* without looking.
2. Write いちど from the three morae.
3. Read もういちど, keeping the two beats in もう.

Before you move on

Circle the dakuten. It changes the final mora, not the first two.

Source: Japan Foundation Irodori Starter lesson 2, pp. 1–3.

9.11 おねがいします — please, as a polite request

Read いちど. Say *sumimasen*, *yoku wakarimasen*. Write く.

What to know first

おねがいします。 — *o-ne-ga-i shi-ma-su* — please; I request it

The pieces make the social direction visible: respectful *o-*, *negai* “request or wish,” and polite *shimasu* “do.” Learn the whole as the courteous request ending. Do not translate each piece while speaking.

The common kanji spelling can wait. This chapter earns the sound and social use first, without switching writing systems mid-ramp.

Your turn

- *Hear: onegaishimasu* → choose a **polite request**
- *Say it: onegaishimasu* once at an even pace
- *Join: mō ichido, onegaishimasu*

Before you move on

Keep the tone even and courteous; volume does not make the request more polite.

Source: Japan Foundation Irodori Starter lesson 2, pp. 1–3.

9.12 もういちど、おねがいします — ask for one more pass

Write み, め, く, と, も. Say *sumimasen, yoku wakarimasen*. Then retrieve *mō, ichido*, and *onegaishimasu* separately.

What to know first

もういちど、おねがいします。

mō ichido, onegai shimasu — one more time, please

Nothing new is hidden inside the line. もう supplies “again,” いちど supplies “one time,” and おねがいします makes the request polite. The first two words are now readable; the final expression remains supported exposure until its own longer script runway is complete.

Your turn

1. **Listen:** distinguish *sumimasen* from *mō ichido, onegaishimasu*.
2. **Speak:** say the opener, then the request, with a small pause.
3. **Read:** independently read もういちど; use the printed support for the rest.
4. **Write:** from dictation, write only the independently earned block もういちど.

Before you move on

Stop after one accurate repair. Chapter 10 will ask for slower speech instead.

Source: Japan Foundation Irodori Starter lesson 2, pp. 1–3.

Chapter 10

A Little More Slowly

Modes: ⇄ voice (7) ✍ pen (5) ⇄ Hands-free start: none of the 12 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can ask for slower speech, close the repair with *wakarimashita*, read and write the repair lines earned in the previous chapter, and write five new hiragana signs.

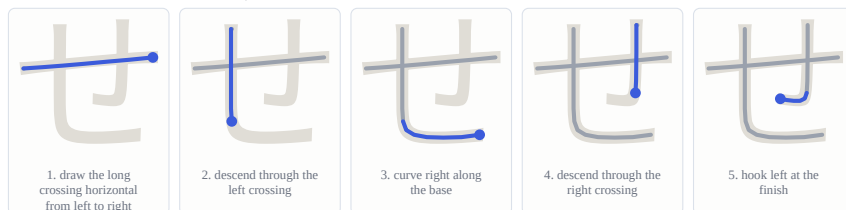
A second repair strategy assembled from seven tiny lexical steps while independent reading and writing stay inside the learner's earned script boundary.

10.1 せ — close the opener

Ask for one repetition. Then hear the farewell in your mind, say it, read *さようなら*, and write its final ら. Write known す, み, ま, ん separately. Only the fourth sign of *sumimasen* is still missing.

Script — the shape

How it is written — 3 strokes · 2 pen lifts · 5 movements



Stroke order after Sirgazil, Hiragana stroke order animation.gif, hiragana 33 frames, 3.3 seconds (Wikimedia Commons, 1 October 2009)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How せ is written, stroke by stroke

せ — *se*

Three strokes: a short horizontal, a longer crossing horizontal with a small hook, then a vertical curve through the right side. Keep the two horizontals separate.

Your turn

1. Copy せ once.
2. Hide it and write it after ten seconds.
3. Join the five known blocks: す | み | ま | せ | ん.

Before you move on

Read すみません once without romanization.

Source: Unicode Hiragana chart; stroke order per *Hitsujun Shido no Tebiki* (Japanese Ministry of Education, 1958).

10.2 お — the respectful opening sign

Say *onegaishimasu*, write せ, then retrieve *yoku* as “well.”

Script — the shape

お — *o*

Three strokes. Write the short top horizontal, then the long central stroke that curves left and loops right. Finish with the small separate mark at upper right.

Your turn

- *Trace it:* お once
- *Copy:* お once with the model visible
- *Find:* point to the first sign in おねがいします

Before you move on

Cover the model and air-write all three strokes.

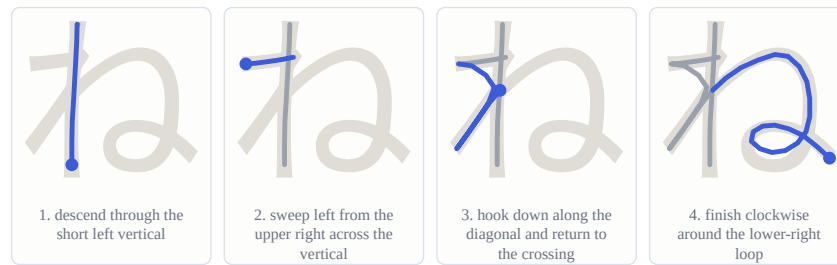
Source: Unicode Hiragana chart; stroke order per *Hitsujun Shido no Tebiki* (Japanese Ministry of Education, 1958).

10.3 ね — finish the polite request

Write お, then known が, い, し, ま, す. Say the whole request ending once. One written mora remains between お and が.

Script — the shape

How it is written — 2 strokes · 1 pen lift · 4 movements



Stroke order after Sirgazil, Hiragana stroke order animation.gif, hiragana 35 frames, 3.5 seconds (Wikimedia Commons, 1 October 2009)

This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ね is written, stroke by stroke

ね — *ne*

Two strokes. First a short vertical. Second, cross it from the upper right, hook left, sweep down, and finish with a small loop at the lower right.

Your turn

1. Copy ね once.
2. Hide it and write it from *ne*.
3. Assemble お | ね | が | い | し | ま | す.

Before you move on

Read おねがいします without romanization, then stop.

Source: Unicode Hiragana chart; stroke order per *Hitsujun Shido no Tebiki* (Japanese Ministry of Education, 1958).

10.4 すこし — ask for a small change

Ask for one repetition, then write known す, こ, and ね.

What to know first

すこし — *su-ko-shi* — a little

Three morae. This word makes a request smaller and gentler: not a completely different explanation, only **a little** adjustment. The last sign is exposure for one lesson; its own writing step comes next.

Your turn

- *Hear*: *sukoshi* → choose **a little**
- *Say it*: *su / ko / shi* [REPEAT x2]
- *Point to*: known す, known こ, supported final sign

Before you move on

Keep it to three even beats.

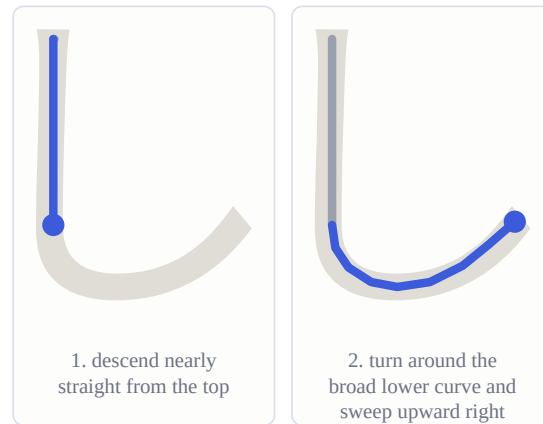
Source: Japan Foundation Irodori Starter lesson 2, pp. 1–3.

10.5 し — one falling curve

Say *sukoshi*. Write す, こ, and review み.

Script — the shape

How it is written — one unbroken stroke · 2 moves



Stroke order after Sirgazil, Hiragana し stroke order animation.gif, hiragana し, 23 frames, 2.3 seconds (Wikimedia Commons, 1 October 2009)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How し is written, stroke by stroke

し — *shi*

One stroke. Begin high, descend almost vertically, then curve gently up and to the right. Do not add a second stroke or close the curve.

Your turn

1. Trace し once.
2. Hide it and write the single curve.
3. Join す | こ | し and read the three morae.

Before you move on

Read すこし once without support.

Source: Unicode Hiragana chart; stroke order per *Hitsujun Shido no Tebiki* (Japanese Ministry of Education, 1958).

10.6 ゆっくり — slowly, with a held beat

Read すこし, then write known く, り, and し.

What to know first

ゆっくり — *yu-k-ku-ri* — slowly

Do not squeeze the middle. The small つ holds one beat of closure before *ku*. The spelling is exposure today; this lesson earns the sound and practical job without pretending the two new shapes are already readable.

Your turn

- *Hear: yukkuri* → choose **slowly**
- *Tap: yu / hold / ku / ri*
- *Say it: yukkuri* slowly, without adding a vowel in the held beat

Before you move on

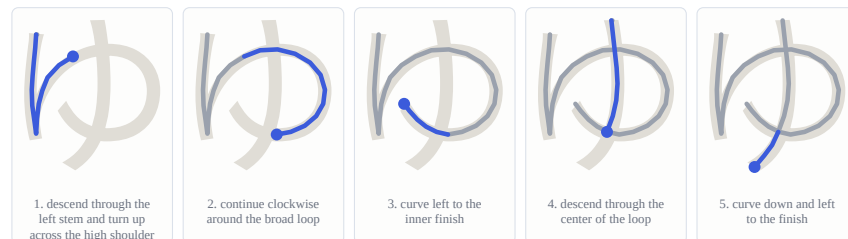
Meaning and timing are enough. The new opening sign comes next.
Source: Japan Foundation Irodori Starter lesson 2, pp. 1–3.

10.7 ゆ — open yukkuri

Tap *yu / hold / ku / ri*, then write known よ and も.

Script — the shape

How it is written — 2 strokes · 1 pen lift · 5 movements



Stroke order after Sirgazil, Hiragana stroke order animation.gif, hiragana 30 frames, 3.0 seconds (Wikimedia Commons, 1 October 2009)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ゆ is written, stroke by stroke

ゆ — *yu*

Two strokes. First a short curved vertical on the left. Second, begin at the upper right, sweep left through the middle, loop around, and finish to the right.

Your turn

- *Trace it:* ゆ once
- *Copy:* ゆ once
- *Find:* point to ゆ at the start of ゆっくり

Before you move on

The small つ remains supported; do not decode past what you own.
Source: Unicode Hiragana chart; stroke order per *Hitsujun Shido no Tebiki* (Japanese Ministry of Education, 1958).

10.8 いってください — please say it

Say *yukkuri*. Retrieve *onegaishimasu*, then write い, く, さ.

What to know first

いってください。 — *itte kudasai* — please say it

The first part is the request-linking form of *iu*, “to say.” *Kudasai* makes the requested action polite. Learn the whole spoken frame now. Its small つ, て, and voiced だ receive separate writing steps later.

Your turn

- *Hear:* *itte kudasai* → choose **please say it**
- *Say it:* *it-te ku-da-sa-i*
- *Join:* *yukkuri itte kudasai* — please say it slowly

Before you move on

Do not write the supported signs from memory yet.

Source: Japan Foundation Irodori Starter lesson 2, pp. 1–3.

10.9 もうすこし — a little more

Say *itte kudasai*, write ゆ, then write もう and すこし separately.
Read both.

What to know first

もうすこし — *mō sukoshi* — a little more

No new grammar is hiding here. もう points beyond the present amount; すこし keeps the requested change small. Every sign is already earned.

Your turn

1. Read もう | すこし.
2. Say *mō sukoshi*, keeping the extra beat in もう.
3. Hear the phrase, wait ten seconds, and write it from memory.

Before you move on

Circle う, the second beat of *mō*.

Source: Japan Foundation Irodori Starter lesson 2, pp. 1–3.

10.10 わかりました — the repair worked

Say “I do not understand,” then read もうすこし. Write み and し.

What to know first

わかりました。 — *wakarimashita* — I understand; understood

The familiar *wakari*- stem returns. Polite *-mashita* presents the change as achieved: the explanation landed. The final た is supported exposure until its own sign lesson.

Your turn

- Hear: *wakarimasen* → not understood
- Hear: *wakarimashita* → understood now
- Say it: *wakarimashita* after a successful repetition

Before you move on

Keep *-masen* and *-mashita* distinct; one reports a problem, the other success.

Source: Japan Foundation Irodori Starter lesson 2, pp. 2–3.

10.11 ここ — here, with one known sign twice

Write こ, say *wakarimashita*, then retrieve *sumimasen*.

What to know first

ここ — *ko-ko* — here; this place

One owned sign appears twice. The word belongs to a larger pointing family that will later contrast near me, near you, and over there. Today, keep only the speaker-near place: **here**.

Your turn

1. Point beside yourself and say *koko*.
2. Read こ | こ.
3. Hear *ko-ko*, wait ten seconds, and write both signs.

Before you move on

No new shape was needed; the payoff is recombination.

Source: Japan Foundation Irodori Starter lesson 2, p. 2.

10.12 もうすこし、ゆっくりいってください — slower, please

Write せ, お, ね, し, ゆ. Read *sumimasen* and *onegaishimasu*.
Retrieve the repetition request, then the three new spoken pieces
mō sukoshi, *yukkuri*, and *itte kudasai*.

What to know first

もうすこし、ゆっくりいってください。

mō sukoshi, *yukkuri itte kudasai* — please say it a little more
slowly

No new rule arrives here. The first block is independently readable and writable. The second and third remain sound-first exposure where their small つ, て, and だ have not yet received individual writing lessons.

Your turn

1. **Listen:** choose repetition or slower speech from the request you hear.
2. **Speak:** *sumimasen* + the slower request.
3. **Read/write:** independently retrieve only もうすこし.
4. **Close:** after the repeated line, say *wakarimashita*.

Before you move on

Stop after one accurate repair and one *wakarimashita*.
Source: Japan Foundation Irodori Starter lesson 2, pp. 1–3.

Chapter 11

Seven Body Words, No New Guessing

Modes: ⇄ voice (8) ✍ pen (4) ⇄ Hands-free start: none of the 12 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can read, write, hear, and say seven basic body words, and I can decode the repair signs that were previously only sound-first exposure.

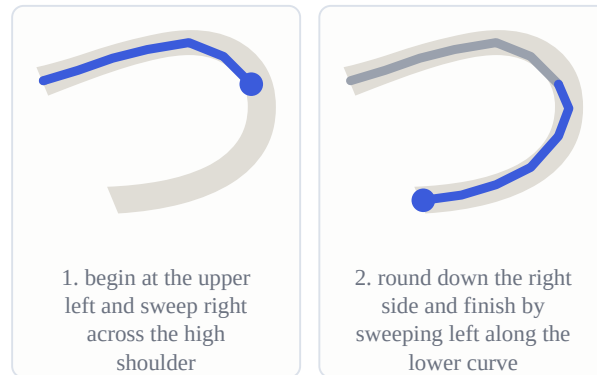
Seven concrete body labels built only from earned hiragana after four tiny lessons close every outstanding repair-script exposure.

11.1 っ — one small held beat

Point here and say *koko*. Count one time with *ichido*. Ask for the line a little more slowly, then isolate *yukkuri* and *itte kudasai*. Hold the silence before each second consonant; do not add a vowel.

Script — the shape

How it is written — one unbroken stroke · 2 moves



Stroke order after Sirgazil, Hiragana っ stroke order animation.gif, hiragana っ, 24 frames, 2.4 seconds (Wikimedia Commons, 1 October 2009); Unicode Standard 17.0 names U+3063 HIRAGANA LETTER SMALL TU, alias small tsu. This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How っ is written, stroke by stroke

っ — small *tsu* — one beat of consonant closure

It has the same family shape as full-sized つ, but it is smaller and sits lower. Copy only the small form today. In っくり, it holds before *k*; in って, it holds before *t*.

Your turn

1. Trace っ once and copy it once.
2. Hide it; write the small sign after ten seconds.
3. Read っくり and って with one silent beat at っ.

Before you move on

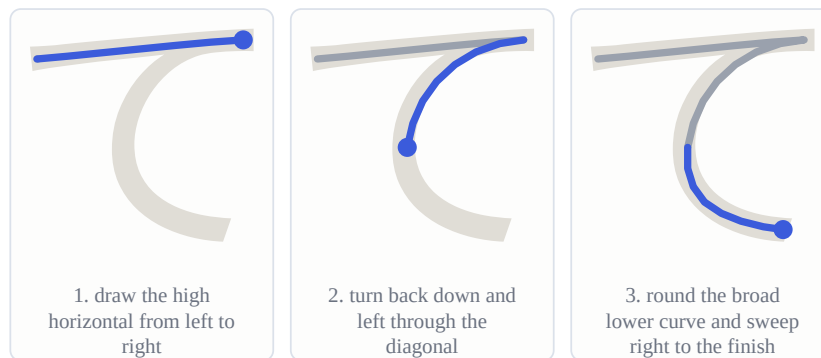
Stop after one accurate small form.
Source: Unicode Hiragana chart.

11.2 て — close *itte*

Write もうすこし, say *itte kudasai*, then write the small つ that holds before *t*.

Script — the shape

How it is written — one unbroken stroke · 3 movements



Stroke order after Sirgazil, Hiragana ㇰ stroke order animation.gif, hiragana ㇰ, 28 frames, 2.8 seconds (Wikimedia Commons, 1 October 2009)

This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How て is written, stroke by stroke

て — *te*

One continuous stroke: begin across the top, turn back, then sweep down and right. Keep the lower curve open.

Your turn

1. Trace て once.
2. Copy it once, then retrieve it after ten seconds.
3. Join the earned ending: い | つ | て.

Before you move on

Read **いって** once without romanization.

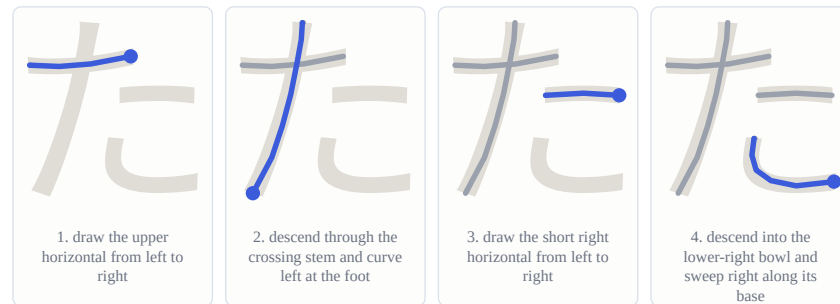
Source: Unicode Hiragana chart; stroke order per *Hitsujun Shido no Tebiki* (Japanese Ministry of Education, 1958).

11.3 た — close *wakarimashita*

Say *wakarimashita*. Write と and notice that today's *ta* belongs to the same consonant row but has its own shape.

Script — the shape

How it is written — 4 strokes · 3 pen lifts · 4 movements



Stroke order after Sirgazil, Hiragana 𐰇 stroke order animation.gif, hiragana 𐰇, 31 frames, 3.1 seconds (Wikimedia Commons, 1 October 2009)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How た is written, stroke by stroke

た — *ta*

Four strokes: a short top stroke, a crossing vertical curve, then two small right-side strokes. Keep the right pair separate.

Your turn

1. Trace た once and copy it once.
2. Hide it; write it after ten seconds.
3. Add it to the known final block し | た.

Before you move on

Read the ending した once.

Source: Unicode Hiragana chart; stroke order per *Hitsujun Shido no Tebiki* (Japanese Ministry of Education, 1958).

11.4 だ — voice the known base

Write た, then add the two-stroke dakuten without changing the base. Say the *da* in *kudasai*.

Script — the change

た + dakuten → だ — *ta* → *da*

The voicing mark does the same job it did before. This is transfer, not a new complex shape.

Your turn

1. Write た once.
2. Add dakuten to make だ.
3. Point to だ while saying the middle of *kudasai*.

Before you move on

Read ください once, attending to だ.

Source: Unicode Hiragana chart.

11.5 て — hand

Write て and だ. Point here and say *koko*, then ask for the line a little more slowly.

What to know first

て — *te* — hand

The one-sign word names the hand. Sound, meaning, reading, and writing can meet without adding another shape.

Your turn

1. Hear *te*; touch one hand.
2. See ㇰ; say “hand.”
3. Hide the word and write its one sign.

Before you move on

Stop after one clean retrieval.

Source: Japan Foundation Marugoto A1 vocabulary database.

11.6 みみ — ear

Write み once, then retrieve ㇰ — hand.

What to know first

みみ — *mimi* — ear; ears

No new sign: repeat み on two even morae.

Your turn

1. Hear *mimi*; point to an ear.
2. Read み | み aloud.
3. Hide it and write the repeated sign twice.

Before you move on

Keep the two morae even.

Source: Japan Foundation Marugoto A1 vocabulary database.

11.7 くち — mouth

Write く and ち separately. Retrieve みみ.

What to know first

くち — *kuchi* — mouth

Join two earned signs; keep two even morae.

Your turn

1. Hear *kuchi*; point to the mouth.
2. Read く | ち.
3. Hide it and write the two signs in order.

Before you move on

Contrast *mimi* and *kuchi* once.

Source: Japan Foundation Marugoto A1 vocabulary database.

11.8 あし — foot or leg

Write あ and し. Retrieve くち — mouth.

What to know first

あし — *ashi* — foot; leg

Context chooses the narrower English translation. The Japanese word stays the same.

Your turn

1. Hear *ashi*; touch a foot or leg.
2. Read あ | し.
3. Hide it and write both known signs.

Before you move on

Stop after one accurate retrieval.

Source: Japan Foundation Marugoto A1 vocabulary database.

11.9 はな — nose

Write は and な. Retrieve あし.

What to know first

はな — *hana* — nose

Read は as *ha* inside this word. Its *wa* reading was tied to the topic marker job, not to every appearance of the sign.

Your turn

1. Hear *hana*; point to the nose.
2. Read は | な as *ha-na*.
3. Hide it and write both signs.

Before you move on

Say *hana* once without turning the first mora into *wa*.
Source: Japan Foundation Marugoto A1 vocabulary database.

11.10 かお — face

Write か and お. Retrieve はな — nose.

What to know first

かお — *kao* — face

Give か and お one mora each: *ka-o*.

Your turn

1. Hear two beats, *ka-o*; point to the face.
2. Read か | お.
3. Hide it and write the two signs.

Before you move on

Contrast はな inside the かお once.

Source: Japan Foundation Marugoto A1 vocabulary database.

11.11 め — eye

Write め. Retrieve かお and みみ.

What to know first

め — *me* — eye; eyes

One learned sign is the complete everyday word.

Your turn

1. Hear *me*; point to an eye.
2. See め; say the meaning.
3. Hide it and write the one-sign word.

Before you move on

Keep め and みみ distinct.

Source: Japan Foundation Marugoto A1 vocabulary database.

11.12 Seven readable body words

Write つ, て, た, だ. Read ゆっくり, いて, わかりました, and ください once; the old repair exposure is now closed.

What to know first

て ・ みみ ・ くち ・ あし ・ はな ・ かお ・ め

This is a reading-and-writing map, not a new-word dump. Every word arrived in its own lesson, and every sign was already earned.

Your turn

1. **Listen:** point to the named body part.
2. **Speak:** name any three without reading.
3. **Read:** read all seven from left to right.
4. **Write:** choose any three and write them from memory.

Before you move on

Stop after one accurate three-word dictation.

Source: Japan Foundation Marugoto A1 vocabulary database.

Chapter 12

Seven More Body Words, Spaced on Purpose

Modes: 🗣️ voice (20) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 20 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can read, write, hear, and say seven more body words while retrieving older script, greeting, farewell, and repair knowledge at expanding intervals.

Seven fully decodable body labels interleaved with measured R3 and R4 retrieval rather than taught as a single topical list.

12.1 Retrieval 1 — mora, politeness, and し

Tap one mora for い, then write い and し from memory. Hear, say, read, and write the first seven-word body map; finish by isolating あし.

Your turn

Hear a polite thank-you, say it, read ありがとうございます, and choose it for someone outside your close circle.

Before you move on

Stop after one accurate card.

12.2 あたま — head

Write は and 日. Read ございます, say *yukkuri*, then retrieve はな.

What to know first

あたま — *a-ta-ma* — head

Every sign is earned. Keep three even morae.

Your turn

Hear, point, say, read, then hide and write あたま.

Before you move on

Source: Japan Foundation Marugoto A1 vocabulary database.

12.3 かみ — hair

Write あたま, read はい, write 本, sketch the speech component, write ゆ, and finish with かお.

What to know first

かみ — *ka-mi* — hair

Two known signs, two morae.

Your turn

Hear, point, say, read, then write かみ from memory.

Before you move on

Source: Japan Foundation Marugoto A1 vocabulary database.

12.4 Retrieval 2 — old signs, recent request

Write え and かみ. Build the five and mouth components of 語.
Then ask someone to say it with *itte kudasai* and write め.

Before you move on

Stop after one pass.

12.5 は — tooth

Say はい, write 語, recall its Chinese-derived bridge, and write もうすこし. Then hear, say, read, and write the first seven body words.

What to know first

は — *ha* — tooth; teeth

One sign is the complete word.

Your turn

Hear, point, say, read, and write は.

Before you move on

Source: Japan Foundation Marugoto A1 vocabulary database.

12.6 かた — shoulder

Write は. Say いいえ with its full vowel length. Read 日本語 with its learned readings, then close with *wakarimashita*.

What to know first

かた — *ka-ta* — shoulder

Two known signs, two even morae.

Your turn

Hear, point, say, read, then write かた.

Before you move on

Source: Japan Foundation Marugoto A1 vocabulary database.

12.7 Retrieval 3 — keep the scripts apart

Write hiragana こ, then katakana コー and hold the vowel. Point here with ここ. Name shoulder, then retrieve head after the longer gap.

Before you move on

Stop after one pass.

12.8 おなか — belly

Write ん, ー, and ヒ. Ask for slower speech, then write かみ after its longer gap.

What to know first

おなか — *o-na-ka* — belly; stomach area

Keep three morae.

Your turn

Hear, point, say, read, then write おなか.

Before you move on

Source: Japan Foundation Marugoto A1 vocabulary database.

12.9 セなか — back

Write おなか and に. Read コーヒー as a katakana loan, then write small っ.

What to know first

せなか — *se-na-ka* — back

Only the opening changes from おなか.

Your turn

Hear, point, say, read, then write せなか.

Before you move on

Source: Japan Foundation Marugoto A1 vocabulary database.

12.10 Retrieval 4 — leave the body-word topic

Write ち. Run the old doorway exchange and end with さようなら. Write て. Retrieve せなか, then は after five lessons.

Before you move on

Stop after one pass.

12.11 こし — waist or lower back

Write わ, then explain why topic は can sound *wa*. Hear *sayō-nara*, write its ら, write た, and retrieve かた.

What to know first

こし — *ko-shi* — waist; lower back

Two signs, two morae.

Your turn

Hear, point, say, read, then write こし.

Before you move on

Source: Japan Foundation Marugoto A1 vocabulary database.

12.12 Retrieval 5 — enter, leave, voice

Read こんにちは. Hear, say, read, and write さようなら. Write だ, then retrieve こし without looking back.

Before you move on

Stop after one pass.

12.13 Retrieval 6 — greet, repair, point

Greet, say that you do not understand well, write て, and retrieve おなか after five lessons.

Before you move on

Stop after one pass.

12.14 Retrieval 7 — from あ to せなか

Write あ and ど. Say *mō* on two morae. Write みみ, then retrieve せなか after five lessons.

Before you move on

Stop after one pass.

12.15 Retrieval 8 — り, も, いちど, くち

Write り and も. Say and write いちど, then retrieve くち.

Before you move on

Stop after one pass.

12.16 Retrieval 9 — request, leg, waist

Write か. Say *onegaishimasu*, then the complete repetition request. Write あし, then retrieve こし after five lessons.

Before you move on

Stop after one pass.

12.17 Retrieval 10 — mark, signs, nose

Add dakuten to a known base, write せ and ね, then write はな from memory.

Before you move on

Stop after one pass.

12.18 Retrieval 11 — と, すこし, かお

Write と, then すこし. Finish with かお, keeping *ka-o* on two morae.

Before you move on

Stop after one pass.

12.19 Retrieval 12 — う and め

Write う, then hear, say, read, and write め.

Before you move on

Stop after one pass.

12.20 Seven more body words, spaced on purpose

Read ありがとう. Then hear, say, read, and write any three words from the first seven-word body map.

What to know first

あたま・かみ・は・かた・おなか・せなか・こし

Every sign is earned, and every new word has already had short and medium retrieval scheduled in this chapter.

Your turn

Listen and point; say all seven; read all seven; then write any four from memory.

Before you move on

Stop after one accurate seven-word map.

Source: Japan Foundation Marugoto A1 vocabulary database.

Chapter 13

Nine Family Words Through One New Kana

Modes: ⇄ voice (15) ✍ pen (2) ⇄ Hands-free start: none of the 17 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can hear, say, read, and write nine immediate-family words, with listening, speaking, reading, and writing scored independently.

Nine official Irodori Starter family words built from earned hiragana plus one separately traced, copied, and recalled full-size つ.

13.1 つ — one full-size curve

Write ありがとう, name its older *arigatashi* family, and point to the dakuten. Then write small つ and retrieve one word from the body map.

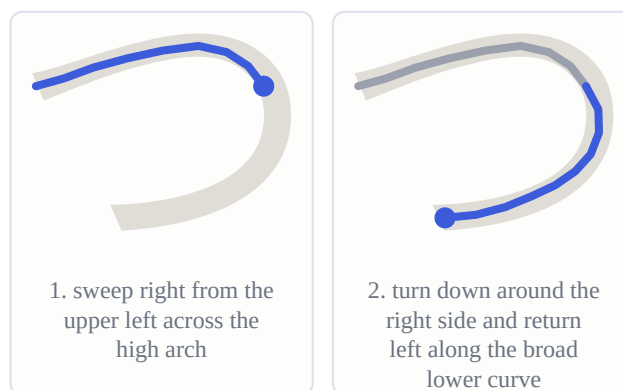
Script — notice and trace

つ — *tsu*

This is the full-size sign. Trace its one stroke: begin at the upper left, sweep right, turn downward, and finish toward the lower left.

Writing — copy, then recall

How it is written — one unbroken stroke · 2 moves



Stroke order after Sirgazil, Hiragana ㇰ stroke order animation.gif, hiragana ㇰ, 24 frames, 2.4 seconds (Wikimedia Commons, 1 October 2009)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How つ is written, stroke by stroke

Copy つ once. Hide it for ten seconds, write it once, then place つ beside small つ and check that the full-size sign is clearly larger.

Before you move on

Read it once: *tsu*.

Source: Unicode Hiragana chart; stroke order per *Hitsujun Shido no Tebiki* (Japanese Ministry of Education, 1958).

13.2 Full つ, small っ

Write distant ㇰ once from memory.

Your turn — one contrast

Write distant ㇰ, then つ・っ. Say *tsu* for the full-size sign; hold one silent beat for the small sign.

Before you move on

Stop after one accurate pair.

13.3 ちち — my father

Write known ち once and give it one even mora.

You'll Want to Know — hear it before reading it

Hear *chi-chi*. Point to “my father,” then say the two even morae once.

Your turn — read, copy, recall

Read ち | ち. Copy ちち, hide it, and write it once from the meaning.

Before you move on

Source: Japan Foundation Irodori Starter word list, Lesson 4.

13.4 はは — my mother

Say and write ちち once before meeting the paired family word.

You'll Want to Know — hear and say

Write distant す. Hear *ha-ha*, say it once, then contrast *chichi*.

Your turn — read, copy, recall

Read は | は. Copy はは, hide it, and write it once from the meaning.

Before you move on

Source: Japan Foundation Irodori Starter word list, Lesson 4.

13.5 あに — my elder brother

Retrieve はは once from its meaning.

You'll Want to Know — hear and say

Thank a stranger with **ありがとうございます**, name the polite-register choice, and retrieve any two body words. Then hear *a-ni* and say both morae once.

Your turn — read, copy, recall

Read **あ | に**. Copy **あに**, hide it, and write it from the meaning.

Before you move on

Source: Japan Foundation Irodori Starter word list, Lesson 4.

13.6 あね — my elder sister

Retrieve **あに** once from its meaning.

You'll Want to Know — hear and say

Read the distant block **ございます** once. Hear *a-ne*, say it, then contrast *a-ni*, my elder brother.

Your turn — read, copy, recall

Read **あ | ね**. Copy **あね**, hide it, and write it from the meaning.

Before you move on

Source: Japan Foundation Irodori Starter word list, Lesson 4.

13.7 おとうと — my younger brother

Retrieve **あね** once from its meaning.

You'll Want to Know — hear it first

Write distant **お** once. Hear *o-to-o-to*: **o | to | o | to**, with the long *o* occupying two beats.

Your turn — read, copy, recall

Read お | と | う | と. Copy おとうと, hide it, and write it once.

Before you move on

Source: Japan Foundation Irodori Starter word list, Lesson 4.

13.8 いもうと — my younger sister

Say おとうと once and keep its four even morae.

You'll Want to Know — hear and contrast

Write distant 本 once. Hear *i-mo-o-to*, say it, then contrast *o-to-o-to*.

Your turn — read, copy, recall

Read い | も | う | と. Copy いもうと, hide it, and write it once.

Before you move on

Source: Japan Foundation Irodori Starter word list, Lesson 4.

13.9 おっと — my husband

Retrieve いもうと once from its meaning.

You'll Want to Know — hear the held beat

Write distant 言 once. Hear *o / hold / to* and say it without inserting a vowel into the held beat.

Your turn — read, copy, recall

Read お | っ | と. Copy おっと, hide it, and write it once.

Before you move on

Source: Japan Foundation Irodori Starter word list, Lesson 4.

13.10 つま — my wife

Retrieve おっと once and notice the small つ.

You'll Want to Know — hear and say

Write distant 五 once. Hear *tsu-ma* and say two morae, with a full vowel after *ts*.

Your turn — read, copy, recall

Read つ | ま. Copy つま, hide it, and write it once.

Before you move on

Source: Japan Foundation Irodori Starter word list, Lesson 4.

13.11 こども — child

Retrieve つま once from its meaning.

You'll Want to Know — hear and say

Write distant □ once. Hear *ko-do-mo*, choose “child,” then say the three even morae.

Your turn — read, copy, recall

Read こ | ど | も. Copy こども, hide it, and write it once.

Before you move on

Source: Japan Foundation Irodori Starter word list, Lesson 4.

13.12 Family retrieval A

Say おとうと once without looking back.

Your turn — two directions

Build distant 語 once. Hear *otooto* and point to “younger brother.” Read こども, then write both family words from memory.

Before you move on

Stop after one accurate pair.

13.13 Family retrieval B

Say いもうと once without looking back.

Your turn — three cues

Read distant 日本語 as *nihongo* and recall that borrowed kanji can carry word-specific readings. Then hear “younger sister,” say いもうと, read ちち・はは, and write all three.

Before you move on

Stop after one accurate set.

13.14 Family retrieval C

Say おっと once without looking back.

Your turn — three cues

Write distant katakana コ. Hear *otto* and mark its held beat. Read あに・あね, say each meaning, then write all three.

Before you move on

Stop after one accurate set.

13.15 Family retrieval D

Say つま once without looking back.

Your turn — size carries sound

Add distant ー after コ and state that it holds the vowel for one more beat. Then hear, read, and write つま・おっと with a clear size contrast.

Before you move on

Stop after one accurate pair.

13.16 Nine family words — reception check

Retrieve こども once from the English cue “child.”

Your turn — listening

Use sound only. Score listening before revealing any written word.

Your turn — reading

Read without romanization. A failed section is repeated on its own.

Before you move on

Keep listening and reading scores separate; repair only the weaker channel.

13.17 Nine family words — production check

Start with two older forms. Write distant katakana ヒ. Then read コーヒー and recall why a loanword uses katakana.

Now hear, say, read, and write these four later body words:
あたま・かみ・は・かた.

Finish with the remaining three: おなか・せなか・こし.

Your turn — speaking

Use no written answer while speaking. Check task completion and mora timing.

Writing

No section compensates for another. Repeat only the section below its own pass mark.

Before you move on

Keep speaking and writing scores separate; repair only the weaker channel.

Source: Japan Foundation Irodori Starter word list, Lesson 4.

Chapter 14

Five Numbers, No New Signs

Modes: ⇄ voice (6) ⇄ Hands-free start: all 6 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say and write one to five in Japanese, and I can say which number has a native word standing beside its borrowed reading.

Run ichi to go in order, then name the two of the five that were already yours and say where you had met each.

14.1 いち — one, taken out of a word you already say

Two recalls, at two distances.

- *Recall:* run the nine family words — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* the whole doorway exchange, start to finish — **R4**, eighty lessons back

You'll Want to Know — hear and say

いち — *ichi* — **one**

Say もういちど. You have asked for one more time since chapter nine, and that lesson told you what the first two morae were: *ichi* is **one**. Nothing about the word changes today. It stops being part of a phrase and starts being a number you can use on its own.

Both signs are yours: い + ち.

Your turn — read, copy, recall

Read い | ち. Copy いち, hide it, and write it from the meaning. Then say いちど and point to the part of it that is the number.

Before you move on

How many new signs did this lesson need? (**None.**)

Source: Wiktionary: いち.

14.2 ご — five, and the sign that was holding it

Two recalls, then the second number.

- *Recall*: say *one* — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall*: say the farewell, and say it after hearing it — **R4**, eighty lessons back

You'll Want to Know — hear and say

ご — *go* — **five**

Write 五 once. Chapter five taught you those four strokes, gave you the sound *go*, said on the page that **the sign means five on its own**, and then asked you for nothing but the sound, because it was only there to cue the *go* inside 語.

That was the whole of the deferral. 五 is **five**, and you have been able to write it for nine chapters.

In hiragana it is こ with the dakuten: ござ. Both marks are yours.

Your turn — read, copy, recall

Write 五 from memory: top, turn, middle, long bottom. Then write ござ and say *go*. Say いち, then ござ — the two numbers you owned before this chapter opened.

Before you move on

How many new signs did this lesson need? (**None.**)

Sources: Wiktionary: ござ; KanjiVG stroke-order data.

14.3 に — two, one mora long

Three recalls, then the third number.

- *Recall:* say *five* — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* run the fourteen body words — **R3**, twenty lessons back
- *Recall:* write よ — **R4**, eighty lessons back

You'll Want to Know — hear and say

に — *ni* — **two**

One mora, one sign, and you learned that sign in chapter two to build こんにちは. Say the three numbers you now have, in the order you met them: *ichi*, *go*, *ni*.

Do not let the shortness fool you into hurrying it. に is one full beat, exactly as long as either beat of いち.

Your turn — read, copy, recall

Read に. Write it, hide it, write it again from the meaning. Then say *ichi* — *ni* and hold both at one beat each.

Before you move on

How many new signs has this chapter needed? (**None.**)

Source: Wiktionary: に.

14.4 さん — three, on two old signs

Four recalls, then the fourth number.

- *Recall:* say *two* — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* take the family reception once more — **R2**, five lessons back
- *Recall:* write full-size つ — **R3**, twenty lessons back
- *Recall:* write な — **R4**, eighty lessons back

You'll Want to Know — hear and say

さん — *san* — **three**

さ came in chapter four for ありがとうございます; ん came in chapter two, and its lesson said it is the one hiragana sign that is not a full syllable. It still is not. さん is **two beats**: *sa*, then a beat of the nasal on its own.

Say *ichi* — *ni* — *san*. Four numbers, four lessons, no new signs.

Your turn — read, copy, recall

Read さ | ん as two beats. Write さん, hide it, write it again. Then say *ichi*, *ni*, *san* three times without slowing at ん.

Before you move on

Which four numbers do you now have? (*Ich*i, *ni*, *san*, *go*.)

Source: Wiktionary: さん.

14.5 よん — four, and where the two systems meet

Four recalls, then the number with two names.

- *Recall*: say *three* — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall*: run the nine family words — **R2**, five lessons back
- *Recall*: say *my father* — **R3**, twenty lessons back
- *Recall*: write 𐰚 — **R4**, eighty lessons back

You'll Want to Know — hear and say

よん — *yon* — **four**

し — *shi* — **four**, the same number said the other way

Both signs of よん are yours, and so is し. Two beats each: *yo* plus the nasal beat, or *shi* alone.

Grammar Lens — a native word inside a borrowed count

Japanese has two ways of reading a sign: the reading it borrowed from Chinese along with the sign, and the reading it already had for the thing the sign means. Wiktionary's readings box for the kanji **four** lists them side by side:

reading	kind	which
し <i>shi</i>	on'yomi, borrowed with the sign	four
よん <i>yon</i>	kun'yomi, the native word	four

Ichi, ni, san and *go* are all borrowed readings, and none of them has a native word standing beside it in the everyday count. **Four is the first place in the run where the native word is used too** — and in ordinary speech よん is the one you will hear far more often. That split is coming back. It is the same seam the counters run along, and it opens here.

Your turn — read, copy, recall

Write よん and し. Say the run in order: *ichi, ni, san, yon, go*. Then say it once with し in place of よん and hear how much closer *shi* sits to *ichi*.

Before you move on

Which four is a native Japanese word? (よん.)

Sources: Wiktionary: the kanji read *shi* and *yon*; Wiktionary: よん.

14.6 One to five, in order at last

Three recalls before the run.

- *Recall*: say *four*, both ways — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall*: say *my father* — **R3**, twenty lessons back
- *Recall*: read さようなら off the page — **R4**, eighty lessons back

Nothing new arrives here. This is the first time the five stand in numerical order, and that has been deliberate.

Your turn — the run, and the two you started with

- *Say it:* *ichi ni san yon go* — the run, without stopping
- *Say it:* it again with 𛄠 at four
- *Write it:* 𛄡, and say which of the five it is

What you've built this chapter, in one number

Five numbers, and zero new signs. Every mark in *ichi*, *ni*, *san*, *yon*, *go* was taught before this chapter opened, and two of the five words were already in your hands: *ichi* inside もういちど, and *go* as the kanji 五.

One thing did arrive that is not a word: at **four**, the native reading stands beside the borrowed one. Watch for it again.

Before you move on

How many new signs did this chapter cost? (**None.**) Which number in the run has a native word beside its borrowed reading? (**Four.**)

Chapter 15

The Two Signs the Rest of the Run Cost

Modes:  voice (5)  eyes (1)  pen (2)  Hands-free start: first 1 of 8 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say and write one to ten in Japanese, build any number up to ninety-nine out of those ten words, and say which of them carry a second reading and why.

Run ichi to juu in order, build thirteen and thirty out of the same two words, and say what the ten numbers cost in signs.

15.1 なな — seven, and the pattern from four holding

Three recalls, then a number out of order, on purpose.

- *Recall:* say *four* both ways, and say which is the native one — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say *my mother* — **R3**, twenty lessons back
- *Recall:* take the farewell in all four skills — **R4**, eighty lessons back

This chapter does not start at six. Six is one of only two numbers left that costs a new sign, and both of those wait until the end.

You'll Want to Know — hear and say

なな — *nana* — **seven**

しち — *shichi* — **seven**, the same number said the other way

All three signs are yours: な, し, ち.

What you've built — the same seam, a second time

Wiktionary's readings box for the kanji **seven** says exactly what the box for **four** said:

number	borrowed reading	native word
four	し <i>shi</i>	よん <i>yon</i>
seven	しち <i>shichi</i>	なな <i>nana</i>

Twice now, and both times at a number where the borrowed reading is easy to mishear — *shi* against *ichi*, *shichi* against *ichi*. The native word is the one that keeps the count clear, and it is the one you will hear. One instance was a fact about four. Two is a pattern, and this is where the book says so.

Your turn — read, copy, recall

Write なな. Say what you have: *ichi, ni, san, yon, go ... nana*. Leave the hole where six is; you will hear it.

Before you move on

How many new signs did this lesson need? (**None.**)

Sources: Wiktionary: the kanji read shichi and nana; Wiktionary: なな.

15.2 はち — eight, with nothing standing beside it

Three recalls, then the plain case.

- *Recall*: say *seven*, both ways — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall*: say *my elder brother* — **R3**, twenty lessons back
- *Recall*: say *excuse me* — **R4**, eighty lessons back

You'll Want to Know — hear and say

はち — *hachi* — **eight**

Two beats, two old signs: は from chapter one and ち from chapter two.

And that is the whole lesson, which is the point of it. **Eight has no second name.** Four had one and seven had one; eight does not, and neither did one, two, three or five. The pattern you were shown twice is not everywhere — it sits at two numbers out of the seven you now hold.

A rule you cannot see the edge of is not a rule you can use. This is the edge.

Your turn — read, copy, recall

Write はち. Say what you hold: *ichi, ni, san, yon, go ... nana, hachi*. The hole at six is still there.

Before you move on

How many new signs did this lesson need? (**None.**)

Source: Wiktionary: はち.

15.3 < — nine, and the exception to the seam

Three recalls, then a number with two readings and no native one.

- *Recall: say eight* — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall: say my elder sister* — **R3**, twenty lessons back
- *Recall: write み* — **R4**, eighty lessons back

You'll Want to Know — hear and say

< — *ku* — **nine**

One mora, one sign, and you have had that sign since chapter nine, where it closed よく. Say *hachi, ku*.

Nine has a second everyday reading as well, *kyū*, and it is the commoner of the two. This book cannot spell it yet — it needs two signs you have not met — so it is written here in romanization only and will be spelled when those signs arrive.

What you've built — a second reading that is not a native word

Four and seven each had two names, and in both the second was the **native** word. Nine has two names too, and Wiktionary's readings box puts **both** of them on the borrowed side:

number	readings the box calls borrowed	the native word
four	し	よん — used
seven	しち	なな — used
nine	く, <i>kyū</i>	<i>kokono</i> — not used in the plain count

So the pattern is narrower than it looked two lessons ago: *some* numbers have two everyday names, and only *some of those* get their second name from the native side. Nine has two names for a different reason.

You met the plain case at eight. This is the other edge.

Your turn — read, copy, recall

Write く. Say what you hold: *ichi, ni, san, yon, go ... nana, hachi, ku*. Two numbers are missing and you can hear both gaps.

Before you move on

Which two numbers are still missing? (**Six and ten** — the two that cost a sign.)

Source: Wiktionary: the kanji read *kyuu* and *ku*.

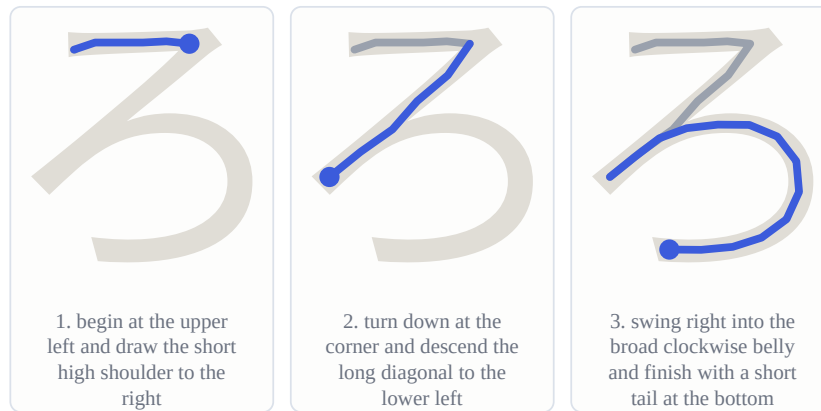
15.4 ㄣ — one turn, and the r you already make

Three recalls, then one sign.

- *Recall*: say *nine* — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall*: say *my younger brother* — **R3**, twenty lessons back
- *Recall*: write ㄣ — **R4**, eighty lessons back

Script — the shape

How it is written — one unbroken stroke · 3 movements



Stroke order after Sirgazil, Hiragana  stroke order animation.gif, hiragana , 26 frames, 2.6 seconds (Wikimedia Commons, 1 October 2009)

This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ろ is written, stroke by stroke

ろ — ro

Write ろ once. ろ starts the same way and ends differently: a short stroke across the top, then down and round to the left and back up, closing the loop instead of leaving a hook.

The sound is the one ろ already taught you — a single tap of the tongue, neither the English *r* nor the English *l*.

This is the first new sign in two chapters, and it is here for one word.

Your turn

1. Trace ろ once and copy it once.
2. Hide it; write it after ten seconds.
3. Write ろ and ろ side by side and say both, one tap each.

Before you move on

Stop after one accurate form.

Source: Unicode Hiragana chart.

15.5 ろく — six, and the hole closes

Three recalls, then the word the last lesson bought a sign for.

- *Recall:* write ろ — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say *my younger sister* — **R3**, twenty lessons back
- *Recall:* say *well, fully* — **R4**, eighty lessons back

You'll Want to Know — hear and say

ろく — *roku* — **six**

ろ arrived last lesson; く you have had since chapter nine, where it also became the number **nine**. So the sign く does two jobs in this run: it is *nine* on its own and the second beat of *six*.

Six has one everyday reading. No native word stands beside it.

What you've built — why six waited

You have been counting round a gap for three lessons. Here is what the gap was: of the ten numbers in this run, **exactly two need a sign this book had not taught**, and six is the first of them. That is why the chapter did not start here. Everything that cost nothing came first, so that when a lesson finally spends a sign you can see exactly what it bought.

Say the run: *ichi, ni, san, yon, go, roku, nana, hachi, ku*. Nine of ten, and only one gap left.

Your turn — read, copy, recall

Read ろ | く. Write ろく, hide it, write it again from the meaning. Then say *roku, nana, hachi, ku* four times, without stopping.

Before you move on

How many of the ten numbers cost a new sign? (**Two** — this one, and one more.)

Source: Wiktionary: 𐤆𐤃.

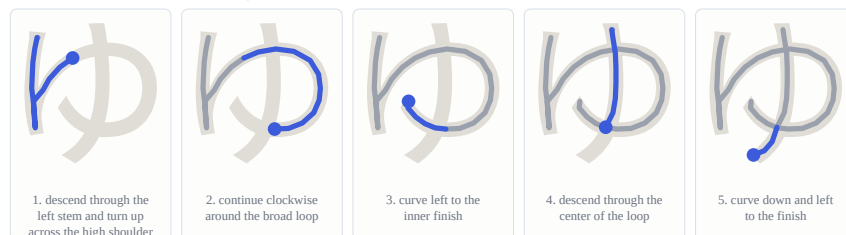
15.6 𐤆 — a small sign that joins forward

Three recalls, then the last new sign of the run.

- *Recall*: write 𐤆, full size — **R2**, five lessons back
- *Recall*: say *my husband* — **R3**, twenty lessons back
- *Recall*: write < — **R4**, eighty lessons back

Script — the shape

How it is written — 2 strokes · 1 pen lift · 5 movements



Stroke order after Sirgazil, Hiragana 𐤆 stroke order animation.gif, hiragana 𐤆 30 frames, 3.0 seconds (Wikimedia Commons, 1 October 2009); the Unicode Standard names U+3085 HIRAGANA LETTER SMALL YU, alias small yu. This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How 𐤆 is written, stroke by stroke

𐤆 — small *yu*

Same shape as 𐤆, written small and sitting low — the way 𐤃 is a small 𐤃.

The two small signs do opposite jobs, and it is worth putting them side by side:

sign	what it does
𐤃	holds a silent beat <i>before</i> the next consonant
𐤆	joins to the sign <i>before</i> it, and the two become one beat

So し plus む is not *shi-yu*. It is one beat, *shu*. Voice the し with the dakuten first and じ plus む is one beat, *ju*.

That is the sign the last number needs.

Your turn

1. Write む, then む beneath it, half the height.
2. Write つ and む side by side; say which one holds and which one joins.
3. Read じ む as a single beat. Do not let a *yu* escape between the two.

Before you move on

Stop after one accurate small form.
Source: Unicode Hiragana chart.

15.7 じゅう — ten, and what ten does

Three recalls, then the last number.

- *Recall*: write む, and say what it does to the sign before it — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall*: say *my wife* — **R3**, twenty lessons back
- *Recall*: say *I do not understand* — **R4**, eighty lessons back

You'll Want to Know — hear and say

じゅう — *jū* — ten

Three signs, two beats. し voiced with the dakuten is じ; じ with the small む is one beat, *ju*; the ー after it holds that beat long. Say it as two beats, not three: *ju-u*, not *ji-yu-u*.

Grammar Lens — ten words, ninety-nine numbers

じゅう is not just the tenth word in a list. It is the one that makes the list go further than itself, and it does so with no joining word at all:

what you say	what it is
じゅういち	ten, one → eleven
にじゅう	two, ten → twenty
にじゅういち	two, ten, one → twenty-one
A number before じゅう multiplies it. A number after じゅう is added to it. Nothing is inserted between them. Ten words, and every number up to ninety-nine is one of their arrangements. That is what the last two chapters were for.	

Your turn — read, copy, recall

Write じゅう. Say the whole run, one to ten, without stopping. Then say *jūichi*, *nijū*, *sanjū*, and build one number of your own between twenty and ninety-nine.

Before you move on

How many beats is じゅう? (**Two**.)

Source: Wiktionary: じゅう.

15.8 One to ten, and what the run cost

Four recalls before the run.

- *Recall*: say *ten*, in two beats — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall*: say *seven*, both ways — **R2**, five lessons back
- *Recall*: say *child* — **R3**, twenty lessons back
- *Recall*: write ㇿ — **R4**, eighty lessons back

Nothing new arrives here. This is the first time all ten stand in order.

Your turn — the run

- *Say it*: *ichi ni san yon go roku nana hachi ku jū* — without stopping
- *Say it*: it again with し at four and しち at seven
- *Write it*: 五

What you've built in two chapters, in three numbers

Ten numbers. Two new signs. Ninety-nine numbers you can now say.

*Ich*i and *go* were yours before chapter fourteen opened. Only 三 and 四 had to be bought, one word each.

At **four** and **seven** the native word stands beside the borrowed reading; at **nine** both readings are borrowed, and **eight** has no second name at all.

五 is still the only one of the ten you can write as Japanese writes it. The other nine kanji are the next thing this book owes you.

Before you move on

How many new signs did ten numbers cost? (**Two.**) Which two numbers have a native word standing beside a borrowed reading? (**Four and seven.**) What does a number *before* じゅう do to it? (**Multiplies it.**)

Chapter 16

The Other Way to Count

Modes: ⇄ voice (5) 👁 eyes (1) ✍ pen (2) ⇄ Hands-free start: none of the 8 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can count things from one to five in the native Japanese series, write the two signs it cost, and say the one place where the same word stands in both of Japanese's counts.

Run hitotsu to itsutsu, say the borrowed five beside them, and name the one number where a single word appears in both counts.

16.1 ∪ — one stroke, and a second count begins

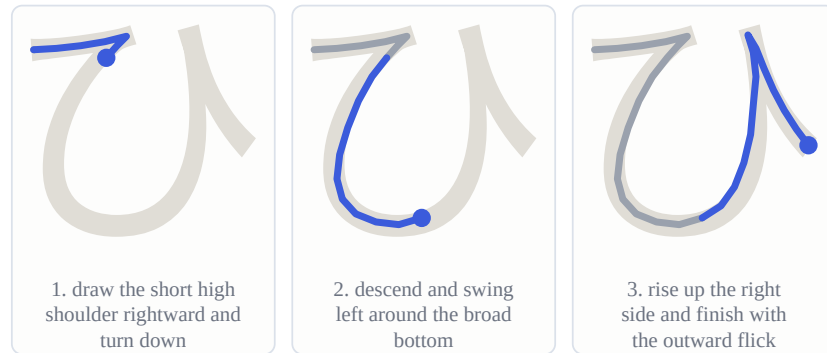
Three recalls, then one sign.

- *Recall:* write 𠄎 — **R2**, five lessons back
- *Recall:* say *ten*, then build *thirteen* and *thirty* from it — **R2**, five lessons back
- *Recall:* say *more, again* — **R4**, eighty lessons back

Last chapter bought two signs for a count of ten. This chapter buys five, for a count of ten that Japanese runs **beside** the one you already have.

Script — the shape

How it is written — one unbroken stroke · 3 movements



Stroke order after Sirgazil, Hiragana ひ stroke order animation.gif, hiragana ひ, 33 frames, 3.3 seconds (Wikimedia Commons, 1 October 2009)

This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ひ is written, stroke by stroke

ひ — *hi*

One stroke, and the KanjiVG stroke data for this sign holds exactly one path: start high on the left, run a short way to the right, then sweep down and far to the left in a long shallow curve and finish by turning up. The pen does not lift once.

Compare ㇿ, which you wrote five lessons ago: also one stroke, but ㇿ closes its loop and ひ never closes at all.

Your turn

1. Trace ひ once and copy it once, without lifting.
2. Hide it; write it after ten seconds.
3. Write ㇿ and ひ side by side: one closes, one does not.

Before you move on

How many strokes? (**One.**)

Source: Unicode Hiragana chart; stroke count and order per KanjiVG.

16.2 ひとつ — one thing

Three recalls, then the first word of a second count.

- *Recall:* write ひ — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say *six* — **R2**, five lessons back
- *Recall:* write も — **R4**, eighty lessons back

You'll Want to Know — hear and say

ひとつ — *hi-to-tsu* — **one thing**

Three beats, three signs: ひ from last lesson, と and つ long since yours.

You already have a word for *one*. It is いち, and it is borrowed. ひとつ is the word Japanese had before it borrowed anything, and the two are not interchangeable:

word	what it is for
いち	the number itself — <i>one</i> , counting aloud, a house number
ひとつ	one thing — a thing you are pointing at

Wiktionary's usage note for ひとつ is one sentence and it is the sentence this chapter turns on: it is used *when the items counted have no specific counter category*. Hold that. It will be the whole of the next chapter.

Your turn — read, copy, recall

Write ひとつ. Say *ichi*, then *hitotsu*, and hear that they share nothing — not a beat, not a sound.

Before you move on

Which of the two words is the borrowed one? (いち.)
Sources: Wiktionary: hitotsu.

16.3 ふ — four strokes, and a counter you already own

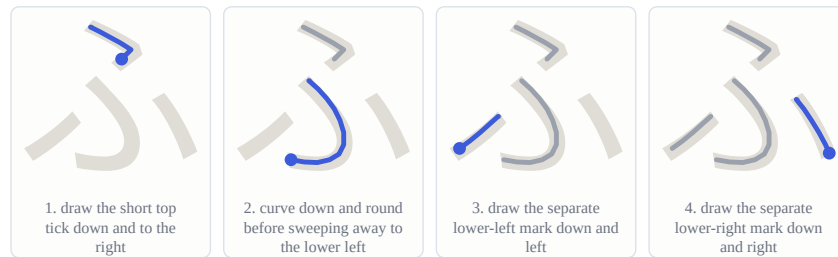
Three recalls, then one sign.

- *Recall*: say *one thing* — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall*: write the small ㇰ — **R2**, five lessons back
- *Recall*: say *one time* — **R4**, eighty lessons back

いちど is worth stopping on. Its own lesson said *do counts an occurrence* — which is to say **いちど is a number with a counter behind it**, and you have been saying it since chapter nine without anyone calling it that. Two chapters from now that sentence is the whole point.

Script — the shape

How it is written — 4 strokes · 3 pen lifts · 4 movements



Stroke order after Sirgazil, Hiragana ㇰ stroke order animation.gif, hiragana ㇰ. 31 frames, 3.1 seconds (Wikimedia Commons, 1 October 2009)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ふ is written, stroke by stroke

ふ — *fu*

Four separate strokes, in this order, as KanjiVG records them: a short tick at the top; then the body, starting below it and curving down and to the left; then a small mark low on the left; then a small mark low on the right.

Everything this book has taught you so far has been one, two or three strokes. This is the first sign with four, and the last two are easy to run together by accident. They are separate.

Your turn

1. Trace ふ once, counting the four lifts aloud.
2. Copy it once; hide it; write it again.

3. Check only one thing: are the bottom two marks separate?

Before you move on

How many strokes? (**Four.**)

Source: Unicode Hiragana chart; stroke count and order per KanjiVG.

16.4 ふたつ — two things

Four recalls, then the second thing.

- *Recall*: write ふ, all four strokes — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall*: say *ten*, then *twenty* — **R2**, five lessons back
- *Recall*: say *please* — **R4**, eighty lessons back

You'll Want to Know — hear and say

ふたつ — *fu-ta-tsu* — **two things**

Three signs, and the only new one arrived last lesson.

Now hear the two words together: ひとつ, ふたつ. Both end in つ, and the part in front changes — *hito-*, *futa-*. That つ is not decoration. It is the piece doing the counting, and every word in this chapter but the last one carries it.

に is *two*. ふたつ is *two things*. Same relation as いち and ひとつ, and again the two words share nothing at all.

Your turn — read, copy, recall

Write ふたつ. Say the pair: *hitotsu*, *futatsu*. Then say *ichi*, *ni* straight after, and hear two different counts running side by side.

Before you move on

What does the つ do? (**It counts.**)

Sources: Wiktionary: futatsu.

16.5 みつつ — three things, for nothing

Three recalls, then a word that costs nothing.

- *Recall:* say *two things* — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* run the family reception — **R3**, twenty lessons back
- *Recall:* say *one more time, please* — **R4**, eighty lessons back

You'll Want to Know — hear and say

みつつ — *mi-t-tsu* — **three things**

Every sign is already yours: み, the small つ, and つ.

The small つ is the sign you met in ゆっくり: it holds the mouth shut for one beat. みつつ is three beats, and the middle one is silence.

さん is *three*. みつつ is *three things*.

Your turn — read, copy, recall

Write みつつ. Say the run so far, slowly: *hitotsu, futatsu, mittsu*. Stop on the silent beat in the third one.

Before you move on

How many signs did this word cost? (**None** — all three were yours.)
Sources: Wiktionary: mittsu.

16.6 よつつ — four things, and the seam opens

Three recalls, then the number that has been in both counts all along.

- *Recall:* say *three things* — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* run the nine family words — **R3**, twenty lessons back
- *Recall:* write 世 — **R4**, eighty lessons back

You'll Want to Know — hear and say

よっつ — *yo-t-tsu* — **four things**

No new sign. よ, the small つ, つ.

Grammar Lens — the seam, from the other side

Chapter fourteen taught よん and said something that was left hanging: *that split is coming back; it is the same seam the counters run along*. Here it is.

よん is a native word standing inside the borrowed count. よっつ is that same native word in the count it belongs to. They begin with the same beat, and that is not an accident — it is one word appearing twice:

number	borrowed	native
one	いち	ひと-
two	に	ふた-
three	さん	み-
four	<i>shi</i>	よ-

Every other line of the borrowed column is genuinely borrowed. At four, the native word came across into the borrowed count and stayed — which is why the number you actually say for four is よん and not *shi*. That is what chapter fourteen was pointing at, and you can now see both halves of it at once.

Your turn — read, copy, recall

Write よっつ. Say *yon*, then *yottsu*, and hear the shared beat. Then say *shi* and hear that it has none.

Before you move on

Which two words share a beat? (よん and よっつ.)

Sources: Wiktionary: yottsu.

16.7 いつつ — five things

Three recalls, then five.

- *Recall*: say *four things* — **R1**, one lesson back

- *Recall: say one* — **R3**, twenty lessons back
- *Recall: write お* — **R4**, eighty lessons back

You'll Want to Know — hear and say

いつつ — *i-tsu-tsu* — **five things**

Three signs, and two of them are the same one. い, つ, つ.

A warning worth one sentence: いつつ opens on the same beat as いち, and the two have nothing to do with each other. ご is *five*; いつつ is *five things*; いち is *one*. The ear will try to pair the wrong two.

Your turn — read, copy, recall

Write いつつ. Say *ichi* and *itsutsu* back to back, then *go* and *itsutsu*, and fix which pair actually means the same number.

Before you move on

Which number does いつつ NOT mean? (**One** — however it starts.)
Sources: Wiktionary: itsutsu.

16.8 Five things, and five numbers

Three recalls, then the run.

- *Recall: say five things* — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall: say one thing* — **R2**, six lessons back
- *Recall: say I understood* — **R4**, eighty lessons back

Nothing new arrives here.

Your turn — the run

- *Say it: ichi, hitotsu; ni, futatsu; san, mittsu; yon, yottsu; go, itsutsu*
- *Write it: ひと and ふ* — the two signs this chapter bought

What you've built so far

Five words for **two signs**. ひ and ふ were bought in the lessons immediately before the words that needed them; みつつ, よつつ and izzu cost nothing, because every sign in them was already yours. Two counts of five now run side by side, and they share exactly one thing: at **four**, よん and よつつ begin with the same beat. Everywhere else the two words have nothing in common — *ichi* and *hitotsu*, *ni* and *futatsu*, and so on down. Five more to go, and three more signs.

Before you move on

How many signs did these five words cost? (**Two.**) Where do the two counts touch? (**At four.**)

Chapter 17

The Other Five, and Where the Count Stops

Modes: ⇄ voice (6) ✍ pen (3) ⇄ **Hands-free start:** none of the 9 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can count things from one to ten in the native Japanese series, write the three further signs it cost, and say why the series stops at ten when the borrowed count does not.

Run hitotsu to too in order, name the two numbers whose native word is used in both counts, and say what the two chapters cost in signs.

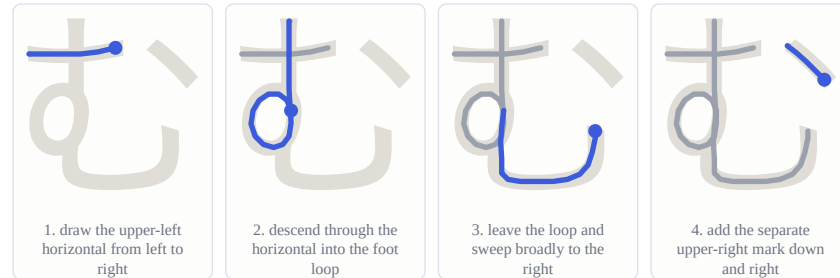
17.1 ㊦ — three strokes, one of them a dot

Three recalls, then one sign.

- *Recall:* say *five things* — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say *five* — **R3**, twenty lessons back
- *Recall:* write ㊦ — **R4**, eighty lessons back

Script — the shape

How it is written — 3 strokes · 2 pen lifts · 4 movements



Stroke order after Sirgazil, Hiragana む stroke order animation.gif, hiragana む 32 frames, 3.2 seconds (Wikimedia Commons, 1 October 2009)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How む is written, stroke by stroke

む — *mu*

Three strokes, in this order, as KanjiVG records them: a horizontal across the upper left; then a long stroke from above it running down and looping at the foot; then a small separate mark up on the right.

That third mark is the one to watch. It is not attached to anything, and a む without it is not a む.

ね also ends in a loop at the foot. The difference is what comes before it and that separate mark on the right.

Your turn

1. Trace む once, counting three lifts.
2. Copy it; hide it; write it again.
3. Check one thing: is the right-hand mark there, and separate?

Before you move on

How many strokes? (**Three.**)

Source: Unicode Hiragana chart; stroke count and order per KanjiVG.

17.2 むつつ — six things

Three recalls, then six.

- *Recall:* write む, all three strokes — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say *two* — **R3**, twenty lessons back
- *Recall:* say *a little* — **R4**, eighty lessons back

You'll Want to Know — hear and say

むつつ — *mu-t-tsu* — six things

む from last lesson, then the small つ and つ.

Last chapter said of ろく: *six has one everyday reading; no native word stands beside it*. That was true of the borrowed count and it is worth putting straight now. The native word for six exists — it is む, and you are holding it. What it does not do is stand inside the borrowed count the way よん does.

Your turn — read, copy, recall

Write むつつ. Say *roku* and *muttsu*: same number, two words, no shared sound. Then run the count so far: *hitotsu*, *futatsu*, *mittsu*, *yottsu*, *itsutsu*, *muttsu*.

Before you move on

Do ろく and むつつ share a sound? (**No.**)

Sources: Wiktionary: muttsu.

17.3 ななつ — seven things, and the seam again

Three recalls, then seven.

- *Recall:* say *six things* — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say *three* — **R3**, twenty lessons back
- *Recall:* write し — **R4**, eighty lessons back

You'll Want to Know — hear and say

ななつ — *na-na-tsu* — seven things

No new sign, and no new word either — you have said なな since the last chapter.

Grammar Lens — the second place the seam shows

なな is the native word, and the borrowed count uses it — the same move you saw at four with よん. Write the two rows out and the pattern is exact:

the reading	four	seven
borrowed reading	<i>shi</i>	<i>shichi</i>
native word, used instead	よん	なな
native count	よっつ	ななつ

Two places in ten where the native word walked into the borrowed count and stayed, and both of them are places where the borrowed reading collides with another word. This is the seam, and you have now seen both ends of it.

Your turn — read, copy, recall

Write ななつ. Say *nana*, then *nanatsu*: the same word, once as a number and once as a count of things.

Before you move on

Which word did this lesson cost you? (**None** — you already had なな.)

Sources: Wiktionary: nanatsu.

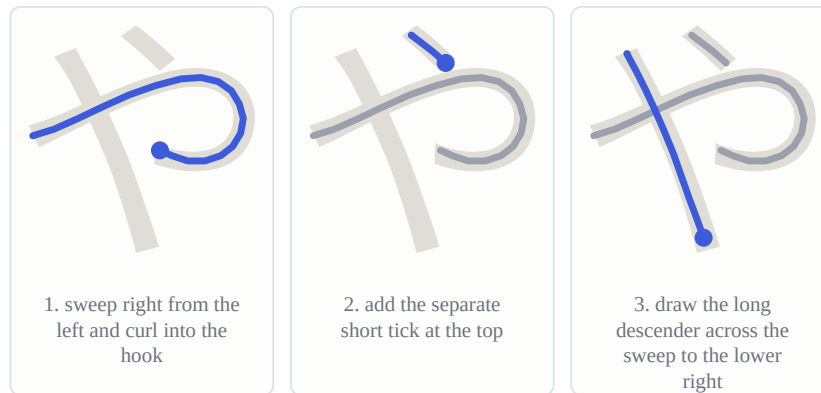
17.4 や — the long stroke goes first

Three recalls, then one sign.

- *Recall*: say *seven things* — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall*: say *four*, and which of its two readings is the native one — **R3**, twenty lessons back
- *Recall*: say *slowly* — **R4**, eighty lessons back

Script — the shape

How it is written — 3 strokes · 2 pen lifts · 3 movements



Stroke order after Sirgazil, Hiragana  stroke order animation.gif, hiragana , 28 frames, 2.8 seconds (Wikimedia Commons, 1 October 2009)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How や is written, stroke by stroke

や — *ya*

Three strokes, and the order is the surprise. KanjiVG has them as: **first** the long sweep, starting low on the left and running up and away to the right; **then** a short tick at the top; **then** the long stroke that comes down through the middle and out to the bottom right.

Look at the finished shape and you would guess the descender was drawn first. It is not. Draw the sweep, then the tick, then the descender.

よ is already yours and shares the same first sound. It is built the other way round — the crossing stroke comes down first there.

Your turn

1. Trace や in the KanjiVG order, saying “sweep, tick, down”.
2. Copy it; hide it; write it again.
3. Write よ beside it and say both.

Before you move on

Which stroke is first? (**The sweep.**)

Source: Unicode Hiragana chart; stroke count and order per KanjiVG.

17.5 やっつ — eight things

Three recalls, then eight.

- *Recall:* write や, sweep first — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say *four* — **R3**, twenty lessons back
- *Recall:* write 𐰇 — **R4**, eighty lessons back

You'll Want to Know — hear and say

やっつ — *ya-t-tsu* — **eight things**

や from last lesson, the small っ, and つ.

Eight is the plain case. はち is the borrowed word, やっつ is the native one, neither has walked into the other's count, and there is nothing to disentangle. The last chapter used はち for exactly the same job — to show what the ordinary case looks like once the odd ones have been seen.

Say the run: *hitotsu, futatsu, mittsu, yottsu, itsutsu, muttsu, nanatsu, yattsu*. Eight of ten, and two signs left to buy.

Your turn — read, copy, recall

Write やっつ. Say *hachi*, then *yattsu*. Then run the eight in order without stopping.

Before you move on

Is eight one of the crossing places? (**No.**)

Sources: Wiktionary: *yattsu*.

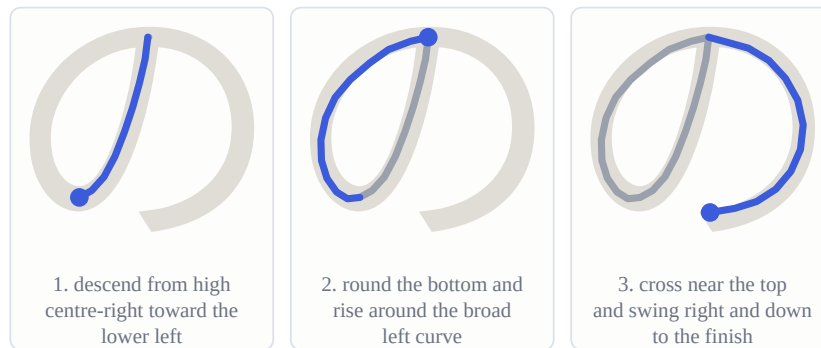
17.6 の — one stroke, and the last sign of the chapter

Three recalls, then the fifth and last sign.

- *Recall: say eight things* — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall: say seven* — **R3**, twenty lessons back
- *Recall: say please say it* — **R4**, eighty lessons back

Script — the shape

How it is written — one unbroken stroke · 3 movements



Stroke order after Sirgazil, Hiragana  stroke order animation.gif, hiragana , 32 frames, 3.2 seconds (Wikimedia Commons, 1 October 2009)

This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How の is written, stroke by stroke

の — *no*

One stroke. KanjiVG's data holds a single path: start high and to the right of centre, run down and left, round the bottom, up the left side and across the top, finishing by crossing what you have just drawn.

ひ, from the start of this chapter, was also one stroke and never closed. の closes and then keeps going.

This is the fifth sign this chapter has bought, and the last. Everything after it is words.

Your turn

1. Trace の once without lifting.
2. Copy it; hide it; write it again.
3. Write ひ and の side by side: one stroke each, one open, one crossed.

Before you move on

How many signs has this chapter bought? (**Five**, and this is the last.)

Source: Unicode Hiragana chart; stroke count and order per KanjiVG.

17.7 ここのつ — nine things

Three recalls, then the longest word in the chapter.

- *Recall*: write の — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall*: say *nine* — **R3**, twenty lessons back
- *Recall*: say *here* — **R4**, eighty lessons back

You'll Want to Know — hear and say

ここのつ — *ko-ko-no-tsu* — **nine things**

Four beats, four signs, and only の is new — you bought it last lesson.

Read the first two signs on their own: ここ, the word for *here* you have had since chapter ten. **They are the same two signs, and it means nothing.** *kokono-* is simply the native word for nine; it is not built on *here* and there is no story joining them. Say so and move on — an accident that gets explained is worse than one that gets named.

What it does mean is that you can write this four-beat word straight away, which no other word in the chapter has managed.

Your turn — read, copy, recall

Write ここのつ. Say *hachi*, *ku*, then *yattsu*, *kokonotsu* — both counts, two numbers each. Then say *ku* and *kokonotsu* again. Then say *koko* and *kokonotsu* and remind yourself that the second is not made of the first.

Before you move on

How many beats? (**Four.**)

Sources: Wiktionary: kokonotsu.

17.8 とお — ten things, and the end of the run

Three recalls, then the last word.

- *Recall: say nine things* — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall: say ten, then twenty-five* — **R3**, twenty lessons back
- *Recall: say a little more* — **R4**, eighty lessons back

You'll Want to Know — hear and say

とお — *tō* — **ten things**

Two signs, both old, and **no つ at all**.

Nine words in this count carry the つ that does the counting. The tenth drops it, and that is not a spelling quirk — it is the edge of the count. とお is where the native series ends. There is no *eleven things* in it.

Above ten, Japanese has only the borrowed count and a counter word, which is exactly the machinery the next chapter is for. じゅう goes on to ninety-nine; とお goes nowhere.

Your turn — read, copy, recall

Write とお. Say *juu*, then *tō*: same number, and only one of them can be built on. Then say *kokonotsu*, *tō* and stop.

Before you move on

Can you say *eleven things* this way? (**No.**)
Sources: Wiktionary: too.

17.9 The other ten, in order at last

Three recalls, then the run.

- *Recall: say ten things* — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall: say one thing* — **R2**, thirteen lessons back
- *Recall: say I understood* — **R4**, eighty lessons back
- *Recall: say here* — **R4**, eighty lessons back

Nothing new arrives here.

Your turn — the run

- *Say it:* the borrowed ten, then the native ten, back to back
- *Say it:* *ku*, then *kokonotsu* — the two nines, one from each count
- *Write it:* ㇿ from last chapter, then ひ, ふ, む, や, の — the one sign the borrowed count bought late, and the five this chapter bought

What you've built this chapter

Ten words, and **five signs**: ひ, ふ, む, や, の. Five of the ten words cost nothing at all — みつつ, よつつ, いくつ, ななつ and とお were spelled entirely out of signs you already had.

Two things about the shape of what you now hold:

- The native count **stops at ten**. とお carries no つ and nothing is built on it. The borrowed count runs to ninety-nine on じゅう alone.
- At **four** and **seven** the native word is the one used in *both* counts. Nowhere else.

What the chapter has not yet said is what つ actually is. It is not a decoration and it is not part of the words: it is a **counter**, and the next chapter is about choosing one.

Before you move on

How many signs did the chapter cost? (**Five.**) Where does the native count stop? (**At とお.**) Which two numbers use the native word in both counts? (**Four and seven.**)

Chapter 18

A Counter for the Shape of the Thing

Modes:  voice (6)  eyes (1)  pen (2)  Hands-free start: first 4 of 9 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can put a counter behind a number in Japanese, choose between the general one, the one for people and the one for long thin things, and say which one to reach for when I do not know.

Complete JA-R18-counting-things: say one thing, one person and one long thin thing, count two eyes, two legs, two people and two hairs, and state the rule with both its edges.

18.1 What the $\supset$ was doing

Three recalls, then the word for what you have been doing.

- *Recall:* say *one thing* and *two things* — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say *eight things* — **R2**, five lessons back
- *Recall:* say *six* — **R3**, twenty lessons back
- *Recall:* ask for it more slowly, in full — **R4**, eighty lessons back

Grammar Lens — a number cannot stand alone

In Japanese a number does not simply sit in front of a thing. It takes a **counter** — a small word behind the number that says what kind of thing is being counted. Wikipedia's article calls counters *measure words used with numbers to count things, actions, and events*, and English has a few of the same shape: *two **sheets** of paper, three **head** of cattle*.

You have been using one since chapter nine and nobody said so.

いちど — *ichido* — **one time**

Its own lesson said: *ichi is one, and do counts an occurrence*. That ど is a counter. It counts occurrences, which is why いちど is *one time* and not *one*.

And the つ you spent all of last chapter on is a counter too — the **general** one. That is why nine of the ten native words carry it and とお does not.

You'll Want to Know — when to reach for it

Japanese has a great many counters and you will not learn them all here. What you can learn in one sentence is the rule that gets you through:

When you do not know the counter, use the ~つ series.

Up to ten it will carry almost any ordinary object.

That is exactly what Wikipedia says of the traditional numerals — that the problem of choosing *can often be sidestepped* by using them. ひとつ to とお, and no further, because that is where the series stops.

コーヒー ふたつ — two coffees. Nobody will blink.

The rule has an edge, and it is the next lesson: **people and animals do not take ~つ**. They have counters of their own and there is no way round it.

Your turn — read, copy, recall

Say コーヒー ふたつ. Then say いちど and name the counter inside it.

Before you move on

What do you use when you do not know the counter? (~っ, up to ten.)

Sources: Wikipedia: Japanese counter word; Wiktionary: hitotsu.

18.2 にん — counting people

Three recalls, then the counter the last rule cannot reach.

- *Recall*: say what to use when you do not know the counter — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall*: write の — **R2**, five lessons back
- *Recall*: write the small っ — **R3**, twenty lessons back
- *Recall*: write the small っ — **R4**, eighty lessons back

You'll Want to Know — hear and say

にん — *-nin* — the counter for **people**

Both signs are old. What is new is that it attaches to the **borrowed** numbers, not the native ones:

how many	how you say it
three people	さんにん
four people	よにん
five people	ごにん
ten people	じゅうにん

さん plus にん, ご plus にん. Nothing changes. Four is the one to watch: it is よ, not よん — the native word again, and shorter here.

You have nine family words and until now no way to say how many of anything you had. こども さんにん — three children.

Grammar Lens — where the tsu rule stops

Last lesson's rule had an edge, and this is it. ~っ **never counts people**. There is no *hitotsu* of a person; you cannot sidestep にん, and the same is true of animals, which have counters of their own. So the rule now reads with both ends showing: **use ~っ for ordinary things up to ten; use the proper counter for anything alive.**

And にん itself has an exception, at exactly two numbers. That is the next lesson.

Your turn — read, copy, recall

Write にん. Say *sannin*, *yonin*, *gonin*, *juunin*. Then say こども さんにん.

Before you move on

Which number is odd in this list? (**Four** — よにん, not *yonnin*.)
Sources: Wikipedia: Japanese counter word.

18.3 ひとり・ふたり — one person, two people

Three recalls, then the two people the last lesson could not count.

- Recall: say *three people* — **R1**, one lesson back
- Recall: say *nine things* — **R2**, five lessons back
- Recall: say *ten*, then *twelve* — **R3**, twenty lessons back
- Recall: write ㊦ — **R4**, eighty lessons back

You'll Want to Know — hear and say

ひとり — *hitori* — **one person**

ふたり — *futari* — **two people**

Not *ichinin*. Not *ninin*. Every other number takes にん and these two do not.

Every sign is yours: ひ and ふ came two chapters ago, と, た and り long before.

Grammar Lens — the seam, one more time

Read the four words together and the exception stops looking like one:

number	native count	with the people counter
one	ひとつ	ひとり
two	ふたつ	ふたり
three	みっつ	さんにん

hito- and *futa-* are the same pieces you learned two chapters ago. At one and two, the **native** number walks into the borrowed counter and stays; from three on, the borrowed number takes over. That is the third time you have seen this. At よん and なな the native word stood inside the borrowed count. Here the native word stands inside a borrowed counter. It is one seam, and it runs the whole length of Japanese numbers.

あね ひとり、あに ふたり — one elder sister, two elder brothers.

Your turn — read, copy, recall

Write ひとり and ふたり. Say *hitori*, *futari*, *sannin*, *yonin* — and hear the switch happen between the second and the third.

Before you move on

Where does the switch happen? (**Between two and three.**)

Sources: Wikipedia: Japanese counter word.

18.4 Counting your own face

Three recalls, then the first thing in this book you can count.

- *Recall*: say *one person* and *two people* — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall*: say *face* — **R3**, twenty lessons back
- *Recall*: write た — **R4**, eighty lessons back

Your turn — count what you have

Chapter twelve gave you a face. Until this chapter you could name every part of it and say how many of nothing.

め ふたつ — two eyes

みみ ふたつ — two ears

はな ひとつ — one nose

くち ひとつ — one mouth

Four nouns, none of them alive on its own, so the ~つ rule covers all four without your having to know a thing about which counter a nose takes.

- *Say it:* the four face lines without stopping, then ふたり

Before you move on

Which of the four needed you to know a special counter? (**None.**)
Which nearby word did? (**A person** — ふたり, not ふたつ.)

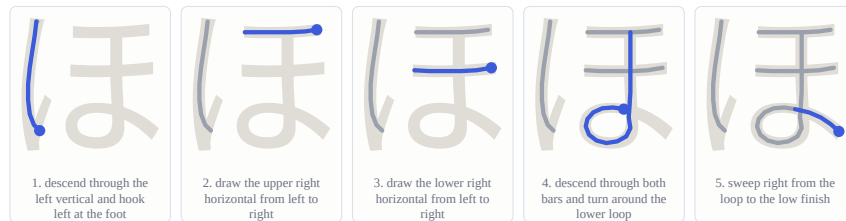
18.5 ほ — は with one more bar

Three recalls, then the last sign of the chapter.

- *Recall:* count the four parts of a face — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* write ひ — **R3**, twenty lessons back
- *Recall:* write だ — **R4**, eighty lessons back

Script — the shape

How it is written — 4 strokes · 3 pen lifts · 5 movements



Stroke order after Sirgazil, Hiragana stroke order animation.gif, hiragana 37 frames, 3.7 seconds (Wikimedia Commons, 1 October 2009)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ほ is written, stroke by stroke

ほ — *ho*

Write は first. You have had it since chapter one: a left vertical, one horizontal, then the right stroke that loops at the foot.

ほ is that figure with **one more horizontal**, and Sirgazil's animation puts it above the one は already has. Four strokes, in this order:

1. the left vertical, hooking at the foot
2. the **upper** horizontal on the right
3. the **lower** horizontal on the right
4. the right vertical, down through both bars and looping at the foot

So the only thing you are learning is a bar, and where it goes.

ほ also finishes a set. Japanese's **h-row** runs *ha*, *hi*, *fu*, *he*, *ho*, and you now hold four of its five: は from chapter one, ひ and ふ from two chapters ago, and ほ here. Only へ is missing.

Write ひ once beside them and hear the row.

Your turn

1. Write は, then ほ beneath it, and mark the stroke that differs.
2. Copy ほ; hide it; write it again.
3. Say both aloud: *ha*, *ho*. Then say ひとつ and hear the same ひ.

Before you move on

How many strokes? (**Four.**)

Source: Unicode Hiragana chart; stroke count and order per KanjiVG and Sirgazil's Commons animation.

18.6 ほん — counting long thin things

Three recalls, then a counter chosen by shape.

- *Recall*: write ほ — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall*: say *hand* — **R4**, eighty lessons back
- *Recall*: say what ~つ is for, and what it is not for — **R2**, five lessons back

You'll Want to Know — hear and say

ほん — *-hon* — the counter for **long, thin things**

Wikipedia's list for it is worth reading whole: *rivers, roads, train tracks, ties, pencils, bottles, guitars*. Nothing on that list is a book, though the sign it is written with is 本 — the very kanji you have been writing since chapter five, inside 日本語.

That is the shape rule in one word: ほん does not care what the thing *is*, only that it is longer than it is wide.

Two of your own words qualify. One of them you can already say:

あし にほん — two legs

The other is かみ, a hair — and the word for *one* hair has to wait two lessons, because at one the counter changes shape.

Grammar Lens — the counter bends the sound

にん attached to the numbers and nothing moved. ほん does not behave. Here are the four that leave it alone:

number	the form
two	にほん
four	よんほん
five	ごほん
seven	ななほん

At **three** the ぽ takes the **dakuten** you have had since chapter three, and at **one, six, eight and ten** it goes further still — further than the dakuten can take it. Both of those need a mark on the sign, and the second mark is one this book has never taught. The next two lessons buy it and then spend it; until then, say the four plain ones.

Your turn — read, copy, recall

Write ほん. Say *nihon, yonhon, gohon, nanahon* — the four that leave the counter alone. Then say あし にほん.

Before you move on

What does ほん count? (**Anything longer than it is wide.**)

Sources: Wikipedia: Japanese counter word.

18.7 ° — the other mark

Three recalls, then the mark the last lesson stopped short of.

- *Recall: say three long thin things* — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall: write ふ, all four strokes* — **R3**, twenty lessons back
- *Recall: say ear* — **R4**, eighty lessons back

Script — the shape

° — the **handakuten**

A small circle, written at the top right of a kana, in the same place the **dakuten** goes.

Japanese has exactly two of these marks and you have had one of them since chapter three:

mark	what it does	example
゛ dakuten	voices the consonant	ほ → ぼ
゜ handakuten	turns the h -row into p	ほ → ぽ

The handakuten works on **one row only** — the row は and ほ belong to. Nowhere else in the syllabary does it appear, which makes it the rarest thing in the writing system and the easiest to place: if you see the little circle, the sign under it is an h-row kana and the sound is **p**.

That row is the one you have just been filling in. ふ takes both marks too, giving *bu* and *pu*, and so does ぷ. The mark is rare; the row is not.

Write the circle small. It is a circle, not a dot, and it does not touch the sign it sits on.

Your turn

1. Write ほ, then ぼ, then ぽ, and say all three.
2. Say the same three sounds on は, without writing them.
3. Check one thing: is the circle open?

Before you move on

Which row does the handakuten work on? (**Only the h-row.**)

Source: Unicode Hiragana chart, U+309C.

18.8 いっぽん — and the four that bend

Three recalls, then the form the counter takes at one.

- *Recall*: write ぽ — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall*: say *mouth* — **R4**, eighty lessons back
- *Recall*: write the small つ — **R2**, six lessons back

You'll Want to Know — hear and say

いっぽん — *ippon* — one long thin thing

Not *ichihon*. The いち shortens to っ, and the ぽ takes the handakuten you learned last lesson.

Here is the whole counter, with the numbers this book can spell:

number	the form	what happens
one	いっぽん	p , and a held beat
two	にほん	plain
three	さんぽん	b
four	よんほん	plain
five	ごほん	plain
six	ろっぽん	p , and a held beat
seven	ななほん	plain
eight	はっぽん	p , and a held beat
ten	じゅうぽん	p , and a held beat

Nine is missing from that table on purpose. Its everyday form needs a sign this book has not taught, so it is left out rather than guessed at.

Read the shape of the rest: **one, six, eight and ten** all end in a held beat and take **p**. **Three** ends in the nasal ん and takes **b**. Everything else is plain. The counter is not being irregular — it is being pushed by the sound in front of it.

かみ いっぽん — one hair.

Your turn — read, copy, recall

Write いっぱん. Say the run: *ippon, nihon, sanbon, yonhon, gohon, roppon*. Then say かみ いっぱん.

Before you move on

Why is nine missing from the table? (**Its form needs a sign this book has not taught.**)

Sources: Wikipedia: Japanese counter word.

18.9 Three counters, and how to choose

Three recalls, then the run.

- *Recall*: say *one long thin thing* — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall*: say *three things* and *four things* — **R3**, twenty lessons back
- *Recall*: say *nose* — **R4**, eighty lessons back
- *Recall*: say *leg* — **R4**, eighty lessons back
- *Recall*: say what to use when you do not know the counter — **R2**, nine lessons back

Nothing new arrives here.

Your turn — the run

- *Say it*: かみ いっぱん, あし にほん, ふたり, はな ひとつ
- *Write it*: ぽ, then the same sign with the handakuten — ぽ

What you've built this chapter

A number in Japanese does not stand on its own. It takes a **counter**, and the counter is chosen by what kind of thing is being counted:

the thing	the counter
an ordinary object, up to ten	~つ
a person	にん
anything longer than it is wide	ほん
an occurrence	ど, which you had in chapter nine

Both edges of that are worth carrying. **Reach for ~つ when you do not know** — up to ten it will carry almost any ordinary object. **Do not reach for it for anything alive**, and do not expect it past ten. And the seam this book has been drawing since chapter fourteen runs through all of it. よん and なな: the native word inside the borrowed count. ひとり and ふたり: the native word inside a borrowed counter. Two counts, and the places where they touch are not random — they are the same handful of numbers, every time.

Before you move on

What do you use when you do not know the counter? (~つ, to ten.)
Where does that rule fail? (**Anything alive.**) Say one person and one hair. (ひとり; かみ いっぽん.)

Chapter 19

Reading — Words, Greetings, and the Cues You Have Only Heard

Modes: 🗣️ voice (2) 👁️ eyes (1) 🗣️ Hands-free start: none of the 3 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can read Japanese words, greetings and classroom cues off a page, without anyone saying them first.

The repair cues the book has only ever spoken, read in order, ending with the longest stretch of Japanese it has set on one page.

19.1 (reading) — six words, nothing said first

You have written every sign in every one of these. Not one word is new.

What is new is that nobody says them before you read them.

Read this

て みみ くち はな かお め

Read down the list once. Do not sound out each sign — look at the whole word and let it arrive.

Again, and notice which came at once and which you had to build. Both are fine. The difference is what practice removes.

What to know first

Two of these are one sign long. て and め are whole words, and you have written both as signs on their own.

That is worth noticing, because it is the thing hiragana does that an alphabet does not: a sign can be a letter and a word at the same time, and nothing on the page tells you which it is. Only knowing the word does.

Six is enough for one sitting.

Your turn

- *Say it:* the six words down the list, once, without stopping

Twice through:

Before you move on

How many of the six were new? (**None.**)

What was new? (**Nobody said them first.** You read them.)

19.2 (reading) — the doorway words, on the page

The last lesson gave you six words. These are the six the book opened with.

Every one of them reached your ear before it reached a page.
Today that order is reversed.

Read this

はい いいえ こんにちは ありがとう さようなら
すみません

Read down once, without stopping.

Again — and notice that the two longest are the two you say most often. Length is not difficulty here; familiarity is.

What to know first

こんにちは ends in は, and you know that sign says *ha*. In this word it is read *wa*, because the greeting keeps a spelling from an older sentence that nobody finishes any more.

You do not need the history to read it. You need to know that this one word is spelled the way it is for a reason, and that reading a language means meeting a handful of such words rather than a rule you can apply.

Six lines, and one of them is a small piece of history.

Your turn

- *Say it:* the six lines, once, without stopping

Twice through:

Before you move on

How many of the six were new? (**None.**)

Which sign is read differently in one of them? (は, in こんにちは.)

19.3 (reading) — the cues you have only ever heard

Six words, then six greetings. These are the longest lines the book has set on one page.

Every one of them is a cue you already use. None is new.

Read this

ここ すこし わかりました わかりません
もういちど、おねがいします
もうすこし、ゆっくりいってください

Read down once, without stopping. The list gets longer as it goes; let it.

Again — and notice that the last two are the only ones with a comma in them, and that the comma falls exactly where you pause when you say it.

What to know first

わかりました and わかりません differ in three signs at the end and in nothing else. Understood, and not understood.

That is the pair worth being able to read rather than only hear. A cue you can only recognise when somebody says it to you is a cue you can only use when they do. Read once off a page, it becomes something you can reach for.

Six lines, and the last one is fourteen signs long — the longest stretch of Japanese this book has asked you to take in at once.

Your turn

- *Say it:* the six lines, once, in order, without stopping

Twice through:

Before you move on

How many of the six were new? (**None.**)
Which two differ only at the end? (わかりました and
わかりません.)

Chapter 20

Nail, Elbow, Knee, Throat, Chest

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a nail, an elbow, a knee, the throat and the chest.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 20: i can say a nail, an elbow, a knee, the throat and the chest.

20.1 つめ (tsume) — a nail (finger or toe)

Before the new one: say the Japanese for one person, two people, then the Japanese for the counter for long things.

You'll want to know: つめ

つめ — *tsume* — “a nail (finger or toe)”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tsume*
- *Say it: tsume, once more*
- *Say it: say tsume*

- *Recall*: say the Japanese for one person, two people, then the Japanese for the counter for long things, then say *tsume* again

Before you move on

What does つめ mean? (“A nail (finger or toe)”). Say it once more.

20.2 ひじ (hiji) — an elbow

Before the new one: say the Japanese for the counter for long things, then the Japanese for a nail.

You’ll want to know: ひじ

ひじ — *hiji* — “an elbow”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it*: *hiji*
- *Say it*: *hiji*, once more
- *Say it*: say *hiji*
- *Recall*: say the Japanese for the counter for long things, then the Japanese for a nail, then say *hiji* again

Before you move on

What does ひじ mean? (“An elbow”). Say it once more.

20.3 ひざ (hiza) — a knee

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a nail, then the Japanese for an elbow.

You'll want to know: ひざ

ひざ — *hiza* — “a knee”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: hiza*
- *Say it: hiza, once more*
- *Say it: say hiza*
- *Recall: say the Japanese for a nail, then the Japanese for an elbow, then say hiza again*

Before you move on

What does ひざ mean? (“A knee”.) Say it once more.

20.4 のど (nodo) — the throat

Before the new one: say the Japanese for an elbow, then the Japanese for a knee.

You'll want to know: のど

のど — *nodo* — “the throat”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nodo*
- *Say it: nodo, once more*
- *Say it: say nodo*

- *Recall*: say the Japanese for an elbow, then the Japanese for a knee, then say *nodo* again

Before you move on

What does のど mean? (“The throat”.) Say it once more.

20.5 むね (mune) — the chest

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a knee, then the Japanese for the throat.

You’ll want to know: むね

むね — *mune* — “the chest”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it*: *mune*
- *Say it*: *mune*, once more
- *Say it*: say *mune*
- *Recall*: say the Japanese for a knee, then the Japanese for the throat, then say *mune* again

Before you move on

What does むね mean? (“The chest”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 21

Bone, Chin, Cheek, Eyebrow, Skin

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

***By the end of this chapter:** I can say a bone, the chin, a cheek, an eyebrow and skin.*

Complete the last lesson of chapter 21: i can say a bone, the chin, a cheek, an eyebrow and skin.

21.1 ほね (hone) — a bone

Before the new one: say the Japanese for the throat, then the Japanese for the chest.

You'll want to know: ほね

ほね — *hone* — “a bone”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: hone*
- *Say it: hone, once more*
- *Say it: say hone*

- *Recall*: say the Japanese for the throat, then the Japanese for the chest, then say *hone* again

Before you move on

What does ほね mean? (“A bone”.) Say it once more.

21.2 あご (ago) — the chin

Before the new one: say the Japanese for the chest, then the Japanese for a bone.

You’ll want to know: あご

あご — *ago* — “the chin”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it*: *ago*
- *Say it*: *ago*, once more
- *Say it*: say *ago*
- *Recall*: say the Japanese for the chest, then the Japanese for a bone, then say *ago* again

Before you move on

What does あご mean? (“The chin”.) Say it once more.

21.3 ほお (hoo) — a cheek

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a bone, then the Japanese for the chin.

You'll want to know: ほお

ほお — *hoo* — “a cheek”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: hoo*
- *Say it: hoo*, once more
- *Say it: say hoo*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for a bone, then the Japanese for the chin, then say *hoo* again

Before you move on

What does ほお mean? (“A cheek”.) Say it once more.

21.4 まゆ (mayu) — an eyebrow

Before the new one: say the Japanese for the chin, then the Japanese for a cheek.

You'll want to know: まゆ

まゆ — *mayu* — “an eyebrow”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mayu*
- *Say it: mayu*, once more
- *Say it: say mayu*

- *Recall:* say the Japanese for the chin, then the Japanese for a cheek, then say *mayu* again

Before you move on

What does まゆ mean? (“An eyebrow”.) Say it once more.

21.5 はだ (hada) — skin

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a cheek, then the Japanese for an eyebrow.

You’ll want to know: はだ

はだ — *hada* — “skin”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: hada*
- *Say it: hada, once more*
- *Say it: say hada*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for a cheek, then the Japanese for an eyebrow, then say *hada* again

Before you move on

What does はだ mean? (“Skin”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 22

Sweat, Tears, Voice, Fever, Painful

Modes: 🔄 voice (5) 🔄 Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say sweat, tears, a voice, a fever and painful, it hurts.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 22: i can say sweat, tears, a voice, a fever and painful, it hurts.

22.1 あせ (ase) — sweat

Before the new one: say the Japanese for an eyebrow, then the Japanese for skin.

You'll want to know: あせ

あせ — *ase* — “sweat”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ase*
- *Say it: ase, once more*
- *Say it: say ase*

- *Recall*: say the Japanese for an eyebrow, then the Japanese for skin, then say *ase* again

Before you move on

What does あせ mean? (“Sweat”.) Say it once more.

22.2 なみだ (namida) — tears

Before the new one: say the Japanese for skin, then the Japanese for sweat.

You’ll want to know: なみだ

なみだ — *namida* — “tears”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it*: *namida*
- *Say it*: *namida*, once more
- *Say it*: say *namida*
- *Recall*: say the Japanese for skin, then the Japanese for sweat, then say *namida* again

Before you move on

What does なみだ mean? (“Tears”.) Say it once more.

22.3 こゑ (koe) — a voice

Before the new one: say the Japanese for sweat, then the Japanese for tears.

You'll want to know: こゑ

こゑ — *koe* — “a voice”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: koe*
- *Say it: koe*, once more
- *Say it: say koe*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for sweat, then the Japanese for tears, then say *koe* again

Before you move on

What does こゑ mean? (“A voice”.) Say it once more.

22.4 ねつ (*netsu*) — a fever

Before the new one: say the Japanese for tears, then the Japanese for a voice.

You'll want to know: ねつ

ねつ — *netsu* — “a fever”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: netsu*
- *Say it: netsu*, once more
- *Say it: say netsu*

- *Recall*: say the Japanese for tears, then the Japanese for a voice, then say *netsu* again

Before you move on

What does ねつ mean? (“A fever”.) Say it once more.

22.5 いたい (itai) — painful, it hurts

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a voice, then the Japanese for a fever.

You’ll want to know: いたい

いたい — *itai* — “painful, it hurts”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it*: *itai*
- *Say it*: *itai*, once more
- *Say it*: say *itai*
- *Recall*: say the Japanese for a voice, then the Japanese for a fever, then say *itai* again

Before you move on

What does いたい mean? (“Painful, it hurts”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 23

Medicine, Sleepy, Sad, Fun, Scary

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say medicine, sleepy, sad, fun, enjoyable and scary.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 23: i can say medicine, sleepy, sad, fun, enjoyable and scary.

23.1 くすり (kusuri) — medicine

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a fever, then the Japanese for painful.

You'll want to know: くすり

くすり — *kusuri* — “medicine”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kusuri*
- *Say it: kusuri, once more*
- *Say it: say kusuri*

- *Recall*: say the Japanese for a fever, then the Japanese for painful, then say *kusuri* again

Before you move on

What does くすり mean? (“Medicine”.) Say it once more.

23.2 ねむい (nemui) — sleepy

Before the new one: say the Japanese for painful, then the Japanese for medicine.

You’ll want to know: ねむい

ねむい — *nemui* — “sleepy”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it*: *nemui*
- *Say it*: *nemui*, once more
- *Say it*: say *nemui*
- *Recall*: say the Japanese for painful, then the Japanese for medicine, then say *nemui* again

Before you move on

What does ねむい mean? (“Sleepy”.) Say it once more.

23.3 かなしい (kanashii) — sad

Before the new one: say the Japanese for medicine, then the Japanese for sleepy.

You'll want to know: かなしい

かなしい — *kanashii* — “sad”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kanashii*
- *Say it: kanashii*, once more
- *Say it: say kanashii*
- *Recall: say the Japanese for medicine, then the Japanese for sleepy, then say kanashii again*

Before you move on

What does かなしい mean? (“Sad”.) Say it once more.

23.4 たのしい (*tanoshii*) — fun, enjoyable

Before the new one: say the Japanese for sleepy, then the Japanese for sad.

You'll want to know: たのしい

たのしい — *tanoshii* — “fun, enjoyable”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tanoshii*
- *Say it: tanoshii*, once more
- *Say it: say tanoshii*

- *Recall:* say the Japanese for sleepy, then the Japanese for sad, then say *tanoshii* again

Before you move on

What does たのしい mean? (“Fun, enjoyable”.) Say it once more.

23.5 こわい (kawai) — scary

Before the new one: say the Japanese for sad, then the Japanese for fun.

You’ll want to know: こわい

こわい — *kawai* — “scary”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *kawai*
- *Say it:* *kawai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kawai*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for sad, then the Japanese for fun, then say *kawai* again

Before you move on

What does こわい mean? (“Scary”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 24

Pain, Grandfather, Uncle, Son, Daughter

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say pain, a grandfather, an uncle, a son and a daughter.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 24: i can say pain, a grandfather, an uncle, a son and a daughter.

24.1 いたみ (itami) — pain

Before the new one: say the Japanese for fun, then the Japanese for scary.

You'll want to know: いたみ

いたみ — *itami* — “pain”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *itami*
- Say it: *itami*, once more

- *Say it:* say *itami*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for fun, then the Japanese for scary, then say *itami* again

Before you move on

What does **いたみ** mean? (“Pain”.) Say it once more.

24.2 おじいさん (ojiisan) — a grandfather

Before the new one: say the Japanese for scary, then the Japanese for pain.

You’ll want to know: おじいさん

おじいさん — *ojiisan* — “a grandfather”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ojiisan*
- *Say it:* *ojiisan*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ojiisan*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for scary, then the Japanese for pain, then say *ojiisan* again

Before you move on

What does **おじいさん** mean? (“A grandfather”.) Say it once more.

24.3 おじさん (ojisan) — an uncle

Before the new one: say the Japanese for pain, then the Japanese for a grandfather.

You'll want to know: おじさん

おじさん — *ojisan* — “an uncle”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ojisan*
- *Say it: ojisan*, once more
- *Say it: say ojisan*
- *Recall: say the Japanese for pain, then the Japanese for a grandfather, then say ojisan again*

Before you move on

What does おじさん mean? (“An uncle”.) Say it once more.

24.4 むすこ (*musuko*) — a son

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a grandfather, then the Japanese for an uncle.

You'll want to know: むすこ

むすこ — *musuko* — “a son”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: musuko*
- *Say it: musuko*, once more
- *Say it: say musuko*

- *Recall*: say the Japanese for a grandfather, then the Japanese for an uncle, then say *musuko* again

Before you move on

What does むすこ mean? (“A son”.) Say it once more.

24.5 むすめ (musume) — a daughter

Before the new one: say the Japanese for an uncle, then the Japanese for a son.

You’ll want to know: むすめ

むすめ — *musume* — “a daughter”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: musume*
- *Say it: musume*, once more
- *Say it: say musume*
- *Recall*: say the Japanese for an uncle, then the Japanese for a son, then say *musume* again

Before you move on

What does むすめ mean? (“A daughter”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 25

Friend, Adult, Man, Woman, Teacher

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a friend, an adult, a man, a woman and a teacher.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 25: i can say a friend, an adult, a man, a woman and a teacher.

25.1 ともだち (tomodachi) — a friend

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a son, then the Japanese for a daughter.

You'll want to know: ともだち

ともだち — *tomodachi* — “a friend”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *tomodachi*
- Say it: *tomodachi*, once more

- *Say it:* say *tomodachi*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for a son, then the Japanese for a daughter, then say *tomodachi* again

Before you move on

What does **ともだち** mean? (“A friend”.) Say it once more.

25.2 おとな (*otona*) — an adult

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a daughter, then the Japanese for a friend.

You’ll want to know: おとな

おとな — *otona* — “an adult”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *otona*
- *Say it:* *otona*, once more
- *Say it:* say *otona*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for a daughter, then the Japanese for a friend, then say *otona* again

Before you move on

What does **おとな** mean? (“An adult”.) Say it once more.

25.3 おとこ (*otoko*) — a man

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a friend, then the Japanese for an adult.

You'll want to know: おとこ

おとこ — *otoko* — “a man”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: otoko*
- *Say it: otoko*, once more
- *Say it: say otoko*
- *Recall: say the Japanese for a friend, then the Japanese for an adult, then say otoko again*

Before you move on

What does おとこ mean? (“A man”.) Say it once more.

25.4 おんな (onna) — a woman

Before the new one: say the Japanese for an adult, then the Japanese for a man.

You'll want to know: おんな

おんな — *onna* — “a woman”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: onna*
- *Say it: onna*, once more
- *Say it: say onna*

- *Recall*: say the Japanese for an adult, then the Japanese for a man, then say *onna* again

Before you move on

What does おんな mean? (“A woman”.) Say it once more.

25.5 せんせい (sensei) — a teacher

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a man, then the Japanese for a woman.

You’ll want to know: せんせい

せんせい — *sensei* — “a teacher”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sensei*
- *Say it: sensei*, once more
- *Say it: say sensei*
- *Recall*: say the Japanese for a man, then the Japanese for a woman, then say *sensei* again

Before you move on

What does せんせい mean? (“A teacher”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 26

Next door, Companion, To go, To buy, To drink

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say next door, a companion, to go, to buy and to drink.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 26: i can say next door, a companion, to go, to buy and to drink.

26.1 となり (tonari) — next door; a neighbour

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a woman, then the Japanese for a teacher.

You'll want to know: となり

となり — *tonari* — “next door; a neighbour”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *tonari*
- Say it: *tonari*, once more

- *Say it:* say *tonari*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for a woman, then the Japanese for a teacher, then say *tonari* again

Before you move on

What does となり mean? (“Next door; a neighbour”.) Say it once more.

26.2 なかま (nakama) — a companion

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a teacher, then the Japanese for next door; a neighbour.

You’ll want to know: なかま

なかま — *nakama* — “a companion”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *nakama*
- *Say it:* *nakama*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nakama*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for a teacher, then the Japanese for next door; a neighbour, then say *nakama* again

Before you move on

What does なかま mean? (“A companion”.) Say it once more.

26.3 いく (iku) — to go

Before the new one: say the Japanese for next door; a neighbour, then the Japanese for a companion.

You'll want to know: いく

いく — *iku* — “to go”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: iku*
- *Say it: iku*, once more
- *Say it: say iku*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for next door; a neighbour, then the Japanese for a companion, then say *iku* again

Before you move on

What does いく mean? (“To go”.) Say it once more.

26.4 かう (kau) — to buy

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a companion, then the Japanese for to go.

You'll want to know: かう

かう — *kau* — “to buy”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kau*
- *Say it: kau*, once more
- *Say it: say kau*

- *Recall:* say the Japanese for a companion, then the Japanese for to go, then say *kau* again

Before you move on

What does かう mean? (“To buy”.) Say it once more.

26.5 のむ (nomu) — to drink

Before the new one: say the Japanese for to go, then the Japanese for to buy.

You’ll want to know: のむ

のむ — *nomu* — “to drink”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *nomu*
- *Say it:* *nomu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nomu*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for to go, then the Japanese for to buy, then say *nomu* again

Before you move on

What does のむ mean? (“To drink”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 27

To read, To write, To speak, To wait, To meet

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to read, to write, to speak, to wait and to meet.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 27: i can say to read, to write, to speak, to wait and to meet.

27.1 よむ (yomu) — to read

Before the new one: say the Japanese for to buy, then the Japanese for to drink.

You'll want to know: よむ

よむ — *yomu* — “to read”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *yomu*
- Say it: *yomu*, once more

- *Say it:* say *yomu*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for to buy, then the Japanese for to drink, then say *yomu* again

Before you move on

What does よむ mean? (“To read”.) Say it once more.

27.2 かく (kaku) — to write

Before the new one: say the Japanese for to drink, then the Japanese for to read.

You’ll want to know: かく

かく — *kaku* — “to write”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *kaku*
- *Say it:* *kaku*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kaku*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for to drink, then the Japanese for to read, then say *kaku* again

Before you move on

What does かく mean? (“To write”.) Say it once more.

27.3 はなす (hanasu) — to speak

Before the new one: say the Japanese for to read, then the Japanese for to write.

You'll want to know: はなす

はなす — *hanasu* — “to speak”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: hanasu*
- *Say it: hanasu*, once more
- *Say it: say hanasu*
- *Recall: say the Japanese for to read, then the Japanese for to write, then say hanasu again*

Before you move on

What does はなす mean? (“To speak”.) Say it once more.

27.4 まつ (*matsu*) — to wait

Before the new one: say the Japanese for to write, then the Japanese for to speak.

You'll want to know: まつ

まつ — *matsu* — “to wait”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: matsu*
- *Say it: matsu*, once more
- *Say it: say matsu*

- *Recall*: say the Japanese for to write, then the Japanese for to speak, then say *matsu* again

Before you move on

What does まつ mean? (“To wait”.) Say it once more.

27.5 あう (au) — to meet

Before the new one: say the Japanese for to speak, then the Japanese for to wait.

You’ll want to know: あう

あう — *au* — “to meet”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it*: *au*
- *Say it*: *au*, once more
- *Say it*: say *au*
- *Recall*: say the Japanese for to speak, then the Japanese for to wait, then say *au* again

Before you move on

What does あう mean? (“To meet”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 28

To use, To sing, To say, To think, To hold

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to use, to sing, to say, to think and to hold.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 28: i can say to use, to sing, to say, to think and to hold.

28.1 つかう (tsukau) — to use

Before the new one: say the Japanese for to wait, then the Japanese for to meet.

You'll want to know: つかう

つかう — *tsukau* — “to use”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *tsukau*
- Say it: *tsukau*, once more

- *Say it:* say *tsukau*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for to wait, then the Japanese for to meet, then say *tsukau* again

Before you move on

What does つかう mean? (“To use”.) Say it once more.

28.2 うたう (utau) — to sing

Before the new one: say the Japanese for to meet, then the Japanese for to use.

You’ll want to know: うたう

うたう — *utau* — “to sing”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *utau*
- *Say it:* *utau*, once more
- *Say it:* say *utau*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for to meet, then the Japanese for to use, then say *utau* again

Before you move on

What does うたう mean? (“To sing”.) Say it once more.

28.3 いう (iu) — to say

Before the new one: say the Japanese for to use, then the Japanese for to sing.

You'll want to know: いう

いう — *iu* — “to say”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: iu*
- *Say it: iu*, once more
- *Say it: say iu*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for to use, then the Japanese for to sing, then say *iu* again

Before you move on

What does いう mean? (“To say”.) Say it once more.

28.4 おもう (*omou*) — to think

Before the new one: say the Japanese for to sing, then the Japanese for to say.

You'll want to know: おもう

おもう — *omou* — “to think”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: omou*
- *Say it: omou*, once more
- *Say it: say omou*

- *Recall*: say the Japanese for to sing, then the Japanese for to say, then say *omou* again

Before you move on

What does おもう mean? (“To think”.) Say it once more.

28.5 もつ (motsu) — to hold

Before the new one: say the Japanese for to say, then the Japanese for to think.

You’ll want to know: もつ

もつ — *motsu* — “to hold”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: motsu*
- *Say it: motsu*, once more
- *Say it: say motsu*
- *Recall*: say the Japanese for to say, then the Japanese for to think, then say *motsu* again

Before you move on

What does もつ mean? (“To hold”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 29

To stand, To cry, To live, To rest, To enjoy

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to stand, to cry, to live, to rest and to enjoy.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 29: i can say to stand, to cry, to live, to rest and to enjoy.

29.1 たつ (tatsu) — to stand

Before the new one: say the Japanese for to think, then the Japanese for to hold.

You'll want to know: たつ

たつ — *tatsu* — “to stand”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *tatsu*
- Say it: *tatsu*, once more

- *Say it:* say *tatsu*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for to think, then the Japanese for to hold, then say *tatsu* again

Before you move on

What does たつ mean? (“To stand.”) Say it once more.

29.2 なく (naku) — to cry

Before the new one: say the Japanese for to hold, then the Japanese for to stand.

You’ll want to know: なく

なく — *naku* — “to cry”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *naku*
- *Say it:* *naku*, once more
- *Say it:* say *naku*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for to hold, then the Japanese for to stand, then say *naku* again

Before you move on

What does なく mean? (“To cry.”) Say it once more.

29.3 すむ (sumu) — to live (somewhere)

Before the new one: say the Japanese for to stand, then the Japanese for to cry.

You'll want to know: すむ

すむ — *sumu* — “to live (somewhere)”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sumu*
- *Say it: sumu*, once more
- *Say it: say sumu*
- *Recall: say the Japanese for to stand, then the Japanese for to cry, then say sumu again*

Before you move on

What does すむ mean? (“To live (somewhere)”). Say it once more.

29.4 やすむ (*yasumu*) — to rest

Before the new one: say the Japanese for to cry, then the Japanese for to live.

You'll want to know: やすむ

やすむ — *yasumu* — “to rest”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: yasumu*
- *Say it: yasumu*, once more
- *Say it: say yasumu*

- *Recall:* say the Japanese for to cry, then the Japanese for to live, then say *yasumu* again

Before you move on

What does やすむ mean? (“To rest.”) Say it once more.

29.5 たのしむ (tanoshimu) — to enjoy

Before the new one: say the Japanese for to live, then the Japanese for to rest.

You’ll want to know: たのしむ

たのしむ — *tanoshimu* — “to enjoy”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *tanoshimu*
- *Say it:* *tanoshimu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tanoshimu*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for to live, then the Japanese for to rest, then say *tanoshimu* again

Before you move on

What does たのしむ mean? (“To enjoy.”) Say it once more.

Chapter 30

To push, To pull, To look for, To lend, To give back

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to push, to pull, to look for, to lend and to give back.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 30: i can say to push, to pull, to look for, to lend and to give back.

30.1 おす (osu) — to push

Before the new one: say the Japanese for to rest, then the Japanese for to enjoy.

You'll want to know: おす

おす — *osu* — “to push”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *osu*
- Say it: *osu*, once more

- *Say it:* say *osu*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for to rest, then the Japanese for to enjoy, then say *osu* again

Before you move on

What does おす mean? (“To push.”) Say it once more.

30.2 ひく (hiku) — to pull

Before the new one: say the Japanese for to enjoy, then the Japanese for to push.

You’ll want to know: ひく

ひく — *hiku* — “to pull”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *hiku*
- *Say it:* *hiku*, once more
- *Say it:* say *hiku*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for to enjoy, then the Japanese for to push, then say *hiku* again

Before you move on

What does ひく mean? (“To pull.”) Say it once more.

30.3 さがす (sagasu) — to look for

Before the new one: say the Japanese for to push, then the Japanese for to pull.

You'll want to know: さがす

さがす — *sagasu* — “to look for”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sagasu*
- *Say it: sagasu*, once more
- *Say it: say sagasu*
- *Recall: say the Japanese for to push, then the Japanese for to pull, then say sagasu again*

Before you move on

What does さがす mean? (“To look for”.) Say it once more.

30.4 かす (*kasu*) — to lend

Before the new one: say the Japanese for to pull, then the Japanese for to look for.

You'll want to know: かす

かす — *kasu* — “to lend”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kasu*
- *Say it: kasu*, once more
- *Say it: say kasu*

- *Recall:* say the Japanese for to pull, then the Japanese for to look for, then say *kasu* again

Before you move on

What does かす mean? (“To lend”.) Say it once more.

30.5 かえす (kaesu) — to give back

Before the new one: say the Japanese for to look for, then the Japanese for to lend.

You’ll want to know: かえす

かえす — *kaesu* — “to give back”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *kaesu*
- *Say it:* *kaesu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kaesu*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for to look for, then the Japanese for to lend, then say *kaesu* again

Before you move on

What does かえす mean? (“To give back”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 31

To take out, To drop, To fix, To move, Rice

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to take out, to drop, to fix, to move and rice.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 31: i can say to take out, to drop, to fix, to move and rice.

31.1 だす (dasu) — to take out

Before the new one: say the Japanese for to lend, then the Japanese for to give back.

You'll want to know: だす

だす — *dasu* — “to take out”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *dasu*
- Say it: *dasu*, once more

- *Say it:* say *dasu*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for to lend, then the Japanese for to give back, then say *dasu* again

Before you move on

What does **だす** mean? (“To take out”.) Say it once more.

31.2 おとす (otosu) — to drop

Before the new one: say the Japanese for to give back, then the Japanese for to take out.

You’ll want to know: おとす

おとす — *otosu* — “to drop”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *otosu*
- *Say it:* *otosu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *otosu*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for to give back, then the Japanese for to take out, then say *otosu* again

Before you move on

What does **おとす** mean? (“To drop”.) Say it once more.

31.3 なおす (naosu) — to fix

Before the new one: say the Japanese for to take out, then the Japanese for to drop.

You'll want to know: なおす

なおす — *naosu* — “to fix”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: naosu*
- *Say it: naosu*, once more
- *Say it: say naosu*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for to take out, then the Japanese for to drop, then say *naosu* again

Before you move on

What does なおす mean? (“To fix”.) Say it once more.

31.4 うごく (*ugoku*) — to move

Before the new one: say the Japanese for to drop, then the Japanese for to fix.

You'll want to know: うごく

うごく — *ugoku* — “to move”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ugoku*
- *Say it: ugoku*, once more
- *Say it: say ugoku*

- *Recall:* say the Japanese for to drop, then the Japanese for to fix, then say *ugoku* again

Before you move on

What does うごく mean? (“To move”.) Say it once more.

31.5 ごはん (gohan) — rice; a meal

Before the new one: say the Japanese for to fix, then the Japanese for to move.

You’ll want to know: ごはん

ごはん — *gohan* — “rice; a meal”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *gohan*
- *Say it:* *gohan*, once more
- *Say it:* say *gohan*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for to fix, then the Japanese for to move, then say *gohan* again

Before you move on

What does ごはん mean? (“Rice; a meal”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 32

Fish, Meat, Egg, Vegetables, Fruit

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a fish, meat, an egg, vegetables and fruit.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 32: i can say a fish, meat, an egg, vegetables and fruit.

32.1 さかな (sakana) — a fish

Before the new one: say the Japanese for to move, then the Japanese for rice; a meal.

You'll want to know: さかな

さかな — *sakana* — “a fish”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sakana*
- *Say it: sakana, once more*
- *Say it: say sakana*

- *Recall*: say the Japanese for to move, then the Japanese for rice; a meal, then say *sakana* again

Before you move on

What does さかな mean? (“A fish”.) Say it once more.

32.2 にく (niku) — meat

Before the new one: say the Japanese for rice; a meal, then the Japanese for a fish.

You’ll want to know: にく

にく — *niku* — “meat”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it*: *niku*
- *Say it*: *niku*, once more
- *Say it*: say *niku*
- *Recall*: say the Japanese for rice; a meal, then the Japanese for a fish, then say *niku* again

Before you move on

What does にく mean? (“Meat”.) Say it once more.

32.3 たまご (tamago) — an egg

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a fish, then the Japanese for meat.

You'll want to know: たまご

たまご — *tamago* — “an egg”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tamago*
- *Say it: tamago*, once more
- *Say it: say tamago*
- *Recall: say the Japanese for a fish, then the Japanese for meat, then say tamago again*

Before you move on

What does たまご mean? (“An egg”.) Say it once more.

32.4 やさい (*yasai*) — vegetables

Before the new one: say the Japanese for meat, then the Japanese for an egg.

You'll want to know: やさい

やさい — *yasai* — “vegetables”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: yasai*
- *Say it: yasai*, once more
- *Say it: say yasai*

- *Recall:* say the Japanese for meat, then the Japanese for an egg, then say *yasai* again

Before you move on

What does やさい mean? (“Vegetables”.) Say it once more.

32.5 くだもの (kudamono) — fruit

Before the new one: say the Japanese for an egg, then the Japanese for vegetables.

You’ll want to know: くだもの

くだもの — *kudamono* — “fruit”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *kudamono*
- *Say it:* *kudamono*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kudamono*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for an egg, then the Japanese for vegetables, then say *kudamono* again

Before you move on

What does くだもの mean? (“Fruit”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 33

Apple, Mandarin orange, Strawberry, Peach, Pear

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say an apple, a mandarin orange, a strawberry, a peach and a pear.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 33: i can say an apple, a mandarin orange, a strawberry, a peach and a pear.

33.1 りんご (ringo) — an apple

Before the new one: say the Japanese for vegetables, then the Japanese for fruit.

You'll want to know: りんご

りんご — *ringo* — “an apple”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *ringo*
- Say it: *ringo*, once more

- *Say it:* say *ringo*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for vegetables, then the Japanese for fruit, then say *ringo* again

Before you move on

What does りんご mean? (“An apple”.) Say it once more.

33.2 みかん (mikan) — a mandarin orange

Before the new one: say the Japanese for fruit, then the Japanese for an apple.

You’ll want to know: みかん

みかん — *mikan* — “a mandarin orange”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *mikan*
- *Say it:* *mikan*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mikan*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for fruit, then the Japanese for an apple, then say *mikan* again

Before you move on

What does みかん mean? (“A mandarin orange”.) Say it once more.

33.3 いちご (ichigo) — a strawberry

Before the new one: say the Japanese for an apple, then the Japanese for a mandarin orange.

You'll want to know: いちご

いちご — *ichigo* — “a strawberry”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ichigo*
- *Say it: ichigo*, once more
- *Say it: say ichigo*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for an apple, then the Japanese for a mandarin orange, then say *ichigo* again

Before you move on

What does いちご mean? (“A strawberry”.) Say it once more.

33.4 もも (momo) — a peach

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a mandarin orange, then the Japanese for a strawberry.

You'll want to know: もも

もも — *momo* — “a peach”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: momo*
- *Say it: momo*, once more
- *Say it: say momo*

- *Recall*: say the Japanese for a mandarin orange, then the Japanese for a strawberry, then say *momo* again

Before you move on

What does もも mean? (“A peach.”) Say it once more.

33.5 なし (nashi) — a pear

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a strawberry, then the Japanese for a peach.

You’ll want to know: なし

なし — *nashi* — “a pear”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it*: *nashi*
- *Say it*: *nashi*, once more
- *Say it*: say *nashi*
- *Recall*: say the Japanese for a strawberry, then the Japanese for a peach, then say *nashi* again

Before you move on

What does なし mean? (“A pear.”) Say it once more.

Chapter 34

Watermelon, White radish, Carrot, Tofu, Salt

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a watermelon, a white radish, a carrot, tofu and salt.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 34: i can say a watermelon, a white radish, a carrot, tofu and salt.

34.1 すいか (suika) — a watermelon

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a peach, then the Japanese for a pear.

You'll want to know: すいか

すいか — *suika* — “a watermelon”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *suika*
- Say it: *suika*, once more

- *Say it:* say *suika*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for a peach, then the Japanese for a pear, then say *suika* again

Before you move on

What does すいか mean? (“A watermelon”.) Say it once more.

34.2 дайこん (daikon) — a white radish

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a pear, then the Japanese for a watermelon.

You’ll want to know: дайこん

дайこん — *daikon* — “a white radish”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *daikon*
- *Say it:* *daikon*, once more
- *Say it:* say *daikon*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for a pear, then the Japanese for a watermelon, then say *daikon* again

Before you move on

What does дайこん mean? (“A white radish”.) Say it once more.

34.3 にんじん (ninjin) — a carrot

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a watermelon, then the Japanese for a white radish.

You'll want to know: にんじん

にんじん — *ninjin* — “a carrot”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ninjin*
- *Say it: ninjin*, once more
- *Say it: say ninjin*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for a watermelon, then the Japanese for a white radish, then say *ninjin* again

Before you move on

What does にんじん mean? (“A carrot”.) Say it once more.

34.4 とうふ (toufu) — tofu

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a white radish, then the Japanese for a carrot.

You'll want to know: とうふ

とうふ — *toufu* — “tofu”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: toufu*
- *Say it: toufu*, once more
- *Say it: say toufu*

- *Recall:* say the Japanese for a white radish, then the Japanese for a carrot, then say *toufu* again

Before you move on

What does どうふ mean? (“Tofu”.) Say it once more.

34.5 しお (shio) — salt

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a carrot, then the Japanese for tofu.

You’ll want to know: しお

しお — *shio* — “salt”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: shio*
- *Say it: shio*, once more
- *Say it: say shio*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for a carrot, then the Japanese for tofu, then say *shio* again

Before you move on

What does しお mean? (“Salt”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 35

Sugar, Udon noodles, Sushi, Breakfast, Sweets

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say sugar, udon noodles, sushi, breakfast and sweets, snacks.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 35: i can say sugar, udon noodles, sushi, breakfast and sweets, snacks.

35.1 さとう (satou) — sugar

Before the new one: say the Japanese for tofu, then the Japanese for salt.

You'll want to know: さとう

さとう — *satou* — “sugar”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: satou*
- *Say it: satou, once more*

- *Say it:* say *satou*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for tofu, then the Japanese for salt, then say *satou* again

Before you move on

What does さとう mean? (“Sugar”.) Say it once more.

35.2 うどん (udon) — udon noodles

Before the new one: say the Japanese for salt, then the Japanese for sugar.

You’ll want to know: うどん

うどん — *udon* — “udon noodles”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *udon*
- *Say it:* *udon*, once more
- *Say it:* say *udon*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for salt, then the Japanese for sugar, then say *udon* again

Before you move on

What does うどん mean? (“Udon noodles”.) Say it once more.

35.3 すし (sushi) — sushi

Before the new one: say the Japanese for sugar, then the Japanese for udon noodles.

You'll want to know: すし

すし — *sushi* — “sushi”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sushi*
- *Say it: sushi*, once more
- *Say it: say sushi*
- *Recall: say the Japanese for sugar, then the Japanese for udon noodles, then say sushi again*

Before you move on

What does すし mean? (“Sushi”.) Say it once more.

35.4 あさごはん (asagohan) — breakfast

Before the new one: say the Japanese for udon noodles, then the Japanese for sushi.

You'll want to know: あさごはん

あさごはん — *asagohan* — “breakfast”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: asagohan*
- *Say it: asagohan*, once more
- *Say it: say asagohan*

- *Recall*: say the Japanese for udon noodles, then the Japanese for sushi, then say *asagohan* again

Before you move on

What does あさごはん mean? (“Breakfast”.) Say it once more.

35.5 おかし (okashi) — sweets, snacks

Before the new one: say the Japanese for sushi, then the Japanese for breakfast.

You’ll want to know: おかし

おかし — *okashi* — “sweets, snacks”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it*: *okashi*
- *Say it*: *okashi*, once more
- *Say it*: say *okashi*
- *Recall*: say the Japanese for sushi, then the Japanese for breakfast, then say *okashi* again

Before you move on

What does おかし mean? (“Sweets, snacks”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 36

Seaweed, Japanese plum, Chestnut, Beans, Uncooked rice

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say seaweed, a Japanese plum, a chestnut, beans and uncooked rice.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 36: i can say seaweed, a Japanese plum, a chestnut, beans and uncooked rice.

36.1 のり (nori) — seaweed

Before the new one: say the Japanese for breakfast, then the Japanese for sweets.

You'll want to know: のり

のり — *nori* — “seaweed”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nori*
- *Say it: nori*, once more

- *Say it:* say *nori*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for breakfast, then the Japanese for sweets, then say *nori* again

Before you move on

What does のり mean? (“Seaweed”.) Say it once more.

36.2 うめ (ume) — a Japanese plum

Before the new one: say the Japanese for sweets, then the Japanese for seaweed.

You’ll want to know: うめ

うめ — *ume* — “a Japanese plum”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ume*
- *Say it:* *ume*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ume*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for sweets, then the Japanese for seaweed, then say *ume* again

Before you move on

What does うめ mean? (“A Japanese plum”.) Say it once more.

36.3 <り (kuri) — a chestnut

Before the new one: say the Japanese for seaweed, then the Japanese for a Japanese plum.

You'll want to know: < り

< り — *kuri* — “a chestnut”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kuri*
- *Say it: kuri*, once more
- *Say it: say kuri*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for seaweed, then the Japanese for a Japanese plum, then say *kuri* again

Before you move on

What does < り mean? (“A chestnut”.) Say it once more.

36.4 まめ (mame) — beans

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a Japanese plum, then the Japanese for a chestnut.

You'll want to know: まめ

まめ — *mame* — “beans”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mame*
- *Say it: mame*, once more
- *Say it: say mame*

- *Recall*: say the Japanese for a Japanese plum, then the Japanese for a chestnut, then say *mame* again

Before you move on

What does まめ mean? (“Beans”.) Say it once more.

36.5 こめ (kome) — uncooked rice

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a chestnut, then the Japanese for beans.

You’ll want to know: こめ

こめ — *kome* — “uncooked rice”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it*: *kome*
- *Say it*: *kome*, once more
- *Say it*: say *kome*
- *Recall*: say the Japanese for a chestnut, then the Japanese for beans, then say *kome* again

Before you move on

What does こめ mean? (“Uncooked rice”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 37

Home, Window, Chair, Desk, Roof

Modes: 🗣️ voice (7) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 7 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say home, a window, a chair, a desk and a roof.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 37: i can say home, a window, a chair, a desk and a roof.

37.1 うち (uchi) — home

Before the new one: say the Japanese for beans, then the Japanese for uncooked rice.

You'll want to know: うち

うち — *uchi* — “home”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: uchi*
- *Say it: uchi*, once more
- *Say it: say uchi*

- *Recall*: say the Japanese for beans, then the Japanese for uncooked rice, then say *uchi* again

Before you move on

What does うち mean? (“Home”.) Say it once more.

37.2 まど (mado) — a window

Before the new one: say the Japanese for uncooked rice, then the Japanese for home.

You’ll want to know: まど

まど — *mado* — “a window”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it*: *mado*
- *Say it*: *mado*, once more
- *Say it*: say *mado*
- *Recall*: say the Japanese for uncooked rice, then the Japanese for home, then say *mado* again

Before you move on

What does まど mean? (“A window”.) Say it once more.

37.3 いす (isu) — a chair

Before the new one: say the Japanese for home, then the Japanese for a window.

You'll want to know: いす

いす — *isu* — “a chair”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: isu*
- *Say it: isu*, once more
- *Say it: say isu*
- *Recall: say the Japanese for home, then the Japanese for a window, then say isu again*

Before you move on

What does いす mean? (“A chair”.) Say it once more.

37.4 つくえ (*tsukue*) — a desk

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a window, then the Japanese for a chair.

You'll want to know: つくえ

つくえ — *tsukue* — “a desk”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tsukue*
- *Say it: tsukue*, once more
- *Say it: say tsukue*

- *Recall*: say the Japanese for a window, then the Japanese for a chair, then say *tsukue* again

Before you move on

What does つくえ mean? (“A desk”.) Say it once more.

37.5 やね (yane) — a roof

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a chair, then the Japanese for a desk.

You’ll want to know: やね

やね — *yane* — “a roof”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it*: *yane*
- *Say it*: *yane*, once more
- *Say it*: say *yane*
- *Recall*: say the Japanese for a chair, then the Japanese for a desk, then say *yane* again

Before you move on

What does やね mean? (“A roof”.) Say it once more.

37.6 The body, health and family — a first pass

Say the words for a desk and a roof.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a nail, an elbow, a knee, the throat, the chest
- a bone, the chin, a cheek, an eyebrow, skin
- sweat, tears, a voice, a fever, painful
- medicine, sleepy, sad, fun, scary
- pain, a grandfather, an uncle, a son, a daughter
- a friend, an adult, a man, a woman, a teacher
- next door; a neighbour, a companion, to go, to buy, to drink
- to read, to write, to speak, to wait, to meet
- to use, to sing, to say, to think, to hold

Before you move on

A nail? (*tsume.*) An elbow? (*hiji.*) A knee? (*hiza.*) The throat? (*nodo.*) The chest? (*mune.*) A bone? (*hone.*) The chin? (*ago.*) A cheek? (*hoo.*) An eyebrow? (*mayu.*) Skin? (*hada.*) Sweat? (*ase.*) Tears? (*namida.*) A voice? (*koe.*) A fever? (*netsu.*) Painful? (*itai.*) Medicine? (*kusuri.*) Sleepy? (*nemui.*) Sad? (*kanashii.*) Fun? (*tanoshii.*) Scary? (*kowai.*) Pain? (*itami.*) A grandfather? (*ojiisan.*) An uncle? (*ojisan.*) A son? (*musuko.*) A daughter? (*musume.*) A friend? (*tomodachi.*) An adult? (*otona.*) A man? (*otoko.*) A woman? (*onna.*) A teacher? (*sensei.*) Next door; a neighbour? (*tonari.*) A companion? (*nakama.*) To go? (*iku.*) To buy? (*kau.*) To drink? (*nomu.*) To read? (*yomu.*) To write? (*kaku.*) To speak? (*hanasu.*) To wait? (*matsu.*) To meet? (*au.*) To use? (*tsukau.*) To sing? (*utau.*) To say? (*iu.*) To think? (*omou.*) To hold? (*motsu.*)

37.7 Verbs — a second pass

Say the words for to stand and to cry.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to stand, to cry, to live, to rest, to enjoy
- to push, to pull, to look for, to lend, to give back
- to take out, to drop, to fix, to move, rice; a meal
- a fish, meat, an egg, vegetables, fruit
- an apple, a mandarin orange, a strawberry, a peach, a pear
- a watermelon, a white radish, a carrot, tofu, salt
- sugar, udon noodles, sushi, breakfast, sweets
- seaweed, a Japanese plum, a chestnut, beans, uncooked rice
- home, a window, a chair, a desk, a roof

Before you move on

To stand? (*tatsu.*) To cry? (*naku.*) To live? (*sumu.*) To rest? (*yasumu.*) To enjoy? (*tanoshimu.*) To push? (*osu.*) To pull? (*hiku.*) To look for? (*sagasu.*) To lend? (*kasu.*) To give back? (*kaesu.*) To take out? (*dasu.*) To drop? (*otosu.*) To fix? (*naosu.*) To move? (*ugoku.*) Rice; a meal? (*gohan.*) A fish? (*sakana.*) Meat? (*niku.*) An egg? (*tamago.*) Vegetables? (*yasai.*) Fruit? (*kudamono.*) An apple? (*ringo.*) A mandarin orange? (*mikan.*) A strawberry? (*ichigo.*) A peach? (*momo.*) A pear? (*nashi.*) A watermelon? (*suika.*) A white radish? (*daikon.*) A carrot? (*ninjin.*) Tofu? (*toufu.*) Salt? (*shio.*) Sugar? (*satou.*) Udon noodles? (*udon.*) Sushi? (*sushi.*) Breakfast? (*asagohan.*) Sweets? (*okashi.*) Seaweed? (*nori.*) A Japanese plum? (*ume.*) A chestnut? (*kuri.*) Beans? (*mame.*) Uncooked rice? (*kome.*) Home? (*uchi.*) A window? (*mado.*) A chair? (*isu.*) A desk? (*tsukue.*) A roof? (*yane.*)

Chapter 38

Floor, Mirror, Futon, Chopsticks, Kitchen

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say the floor, a mirror, a futon, chopsticks and a kitchen.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 38: i can say the floor, a mirror, a futon, chopsticks and a kitchen.

38.1 ゆか (yuka) — the floor

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a desk, then the Japanese for a roof.

You'll want to know: ゆか

ゆか — *yuka* — “the floor”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *yuka*
- Say it: *yuka*, once more

- *Say it:* say *yuka*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for a desk, then the Japanese for a roof, then say *yuka* again

Before you move on

What does ゆか mean? (“The floor”.) Say it once more.

38.2 かがみ (kagami) — a mirror

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a roof, then the Japanese for the floor.

You’ll want to know: かがみ

かがみ — *kagami* — “a mirror”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *kagami*
- *Say it:* *kagami*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kagami*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for a roof, then the Japanese for the floor, then say *kagami* again

Before you move on

What does かがみ mean? (“A mirror”.) Say it once more.

38.3 ふとん (futon) — a futon

Before the new one: say the Japanese for the floor, then the Japanese for a mirror.

You'll want to know: ふとん

ふとん — *futon* — “a futon”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: futon*
- *Say it: futon*, once more
- *Say it: say futon*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for the floor, then the Japanese for a mirror, then say *futon* again

Before you move on

What does ふとん mean? (“A futon”.) Say it once more.

38.4 はし (hashi) — chopsticks

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a mirror, then the Japanese for a futon.

You'll want to know: はし

はし — *hashi* — “chopsticks”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: hashi*
- *Say it: hashi*, once more
- *Say it: say hashi*

- *Recall:* say the Japanese for a mirror, then the Japanese for a futon, then say *hashi* again

Before you move on

What does はし mean? (“Chopsticks”.) Say it once more.

38.5 だいどころ (daidokoro) — a kitchen

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a futon, then the Japanese for chopsticks.

You’ll want to know: だいどころ

だいどころ — *daidokoro* — “a kitchen”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *daidokoro*
- *Say it:* *daidokoro*, once more
- *Say it:* say *daidokoro*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for a futon, then the Japanese for chopsticks, then say *daidokoro* again

Before you move on

What does だいどころ mean? (“A kitchen”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 39

Garden, Bath, Tatami mat, Shelf, Box

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a garden, a bath, a tatami mat, a shelf and a box.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 39: i can say a garden, a bath, a tatami mat, a shelf and a box.

39.1 にわ (niwa) — a garden

Before the new one: say the Japanese for chopsticks, then the Japanese for a kitchen.

You'll want to know: にわ

にわ — *niwa* — “a garden”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *niwa*
- Say it: *niwa*, once more

- *Say it:* say *niwa*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for chopsticks, then the Japanese for a kitchen, then say *niwa* again

Before you move on

What does にわ mean? (“A garden”.) Say it once more.

39.2 おふろ (ofuro) — a bath

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a kitchen, then the Japanese for a garden.

You’ll want to know: おふろ

おふろ — *ofuro* — “a bath”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ofuro*
- *Say it:* *ofuro*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ofuro*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for a kitchen, then the Japanese for a garden, then say *ofuro* again

Before you move on

What does おふろ mean? (“A bath”.) Say it once more.

39.3 たたみ (tatami) — a tatami mat

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a garden, then the Japanese for a bath.

You'll want to know: たたみ

たたみ — *tatami* — “a tatami mat”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tatami*
- *Say it: tatami*, once more
- *Say it: say tatami*
- *Recall: say the Japanese for a garden, then the Japanese for a bath, then say tatami again*

Before you move on

What does たたみ mean? (“A tatami mat”.) Say it once more.

39.4 たな (tana) — a shelf

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a bath, then the Japanese for a tatami mat.

You'll want to know: たな

たな — *tana* — “a shelf”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tana*
- *Say it: tana*, once more
- *Say it: say tana*

- *Recall:* say the Japanese for a bath, then the Japanese for a tatami mat, then say *tana* again

Before you move on

What does たな mean? (“A shelf”.) Say it once more.

39.5 はこ (hako) — a box

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a tatami mat, then the Japanese for a shelf.

You’ll want to know: はこ

はこ — *hako* — “a box”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *hako*
- *Say it:* *hako*, once more
- *Say it:* say *hako*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for a tatami mat, then the Japanese for a shelf, then say *hako* again

Before you move on

What does はこ mean? (“A box”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 40

Umbrella, School, Homework, Problem, Answer

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say an umbrella, a school, homework, a problem, a question and an answer.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 40: i can say an umbrella, a school, homework, a problem, a question and an answer.

40.1 かさ (kasa) — an umbrella

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a shelf, then the Japanese for a box.

You'll want to know: かさ

かさ — *kasa* — “an umbrella”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *kasa*
- Say it: *kasa*, once more

- *Say it:* say *kasa*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for a shelf, then the Japanese for a box, then say *kasa* again

Before you move on

What does *かさ* mean? (“An umbrella”.) Say it once more.

40.2 がっこう (gakkou) — a school

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a box, then the Japanese for an umbrella.

You’ll want to know: がっこう

がっこう — *gakkou* — “a school”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *gakkou*
- *Say it:* *gakkou*, once more
- *Say it:* say *gakkou*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for a box, then the Japanese for an umbrella, then say *gakkou* again

Before you move on

What does がっこう mean? (“A school”.) Say it once more.

40.3 しゅくだい (shukudai) — homework

Before the new one: say the Japanese for an umbrella, then the Japanese for a school.

You'll want to know: しゅくだい

しゅくだい — *shukudai* — “homework”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: shukudai*
- *Say it: shukudai*, once more
- *Say it: say shukudai*
- *Recall: say the Japanese for an umbrella, then the Japanese for a school, then say shukudai again*

Before you move on

What does しゅくだい mean? (“Homework”.) Say it once more.

40.4 もんだい (mondai) — a problem, a question

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a school, then the Japanese for homework.

You'll want to know: もんだい

もんだい — *mondai* — “a problem, a question”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mondai*
- *Say it: mondai*, once more
- *Say it: say mondai*

- *Recall*: say the Japanese for a school, then the Japanese for homework, then say *mondai* again

Before you move on

What does もんだい mean? (“A problem, a question”.) Say it once more.

40.5 こたえ (kotae) — an answer

Before the new one: say the Japanese for homework, then the Japanese for a problem.

You’ll want to know: こたえ

こたえ — *kotae* — “an answer”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it*: *kotae*
- *Say it*: *kotae*, once more
- *Say it*: say *kotae*
- *Recall*: say the Japanese for homework, then the Japanese for a problem, then say *kotae* again

Before you move on

What does こたえ mean? (“An answer”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 41

Letter, Time, Name, Money, Mountain

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a letter, time, a name, money and a mountain.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 41: i can say a letter, time, a name, money and a mountain.

41.1 てがみ (tegami) — a letter (post)

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a problem, then the Japanese for an answer.

You'll want to know: てがみ

てがみ — *tegami* — “a letter (post)”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *tegami*
- Say it: *tegami*, once more

- *Say it:* say *tegami*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for a problem, then the Japanese for an answer, then say *tegami* again

Before you move on

What does **てがみ** mean? (“A letter (post).”) Say it once more.

41.2 じかん (jikan) — time; an hour

Before the new one: say the Japanese for an answer, then the Japanese for a letter.

You’ll want to know: じかん

じかん — *jikan* — “time; an hour”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *jikan*
- *Say it:* *jikan*, once more
- *Say it:* say *jikan*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for an answer, then the Japanese for a letter, then say *jikan* again

Before you move on

What does **じかん** mean? (“Time; an hour”.) Say it once more.

41.3 なまえ (namae) — a name

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a letter, then the Japanese for time; an hour.

You'll want to know: なまえ

なまえ — *namae* — “a name”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: namae*
- *Say it: namae*, once more
- *Say it: say namae*
- *Recall: say the Japanese for a letter, then the Japanese for time; an hour, then say namae again*

Before you move on

What does なまえ mean? (“A name”.) Say it once more.

41.4 おかね (*okane*) — money

Before the new one: say the Japanese for time; an hour, then the Japanese for a name.

You'll want to know: おかね

おかね — *okane* — “money”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: okane*
- *Say it: okane*, once more
- *Say it: say okane*

- *Recall:* say the Japanese for time; an hour, then the Japanese for a name, then say *okane* again

Before you move on

What does おかね mean? (“Money”.) Say it once more.

41.5 やま (yama) — a mountain

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a name, then the Japanese for money.

You’ll want to know: やま

やま — *yama* — “a mountain”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *yama*
- *Say it:* *yama*, once more
- *Say it:* say *yama*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for a name, then the Japanese for money, then say *yama* again

Before you move on

What does やま mean? (“A mountain”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 42

River, Sea, Grass, Forest, Stone

Modes: 🔄 voice (5) 🔄 Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a river, the sea, grass, a forest and a stone.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 42: i can say a river, the sea, grass, a forest and a stone.

42.1 かわ (kawa) — a river

Before the new one: say the Japanese for money, then the Japanese for a mountain.

You'll want to know: かわ

かわ — *kawa* — “a river”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kawa*
- *Say it: kawa, once more*
- *Say it: say kawa*

- *Recall:* say the Japanese for money, then the Japanese for a mountain, then say *kawa* again

Before you move on

What does *かわ* mean? (“A river”.) Say it once more.

42.2 うみ (umi) — the sea

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a mountain, then the Japanese for a river.

You’ll want to know: うみ

うみ — *umi* — “the sea”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *umi*
- *Say it:* *umi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *umi*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for a mountain, then the Japanese for a river, then say *umi* again

Before you move on

What does うみ mean? (“The sea”.) Say it once more.

42.3 くさ (kusa) — grass

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a river, then the Japanese for the sea.

You'll want to know: くさ

くさ — *kusa* — “grass”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kusa*
- *Say it: kusa*, once more
- *Say it: say kusa*
- *Recall: say the Japanese for a river, then the Japanese for the sea, then say kusa again*

Before you move on

What does くさ mean? (“Grass”.) Say it once more.

42.4 もり (mori) — a forest

Before the new one: say the Japanese for the sea, then the Japanese for grass.

You'll want to know: もり

もり — *mori* — “a forest”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mori*
- *Say it: mori*, once more
- *Say it: say mori*

- *Recall:* say the Japanese for the sea, then the Japanese for grass, then say *mori* again

Before you move on

What does もり mean? (“A forest.”) Say it once more.

42.5 いし (ishi) — a stone

Before the new one: say the Japanese for grass, then the Japanese for a forest.

You’ll want to know: いし

いし — *ishi* — “a stone”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ishi*
- *Say it:* *ishi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ishi*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for grass, then the Japanese for a forest, then say *ishi* again

Before you move on

What does いし mean? (“A stone.”) Say it once more.

Chapter 43

Sand, Rice field, Star, Cloud, Sun

Modes: 🔄 voice (5) 🔄 Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say sand, a rice field, a star, a cloud and the sun.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 43: i can say sand, a rice field, a star, a cloud and the sun.

43.1 すな (suna) — sand

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a forest, then the Japanese for a stone.

You'll want to know: すな

すな — *suna* — “sand”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: suna*
- *Say it: suna, once more*
- *Say it: say suna*

- *Recall*: say the Japanese for a forest, then the Japanese for a stone, then say *sun* again

Before you move on

What does すな mean? (“Sand”.) Say it once more.

43.2 たんぼ (tanbo) — a rice field

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a stone, then the Japanese for sand.

You’ll want to know: たんぼ

たんぼ — *tanbo* — “a rice field”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it*: *tanbo*
- *Say it*: *tanbo*, once more
- *Say it*: say *tanbo*
- *Recall*: say the Japanese for a stone, then the Japanese for sand, then say *tanbo* again

Before you move on

What does たんぼ mean? (“A rice field”.) Say it once more.

43.3 ほし (hoshi) — a star

Before the new one: say the Japanese for sand, then the Japanese for a rice field.

You'll want to know: ほし

ほし — *hoshi* — “a star”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: hoshi*
- *Say it: hoshi*, once more
- *Say it: say hoshi*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for sand, then the Japanese for a rice field, then say *hoshi* again

Before you move on

What does ほし mean? (“A star”.) Say it once more.

43.4 くも (kumo) — a cloud; a spider

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a rice field, then the Japanese for a star.

You'll want to know: くも

くも — *kumo* — “a cloud; a spider”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kumo*
- *Say it: kumo*, once more
- *Say it: say kumo*

- *Recall:* say the Japanese for a rice field, then the Japanese for a star, then say *kumo* again

Before you move on

What does くも mean? (“A cloud; a spider”.) Say it once more.

43.5 たいよう (taiyou) — the sun

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a star, then the Japanese for a cloud; a spider.

You’ll want to know: たいよう

たいよう — *taiyou* — “the sun”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *taiyou*
- *Say it:* *taiyou*, once more
- *Say it:* say *taiyou*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for a star, then the Japanese for a cloud; a spider, then say *taiyou* again

Before you move on

What does たいよう mean? (“The sun”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 44

Island, Wave, Soil, Seed, Rain

Modes: 🔄 voice (5) 🔄 Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say an island, a wave, soil, a seed and rain.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 44: i can say an island, a wave, soil, a seed and rain.

44.1 しま (shima) — an island

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a cloud; a spider, then the Japanese for the sun.

You'll want to know: しま

しま — *shima* — “an island”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: shima*
- *Say it: shima, once more*
- *Say it: say shima*

- *Recall*: say the Japanese for a cloud; a spider, then the Japanese for the sun, then say *shima* again

Before you move on

What does しま mean? (“An island”.) Say it once more.

44.2 なみ (nami) — a wave

Before the new one: say the Japanese for the sun, then the Japanese for an island.

You’ll want to know: なみ

なみ — *nami* — “a wave”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it*: *nami*
- *Say it*: *nami*, once more
- *Say it*: say *nami*
- *Recall*: say the Japanese for the sun, then the Japanese for an island, then say *nami* again

Before you move on

What does なみ mean? (“A wave”.) Say it once more.

44.3 つち (tsuchi) — soil

Before the new one: say the Japanese for an island, then the Japanese for a wave.

You'll want to know: つち

つち — *tsuchi* — “soil”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tsuchi*
- *Say it: tsuchi*, once more
- *Say it: say tsuchi*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for an island, then the Japanese for a wave, then say *tsuchi* again

Before you move on

What does つち mean? (“Soil.”) Say it once more.

44.4 たね (tane) — a seed

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a wave, then the Japanese for soil.

You'll want to know: たね

たね — *tane* — “a seed”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tane*
- *Say it: tane*, once more
- *Say it: say tane*

- *Recall:* say the Japanese for a wave, then the Japanese for soil, then say *tane* again

Before you move on

What does たね mean? (“A seed”.) Say it once more.

44.5 あめ (ame) — rain; candy

Before the new one: say the Japanese for soil, then the Japanese for a seed.

You’ll want to know: あめ

あめ — *ame* — “rain; candy”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ame*
- *Say it:* *ame*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ame*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for soil, then the Japanese for a seed, then say *ame* again

Before you move on

What does あめ mean? (“Rain; candy”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 45

Cat, Horse, Cow, Bird, Bear

Modes: 🔄 voice (5) 🔄 Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a cat, a horse, a cow, a bird and a bear.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 45: i can say a cat, a horse, a cow, a bird and a bear.

45.1 ねこ (neko) — a cat

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a seed, then the Japanese for rain; candy.

You'll want to know: ねこ

ねこ — *neko* — “a cat”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: neko*
- *Say it: neko, once more*
- *Say it: say neko*

- *Recall*: say the Japanese for a seed, then the Japanese for rain; candy, then say *neko* again

Before you move on

What does ねこ mean? (“A cat.”) Say it once more.

45.2 うま (uma) — a horse

Before the new one: say the Japanese for rain; candy, then the Japanese for a cat.

You’ll want to know: うま

うま — *uma* — “a horse”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it*: *uma*
- *Say it*: *uma*, once more
- *Say it*: say *uma*
- *Recall*: say the Japanese for rain; candy, then the Japanese for a cat, then say *uma* again

Before you move on

What does うま mean? (“A horse.”) Say it once more.

45.3 うし (ushi) — a cow

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a cat, then the Japanese for a horse.

You'll want to know: うし

うし — *ushi* — “a cow”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ushi*
- *Say it: ushi*, once more
- *Say it: say ushi*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for a cat, then the Japanese for a horse, then say *ushi* again

Before you move on

What does うし mean? (“A cow”.) Say it once more.

45.4 とり (tori) — a bird

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a horse, then the Japanese for a cow.

You'll want to know: とり

とり — *tori* — “a bird”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tori*
- *Say it: tori*, once more
- *Say it: say tori*

- *Recall:* say the Japanese for a horse, then the Japanese for a cow, then say *tori* again

Before you move on

What does とり mean? (“A bird”.) Say it once more.

45.5 くま (kuma) — a bear

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a cow, then the Japanese for a bird.

You’ll want to know: くま

くま — *kuma* — “a bear”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *kuma*
- *Say it:* *kuma*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kuma*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for a cow, then the Japanese for a bird, then say *kuma* again

Before you move on

What does くま mean? (“A bear”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 46

Insect, Ant, Pigeon, Sheep, Deer

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say an insect, an ant, a pigeon, a sheep and a deer.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 46: i can say an insect, an ant, a pigeon, a sheep and a deer.

46.1 むし (mushi) — an insect

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a bird, then the Japanese for a bear.

You'll want to know: むし

むし — *mushi* — “an insect”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mushi*
- *Say it: mushi, once more*
- *Say it: say mushi*

- *Recall:* say the Japanese for a bird, then the Japanese for a bear, then say *mushi* again

Before you move on

What does むし mean? (“An insect”.) Say it once more.

46.2 あり (ari) — an ant

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a bear, then the Japanese for an insect.

You’ll want to know: あり

あり — *ari* — “an ant”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ari*
- *Say it:* *ari*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ari*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for a bear, then the Japanese for an insect, then say *ari* again

Before you move on

What does あり mean? (“An ant”.) Say it once more.

46.3 はと (hato) — a pigeon

Before the new one: say the Japanese for an insect, then the Japanese for an ant.

You'll want to know: はと

はと — *hato* — “a pigeon”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: hato*
- *Say it: hato*, once more
- *Say it: say hato*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for an insect, then the Japanese for an ant, then say *hato* again

Before you move on

What does はと mean? (“A pigeon”.) Say it once more.

46.4 ひつじ (*hitsuji*) — a sheep

Before the new one: say the Japanese for an ant, then the Japanese for a pigeon.

You'll want to know: ひつじ

ひつじ — *hitsuji* — “a sheep”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: hitsuji*
- *Say it: hitsuji*, once more
- *Say it: say hitsuji*

- *Recall:* say the Japanese for an ant, then the Japanese for a pigeon, then say *hitsuji* again

Before you move on

What does ひつじ mean? (“A sheep”.) Say it once more.

46.5 しか (shika) — a deer

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a pigeon, then the Japanese for a sheep.

You’ll want to know: しか

しか — *shika* — “a deer”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *shika*
- *Say it:* *shika*, once more
- *Say it:* say *shika*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for a pigeon, then the Japanese for a sheep, then say *shika* again

Before you move on

What does しか mean? (“A deer”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 47

Crab, Octopus, Squid, Turtle, Wolf

Modes: 🔄 voice (5) 🔄 Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

***By the end of this chapter:** I can say a crab, an octopus, a squid, a turtle and a wolf.*

Complete the last lesson of chapter 47: i can say a crab, an octopus, a squid, a turtle and a wolf.

47.1 かに (kani) — a crab

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a sheep, then the Japanese for a deer.

You'll want to know: かに

かに — *kani* — “a crab”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kani*
- *Say it: kani, once more*
- *Say it: say kani*

- *Recall:* say the Japanese for a sheep, then the Japanese for a deer, then say *kani* again

Before you move on

What does *かに* mean? (“A crab.”) Say it once more.

47.2 たこ (tako) — an octopus

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a deer, then the Japanese for a crab.

You’ll want to know: たこ

たこ — *tako* — “an octopus”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *tako*
- *Say it:* *tako*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tako*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for a deer, then the Japanese for a crab, then say *tako* again

Before you move on

What does *たこ* mean? (“An octopus.”) Say it once more.

47.3 いか (ika) — a squid

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a crab, then the Japanese for an octopus.

You'll want to know: いか

いか — *ika* — “a squid”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ika*
- *Say it: ika*, once more
- *Say it: say ika*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for a crab, then the Japanese for an octopus, then say *ika* again

Before you move on

What does いか mean? (“A squid”.) Say it once more.

47.4 かめ (kame) — a turtle

Before the new one: say the Japanese for an octopus, then the Japanese for a squid.

You'll want to know: かめ

かめ — *kame* — “a turtle”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kame*
- *Say it: kame*, once more
- *Say it: say kame*

- *Recall*: say the Japanese for an octopus, then the Japanese for a squid, then say *kame* again

Before you move on

What does かめ mean? (“A turtle.”) Say it once more.

47.5 おおかみ (ookami) — a wolf

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a squid, then the Japanese for a turtle.

You’ll want to know: おおかみ

おおかみ — *ookami* — “a wolf”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it*: *ookami*
- *Say it*: *ookami*, once more
- *Say it*: say *ookami*
- *Recall*: say the Japanese for a squid, then the Japanese for a turtle, then say *ookami* again

Before you move on

What does おおかみ mean? (“A wolf.”) Say it once more.

Chapter 48

Chicken, Small, Good, Long, Short

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a chicken, small, good, long and short.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 48: i can say a chicken, small, good, long and short.

48.1 にわとり (niwatori) — a chicken

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a turtle, then the Japanese for a wolf.

You'll want to know: にわとり

にわとり — *niwatori* — “a chicken”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: niwatori*
- *Say it: niwatori, once more*
- *Say it: say niwatori*

- *Recall*: say the Japanese for a turtle, then the Japanese for a wolf, then say *niwatori* again

Before you move on

What does にわとり mean? (“A chicken”.) Say it once more.

48.2 ちいさい (chiisai) — small

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a wolf, then the Japanese for a chicken.

You’ll want to know: ちいさい

ちいさい — *chiisai* — “small”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it*: *chiisai*
- *Say it*: *chiisai*, once more
- *Say it*: say *chiisai*
- *Recall*: say the Japanese for a wolf, then the Japanese for a chicken, then say *chiisai* again

Before you move on

What does ちいさい mean? (“Small”.) Say it once more.

48.3 いい (ii) — good

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a chicken, then the Japanese for small.

You'll want to know: いい

いい — *ii* — “good”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ii*
- *Say it:* *ii*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ii*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for a chicken, then the Japanese for small, then say *ii* again

Before you move on

What does いい mean? (“Good”.) Say it once more.

48.4 ながい (*nagai*) — long

Before the new one: say the Japanese for small, then the Japanese for good.

You'll want to know: ながい

ながい — *nagai* — “long”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *nagai*
- *Say it:* *nagai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nagai*

- *Recall:* say the Japanese for small, then the Japanese for good, then say *nagai* again

Before you move on

What does **ながい** mean? (“Long”.) Say it once more.

48.5 みじかい (mijikai) — short

Before the new one: say the Japanese for good, then the Japanese for long.

You’ll want to know: みじかい

みじかい — *mijikai* — “short”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *mijikai*
- *Say it:* *mijikai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mijikai*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for good, then the Japanese for long, then say *mijikai* again

Before you move on

What does **みじかい** mean? (“Short”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 49

Tall, Low, Cheap, Fast, Easy

Modes: ⇄ voice (5) ⇄ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say tall, low, cheap, fast and easy.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 49: i can say tall, low, cheap, fast and easy.

49.1 たかい (takai) — tall; expensive

Before the new one: say the Japanese for long, then the Japanese for short.

You'll want to know: たかい

たかい — *takai* — “tall; expensive”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: takai*
- *Say it: takai, once more*
- *Say it: say takai*

- *Recall*: say the Japanese for long, then the Japanese for short, then say *takai* again

Before you move on

What does *たかい* mean? (“Tall; expensive”.) Say it once more.

49.2 ひくい (hikui) — low

Before the new one: say the Japanese for short, then the Japanese for tall; expensive.

You’ll want to know: ひくい

ひくい — *hikui* — “low”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it*: *hikui*
- *Say it*: *hikui*, once more
- *Say it*: say *hikui*
- *Recall*: say the Japanese for short, then the Japanese for tall; expensive, then say *hikui* again

Before you move on

What does ひくい mean? (“Low”.) Say it once more.

49.3 やすい (yasui) — cheap

Before the new one: say the Japanese for tall; expensive, then the Japanese for low.

You'll want to know: やすい

やすい — *yasui* — “cheap”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: yasui*
- *Say it: yasui*, once more
- *Say it: say yasui*
- *Recall: say the Japanese for tall; expensive, then the Japanese for low, then say yasui again*

Before you move on

What does やすい mean? (“Cheap”.) Say it once more.

49.4 はやい (hayai) — fast; early

Before the new one: say the Japanese for low, then the Japanese for cheap.

You'll want to know: はやい

はやい — *hayai* — “fast; early”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: hayai*
- *Say it: hayai*, once more
- *Say it: say hayai*

- *Recall:* say the Japanese for low, then the Japanese for cheap, then say *hayai* again

Before you move on

What does **はやい** mean? (“Fast; early”.) Say it once more.

49.5 やさしい (yasashii) — easy; kind

Before the new one: say the Japanese for cheap, then the Japanese for fast; early.

You’ll want to know: やさしい

やさしい — *yasashii* — “easy; kind”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *yasashii*
- *Say it:* *yasashii*, once more
- *Say it:* say *yasashii*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for cheap, then the Japanese for fast; early, then say *yasashii* again

Before you move on

What does **やさしい** mean? (“Easy; kind”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 50

Sweet, Bitter, Wide, Narrow, Heavy

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say sweet, bitter, wide, narrow and heavy.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 50: i can say sweet, bitter, wide, narrow and heavy.

50.1 あまい (amai) — sweet

Before the new one: say the Japanese for fast; early, then the Japanese for easy; kind.

You'll want to know: あまい

あまい — *amai* — “sweet”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *amai*
- Say it: *amai*, once more

- *Say it:* say *amai*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for fast; early, then the Japanese for easy; kind, then say *amai* again

Before you move on

What does あまい mean? (“Sweet”.) Say it once more.

50.2 にがい (nigai) — bitter

Before the new one: say the Japanese for easy; kind, then the Japanese for sweet.

You’ll want to know: にがい

にがい — *nigai* — “bitter”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *nigai*
- *Say it:* *nigai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nigai*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for easy; kind, then the Japanese for sweet, then say *nigai* again

Before you move on

What does にがい mean? (“Bitter”.) Say it once more.

50.3 ひろい (hiro) — wide

Before the new one: say the Japanese for sweet, then the Japanese for bitter.

You'll want to know: ひろい

ひろい — *hiroi* — “wide”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: hiroi*
- *Say it: hiroi*, once more
- *Say it: say hiroi*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for sweet, then the Japanese for bitter, then say *hiroi* again

Before you move on

What does ひろい mean? (“Wide”.) Say it once more.

50.4 せまい (semai) — narrow

Before the new one: say the Japanese for bitter, then the Japanese for wide.

You'll want to know: せまい

せまい — *semai* — “narrow”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: semai*
- *Say it: semai*, once more
- *Say it: say semai*

- *Recall:* say the Japanese for bitter, then the Japanese for wide, then say *semai* again

Before you move on

What does せまい mean? (“Narrow”.) Say it once more.

50.5 おもい (omoi) — heavy

Before the new one: say the Japanese for wide, then the Japanese for narrow.

You’ll want to know: おもい

おもい — *omoi* — “heavy”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *omoi*
- *Say it:* *omoi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *omoi*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for wide, then the Japanese for narrow, then say *omoi* again

Before you move on

What does おもい mean? (“Heavy”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 51

Strong, Weak, Beautiful, Blue, Red

Modes: ⇄ voice (5) ⇄ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say strong, weak, beautiful, blue and red.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 51: i can say strong, weak, beautiful, blue and red.

51.1 つよい (tsuyoi) — strong

Before the new one: say the Japanese for narrow, then the Japanese for heavy.

You'll want to know: つよい

つよい — *tsuyoi* — “strong”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tsuyoi*
- *Say it: tsuyoi, once more*
- *Say it: say tsuyoi*

- *Recall*: say the Japanese for narrow, then the Japanese for heavy, then say *tsuyoi* again

Before you move on

What does つよい mean? (“Strong”.) Say it once more.

51.2 よわい (yowai) — weak

Before the new one: say the Japanese for heavy, then the Japanese for strong.

You’ll want to know: よわい

よわい — *yowai* — “weak”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it*: *yowai*
- *Say it*: *yowai*, once more
- *Say it*: say *yowai*
- *Recall*: say the Japanese for heavy, then the Japanese for strong, then say *yowai* again

Before you move on

What does よわい mean? (“Weak”.) Say it once more.

51.3 うつくしい (utsukushii) — beautiful

Before the new one: say the Japanese for strong, then the Japanese for weak.

You'll want to know: うつくしい

うつくしい — *utsukushii* — “beautiful”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *utsukushii*
- *Say it:* *utsukushii*, once more
- *Say it:* say *utsukushii*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for strong, then the Japanese for weak, then say *utsukushii* again

Before you move on

What does うつくしい mean? (“Beautiful”.) Say it once more.

51.4 あおい (aoi) — blue

Before the new one: say the Japanese for weak, then the Japanese for beautiful.

You'll want to know: あおい

あおい — *aoi* — “blue”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *aoi*
- *Say it:* *aoi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *aoi*

- *Recall*: say the Japanese for weak, then the Japanese for beautiful, then say *aoi* again

Before you move on

What does あおい mean? (“Blue”.) Say it once more.

51.5 あかい (akai) — red

Before the new one: say the Japanese for beautiful, then the Japanese for blue.

You’ll want to know: あかい

あかい — *akai* — “red”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it*: *akai*
- *Say it*: *akai*, once more
- *Say it*: say *akai*
- *Recall*: say the Japanese for beautiful, then the Japanese for blue, then say *akai* again

Before you move on

What does あかい mean? (“Red”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 52

White, Black, Green, Thick, Warm

Modes: 🔄 voice (5) 🔄 Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say white, black, green, thick and warm.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 52: i can say white, black, green, thick and warm.

52.1 しろい (shiroi) — white

Before the new one: say the Japanese for blue, then the Japanese for red.

You'll want to know: しろい

しろい — *shiroi* — “white”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: shiroi*
- *Say it: shiroi, once more*
- *Say it: say shiroi*

- *Recall*: say the Japanese for blue, then the Japanese for red, then say *shiroi* again

Before you move on

What does しろい mean? (“White”.) Say it once more.

52.2 くろい (kuroi) — black

Before the new one: say the Japanese for red, then the Japanese for white.

You’ll want to know: くろい

くろい — *kuroi* — “black”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it*: *kuroi*
- *Say it*: *kuroi*, once more
- *Say it*: say *kuroi*
- *Recall*: say the Japanese for red, then the Japanese for white, then say *kuroi* again

Before you move on

What does くろい mean? (“Black”.) Say it once more.

52.3 みどり (midori) — green

Before the new one: say the Japanese for white, then the Japanese for black.

You'll want to know: みどり

みどり — *midori* — “green”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: midori*
- *Say it: midori*, once more
- *Say it: say midori*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for white, then the Japanese for black, then say *midori* again

Before you move on

What does みどり mean? (“Green”.) Say it once more.

52.4 ふとい (*futoi*) — thick

Before the new one: say the Japanese for black, then the Japanese for green.

You'll want to know: ふとい

ふとい — *futoi* — “thick”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: futoi*
- *Say it: futoi*, once more
- *Say it: say futoi*

- *Recall:* say the Japanese for black, then the Japanese for green, then say *futoi* again

Before you move on

What does ふとい mean? (“Thick.”) Say it once more.

52.5 あたたかい (atatakai) — warm

Before the new one: say the Japanese for green, then the Japanese for thick.

You’ll want to know: あたたかい

あたたかい — *atatakai* — “warm”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *atatakai*
- *Say it:* *atatakai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *atatakai*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for green, then the Japanese for thick, then say *atatakai* again

Before you move on

What does あたたかい mean? (“Warm.”) Say it once more.

Chapter 53

Cold, Tasty, Hot, Cold, Morning

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say cold, tasty, hot, cold and morning.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 53: i can say cold, tasty, hot, cold and morning.

53.1 つめたい (tsumetai) — cold (to the touch)

Before the new one: say the Japanese for thick, then the Japanese for warm.

You'll want to know: つめたい

つめたい — *tsumetai* — “cold (to the touch)”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tsumetai*
- *Say it: tsumetai, once more*
- *Say it: say tsumetai*

- *Recall*: say the Japanese for thick, then the Japanese for warm, then say *tsumetai* again

Before you move on

What does つめたい mean? (“Cold (to the touch)”). Say it once more.

53.2 おいしい (oishii) — tasty

Before the new one: say the Japanese for warm, then the Japanese for cold.

You’ll want to know: おいしい

おいしい — *oishii* — “tasty”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it*: *oishii*
- *Say it*: *oishii*, once more
- *Say it*: say *oishii*
- *Recall*: say the Japanese for warm, then the Japanese for cold, then say *oishii* again

Before you move on

What does おいしい mean? (“Tasty”). Say it once more.

53.3 あつい (atsui) — hot

Before the new one: say the Japanese for cold, then the Japanese for tasty.

You'll want to know: あつい

あつい — *atsui* — “hot”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: atsui*
- *Say it: atsui*, once more
- *Say it: say atsui*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for cold, then the Japanese for tasty, then say *atsui* again

Before you move on

What does あつい mean? (“Hot”.) Say it once more.

53.4 さむい (*samui*) — cold (weather)

Before the new one: say the Japanese for tasty, then the Japanese for hot.

You'll want to know: さむい

さむい — *samui* — “cold (weather)”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: samui*
- *Say it: samui*, once more
- *Say it: say samui*

- *Recall:* say the Japanese for tasty, then the Japanese for hot, then say *samui* again

Before you move on

What does さむい mean? (“Cold (weather).”) Say it once more.

53.5 あさ (asa) — morning

Before the new one: say the Japanese for hot, then the Japanese for cold.

You’ll want to know: あさ

あさ — *asa* — “morning”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *asa*
- *Say it:* *asa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *asa*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for hot, then the Japanese for cold, then say *asa* again

Before you move on

What does あさ mean? (“Morning.”) Say it once more.

Chapter 54

Evening, Tomorrow, Now, Every day, Year

Modes: 🗣️ voice (7) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 7 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say evening, tomorrow, now, every day and a year.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 54: i can say evening, tomorrow, now, every day and a year.

54.1 ゆうがた (yuugata) — evening

Before the new one: say the Japanese for cold, then the Japanese for morning.

You'll want to know: ゆうがた

ゆうがた — *yuugata* — “evening”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *yuugata*
- Say it: *yuugata*, once more

- *Say it:* say *yuugata*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for cold, then the Japanese for morning, then say *yuugata* again

Before you move on

What does ゆうがた mean? (“Evening”.) Say it once more.

54.2 あした (ashita) — tomorrow

Before the new one: say the Japanese for morning, then the Japanese for evening.

You’ll want to know: あした

あした — *ashita* — “tomorrow”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ashita*
- *Say it:* *ashita*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ashita*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for morning, then the Japanese for evening, then say *ashita* again

Before you move on

What does あした mean? (“Tomorrow”.) Say it once more.

54.3 いま (ima) — now

Before the new one: say the Japanese for evening, then the Japanese for tomorrow.

You'll want to know: いま

いま — *ima* — “now”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ima*
- *Say it: ima*, once more
- *Say it: say ima*
- *Recall: say the Japanese for evening, then the Japanese for tomorrow, then say ima again*

Before you move on

What does いま mean? (“Now”.) Say it once more.

54.4 まいにち (mainichi) — every day

Before the new one: say the Japanese for tomorrow, then the Japanese for now.

You'll want to know: まいにち

まいにち — *mainichi* — “every day”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mainichi*
- *Say it: mainichi*, once more
- *Say it: say mainichi*

- *Recall:* say the Japanese for tomorrow, then the Japanese for now, then say *mainichi* again

Before you move on

What does まいにち mean? (“Every day”.) Say it once more.

54.5 とし (toshi) — a year; age

Before the new one: say the Japanese for now, then the Japanese for every day.

You’ll want to know: とし

とし — *toshi* — “a year; age”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *toshi*
- *Say it:* *toshi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *toshi*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for now, then the Japanese for every day, then say *toshi* again

Before you move on

What does とし mean? (“A year; age”.) Say it once more.

54.6 Food and the home — a first pass

Say the words for every day and a year; age.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the floor, a mirror, a futon, chopsticks, a kitchen
- a garden, a bath, a tatami mat, a shelf, a box
- an umbrella, a school, homework, a problem, an answer
- a letter, time; an hour, a name, money, a mountain
- a river, the sea, grass, a forest, a stone
- sand, a rice field, a star, a cloud; a spider, the sun
- an island, a wave, soil, a seed, rain; candy
- a cat, a horse, a cow, a bird, a bear

Before you move on

The floor? (*yuka.*) A mirror? (*kagami.*) A futon? (*futon.*)
 Chopsticks? (*hashi.*) A kitchen? (*daidokoro.*) A garden? (*niwa.*) A
 bath? (*ofuro.*) A tatami mat? (*tatami.*) A shelf? (*tana.*) A box?
 (*hako.*) An umbrella? (*kasa.*) A school? (*gakkou.*) Homework?
 (*shukudai.*) A problem? (*mondai.*) An answer? (*kotae.*) A letter?
 (*tegami.*) Time; an hour? (*jikan.*) A name? (*namae.*) Money?
 (*okane.*) A mountain? (*yama.*) A river? (*kawa.*) The sea? (*umi.*)
 Grass? (*kusa.*) A forest? (*mori.*) A stone? (*ishi.*) Sand? (*sun.*) A
 rice field? (*tanbo.*) A star? (*hoshi.*) A cloud; a spider? (*kumo.*) The
 sun? (*taiyou.*) An island? (*shima.*) A wave? (*nami.*) Soil? (*tsuchi.*)
 A seed? (*tane.*) Rain; candy? (*ame.*) A cat? (*neko.*) A horse?
 (*uma.*) A cow? (*ushi.*) A bird? (*tori.*) A bear? (*kuma.*)

54.7 School, nature and animals — a second pass

Say the words for an insect and an ant.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- an insect, an ant, a pigeon, a sheep, a deer
- a crab, an octopus, a squid, a turtle, a wolf
- a chicken, small, good, long, short
- tall; expensive, low, cheap, fast; early, easy; kind
- sweet, bitter, wide, narrow, heavy
- strong, weak, beautiful, blue, red
- white, black, green, thick, warm
- cold, tasty, hot, cold, morning
- evening, tomorrow, now, every day, a year; age

Before you move on

An insect? (*mushi.*) An ant? (*ari.*) A pigeon? (*hato.*) A sheep? (*hitsuji.*) A deer? (*shika.*) A crab? (*kani.*) An octopus? (*tako.*) A squid? (*ika.*) A turtle? (*kame.*) A wolf? (*ookami.*) A chicken? (*niwatori.*) Small? (*chiisai.*) Good? (*ii.*) Long? (*nagai.*) Short? (*mijikai.*) Tall; expensive? (*takai.*) Low? (*hikui.*) Cheap? (*yasui.*) Fast; early? (*hayai.*) Easy; kind? (*yasashii.*) Sweet? (*amai.*) Bitter? (*nigai.*) Wide? (*hiro.*) Narrow? (*semai.*) Heavy? (*omoi.*) Strong? (*tsuyoi.*) Weak? (*yowai.*) Beautiful? (*utsukushii.*) Blue? (*aoi.*) Red? (*akai.*) White? (*shiroi.*) Black? (*kuroi.*) Green? (*midori.*) Thick? (*futoi.*) Warm? (*atatakai.*) Cold? (*tsumetai.*) Tasty? (*oishii.*) Hot? (*atsui.*) Cold? (*samui.*) Morning? (*asa.*) Evening? (*yuugata.*) Tomorrow? (*ashita.*) Now? (*ima.*) Every day? (*mainichi.*) A year; age? (*toshi.*)

Chapter 55

Minute, Summer, Winter, Always, Still

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a minute, summer, winter, always and still, not yet.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 55: i can say a minute, summer, winter, always and still, not yet.

55.1 ふん (fun) — a minute

Before the new one: say the Japanese for every day, then the Japanese for a year; age.

You'll want to know: ふん

ふん — *fun* — “a minute”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *fun*
- Say it: *fun*, once more

- *Say it:* say *fun*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for every day, then the Japanese for a year; age, then say *fun* again

Before you move on

What does ふん mean? (“A minute”.) Say it once more.

55.2 なつ (natsu) — summer

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a year; age, then the Japanese for a minute.

You’ll want to know: なつ

なつ — *natsu* — “summer”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *natsu*
- *Say it:* *natsu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *natsu*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for a year; age, then the Japanese for a minute, then say *natsu* again

Before you move on

What does なつ mean? (“Summer”.) Say it once more.

55.3 ふゆ (fuyu) — winter

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a minute, then the Japanese for summer.

You'll want to know: ふゆ

ふゆ — *fuyu* — “winter”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: fuyu*
- *Say it: fuyu*, once more
- *Say it: say fuyu*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for a minute, then the Japanese for summer, then say *fuyu* again

Before you move on

What does ふゆ mean? (“Winter”.) Say it once more.

55.4 いつも (*itsumo*) — always

Before the new one: say the Japanese for summer, then the Japanese for winter.

You'll want to know: いつも

いつも — *itsumo* — “always”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: itsumo*
- *Say it: itsumo*, once more
- *Say it: say itsumo*

- *Recall*: say the Japanese for summer, then the Japanese for winter, then say *itsumo* again

Before you move on

What does いつも mean? (“Always”.) Say it once more.

55.5 まだ (mada) — still, not yet

Before the new one: say the Japanese for winter, then the Japanese for always.

You’ll want to know: まだ

まだ — *mada* — “still, not yet”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it*: *mada*
- *Say it*: *mada*, once more
- *Say it*: say *mada*
- *Recall*: say the Japanese for winter, then the Japanese for always, then say *mada* again

Before you move on

What does まだ mean? (“Still, not yet”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 56

After, Before, Above, Inside, Left

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say after, later, before, above, on top, inside and left.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 56: i can say after, later, before, above, on top, inside and left.

56.1 あと (ato) — after, later

Before the new one: say the Japanese for always, then the Japanese for still.

You'll want to know: あと

あと — *ato* — “after, later”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ato*
- *Say it: ato, once more*
- *Say it: say ato*

- *Recall*: say the Japanese for always, then the Japanese for still, then say *ato* again

Before you move on

What does あと mean? (“After, later”.) Say it once more.

56.2 まえ (mae) — before; in front

Before the new one: say the Japanese for still, then the Japanese for after.

You’ll want to know: まえ

まえ — *mae* — “before; in front”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it*: *mae*
- *Say it*: *mae*, once more
- *Say it*: say *mae*
- *Recall*: say the Japanese for still, then the Japanese for after, then say *mae* again

Before you move on

What does まえ mean? (“Before; in front”.) Say it once more.

56.3 うえ (ue) — above, on top

Before the new one: say the Japanese for after, then the Japanese for before; in front.

You'll want to know: うえ

うえ — *ue* — “above, on top”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ue*
- *Say it:* *ue*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ue*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for after, then the Japanese for before; in front, then say *ue* again

Before you move on

What does うえ mean? (“Above, on top”.) Say it once more.

56.4 なか (*naka*) — inside

Before the new one: say the Japanese for before; in front, then the Japanese for above.

You'll want to know: なか

なか — *naka* — “inside”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *naka*
- *Say it:* *naka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *naka*

- *Recall*: say the Japanese for before; in front, then the Japanese for above, then say *naka* again

Before you move on

What does なか mean? (“Inside”.) Say it once more.

56.5 ひだり (hidari) — left

Before the new one: say the Japanese for above, then the Japanese for inside.

You’ll want to know: ひだり

ひだり — *hidari* — “left”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it*: *hidari*
- *Say it*: *hidari*, once more
- *Say it*: say *hidari*
- *Recall*: say the Japanese for above, then the Japanese for inside, then say *hidari* again

Before you move on

What does ひだり mean? (“Left”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 57

Near, Far, Town, Road, Shop

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say near, far, a town, a road and a shop.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 57: i can say near, far, a town, a road and a shop.

57.1 ちかい (chikai) — near

Before the new one: say the Japanese for inside, then the Japanese for left.

You'll want to know: ちかい

ちかい — *chikai* — “near”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *chikai*
- Say it: *chikai*, once more
- Say it: say *chikai*

- *Recall:* say the Japanese for inside, then the Japanese for left, then say *chikai* again

Before you move on

What does ちかい mean? (“Near”.) Say it once more.

57.2 とおい (tooi) — far

Before the new one: say the Japanese for left, then the Japanese for near.

You’ll want to know: とおい

とおい — *tooi* — “far”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *tooi*
- *Say it:* *tooi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tooi*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for left, then the Japanese for near, then say *tooi* again

Before you move on

What does とおい mean? (“Far”.) Say it once more.

57.3 まち (machi) — a town

Before the new one: say the Japanese for near, then the Japanese for far.

You'll want to know: まち

まち — *machi* — “a town”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: machi*
- *Say it: machi*, once more
- *Say it: say machi*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for near, then the Japanese for far, then say *machi* again

Before you move on

What does まち mean? (“A town”.) Say it once more.

57.4 みち (michi) — a road

Before the new one: say the Japanese for far, then the Japanese for a town.

You'll want to know: みち

みち — *michi* — “a road”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: michi*
- *Say it: michi*, once more
- *Say it: say michi*

- *Recall*: say the Japanese for far, then the Japanese for a town, then say *michi* again

Before you move on

What does *みち* mean? (“A road”.) Say it once more.

57.5 みせ (mise) — a shop

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a town, then the Japanese for a road.

You’ll want to know: みせ

みせ — *mise* — “a shop”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it*: *mise*
- *Say it*: *mise*, once more
- *Say it*: say *mise*
- *Recall*: say the Japanese for a town, then the Japanese for a road, then say *mise* again

Before you move on

What does *みせ* mean? (“A shop”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 58

Underground, Park, Country, Clothes, Shoes

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say underground, a park, a country, clothes and shoes.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 58: i can say underground, a park, a country, clothes and shoes.

58.1 ちか (chika) — underground

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a road, then the Japanese for a shop.

You'll want to know: ちか

ちか — *chika* — “underground”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *chika*
- Say it: *chika*, once more

- *Say it:* say *chika*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for a road, then the Japanese for a shop, then say *chika* again

Before you move on

What does ちか mean? (“Underground”.) Say it once more.

58.2 こうえん (kouen) — a park

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a shop, then the Japanese for underground.

You’ll want to know: こうえん

こうえん — *kouen* — “a park”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *kouen*
- *Say it:* *kouen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kouen*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for a shop, then the Japanese for underground, then say *kouen* again

Before you move on

What does こうえん mean? (“A park”.) Say it once more.

58.3 く に (kuni) — a country

Before the new one: say the Japanese for underground, then the Japanese for a park.

You'll want to know: <に

<に — *kuni* — “a country”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kuni*
- *Say it: kuni*, once more
- *Say it: say kuni*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for underground, then the Japanese for a park, then say *kuni* again

Before you move on

What does <に mean? (“A country”.) Say it once more.

58.4 ふく (fuku) — clothes

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a park, then the Japanese for a country.

You'll want to know: ふく

ふく — *fuku* — “clothes”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: fuku*
- *Say it: fuku*, once more
- *Say it: say fuku*

- *Recall*: say the Japanese for a park, then the Japanese for a country, then say *fuku* again

Before you move on

What does 服 mean? (“Clothes”.) Say it once more.

58.5 < っ (kutsu) — shoes

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a country, then the Japanese for clothes.

You’ll want to know: < っ

< っ — *kutsu* — “shoes”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it*: *kutsu*
- *Say it*: *kutsu*, once more
- *Say it*: say *kutsu*
- *Recall*: say the Japanese for a country, then the Japanese for clothes, then say *kutsu* again

Before you move on

What does < っ mean? (“Shoes”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 59

Hat, Socks, Glasses, Thirty, Thousand

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a hat, socks, glasses, thirty and a thousand.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 59: i can say a hat, socks, glasses, thirty and a thousand.

59.1 ぼうし (boushi) — a hat

Before the new one: say the Japanese for clothes, then the Japanese for shoes.

You'll want to know: ぼうし

ぼうし — *boushi* — “a hat”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *boushi*
- Say it: *boushi*, once more

- *Say it:* say *boushi*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for clothes, then the Japanese for shoes, then say *boushi* again

Before you move on

What does ぼうし mean? (“A hat”.) Say it once more.

59.2 くつした (*kutsushita*) — socks

Before the new one: say the Japanese for shoes, then the Japanese for a hat.

You’ll want to know: くつした

くつした — *kutsushita* — “socks”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *kutsushita*
- *Say it:* *kutsushita*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kutsushita*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for shoes, then the Japanese for a hat, then say *kutsushita* again

Before you move on

What does くつした mean? (“Socks”.) Say it once more.

59.3 めがね (*megane*) — glasses

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a hat, then the Japanese for socks.

You'll want to know: めがね

めがね — *megane* — “glasses”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: megane*
- *Say it: megane*, once more
- *Say it: say megane*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for a hat, then the Japanese for socks, then say *megane* again

Before you move on

What does めがね mean? (“Glasses”.) Say it once more.

59.4 さんじゅう (*sanjuu*) — thirty

Before the new one: say the Japanese for socks, then the Japanese for glasses.

You'll want to know: さんじゅう

さんじゅう — *sanjuu* — “thirty”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sanjuu*
- *Say it: sanjuu*, once more
- *Say it: say sanjuu*

- *Recall:* say the Japanese for socks, then the Japanese for glasses, then say *sanjuu* again

Before you move on

What does さんじゅう mean? (“Thirty”.) Say it once more.

59.5 せん (sen) — a thousand

Before the new one: say the Japanese for glasses, then the Japanese for thirty.

You’ll want to know: せん

せん — *sen* — “a thousand”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *sen*
- *Say it:* *sen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sen*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for glasses, then the Japanese for thirty, then say *sen* again

Before you move on

What does せん mean? (“A thousand”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 60

Ten thousand, Twelve, Aubergine, Song, Branch

Modes: 🔄 voice (5) 🔄 Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say ten thousand, twelve, an aubergine, a song and a branch.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 60: i can say ten thousand, twelve, an aubergine, a song and a branch.

60.1 まん (man) — ten thousand

Before the new one: say the Japanese for thirty, then the Japanese for a thousand.

You'll want to know: まん

まん — *man* — “ten thousand”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *man*
- Say it: *man*, once more

- *Say it:* say *man*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for thirty, then the Japanese for a thousand, then say *man* again

Before you move on

What does まん mean? (“Ten thousand”.) Say it once more.

60.2 じゅうに (juuni) — twelve

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a thousand, then the Japanese for ten thousand.

You’ll want to know: じゅうに

じゅうに — *juuni* — “twelve”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *juuni*
- *Say it:* *juuni*, once more
- *Say it:* say *juuni*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for a thousand, then the Japanese for ten thousand, then say *juuni* again

Before you move on

What does じゅうに mean? (“Twelve”.) Say it once more.

60.3 なす (nasu) — an aubergine

Before the new one: say the Japanese for ten thousand, then the Japanese for twelve.

You'll want to know: なす

なす — *nasu* — “an aubergine”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nasu*
- *Say it: nasu*, once more
- *Say it: say nasu*
- *Recall: say the Japanese for ten thousand, then the Japanese for twelve, then say nasu again*

Before you move on

What does なす mean? (“An aubergine”.) Say it once more.

60.4 うた (uta) — a song

Before the new one: say the Japanese for twelve, then the Japanese for an aubergine.

You'll want to know: うた

うた — *uta* — “a song”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: uta*
- *Say it: uta*, once more
- *Say it: say uta*

- *Recall*: say the Japanese for twelve, then the Japanese for an aubergine, then say *uta* again

Before you move on

What does うた mean? (“A song”.) Say it once more.

60.5 えだ (eda) — a branch

Before the new one: say the Japanese for an aubergine, then the Japanese for a song.

You’ll want to know: えだ

えだ — *eda* — “a branch”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it*: *eda*
- *Say it*: *eda*, once more
- *Say it*: say *eda*
- *Recall*: say the Japanese for an aubergine, then the Japanese for a song, then say *eda* again

Before you move on

What does えだ mean? (“A branch”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 61

Thread, Needle, Comb, String, Rope

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a thread, a needle, a comb, a string and a rope.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 61: i can say a thread, a needle, a comb, a string and a rope.

61.1 いと (ito) — a thread

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a song, then the Japanese for a branch.

You'll want to know: いと

いと — *ito* — “a thread”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ito*
- *Say it: ito, once more*

- *Say it:* say *ito*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for a song, then the Japanese for a branch, then say *ito* again

Before you move on

What does **いと** mean? (“A thread”.) Say it once more.

61.2 はり (hari) — a needle

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a branch, then the Japanese for a thread.

You’ll want to know: はり

はり — *hari* — “a needle”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *hari*
- *Say it:* *hari*, once more
- *Say it:* say *hari*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for a branch, then the Japanese for a thread, then say *hari* again

Before you move on

What does **はり** mean? (“A needle”.) Say it once more.

61.3 くし (kushi) — a comb

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a thread, then the Japanese for a needle.

You'll want to know: くし

くし — *kushi* — “a comb”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kushi*
- *Say it: kushi*, once more
- *Say it: say kushi*
- *Recall: say the Japanese for a thread, then the Japanese for a needle, then say kushi again*

Before you move on

What does くし mean? (“A comb”.) Say it once more.

61.4 ひも (himo) — a string

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a needle, then the Japanese for a comb.

You'll want to know: ひも

ひも — *himo* — “a string”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: himo*
- *Say it: himo*, once more
- *Say it: say himo*

- *Recall:* say the Japanese for a needle, then the Japanese for a comb, then say *himo* again

Before you move on

What does ひも mean? (“A string.”) Say it once more.

61.5 つな (tsuna) — a rope

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a comb, then the Japanese for a string.

You’ll want to know: つな

つな — *tsuna* — “a rope”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *tsuna*
- *Say it:* *tsuna*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tsuna*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for a comb, then the Japanese for a string, then say *tsuna* again

Before you move on

What does つな mean? (“A rope.”) Say it once more.

Chapter 62

Luggage, Ship, Sound, Colour, Shape

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say luggage, a ship, a sound, a colour and a shape.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 62: i can say luggage, a ship, a sound, a colour and a shape.

62.1 にもつ (nimotsu) — luggage

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a string, then the Japanese for a rope.

You'll want to know: にもつ

にもつ — *nimotsu* — “luggage”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *nimotsu*
- Say it: *nimotsu*, once more

- *Say it:* say *nimotsu*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for a string, then the Japanese for a rope, then say *nimotsu* again

Before you move on

What does **にもつ** mean? (“Luggage”.) Say it once more.

62.2 ふね (fune) — a ship

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a rope, then the Japanese for luggage.

You’ll want to know: ふね

ふね — *fune* — “a ship”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *fune*
- *Say it:* *fune*, once more
- *Say it:* say *fune*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for a rope, then the Japanese for luggage, then say *fune* again

Before you move on

What does **ふね** mean? (“A ship”.) Say it once more.

62.3 おと (oto) — a sound

Before the new one: say the Japanese for luggage, then the Japanese for a ship.

You'll want to know: おと

おと — *oto* — “a sound”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: oto*
- *Say it: oto*, once more
- *Say it: say oto*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for luggage, then the Japanese for a ship, then say *oto* again

Before you move on

What does おと mean? (“A sound”.) Say it once more.

62.4 いろ (iro) — a colour

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a ship, then the Japanese for a sound.

You'll want to know: いろ

いろ — *iro* — “a colour”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: iro*
- *Say it: iro*, once more
- *Say it: say iro*

- *Recall*: say the Japanese for a ship, then the Japanese for a sound, then say *iro* again

Before you move on

What does いろ mean? (“A colour”.) Say it once more.

62.5 かたち (katachi) — a shape

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a sound, then the Japanese for a colour.

You’ll want to know: かたち

かたち — *katachi* — “a shape”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it*: *katachi*
- *Say it*: *katachi*, once more
- *Say it*: say *katachi*
- *Recall*: say the Japanese for a sound, then the Japanese for a colour, then say *katachi* again

Before you move on

What does かたち mean? (“A shape”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 63

Dream, Festival, West, East, South

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a dream, a festival, west, east and south.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 63: i can say a dream, a festival, west, east and south.

63.1 ゆめ (yume) — a dream

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a colour, then the Japanese for a shape.

You'll want to know: ゆめ

ゆめ — *yume* — “a dream”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: yume*
- *Say it: yume, once more*
- *Say it: say yume*

- *Recall*: say the Japanese for a colour, then the Japanese for a shape, then say *yume* again

Before you move on

What does ゆめ mean? (“A dream”.) Say it once more.

63.2 まつり (matsuri) — a festival

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a shape, then the Japanese for a dream.

You’ll want to know: まつり

まつり — *matsuri* — “a festival”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: matsuri*
- *Say it: matsuri*, once more
- *Say it: say matsuri*
- *Recall*: say the Japanese for a shape, then the Japanese for a dream, then say *matsuri* again

Before you move on

What does まつり mean? (“A festival”.) Say it once more.

63.3 にし (nishi) — west

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a dream, then the Japanese for a festival.

You'll want to know: にし

にし — *nishi* — “west”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nishi*
- *Say it: nishi*, once more
- *Say it: say nishi*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for a dream, then the Japanese for a festival, then say *nishi* again

Before you move on

What does にし mean? (“West”.) Say it once more.

63.4 ひがし (*higashi*) — east

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a festival, then the Japanese for west.

You'll want to know: ひがし

ひがし — *higashi* — “east”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: higashi*
- *Say it: higashi*, once more
- *Say it: say higashi*

- *Recall*: say the Japanese for a festival, then the Japanese for west, then say *higashi* again

Before you move on

What does ひがし mean? (“East”.) Say it once more.

63.5 みなみ (minami) — south

Before the new one: say the Japanese for west, then the Japanese for east.

You’ll want to know: みなみ

みなみ — *minami* — “south”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it*: *minami*
- *Say it*: *minami*, once more
- *Say it*: say *minami*
- *Recall*: say the Japanese for west, then the Japanese for east, then say *minami* again

Before you move on

What does みなみ mean? (“South”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 64

Powder, Sesame, Sea urchin, Sardine, Flavour

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say powder, flour, sesame, a sea urchin, a sardine and a flavour, a taste.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 64: i can say powder, flour, sesame, a sea urchin, a sardine and a flavour, a taste.

64.1 こな (kona) — powder, flour

Before the new one: say the Japanese for east, then the Japanese for south.

You'll want to know: こな

こな — *kona* — “powder, flour”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *kona*
- Say it: *kona*, once more

- *Say it:* say *kona*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for east, then the Japanese for south, then say *kona* again

Before you move on

What does こな mean? (“Powder, flour”.) Say it once more.

64.2 ごま (goma) — sesame

Before the new one: say the Japanese for south, then the Japanese for powder.

You’ll want to know: ごま

ごま — *goma* — “sesame”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *goma*
- *Say it:* *goma*, once more
- *Say it:* say *goma*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for south, then the Japanese for powder, then say *goma* again

Before you move on

What does ごま mean? (“Sesame”.) Say it once more.

64.3 うに (uni) — a sea urchin

Before the new one: say the Japanese for powder, then the Japanese for sesame.

You'll want to know: うに

うに — *uni* — “a sea urchin”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: uni*
- *Say it: uni*, once more
- *Say it: say uni*
- *Recall: say the Japanese for powder, then the Japanese for sesame, then say uni again*

Before you move on

What does うに mean? (“A sea urchin”.) Say it once more.

64.4 いわし (iwashi) — a sardine

Before the new one: say the Japanese for sesame, then the Japanese for a sea urchin.

You'll want to know: いわし

いわし — *iwashi* — “a sardine”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: iwashi*
- *Say it: iwashi*, once more
- *Say it: say iwashi*

- *Recall*: say the Japanese for sesame, then the Japanese for a sea urchin, then say *iwashi* again

Before you move on

What does いわし mean? (“A sardine”.) Say it once more.

64.5 あじ (aji) — a flavour, a taste

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a sea urchin, then the Japanese for a sardine.

You’ll want to know: あじ

あじ — *aji* — “a flavour, a taste”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it*: *aji*
- *Say it*: *aji*, once more
- *Say it*: say *aji*
- *Recall*: say the Japanese for a sea urchin, then the Japanese for a sardine, then say *aji* again

Before you move on

What does あじ mean? (“A flavour, a taste”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 65

Carp, Cicada, Dragonfly, Potato, Burdock root

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a carp, a cicada, a dragonfly, a potato and burdock root.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 65: i can say a carp, a cicada, a dragonfly, a potato and burdock root.

65.1 こい (koi) — a carp

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a sardine, then the Japanese for a flavour.

You'll want to know: こい

こい — *koi* — “a carp”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *koi*
- Say it: *koi*, once more

- *Say it:* say *koi*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for a sardine, then the Japanese for a flavour, then say *koi* again

Before you move on

What does こい mean? (“A carp.”) Say it once more.

65.2 せみ (semi) — a cicada

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a flavour, then the Japanese for a carp.

You’ll want to know: せみ

せみ — *semi* — “a cicada”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *semi*
- *Say it:* *semi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *semi*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for a flavour, then the Japanese for a carp, then say *semi* again

Before you move on

What does せみ mean? (“A cicada.”) Say it once more.

65.3 とんぼ (tonbo) — a dragonfly

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a carp, then the Japanese for a cicada.

You'll want to know: とんぼ

とんぼ — *tonbo* — “a dragonfly”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tonbo*
- *Say it: tonbo*, once more
- *Say it: say tonbo*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for a carp, then the Japanese for a cicada, then say *tonbo* again

Before you move on

What does とんぼ mean? (“A dragonfly”.) Say it once more.

65.4 いも (imo) — a potato

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a cicada, then the Japanese for a dragonfly.

You'll want to know: いも

いも — *imo* — “a potato”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: imo*
- *Say it: imo*, once more
- *Say it: say imo*

- *Recall*: say the Japanese for a cicada, then the Japanese for a dragonfly, then say *imo* again

Before you move on

What does いも mean? (“A potato”.) Say it once more.

65.5 ごぼう (gobou) — burdock root

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a dragonfly, then the Japanese for a potato.

You’ll want to know: ごぼう

ごぼう — *gobou* — “burdock root”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it*: *gobou*
- *Say it*: *gobou*, once more
- *Say it*: say *gobou*
- *Recall*: say the Japanese for a dragonfly, then the Japanese for a potato, then say *gobou* again

Before you move on

What does ごぼう mean? (“Burdock root”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 66

Basket, Spinning top, Raft, Flute, Drum

Modes: 🔄 voice (5) 🔄 Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a basket, a spinning top, a raft, a flute and a drum.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 66: i can say a basket, a spinning top, a raft, a flute and a drum.

66.1 かご (kago) — a basket

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a potato, then the Japanese for burdock root.

You'll want to know: かご

かご — *kago* — “a basket”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kago*
- *Say it: kago, once more*

- *Say it:* say *kago*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for a potato, then the Japanese for burdock root, then say *kago* again

Before you move on

What does かご mean? (“A basket”.) Say it once more.

66.2 こま (koma) — a spinning top

Before the new one: say the Japanese for burdock root, then the Japanese for a basket.

You’ll want to know: こま

こま — *koma* — “a spinning top”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *koma*
- *Say it:* *koma*, once more
- *Say it:* say *koma*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for burdock root, then the Japanese for a basket, then say *koma* again

Before you move on

What does こま mean? (“A spinning top”.) Say it once more.

66.3 いかだ (ikada) — a raft

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a basket, then the Japanese for a spinning top.

You'll want to know: いかだ

いかだ — *ikada* — “a raft”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ikada*
- *Say it: ikada*, once more
- *Say it: say ikada*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for a basket, then the Japanese for a spinning top, then say *ikada* again

Before you move on

What does いかだ mean? (“A raft”.) Say it once more.

66.4 ふえ (fue) — a flute

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a spinning top, then the Japanese for a raft.

You'll want to know: ふえ

ふえ — *fue* — “a flute”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: fue*
- *Say it: fue*, once more
- *Say it: say fue*

- *Recall*: say the Japanese for a spinning top, then the Japanese for a raft, then say *fue* again

Before you move on

What does ふえ mean? (“A flute”.) Say it once more.

66.5 たいこ (taiko) — a drum

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a raft, then the Japanese for a flute.

You’ll want to know: たいこ

たいこ — *taiko* — “a drum”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it*: *taiko*
- *Say it*: *taiko*, once more
- *Say it*: say *taiko*
- *Recall*: say the Japanese for a raft, then the Japanese for a flute, then say *taiko* again

Before you move on

What does たいこ mean? (“A drum”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 67

Hand fan, Folding fan, Charcoal, Well, Beach

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a hand fan, a folding fan, charcoal, a well and a beach.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 67: i can say a hand fan, a folding fan, charcoal, a well and a beach.

67.1 うちわ (uchiwa) — a hand fan

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a flute, then the Japanese for a drum.

You'll want to know: うちわ

うちわ — *uchiwa* — “a hand fan”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *uchiwa*
- Say it: *uchiwa*, once more

- *Say it:* say *uchiwa*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for a flute, then the Japanese for a drum, then say *uchiwa* again

Before you move on

What does うちわ mean? (“A hand fan”.) Say it once more.

67.2 せんす (sensu) — a folding fan

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a drum, then the Japanese for a hand fan.

You’ll want to know: せんす

せんす — *sensu* — “a folding fan”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *sensu*
- *Say it:* *sensu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sensu*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for a drum, then the Japanese for a hand fan, then say *sensu* again

Before you move on

What does せんす mean? (“A folding fan”.) Say it once more.

67.3 すみ (sumi) — charcoal; a corner

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a hand fan, then the Japanese for a folding fan.

You'll want to know: すみ

すみ — *sumi* — “charcoal; a corner”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sumi*
- *Say it: sumi*, once more
- *Say it: say sumi*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for a hand fan, then the Japanese for a folding fan, then say *sumi* again

Before you move on

What does すみ mean? (“Charcoal; a corner”.) Say it once more.

67.4 いど (ido) — a well

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a folding fan, then the Japanese for charcoal; a corner.

You'll want to know: いど

いど — *ido* — “a well”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ido*
- *Say it: ido*, once more
- *Say it: say ido*

- *Recall*: say the Japanese for a folding fan, then the Japanese for charcoal; a corner, then say *ido* again

Before you move on

What does いど mean? (“A well”.) Say it once more.

67.5 はま (hama) — a beach

Before the new one: say the Japanese for charcoal; a corner, then the Japanese for a well.

You’ll want to know: はま

はま — *hama* — “a beach”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it*: *hama*
- *Say it*: *hama*, once more
- *Say it*: say *hama*
- *Recall*: say the Japanese for charcoal; a corner, then the Japanese for a well, then say *hama* again

Before you move on

What does はま mean? (“A beach”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 68

Hill, Valley, Countryside, Harbour, Setting sun

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a hill, a valley, the countryside, a harbour and the setting sun.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 68: i can say a hill, a valley, the countryside, a harbour and the setting sun.

68.1 おか (oka) — a hill

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a well, then the Japanese for a beach.

You'll want to know: おか

おか — *oka* — “a hill”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: oka*
- *Say it: oka, once more*

- *Say it:* say *oka*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for a well, then the Japanese for a beach, then say *oka* again

Before you move on

What does おか mean? (“A hill.”) Say it once more.

68.2 たに (tani) — a valley

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a beach, then the Japanese for a hill.

You’ll want to know: たに

たに — *tani* — “a valley”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *tani*
- *Say it:* *tani*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tani*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for a beach, then the Japanese for a hill, then say *tani* again

Before you move on

What does たに mean? (“A valley.”) Say it once more.

68.3 いなか (inaka) — the countryside

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a hill, then the Japanese for a valley.

You'll want to know: いなか

いなか — *inaka* — “the countryside”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: inaka*
- *Say it: inaka*, once more
- *Say it: say inaka*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for a hill, then the Japanese for a valley, then say *inaka* again

Before you move on

What does いなか mean? (“The countryside”.) Say it once more.

68.4 みなと (minato) — a harbour

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a valley, then the Japanese for the countryside.

You'll want to know: みなと

みなと — *minato* — “a harbour”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: minato*
- *Say it: minato*, once more
- *Say it: say minato*

- *Recall*: say the Japanese for a valley, then the Japanese for the countryside, then say *minato* again

Before you move on

What does みなと mean? (“A harbour”.) Say it once more.

68.5 ゆうひ (yuuhi) — the setting sun

Before the new one: say the Japanese for the countryside, then the Japanese for a harbour.

You’ll want to know: ゆうひ

ゆうひ — *yuuhi* — “the setting sun”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it*: *yuuhi*
- *Say it*: *yuuhi*, once more
- *Say it*: say *yuuhi*
- *Recall*: say the Japanese for the countryside, then the Japanese for a harbour, then say *yuuhi* again

Before you move on

What does ゆうひ mean? (“The setting sun”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 69

Rainbow, Thunder, Frost, Ice, Summer holidays

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a rainbow, thunder, frost, ice and the summer holidays.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 69: i can say a rainbow, thunder, frost, ice and the summer holidays.

69.1 にじ (niji) — a rainbow

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a harbour, then the Japanese for the setting sun.

You'll want to know: にじ

にじ — *niji* — “a rainbow”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: niji*
- *Say it: niji, once more*

- *Say it:* say *niji*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for a harbour, then the Japanese for the setting sun, then say *niji* again

Before you move on

What does にじ mean? (“A rainbow”.) Say it once more.

69.2 かみなり (kaminari) — thunder

Before the new one: say the Japanese for the setting sun, then the Japanese for a rainbow.

You’ll want to know: かみなり

かみなり — *kaminari* — “thunder”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *kaminari*
- *Say it:* *kaminari*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kaminari*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for the setting sun, then the Japanese for a rainbow, then say *kaminari* again

Before you move on

What does かみなり mean? (“Thunder”.) Say it once more.

69.3 しも (shimo) — frost

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a rainbow, then the Japanese for thunder.

You'll want to know: しも

しも — *shimo* — “frost”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: shimo*
- *Say it: shimo*, once more
- *Say it: say shimo*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for a rainbow, then the Japanese for thunder, then say *shimo* again

Before you move on

What does しも mean? (“Frost”.) Say it once more.

69.4 こおり (*koori*) — ice

Before the new one: say the Japanese for thunder, then the Japanese for frost.

You'll want to know: こおり

こおり — *koori* — “ice”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: koori*
- *Say it: koori*, once more
- *Say it: say koori*

- *Recall:* say the Japanese for thunder, then the Japanese for frost, then say *koori* again

Before you move on

What does こおり mean? (“Ice”.) Say it once more.

69.5 なつやすみ (natsuyasumi) — the summer holidays

Before the new one: say the Japanese for frost, then the Japanese for ice.

You’ll want to know: なつやすみ

なつやすみ — *natsuyasumi* — “the summer holidays”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *natsuyasumi*
- *Say it:* *natsuyasumi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *natsuyasumi*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for frost, then the Japanese for ice, then say *natsuyasumi* again

Before you move on

What does なつやすみ mean? (“The summer holidays”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 70

Rice cake, Natto, Fish-paste tube, Chick, Wing

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a rice cake, natto, fermented soybeans, a fish-paste tube, a chick and a wing.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 70: i can say a rice cake, natto, fermented soybeans, a fish-paste tube, a chick and a wing.

70.1 もち (mochi) — a rice cake

Before the new one: say the Japanese for ice, then the Japanese for the summer holidays.

You'll want to know: もち

もち — *mochi* — “a rice cake”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *mochi*
- Say it: *mochi*, once more

- *Say it:* say *mochi*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for ice, then the Japanese for the summer holidays, then say *mochi* again

Before you move on

What does もち mean? (“A rice cake”.) Say it once more.

70.2 なっとう (nattou) — natto, fermented soybeans

Before the new one: say the Japanese for the summer holidays, then the Japanese for a rice cake.

You’ll want to know: なっとう

なっとう — *nattou* — “natto, fermented soybeans”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *nattou*
- *Say it:* *nattou*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nattou*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for the summer holidays, then the Japanese for a rice cake, then say *nattou* again

Before you move on

What does なっとう mean? (“Natto, fermented soybeans”.) Say it once more.

70.3 ちくわ (chikuwa) — a fish-paste tube

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a rice cake, then the Japanese for natto.

You'll want to know: ちくわ

ちくわ — *chikuwa* — “a fish-paste tube”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: chikuwa*
- *Say it: chikuwa*, once more
- *Say it: say chikuwa*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for a rice cake, then the Japanese for natto, then say *chikuwa* again

Before you move on

What does ちくわ mean? (“A fish-paste tube”.) Say it once more.

70.4 ひよこ (hiyoko) — a chick

Before the new one: say the Japanese for natto, then the Japanese for a fish-paste tube.

You'll want to know: ひよこ

ひよこ — *hiyoko* — “a chick”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: hiyoko*
- *Say it: hiyoko*, once more
- *Say it: say hiyoko*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for natto, then the Japanese for a fish-paste tube, then say *hiyoko* again

Before you move on

What does ひよこ mean? (“A chick”.) Say it once more.

70.5 はね (hane) — a wing; a feather

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a fish-paste tube, then the Japanese for a chick.

You’ll want to know: はね

はね — *hane* — “a wing; a feather”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: hane*
- *Say it: hane*, once more
- *Say it: say hane*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for a fish-paste tube, then the Japanese for a chick, then say *hane* again

Before you move on

What does はね mean? (“A wing; a feather”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 71

Horn, Hole, Rice plant, Nephew, Niece

Modes: 🗣️ voice (7) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 7 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a horn, a hole, a rice plant, a nephew and a niece.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 71: i can say a horn, a hole, a rice plant, a nephew and a niece.

71.1 つの (tsuno) — a horn

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a chick, then the Japanese for a wing; a feather.

You'll want to know: つの

つの — *tsuno* — “a horn”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- Say it: *tsuno*
- Say it: *tsuno*, once more

- *Say it:* say *tsuno*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for a chick, then the Japanese for a wing; a feather, then say *tsuno* again

Before you move on

What does つの mean? (“A horn”.) Say it once more.

71.2 あな (ana) — a hole

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a wing; a feather, then the Japanese for a horn.

You’ll want to know: あな

あな — *ana* — “a hole”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ana*
- *Say it:* *ana*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ana*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for a wing; a feather, then the Japanese for a horn, then say *ana* again

Before you move on

What does あな mean? (“A hole”.) Say it once more.

71.3 いね (ine) — a rice plant

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a horn, then the Japanese for a hole.

You'll want to know: いね

いね — *ine* — “a rice plant”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ine*
- *Say it: ine*, once more
- *Say it: say ine*
- *Recall:* say the Japanese for a horn, then the Japanese for a hole, then say *ine* again

Before you move on

What does いね mean? (“A rice plant”.) Say it once more.

71.4 おい (oi) — a nephew

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a hole, then the Japanese for a rice plant.

You'll want to know: おい

おい — *oi* — “a nephew”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: oi*
- *Say it: oi*, once more
- *Say it: say oi*

- *Recall*: say the Japanese for a hole, then the Japanese for a rice plant, then say *oi* again

Before you move on

What does おい mean? (“A nephew”.) Say it once more.

71.5 めい (mei) — a niece

Before the new one: say the Japanese for a rice plant, then the Japanese for a nephew.

You’ll want to know: めい

めい — *mei* — “a niece”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it*: *mei*
- *Say it*: *mei*, once more
- *Say it*: say *mei*
- *Recall*: say the Japanese for a rice plant, then the Japanese for a nephew, then say *mei* again

Before you move on

What does めい mean? (“A niece”.) Say it once more.

71.6 Describing words and time — a first pass

Say the words for a nephew and a niece.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a minute, summer, winter, always, still
- after, before; in front, above, inside, left
- near, far, a town, a road, a shop
- underground, a park, a country, clothes, shoes
- a hat, socks, glasses, thirty, a thousand
- ten thousand, twelve, an aubergine, a song, a branch
- a thread, a needle, a comb, a string, a rope
- luggage, a ship, a sound, a colour, a shape

Before you move on

A minute? (*fun.*) Summer? (*natsu.*) Winter? (*fuyu.*) Always? (*itsumo.*) Still? (*mada.*) After? (*ato.*) Before; in front? (*mae.*) Above? (*ue.*) Inside? (*naka.*) Left? (*hidari.*) Near? (*chikai.*) Far? (*tooi.*) A town? (*machi.*) A road? (*michi.*) A shop? (*mise.*) Underground? (*chika.*) A park? (*kouen.*) A country? (*kuni.*) Clothes? (*fuku.*) Shoes? (*kutsu.*) A hat? (*boushi.*) Socks? (*kutsushita.*) Glasses? (*megane.*) Thirty? (*sanjuu.*) A thousand? (*sen.*) Ten thousand? (*man.*) Twelve? (*juuni.*) An aubergine? (*nasu.*) A song? (*uta.*) A branch? (*eda.*) A thread? (*ito.*) A needle? (*hari.*) A comb? (*kushi.*) A string? (*himo.*) A rope? (*tsuna.*) Luggage? (*nimotsu.*) A ship? (*fune.*) A sound? (*oto.*) A colour? (*iro.*) A shape? (*katashi.*)

71.7 Places, clothes and more — a second pass

Say the words for a dream and a festival.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a dream, a festival, west, east, south
- powder, sesame, a sea urchin, a sardine, a flavour
- a carp, a cicada, a dragonfly, a potato, burdock root
- a basket, a spinning top, a raft, a flute, a drum
- a hand fan, a folding fan, charcoal; a corner, a well, a beach
- a hill, a valley, the countryside, a harbour, the setting sun
- a rainbow, thunder, frost, ice, the summer holidays
- a rice cake, natto, a fish-paste tube, a chick, a wing; a feather
- a horn, a hole, a rice plant, a nephew, a niece

Before you move on

A dream? (*yume.*) A festival? (*matsuri.*) West? (*nishi.*) East? (*higashi.*) South? (*minami.*) Powder? (*kona.*) Sesame? (*goma.*) A sea urchin? (*uni.*) A sardine? (*iwashi.*) A flavour? (*aji.*) A carp? (*koi.*) A cicada? (*semi.*) A dragonfly? (*tonbo.*) A potato? (*imo.*) Burdock root? (*gobou.*) A basket? (*kago.*) A spinning top? (*koma.*) A raft? (*ikada.*) A flute? (*fue.*) A drum? (*taiko.*) A hand fan? (*uchiwa.*) A folding fan? (*sensu.*) Charcoal; a corner? (*sumi.*) A well? (*ido.*) A beach? (*hama.*) A hill? (*oka.*) A valley? (*tani.*) The countryside? (*inaka.*) A harbour? (*minato.*) The setting sun? (*yuuhi.*) A rainbow? (*niji.*) Thunder? (*kaminari.*) Frost? (*shimo.*) Ice? (*koori.*) The summer holidays? (*natsuyasumi.*) A rice cake? (*mochi.*) Natto? (*nattou.*) A fish-paste tube? (*chikuwa.*) A chick? (*hiyoko.*) A wing; a feather? (*hane.*) A horn? (*tsuno.*) A hole? (*ana.*) A rice plant? (*ine.*) A nephew? (*oi.*) A niece? (*mei.*)

Pronunciation & Writing

Reference

A **reference**, not a chapter. Look a sound up when a lesson names it; do not read this page first. Japanese script is taught inside words the learner can already use, one sign at a time.

Romanization on this track is Hepburn with macrons (*arigatō*, *kōhī*). It is temporary scaffolding. Where a lesson is teaching beat count, it also spells the word out mora by mora (*a-ri-ga-to-o*), because a macron hides exactly the thing being taught.

The writing system in four facts

1. **There are three systems, and they run together.** An ordinary sentence uses all three at once: **hiragana** for grammar, **kanji** for content words, **katakana** for borrowings. None of them is a stage the others replace.
2. **Hiragana and katakana are moraic twins.** One sign is one beat, normally a consonant plus a vowel already fused. The two sets cover the same beats with different shapes; katakana marks a word as coming from outside.
3. **Kanji carry meaning, not a fixed sound.** 日 is read *nichi*, *jitsu*, *hi*, *bi*, or *ka*. A lesson therefore teaches the reading a **word** uses, never “the sound of the character.”
4. **Beats are counted, not stressed.** Every mora is the same length, and length is contrastive: いえ (2 beats) is a house, いいえ (3) is “no.”

Japanese has no case, no grammatical gender, no articles, and no plural agreement — so several standing methods in this curriculum simply do not

apply here. It does have an obligatory politeness level on every predicate, which nothing else in the corpus has.

Sound ids used by the Chapter 1 lessons

- **mora** — give every written sign one equal beat; do not stress one over another. First anchor: はい *hai*.
- **pure-vowels** — five vowels, held steady, no English glide: *a, i, u, e, o*. First anchor: はい *hai*.
- **mora-length** — a long vowel is a second beat, and it changes meaning. First anchor: いいえ *ie* against いえ *ie*.
- **moraic-n** — ん is a consonant that owns a whole beat of its own. First anchor: こんにちは *konnichiwa*.
- **particle-wa** — the sign は is read *wa* when it is working as the topic particle. First anchor: こんにちは.
- **chouon** — the katakana bar — adds one more beat of the vowel before it. First anchor: コーヒー *kōhī*.
- **dakuten** — two short strokes voice a kana: *ka→ga, sa→za, ta→da, ha→ba*. First anchor: ありがとう *arigatō*.
- **long-o** — in hiragana a long *o* is normally written with う, not a bar. First anchor: ありがとう *arigatō*.

Two things this page deliberately does not do

It does not print the kana chart. A learner who wants the full grid will find it anywhere; a learner who is told to memorise it before Lesson 1 usually stops there, which is the wall HL00 exists to remove.

It does not claim a stroke count as a prerequisite. Stroke order for kana and kanji is real and taught, and it lives in Japanese script reference beside each sign, to be consulted when a hand is free.

Sources

- Wiktionary: はい, 今日は, 有難う, and コーヒー.

Glossary

This glossary collects every word and phrase taught in the book. Pronunciation appears when it differs from the written form; chapter numbers show where each entry is introduced.

ほん *-hon*

the counter for long thin things — and a kanji you have been writing since
chapter five
Introduced in Chapter 18.

にん *-nin*

the counter for people — and the first place the tsu rule stops working
Introduced in Chapter 18.

...つ *-tsu*

the counter you already own — what the tsu was doing all along
Introduced in Chapter 18.

あご *ago*

the chin
Introduced in Chapter 21.

あじ *aji*

a flavour, a taste
Introduced in Chapter 64.

あかい *akai*

red
Introduced in Chapter 51.

あまい *amai*

sweet
Introduced in Chapter 50.

あめ *ame*

rain; candy
Introduced in Chapter 44.

あな *ana*

a hole
Introduced in Chapter 71.

あね *ane*

my elder sister

Introduced in Chapter 13.

あに *ani*

my elder brother

Introduced in Chapter 13.

あおい *aoi*

blue

Introduced in Chapter 51.

あり *ari*

an ant

Introduced in Chapter 46.

ありがとう *arigatō*

thank you (plain)

Introduced in Chapter 3.

ありがとうございます *arigatō gozaimasu*

thank you (polite)

Introduced in Chapter 4.

あさ *asa*

morning

Introduced in Chapter 53.

あさごはん *asagohan*

breakfast

Introduced in Chapter 35.

あせ *ase*

sweat

Introduced in Chapter 22.

あし *ashi*

foot; leg

Introduced in Chapter 11.

あした *ashita*

tomorrow

Introduced in Chapter 54.

あたま *atama*

head

Introduced in Chapter 12.

あたたかい *atatakai*

warm

Introduced in Chapter 52.

あと *ato*

after, later

Introduced in Chapter 56.

あつい *atsui*

hot

Introduced in Chapter 53.

あう *au*

to meet

Introduced in Chapter 27.

ぼうし *boushi*

a hat

Introduced in Chapter 59.

ちち *chichi*

my father

Introduced in Chapter 13.

ちいさい *chiisai*

small

Introduced in Chapter 48.

ちか *chika*

underground

Introduced in Chapter 58.

ちかい *chikai*

near

Introduced in Chapter 57.

ちくわ *chikuwa*

a fish-paste tube

Introduced in Chapter 70.

だいどころ *daidokoro*

a kitchen

Introduced in Chapter 38.

だいこん *daikon*

a white radish

Introduced in Chapter 34.

だす *dasu*

to take out

Introduced in Chapter 31.

えだ *eda*

a branch

Introduced in Chapter 60.

ふえ *fue*

a flute

Introduced in Chapter 66.

ふく *fuku*

clothes

Introduced in Chapter 58.

ふん *fun*

a minute

Introduced in Chapter 55.

ふね *fune*

a ship

Introduced in Chapter 62.

ふたつ *futatsu*

two things — and the beat that ties this count to a word you already say

Introduced in Chapter 16.

ふとい *futoi*

thick

Introduced in Chapter 52.

ふとん *futon*

a futon

Introduced in Chapter 38.

ふゆ *fuyu*

winter

Introduced in Chapter 55.

がっこう *gakkou*

a school

Introduced in Chapter 40.

ご *go*

five — the second job of a kanji you have been writing since chapter five

Introduced in Chapter 14.

ごぼう *gobou*

burdock root

Introduced in Chapter 65.

ごはん *gohan*

rice; a meal

Introduced in Chapter 31.

ごま *goma*

sesame

Introduced in Chapter 64.

は *ha*

tooth; teeth

Introduced in Chapter 12.

はち *hachi*

eight — one reading, no native word beside it, and the plain case the pattern needed

Introduced in Chapter 15.

はだ *hada*

skin

Introduced in Chapter 21.

はは *haha*

my mother

Introduced in Chapter 13.

はい *hai*

yes

Introduced in Chapter 1.

はこ *hako*

a box

Introduced in Chapter 39.

はま *hama*

a beach

Introduced in Chapter 67.

はな *hana*

nose

Introduced in Chapter 11.

はなす *hanasu*

to speak

Introduced in Chapter 27.

はね *hane*

a wing; a feather

Introduced in Chapter 70.

はり *hari*

a needle

Introduced in Chapter 61.

はし *hashi*

chopsticks

Introduced in Chapter 38.

はと *hato*

a pigeon

Introduced in Chapter 46.

はやい *hayai*

fast; early

Introduced in Chapter 49.

ひだり *hidari*

left

Introduced in Chapter 56.

ひがし *higashi*

east

Introduced in Chapter 63.

ひじ *hiji*

an elbow

Introduced in Chapter 20.

ひく *hiku*

to pull

Introduced in Chapter 30.

ひくい *hikui*

low

Introduced in Chapter 49.

ひも *himo*

a string

Introduced in Chapter 61.

ひろい *hiroi*

wide

Introduced in Chapter 50.

ひとり ふたり *hitori futari*

one person, two people — the native count reaching into a borrowed counter

Introduced in Chapter 18.

ひとつ *hitotsu*

one thing — the first word of the count Japanese kept when it borrowed another
one

Introduced in Chapter 16.

ひつじ *hitsuji*

a sheep

Introduced in Chapter 46.

ひよこ *hiyoko*

a chick

Introduced in Chapter 70.

ひざ *hiza*

a knee

Introduced in Chapter 20.

ほね *hone*

a bone

Introduced in Chapter 21.

ほお *hoo*

a cheek

Introduced in Chapter 21.

ほし *hoshi*

a star

Introduced in Chapter 43.

いち *ichi*

one — the number you have been saying since chapter nine, standing on its own at last

Introduced in Chapter 14.

いちど *ichido*

one time; once

Introduced in Chapter 9.

いちご *ichigo*

a strawberry

Introduced in Chapter 33.

いど *ido*

a well

Introduced in Chapter 67.

いい *ii*

good

Introduced in Chapter 48.

いいえ *ie*

no; not at all

Introduced in Chapter 1.

いか *ika*

a squid

Introduced in Chapter 47.

いかだ *ikada*

a raft

Introduced in Chapter 66.

いく *iku*

to go

Introduced in Chapter 26.

いま *ima*

now

Introduced in Chapter 54.

いも *imo*

a potato

Introduced in Chapter 65.

いもうと *imooto*

my younger sister

Introduced in Chapter 13.

いなか *inaka*

the countryside

Introduced in Chapter 68.

いね *ine*

a rice plant

Introduced in Chapter 71.

いっぽん *ippon*

one long thin thing — and the four numbers that bend the counter furthest

Introduced in Chapter 18.

いろ *iro*

a colour

Introduced in Chapter 62.

いし *ishi*

a stone

Introduced in Chapter 42.

いす *isu*

a chair

Introduced in Chapter 37.

いたい *itai*

painful, it hurts

Introduced in Chapter 22.

いたみ *itami*

pain

Introduced in Chapter 24.

いと *ito*

a thread

Introduced in Chapter 61.

いつも *itsumo*

always

Introduced in Chapter 55.

いつつ *itsutsu*

five things — three signs, two of them the same, and none of them new

Introduced in Chapter 16.

いってください *itte kudasai*

please say it

Introduced in Chapter 10.

いう *iu*

to say

Introduced in Chapter 28.

いわし *iwashi*

a sardine

Introduced in Chapter 64.

じかん *jikan*

time; an hour

Introduced in Chapter 41.

じゅう *jū*

ten — the last number of the run, and the one that turns nine words into ninety-nine

Introduced in Chapter 15.

じゅうに *juuni*

twelve

Introduced in Chapter 60.

かえす *kaesu*

to give back

Introduced in Chapter 30.

かがみ *kagami*

a mirror

Introduced in Chapter 38.

かご *kago*

a basket

Introduced in Chapter 66.

かく *kaku*

to write

Introduced in Chapter 27.

かめ *kame*

a turtle

Introduced in Chapter 47.

かみ *kami*

hair

Introduced in Chapter 12.

かみなり *kaminari*

thunder

Introduced in Chapter 69.

かなしい *kanashii*

sad

Introduced in Chapter 23.

かに *kani*

a crab

Introduced in Chapter 47.

かお *kao*

face

Introduced in Chapter 11.

かさ *kasa*

an umbrella

Introduced in Chapter 40.

かす *kasu*

to lend

Introduced in Chapter 30.

かた *kata*

shoulder

Introduced in Chapter 12.

かたち *katachi*

a shape

Introduced in Chapter 62.

かう *kau*

to buy

Introduced in Chapter 26.

かわ *kawa*

a river

Introduced in Chapter 42.

こども *kodomo*

child

Introduced in Chapter 13.

こえ *koe*

a voice

Introduced in Chapter 22.

コーヒー *kōhī*

coffee

Introduced in Chapter 6.

こい *koi*

a carp

Introduced in Chapter 65.

ここ *koko*

here; this place

Introduced in Chapter 10.

ここのつ *kokonotsu*

nine things — four beats, and the first two sound like a word you already have

Introduced in Chapter 17.

こま *koma*

a spinning top

Introduced in Chapter 66.

こめ *kome*

uncooked rice

Introduced in Chapter 36.

こな *kona*

powder, flour

Introduced in Chapter 64.

こんにちは *konnichiwa*

hello (daytime greeting)

Introduced in Chapter 2.

こおり *koori*

ice

Introduced in Chapter 69.

こし *koshi*

waist; lower back

Introduced in Chapter 12.

こたえ *kotae*

an answer

Introduced in Chapter 40.

こうえん *kouen*

a park

Introduced in Chapter 58.

こわい *kowai*

scary

Introduced in Chapter 23.

く *ku*

nine — a second reading that is not the native one, which is the exception the pattern needed

Introduced in Chapter 15.

くち *kuchi*

mouth

Introduced in Chapter 11.

くだもの *kudamono*

fruit

Introduced in Chapter 32.

くま *kuma*

a bear

Introduced in Chapter 45.

くも *kumo*

a cloud; a spider

Introduced in Chapter 43.

くに *kuni*

a country

Introduced in Chapter 58.

くり *kuri*

a chestnut

Introduced in Chapter 36.

くろい *kuroi*

black

Introduced in Chapter 52.

くさ *kusa*

grass

Introduced in Chapter 42.

くし *kushi*

a comb

Introduced in Chapter 61.

くすり *kusuri*

medicine

Introduced in Chapter 23.

くつ *kutsu*

shoes

Introduced in Chapter 58.

くつした *kutsushita*

socks

Introduced in Chapter 59.

まち *machi*

a town

Introduced in Chapter 57.

まだ *mada*

still, not yet

Introduced in Chapter 55.

まど *mado*

a window

Introduced in Chapter 37.

まえ *mae*

before; in front

Introduced in Chapter 56.

まいにち *mainichi*

every day

Introduced in Chapter 54.

まめ *mame*

beans

Introduced in Chapter 36.

まん *man*

ten thousand

Introduced in Chapter 60.

まつ *matsu*

to wait

Introduced in Chapter 27.

まつり *matsuri*

a festival

Introduced in Chapter 63.

まゆ *mayu*

an eyebrow

Introduced in Chapter 21.

め *me*

eye; eyes

Introduced in Chapter 11.

めがね *megane*

glasses

Introduced in Chapter 59.

めい *mei*

a niece

Introduced in Chapter 71.

みち *michi*

a road

Introduced in Chapter 57.

みどり *midori*

green

Introduced in Chapter 52.

みじかい *mijikai*

short

Introduced in Chapter 48.

みかん *mikan*

a mandarin orange

Introduced in Chapter 33.

みみ *mimi*

ear; ears

Introduced in Chapter 11.

みなみ *minami*

south

Introduced in Chapter 63.

みなと *minato*

a harbour

Introduced in Chapter 68.

みせ *mise*

a shop

Introduced in Chapter 57.

みつつ *mittsu*

three things — the first word in the chapter that costs nothing at all

Introduced in Chapter 16.

もう *mō*

again; one more, in a request
Introduced in Chapter 9.

もういちど、おねがいします *mō ichido, onegai shimasu*

one more time, please
Introduced in Chapter 9.

もうすこし *mō sukoshi*

a little more
Introduced in Chapter 10.

もうすこし、ゆっくりいってください *mō sukoshi, yukkuri itte kudasai*

please say it a little more slowly
Introduced in Chapter 10.

もち *mochi*

a rice cake
Introduced in Chapter 70.

もも *momo*

a peach
Introduced in Chapter 33.

もんだい *mondai*

a problem, a question
Introduced in Chapter 40.

もり *mori*

a forest
Introduced in Chapter 42.

もつ *motsu*

to hold
Introduced in Chapter 28.

むね *mune*

the chest
Introduced in Chapter 20.

むし *mushi*

an insect
Introduced in Chapter 46.

むすこ *musuko*

a son
Introduced in Chapter 24.

むすめ *musume*

a daughter
Introduced in Chapter 24.

むつつ *muttsu*

six things — and the second count's six, unlike the first one's, is native
Introduced in Chapter 17.

ながい *nagai*

long

Introduced in Chapter 48.

なか *naka*

inside

Introduced in Chapter 56.

なかま *nakama*

a companion

Introduced in Chapter 26.

なく *naku*

to cry

Introduced in Chapter 29.

なまえ *namae*

a name

Introduced in Chapter 41.

なみ *nami*

a wave

Introduced in Chapter 44.

なみだ *namida*

tears

Introduced in Chapter 22.

なな *nana*

seven — the second place the native word stands inside the borrowed count,
which is what makes it a pattern

Introduced in Chapter 15.

ななつ *nanatsu*

seven things — the one word in this chapter the borrowed count already gave you

Introduced in Chapter 17.

なおす *naosu*

to fix

Introduced in Chapter 31.

なし *nashi*

a pear

Introduced in Chapter 33.

なす *nasu*

an aubergine

Introduced in Chapter 60.

なつ *natsu*

summer

Introduced in Chapter 55.

なつやすみ *natsuyasumi*

the summer holidays

Introduced in Chapter 69.

なっとう *nattou*

natto, fermented soybeans

Introduced in Chapter 70.

ねこ *neko*

a cat

Introduced in Chapter 45.

ねむい *nemui*

sleepy

Introduced in Chapter 23.

ねつ *netsu*

a fever

Introduced in Chapter 22.

に *ni*

two — one mora, one sign, and the sign has been yours since chapter two

Introduced in Chapter 14.

にがい *nigai*

bitter

Introduced in Chapter 50.

日本語 *nihongo*

the Japanese language

Introduced in Chapter 5.

にじ *niji*

a rainbow

Introduced in Chapter 69.

にく *niku*

meat

Introduced in Chapter 32.

にもつ *nimotsu*

luggage

Introduced in Chapter 62.

にんじん *ninjin*

a carrot

Introduced in Chapter 34.

にし *nishi*

west

Introduced in Chapter 63.

にわ *niwa*

a garden

Introduced in Chapter 39.

にわとり *niwatori*

a chicken

Introduced in Chapter 48.

のど *nodo*

the throat

Introduced in Chapter 20.

のむ *nomu*

to drink

Introduced in Chapter 26.

のり *nori*

seaweed

Introduced in Chapter 36.

おふろ *ofuro*

a bath

Introduced in Chapter 39.

おい *oi*

a nephew

Introduced in Chapter 71.

おいしい *oishii*

tasty

Introduced in Chapter 53.

おじいさん *ojiisan*

a grandfather

Introduced in Chapter 24.

おじさん *ojisan*

an uncle

Introduced in Chapter 24.

おか *oka*

a hill

Introduced in Chapter 68.

おかね *okane*

money

Introduced in Chapter 41.

おかし *okashi*

sweets, snacks

Introduced in Chapter 35.

おもい *omoi*

heavy

Introduced in Chapter 50.

おもう *omou*

to think

Introduced in Chapter 28.

おなか *onaka*

belly; stomach area

Introduced in Chapter 12.

おねがいします *onegai shimasu*

please; I request it

Introduced in Chapter 9.

おんな *onna*

a woman

Introduced in Chapter 25.

おおかみ *ookami*

a wolf

Introduced in Chapter 47.

おす *osu*

to push

Introduced in Chapter 30.

おと *oto*

a sound

Introduced in Chapter 62.

おとこ *otoko*

a man

Introduced in Chapter 25.

おとな *otona*

an adult

Introduced in Chapter 25.

おとうと *otooto*

my younger brother

Introduced in Chapter 13.

おとす *otosu*

to drop

Introduced in Chapter 31.

おっと *otto*

my husband

Introduced in Chapter 13.

りんご *ringo*

an apple

Introduced in Chapter 33.

ろく *roku*

six — the hole the chapter left open, and the reason it was left

Introduced in Chapter 15.

さがす *sagasu*

to look for

Introduced in Chapter 30.

さかな *sakana*

a fish

Introduced in Chapter 32.

さむい *samui*

cold (weather)

Introduced in Chapter 53.

さん *san*

three — and the moraic ん you have been closing words with since こんにちは

Introduced in Chapter 14.

さんじゅう *sanjuu*

thirty

Introduced in Chapter 59.

さとう *satou*

sugar

Introduced in Chapter 35.

せまい *semai*

narrow

Introduced in Chapter 50.

せみ *semi*

a cicada

Introduced in Chapter 65.

せん *sen*

a thousand

Introduced in Chapter 59.

せなか *senaka*

back

Introduced in Chapter 12.

せんせい *sensei*

a teacher

Introduced in Chapter 25.

せんす *sensu*

a folding fan

Introduced in Chapter 67.

しか *shika*

a deer

Introduced in Chapter 46.

しま *shima*

an island

Introduced in Chapter 44.

しも *shimo*

frost

Introduced in Chapter 69.

しお *shio*

salt

Introduced in Chapter 34.

しろい *shiroi*

white

Introduced in Chapter 52.

しゅくだい *shukudai*

homework

Introduced in Chapter 40.

すいか *suika*

a watermelon

Introduced in Chapter 34.

すこし *sukoshi*

a little; a small amount

Introduced in Chapter 10.

すみ *sumi*

charcoal; a corner

Introduced in Chapter 67.

すみません *sumimasen*

excuse me; I am sorry

Introduced in Chapter 9.

すむ *sumu*

to live (somewhere)

Introduced in Chapter 29.

すな *sunā*

sand

Introduced in Chapter 43.

すし *sushi*

sushi

Introduced in Chapter 35.

たいこ *taiko*

a drum

Introduced in Chapter 66.

たいよう *taiyō*

the sun

Introduced in Chapter 43.

たかい *takai*

tall; expensive

Introduced in Chapter 49.

たこ *tako*

an octopus

Introduced in Chapter 47.

たまご *tamago*

an egg

Introduced in Chapter 32.

たな *tana*

a shelf

Introduced in Chapter 39.

たんぼ *tanbo*

a rice field

Introduced in Chapter 43.

たね *tane*

a seed

Introduced in Chapter 44.

たに *tani*

a valley

Introduced in Chapter 68.

たのしい *tanoshii*

fun, enjoyable

Introduced in Chapter 23.

たのしむ *tanoshimu*

to enjoy

Introduced in Chapter 29.

たたみ *tatami*

a tatami mat

Introduced in Chapter 39.

たつ *tatsu*

to stand

Introduced in Chapter 29.

て *te*

hand

Introduced in Chapter 11.

てがみ *tegami*

a letter (post)

Introduced in Chapter 41.

とお *tō*

ten things — the one word in the count that drops the counting piece

Introduced in Chapter 17.

ともだち *tomodachi*

a friend

Introduced in Chapter 25.

となり *tonari*

next door; a neighbour

Introduced in Chapter 26.

とんぼ *tonbo*

a dragonfly

Introduced in Chapter 65.

とおい *tooi*

far

Introduced in Chapter 57.

とり *tori*

a bird

Introduced in Chapter 45.

とし *toshi*

a year; age

Introduced in Chapter 54.

とうふ *toufu*

tofu

Introduced in Chapter 34.

つち *tsuchi*

soil

Introduced in Chapter 44.

つかう *tsukau*

to use

Introduced in Chapter 28.

つくえ *tsukue*

a desk

Introduced in Chapter 37.

つま *suma*

my wife

Introduced in Chapter 13.

つめ *tsume*

a nail (finger or toe)

Introduced in Chapter 20.

つめたい *tsumetai*

cold (to the touch)

Introduced in Chapter 53.

つな *tsuna*

a rope

Introduced in Chapter 61.

つの *tsuno*

a horn

Introduced in Chapter 71.

つよい *tsuyoi*

strong

Introduced in Chapter 51.

うち *uchi*

home

Introduced in Chapter 37.

うちわ *uchiwa*

a hand fan

Introduced in Chapter 67.

うどん *udon*

udon noodles

Introduced in Chapter 35.

うえ *ue*

above, on top

Introduced in Chapter 56.

うごく *ugoku*

to move

Introduced in Chapter 31.

うま *uma*

a horse

Introduced in Chapter 45.

うめ *ume*

a Japanese plum

Introduced in Chapter 36.

うみ *umi*

the sea

Introduced in Chapter 42.

うに *uni*

a sea urchin

Introduced in Chapter 64.

うし *ushi*

a cow

Introduced in Chapter 45.

うた *uta*

a song

Introduced in Chapter 60.

うたう *utau*

to sing

Introduced in Chapter 28.

うつくしい *utsukushii*

beautiful

Introduced in Chapter 51.

わかりません *wakarimasen*

I do not understand

Introduced in Chapter 9.

わかりました *wakarimashita*

I understand; understood

Introduced in Chapter 10.

わに *wani*

a crocodile

Introduced in Chapter 2.

やま *yama*

a mountain

Introduced in Chapter 41.

やね *yane*

a roof

Introduced in Chapter 37.

やさい *yasai*

vegetables

Introduced in Chapter 32.

やさしい *yasashii*

easy; kind

Introduced in Chapter 49.

やすい *yasui*

cheap

Introduced in Chapter 49.

やすむ *yasumu*

to rest

Introduced in Chapter 29.

やつ *yattsu*

eight things — and the last of the count that a borrowed number could be mistaken for

Introduced in Chapter 17.

よく *yoku*

well; fully, as an adverb

Introduced in Chapter 9.

よむ *yomu*

to read

Introduced in Chapter 27.

よん *yon*

four — the first place in the count where a native Japanese word is standing in a borrowed series

Introduced in Chapter 14.

よつつ *yottsu*

four things — and the seam the last chapter promised would come back

Introduced in Chapter 16.

よわい *yowai*

weak

Introduced in Chapter 51.

ゆか *yuka*

the floor

Introduced in Chapter 38.

ゆっくり *yukkuri*

slowly; without rushing

Introduced in Chapter 10.

ゆめ *yume*

a dream

Introduced in Chapter 63.

ゆうがた *yuugata*

evening

Introduced in Chapter 54.

ゆうひ *yuuhi*

the setting sun

Introduced in Chapter 68.

Review Questions

Try these without looking ahead. Every prompt comes from the same canonical lesson data as its chapter. Answers begin in the next section.

Chapter 1

1.1 い — *two strokes, one beat*

How many strokes does the hiragana sign for 'i' have?

1.2 は — *three strokes*

How many strokes does the hiragana sign read 'ha' have?

1.3 *Two signs, side by side — and a word appears*

How many beats does the written sequence はい take?

1.4 え — *two strokes, and a second word for free*

Write the final sign in i-i-e, then count the three visible beats.

1.5 はい — *yes, in two equal beats*

Write the Japanese word for 'yes' in hiragana.

1.6 いいえ — *no, and why the extra beat matters*

How many beats (morae) does いいえ hold?

Chapter 2

2.1 こ — *two strokes, and the greeting begins*

How many strokes does the hiragana sign read 'ko' have?

2.2 ん — *one stroke, one beat, no vowel*

Which vowel does this sign carry?

2.3 に — *three strokes, and a shape you half know*

Two signs so far share a similar left-hand vertical. Does that shared shape tell you anything about their sound or meaning?

2.4 ち — *two strokes, four roman letters, one beat*

This sign is romanised with four letters. How many beats does it take?

2.5 わに (*wani*) — *a crocodile*

Type the Japanese for 'a crocodile', in rōmaji.

2.6 わ — *the sign for wa, and the trap beside it*

The daytime greeting ends in a sound like 'wa'. Is it written with the sign for wa, or the sign for ha?

2.7 *Five signs in a row — and the greeting is readable*

How many beats (morae) does the written daytime greeting take?

2.8 こんにちは — *hello, and a sign that lies about its sound*

The greeting ends in the sign は. How is it pronounced there?

Chapter 3

3.1 あ — *three strokes, and the thank-you begins*

How many strokes does the hiragana sign read 'a' have?

3.2 り — *two strokes, and a tap rather than an r*

Is the Japanese r in 'ri' closer to an English r or to a single tap of the tongue?

3.3 か — *three strokes, and a shape you will reuse*

How many strokes does the hiragana sign read 'ka' have?

3.4 ` — *two ticks, and every sign you know doubles*

What do the two small marks of the dakuten do to a hiragana sign?

3.5 と — *two strokes, and they never meet*

Do the two strokes of the sign read 'to' touch each other?

3.6 う — *two strokes, and a vowel that stretches*

When u follows an o-sound in hiragana, what does it do?

3.7 ありがとう — *no new sign, and a whole word*

Which sign in ありがとう is another sign plus the dakuten, and what is underneath it?

3.8 ありがとう — *thanks, from "this hardly ever happens"*

Which hiragana sign becomes が when the dakuten is added?

Chapter 4

4.1 さ — *two strokes, and the ticks work here too*

What does the sign read 'sa' become when the dakuten is added?

4.2 ま — *three strokes, and a loop you have drawn before*

How many strokes does the hiragana sign read 'ma' have?

4.3 す — *two strokes, and a vowel you barely hear*

At the end of gozaimasu, what happens to the final u?

4.4 ありがとうございます — *politeness you cannot leave out*

You are thanking a shop assistant you have never met. Which form do you use?

4.5 Practice — *the whole thank-you, off the page*

In ありがとうございます, how many signs are an earlier sign plus the dakuten?

Chapter 5

5.1 日 — *one sun, four strokes*

Write the four-stroke kanji read *nichi* in the word for Japanese.

5.2 本 — *a tree with its root marked*

Write the kanji read *hon*. Which stroke marks the root?

5.3 言 — *build the speech side first*

Write the component that will sit on the left of the kanji for language.

5.4 五 — *four strokes for the sound side*

Write the four-stroke component that cues go in the kanji for language.

5.5 口 — *close a box in three strokes*

Write the three-stroke mouth component that sits under 五.

5.6 語 — *assemble; do not memorise fourteen loose strokes*

Build the kanji read *go*, language, from the three blocks you know.

5.7 日本語 — *three characters, and no single sound each*

How is the character 日 read inside 日本語?

Chapter 6

6.1 コ — *same sound, a new script*

Write *ko* in katakana, the script used for the borrowed word coffee.

6.2 ー — *one line, one extra beat*

Add the katakana long-vowel mark to コ so it reads *kō*.

6.3 ヒ — *two strokes complete the inventory*

Write *hi* in katakana, then place it after コー.

6.4 コーヒー — *the third system, and a word that really is a cousin*

What does the bar ー do in コーヒー?

Chapter 7

7.1 Practice — one daytime exchange, three scripts

From sound alone, write nihongo in its three kanji. Then take B's part in the doorway exchange without notes.

Chapter 8

8.1 Hear sayōnara — one way to say goodbye

You hear sa-yō-na-ra at a parting. What social job does it do, and how many morae do you tap?

8.2 よ — the second sound gets a shape

Which mora does よ write?

8.3 な — one sign for na

Read な as one mora.

8.4 ら — the last new shape

After a five-second delay, write the hiragana for ra.

8.5 さようなら — assemble what the hand already knows

From the five heard morae sa | yo | o | na | ra, write the complete word.

8.6 Practice — meet, thank, then part

From sound alone, write the taught farewell, then say it once on five morae for a parting cue.

Chapter 9

9.1 すみません — open the repair gently

What polite Japanese opener tells a speaker that you need to repair the exchange?

9.2 み — one looped bridge

Which sign carries mi?

9.3 め — cross, loop, release

How many strokes does め have?

9.4 よく — how fully?

In the repair line, what does yoku measure?

9.5 く — one angled stroke

Write the one-stroke hiragana sign for ku.

9.6 わかりません — I do not understand

Say politely: I do not understand.

9.7 ど — *voice a sign you already own*

Voice と with the dakuten and write the resulting sign.

9.8 もう — *one more time begins here*

In a repetition request, what does mō mean, and how many morae does it take?

9.9 も — *two bars, then the curve*

In も, what comes first: the long curve or the two short bars?

9.10 いちど — *one time, all known signs*

From the heard morae i | chi | do, write once in hiragana.

9.11 おねがいします — *please, as a polite request*

What polite expression closes the request one more time, please?

9.12 もういちど、おねがいします — *ask for one more pass*

You missed the line. Ask politely for one more time.

Chapter 10

10.1 せ — *close the opener*

Write the hiragana sign for se.

10.2 お — *the respectful opening sign*

Write the first hiragana sign in onegaishimasu.

10.3 ね — *finish the polite request*

Write the hiragana sign for ne.

10.4 すこし — *ask for a small change*

What Japanese word makes the requested change only a little?

10.5 し — *one falling curve*

Write the one-stroke hiragana sign for shi.

10.6 ゆっくり — *slowly, with a held beat*

Say slowly and mark the held beat in yukkuri.

10.7 ゆ — *open yukkuri*

Write the hiragana sign for yu.

10.8 ってください — *please say it*

Ask politely: please say it.

10.9 もうすこし — *a little more*

From sound alone, write a little more in hiragana.

10.10 わかりました — *the repair worked*

The repetition worked. Respond politely: understood.

10.11 ここ — *here, with one known sign twice*

Write here in hiragana using the same known sign twice.

10.12 もうすこし、ゆっくりいってください — *slower, please*

Ask politely for the line a little more slowly.

Chapter 11

11.1 つ — *one small held beat*

Write the small hiragana sign that holds the following consonant.

11.2 て — *close itte*

Write the hiragana sign for te.

11.3 た — *close wakarimashita*

Write the hiragana sign for ta.

11.4 だ — *voice the known base*

Voice た with dakuten. Write the result.

11.5 て — *hand*

Write the Japanese word for hand.

11.6 みみ — *ear*

Write the Japanese word for ear.

11.7 ぐち — *mouth*

Write the Japanese word for mouth.

11.8 あし — *foot or leg*

Write the Japanese word for foot or leg.

11.9 はな — *nose*

Write the Japanese word for nose.

11.10 かお — *face*

Write the Japanese word for face.

11.11 め — *eye*

Write the Japanese word for eye.

11.12 *Seven readable body words*

Write the Japanese words for hand, ear, and mouth, in that order.

Chapter 12

12.1 Retrieval 1 — *mora, politeness, and し*

Write i, shi, the polite thank-you, and the seven-word body map; label each spoken unit a mora.

12.2 あたま — *head*

Write the Japanese word for head.

12.3 かみ — *hair*

Write the Japanese word for hair.

12.4 Retrieval 2 — *old signs, recent request*

Record the retrieval string: e, five, mouth, please say it, hair, eye.

12.5 は — *tooth*

Write the Japanese word for tooth.

12.6 かた — *shoulder*

Write the Japanese word for shoulder.

12.7 Retrieval 3 — *keep the scripts apart*

Write the retrieval string: hiragana ko, long katakana kō, here, shoulder, head.

12.8 おなか — *belly*

Write the Japanese word for the belly or stomach area.

12.9 せなか — *back*

Write the Japanese word for back.

12.10 Retrieval 4 — *leave the body-word topic*

Write the final retrieval string: chi, goodbye, hand-sign te, back, tooth.

12.11 こし — *waist or lower back*

Write the Japanese word for waist or lower back.

12.12 Retrieval 5 — *enter, leave, voice*

Write the greeting, farewell, voiced da, and waist word.

12.13 Retrieval 6 — *greet, repair, point*

Write the greeting, I do not understand well, hand, and belly.

12.14 Retrieval 7 — *from あ to せなか*

Write a, do, again, ear, and back in Japanese.

12.15 Retrieval 8 — *り, も, いちど, ぐち*

Write ri, mo, once, and mouth in Japanese.

12.16 Retrieval 9 — *request, leg, waist*

Write ka, please, the repetition request, leg, and waist.

12.17 Retrieval 10 — *mark, signs, nose*

Write voiced da, se, ne, and nose.

12.18 Retrieval 11 — と, すこし, かお

Write to, a little, and face in Japanese.

12.19 Retrieval 12 — う and め

Write u and eye in Japanese.

12.20 Seven more body words, spaced on purpose

Write head, hair, tooth, shoulder, belly, back, and waist in Japanese.

Chapter 13

13.1 つ — *one full-size curve*

Write the full-size hiragana sign for tsu.

13.2 Full つ, small つ

Write full tsu, then small tsu.

13.3 ちち — *my father*

Write the Japanese family word for my father.

13.4 はは — *my mother*

Write the Japanese family word for my mother.

13.5 あに — *my elder brother*

Write the Japanese family word for my elder brother.

13.6 あね — *my elder sister*

Write the Japanese family word for my elder sister.

13.7 おとうと — *my younger brother*

Write the Japanese family word for my younger brother.

13.8 いもうと — *my younger sister*

Write the Japanese family word for my younger sister.

13.9 おっと — *my husband*

Write the Japanese family word for my husband.

13.10 つま — *my wife*

Write the Japanese family word for my wife.

13.11 こども — *child*

Write the Japanese family word for child.

13.12 Family retrieval A

Write younger brother, then child, in Japanese.

13.13 Family retrieval B

Write younger sister, my father, and my mother, in that order.

13.14 Family retrieval C

Write my husband, my elder brother, and my elder sister, in that order.

13.15 *Family retrieval D*

Write my wife, then my husband, in Japanese.

13.16 *Nine family words — reception check*

Without a transcript, hear chichi, ane, imoto, tsuma, and kodomo. Type their meanings in order.

13.17 *Nine family words — reception check*

Read あね・おとうと・つま・ちち・いもうと. Type their meanings in order.

13.18 *Nine family words — production check*

From meaning cues only, say my mother, my elder brother, my younger brother, my husband, and child. Then type the Japanese forms you said.

13.19 *Nine family words — production check*

From meaning cues only, write all nine family words in the learned order.

Chapter 14

14.1 いち — *one, taken out of a word you already say*

Which part of ichido is the number, and what number is it?

14.2 ご — *five, and the sign that was holding it*

Which kanji have you been able to write since chapter five, and what number is it?

14.3 に — *two, one mora long*

Write one, two and five in hiragana, in that order.

14.4 さん — *three, on two old signs*

How many beats does san have, and what is the second one?

14.5 よん — *four, and where the two systems meet*

Of shi and yon, which one is the reading Japanese borrowed with the sign, and which is the native word?

14.6 *One to five, in order at last*

Write one to five in hiragana, in order.

14.7 *One to five, in order at last*

Two of these five were already yours before the chapter began. Which two, and where had you met each?

Chapter 15

15.1 なな — *seven, and the pattern from four holding*

Which two numbers so far have a native word standing beside a borrowed reading?

15.2 はち — *eight, with nothing standing beside it*

Does eight have a native word beside its borrowed reading in the everyday count?

15.3 < — *nine, and the exception to the seam*

Nine has two everyday readings. Is either of them the native word?

15.4 ろ — *one turn, and the r you already make*

Write the hiragana sign for the mora ro.

15.5 ろく — *six, and the hole closes*

The sign < does two jobs in this count. Name both.

15.6 っ — *a small sign that joins forward*

How many beats is じっ, and how many is っ?

15.7 じゅう — *ten, and what ten does*

Say what nijuu means and what juuni means, and say why they are different.

15.8 One to ten, and what the run cost

Write six to ten in hiragana, in order.

15.9 One to ten, and what the run cost

Say thirteen and say thirty, and say which part of each does the work.

Chapter 16

16.1 ひ — *one stroke, and a second count begins*

Write the hiragana sign for the mora hi.

16.2 ひとつ — *one thing*

You are pointing at one apple. Do you say ichi or hitotsu?

16.3 ふ — *four strokes, and a counter you already own*

Write the hiragana sign for the mora fu, and say how many strokes it takes.

16.4 ふたつ — *two things*

Say one thing and two things, and name the piece both words share.

16.5 みっつ — *three things, for nothing*

Write three things in hiragana, and say what the small sign in the middle does.

16.6 よっつ — *four things, and the seam opens*

Which word in the borrowed count is really a native word, and which word in this chapter shows where it came from?

16.7 いつつ — *five things*

Which borrowed number means the same as itsutsu?

16.8 Five things, and five numbers

Count things from one to five in the native series.

16.9 *Five things, and five numbers*

Say the two counts side by side to five, then name the ONE place where the same word appears in both.

Chapter 17

17.1 む — *three strokes, one of them a dot*

Write the hiragana sign for the mora mu, and say which stroke is easiest to forget.

17.2 むつつ — *six things*

Give both words for six, and say which one you would use pointing at six apples.

17.3 ななつ — *seven things, and the seam again*

Name the two numbers where a native word is used inside the borrowed count.

17.4 や — *the long stroke goes first*

Write the hiragana sign for the mora ya, and name the stroke that comes first.

17.5 やつつ — *eight things*

Give both words for eight and say whether either one is used inside the other count.

17.6 の — *one stroke, and the last sign of the chapter*

Write the hiragana sign for the mora no, and say how many strokes it takes.

17.7 ここのつ — *nine things*

kokonotsu begins with the same two signs as koko, here. What is the relationship between the two words?

17.8 とお — *ten things, and the end of the run*

Which word in the native count has no tsu on it, and what does that tell you?

17.9 *The other ten, in order at last*

Count things from one to ten in the native series, without stopping.

17.10 *The other ten, in order at last*

Name the two numbers where the same native word is used in BOTH counts, and give both of its forms.

Chapter 18

18.1 *What the つ was doing*

Name the two counters you already owned before this lesson, and say what each one counts.

18.2 にん — *counting people*

Can you count people with the tsu series? Say why or why not, and give three people in Japanese.

18.3 ひとり・ふたり — *one person, two people*

Count people from one to four.

18.4 *Counting your own face*

Count the four parts of a face in Japanese: eyes, ears, nose, mouth.

18.5 *Counting your own face*

Now count two people, and say why the word is not futatsu.

18.6 ほ — は *with one more bar*

Write ho, and say what makes it different from ha.

18.7 ほん — *counting long thin things*

Say two long thin things and four long thin things in Japanese.

18.8 ° — *the other mark*

Write ho, then the same sign with each of the two marks, and say all three.

18.9 いっぱん — *and the four that bend*

Which numbers push the counter to p, and what do they all have in common?

18.10 *Three counters, and how to choose*

Say ONE of each: one thing, one person, one long thin thing.

18.11 *Three counters, and how to choose*

Count these four: two eyes, two legs, two people, two hairs.

Chapter 19

19.1 *(reading) — six words, nothing said first*

Which of the six is one sign long and means eye?

19.2 *(reading) — the doorway words, on the page*

Which line thanks somebody?

19.3 *(reading) — the cues you have only ever heard*

Which line says you did NOT understand?

Chapter 20

20.1 つめ (*tsume*) — *a nail (finger or toe)*

Type the Japanese for 'a nail (finger or toe)'.

20.2 ひじ (*hiji*) — *an elbow*

Type the Japanese for 'an elbow'.

20.3 ひざ (*hiza*) — *a knee*

Type the Japanese for 'a knee'.

20.4 のど (*nodo*) — *the throat*
Type the Japanese for 'the throat'.

20.5 むね (*mune*) — *the chest*
Type the Japanese for 'the chest'.

Chapter 21

21.1 ほね (*hone*) — *a bone*
Type the Japanese for 'a bone'.

21.2 あご (*ago*) — *the chin*
Type the Japanese for 'the chin'.

21.3 ほお (*hoo*) — *a cheek*
Type the Japanese for 'a cheek'.

21.4 まゆ (*mayu*) — *an eyebrow*
Type the Japanese for 'an eyebrow'.

21.5 はだ (*hada*) — *skin*
Type the Japanese for 'skin'.

Chapter 22

22.1 あせ (*ase*) — *sweat*
Type the Japanese for 'sweat'.

22.2 なみだ (*namida*) — *tears*
Type the Japanese for 'tears'.

22.3 こえ (*koe*) — *a voice*
Type the Japanese for 'a voice'.

22.4 ねつ (*netsu*) — *a fever*
Type the Japanese for 'a fever'.

22.5 いたい (*itai*) — *painful, it hurts*
Type the Japanese for 'painful, it hurts'.

Chapter 23

23.1 くすり (*kusuri*) — *medicine*

Type the Japanese for 'medicine'.

23.2 ねむい (*nemui*) — *sleepy*

Type the Japanese for 'sleepy'.

23.3 かなしい (*kanashii*) — *sad*

Type the Japanese for 'sad'.

23.4 たのしい (*tanoshii*) — *fun, enjoyable*

Type the Japanese for 'fun, enjoyable'.

23.5 こわい (*kowai*) — *scary*

Type the Japanese for 'scary'.

Chapter 24

24.1 いたみ (*itami*) — *pain*

Type the Japanese for 'pain'.

24.2 おじいさん (*ojiisan*) — *a grandfather*

Type the Japanese for 'a grandfather'.

24.3 おじさん (*ojisan*) — *an uncle*

Type the Japanese for 'an uncle'.

24.4 むすこ (*musuko*) — *a son*

Type the Japanese for 'a son'.

24.5 むすめ (*musume*) — *a daughter*

Type the Japanese for 'a daughter'.

Chapter 25

25.1 ともだち (*tomodachi*) — *a friend*

Type the Japanese for 'a friend'.

25.2 おとな (*otona*) — *an adult*

Type the Japanese for 'an adult'.

25.3 おとこ (*otoko*) — *a man*

Type the Japanese for 'a man'.

25.4 おんな (*onna*) — *a woman*

Type the Japanese for 'a woman'.

25.5 せんせい (*sensei*) — *a teacher*

Type the Japanese for 'a teacher'.

Chapter 26

26.1 となり (*tonari*) — *next door; a neighbour*

Type the Japanese for 'next door'.

26.2 なかま (*nakama*) — *a companion*

Type the Japanese for 'a companion'.

26.3 いく (*iku*) — *to go*

Type the Japanese for 'to go'.

26.4 かう (*kau*) — *to buy*

Type the Japanese for 'to buy'.

26.5 のむ (*nomu*) — *to drink*

Type the Japanese for 'to drink'.

Chapter 27

27.1 よむ (*yomu*) — *to read*

Type the Japanese for 'to read'.

27.2 かく (*kaku*) — *to write*

Type the Japanese for 'to write'.

27.3 はなす (*hanasu*) — *to speak*

Type the Japanese for 'to speak'.

27.4 まつ (*matsu*) — *to wait*

Type the Japanese for 'to wait'.

27.5 あう (*au*) — *to meet*

Type the Japanese for 'to meet'.

Chapter 28

28.1 つかう (*tsukau*) — *to use*

Type the Japanese for 'to use'.

28.2 うたう (*utau*) — *to sing*

Type the Japanese for 'to sing'.

28.3 いう (*iu*) — *to say*

Type the Japanese for 'to say'.

28.4 おもう (*omou*) — *to think*

Type the Japanese for 'to think'.

28.5 もつ (*motsu*) — *to hold*

Type the Japanese for 'to hold'.

Chapter 29

29.1 たつ (*tatsu*) — *to stand*

Type the Japanese for 'to stand'.

29.2 なく (*naku*) — *to cry*

Type the Japanese for 'to cry'.

29.3 すむ (*sumu*) — *to live (somewhere)*

Type the Japanese for 'to live (somewhere)'.

29.4 やすむ (*yasumu*) — *to rest*

Type the Japanese for 'to rest'.

29.5 たのしむ (*tanoshimu*) — *to enjoy*

Type the Japanese for 'to enjoy'.

Chapter 30

30.1 おす (*osu*) — *to push*

Type the Japanese for 'to push'.

30.2 ひく (*hiku*) — *to pull*

Type the Japanese for 'to pull'.

30.3 さがす (*sagasu*) — *to look for*

Type the Japanese for 'to look for'.

30.4 かす (*kasu*) — *to lend*

Type the Japanese for 'to lend'.

30.5 かえす (*kaesu*) — *to give back*

Type the Japanese for 'to give back'.

Chapter 31

31.1 だす (*dasu*) — *to take out*

Type the Japanese for 'to take out'.

31.2 おとす (*otosu*) — *to drop*

Type the Japanese for 'to drop'.

31.3 なおす (*naosu*) — *to fix*

Type the Japanese for 'to fix'.

31.4 うごく (*ugoku*) — *to move*

Type the Japanese for 'to move'.

31.5 ごはん (*gohan*) — *rice; a meal*

Type the Japanese for 'rice'.

Chapter 32

32.1 さかな (*sakana*) — *a fish*

Type the Japanese for 'a fish'.

32.2 にく (*niku*) — *meat*

Type the Japanese for 'meat'.

32.3 たまご (*tamago*) — *an egg*

Type the Japanese for 'an egg'.

32.4 やさい (*yasai*) — *vegetables*

Type the Japanese for 'vegetables'.

32.5 くだもの (*kudamono*) — *fruit*

Type the Japanese for 'fruit'.

Chapter 33

33.1 りんご (*ringo*) — *an apple*

Type the Japanese for 'an apple'.

33.2 みかん (*mikan*) — *a mandarin orange*

Type the Japanese for 'a mandarin orange'.

33.3 いちご (*ichigo*) — *a strawberry*

Type the Japanese for 'a strawberry'.

33.4 もも (*momo*) — *a peach*

Type the Japanese for 'a peach'.

33.5 なし (*nashi*) — a pear

Type the Japanese for 'a pear'.

Chapter 34

34.1 すいか (*suika*) — a watermelon

Type the Japanese for 'a watermelon'.

34.2 だいこん (*daikon*) — a white radish

Type the Japanese for 'a white radish'.

34.3 にんじん (*ninjin*) — a carrot

Type the Japanese for 'a carrot'.

34.4 とうふ (*toufu*) — tofu

Type the Japanese for 'tofu'.

34.5 しお (*shio*) — salt

Type the Japanese for 'salt'.

Chapter 35

35.1 さとう (*satou*) — sugar

Type the Japanese for 'sugar'.

35.2 うどん (*udon*) — udon noodles

Type the Japanese for 'udon noodles'.

35.3 すし (*sushi*) — sushi

Type the Japanese for 'sushi'.

35.4 あさごはん (*asagohan*) — breakfast

Type the Japanese for 'breakfast'.

35.5 おかし (*okashi*) — sweets, snacks

Type the Japanese for 'sweets, snacks'.

Chapter 36

36.1 のり (*nori*) — seaweed

Type the Japanese for 'seaweed'.

36.2 うめ (*ume*) — a Japanese plum

Type the Japanese for 'a Japanese plum'.

36.3 くり (*kuri*) — *a chestnut*

Type the Japanese for 'a chestnut'.

36.4 まめ (*mame*) — *beans*

Type the Japanese for 'beans'.

36.5 こめ (*kome*) — *uncooked rice*

Type the Japanese for 'uncooked rice'.

Chapter 37

37.1 うち (*uchi*) — *home*

Type the Japanese for 'home'.

37.2 まど (*mado*) — *a window*

Type the Japanese for 'a window'.

37.3 いす (*isu*) — *a chair*

Type the Japanese for 'a chair'.

37.4 つくえ (*tsukue*) — *a desk*

Type the Japanese for 'a desk'.

37.5 やね (*yane*) — *a roof*

Type the Japanese for 'a roof'.

37.6 *The body, health and family — a first pass*

Type the Japanese for 'a desk'.

37.7 *Verbs — a second pass*

Type the Japanese for 'to stand'.

Chapter 38

38.1 ゆか (*yuka*) — *the floor*

Type the Japanese for 'the floor'.

38.2 かがみ (*kagami*) — *a mirror*

Type the Japanese for 'a mirror'.

38.3 ふとん (*futon*) — *a futon*

Type the Japanese for 'a futon'.

38.4 はし (*hashi*) — *chopsticks*

Type the Japanese for 'chopsticks'.

38.5 だいどころ (*daidokoro*) — *a kitchen*

Type the Japanese for 'a kitchen'.

Chapter 39

39.1 にわ (*niwa*) — a garden

Type the Japanese for 'a garden'.

39.2 おふろ (*ofuro*) — a bath

Type the Japanese for 'a bath'.

39.3 たたみ (*tatami*) — a tatami mat

Type the Japanese for 'a tatami mat'.

39.4 たな (*tana*) — a shelf

Type the Japanese for 'a shelf'.

39.5 はこ (*hako*) — a box

Type the Japanese for 'a box'.

Chapter 40

40.1 かさ (*kasa*) — an umbrella

Type the Japanese for 'an umbrella'.

40.2 がっこう (*gakkou*) — a school

Type the Japanese for 'a school'.

40.3 しゅくだい (*shukudai*) — homework

Type the Japanese for 'homework'.

40.4 もんだい (*mondai*) — a problem, a question

Type the Japanese for 'a problem, a question'.

40.5 こたえ (*kotae*) — an answer

Type the Japanese for 'an answer'.

Chapter 41

41.1 てがみ (*tegami*) — a letter (post)

Type the Japanese for 'a letter (post)'.

41.2 じかん (*jikan*) — time; an hour

Type the Japanese for 'time'.

41.3 なまえ (*namae*) — a name

Type the Japanese for 'a name'.

41.4 おかね (*okane*) — money

Type the Japanese for 'money'.

41.5 やま (*yama*) — a mountain

Type the Japanese for 'a mountain'.

Chapter 42**42.1 かわ (*kawa*) — a river**

Type the Japanese for 'a river'.

42.2 うみ (*umi*) — the sea

Type the Japanese for 'the sea'.

42.3 くさ (*kusa*) — grass

Type the Japanese for 'grass'.

42.4 もり (*mori*) — a forest

Type the Japanese for 'a forest'.

42.5 いし (*ishi*) — a stone

Type the Japanese for 'a stone'.

Chapter 43**43.1 すな (*sunā*) — sand**

Type the Japanese for 'sand'.

43.2 たんぼ (*tanbo*) — a rice field

Type the Japanese for 'a rice field'.

43.3 ほし (*hoshi*) — a star

Type the Japanese for 'a star'.

43.4 くも (*kumo*) — a cloud; a spider

Type the Japanese for 'a cloud'.

43.5 たいよう (*taiyō*) — the sun

Type the Japanese for 'the sun'.

Chapter 44**44.1 しま (*shima*) — an island**

Type the Japanese for 'an island'.

44.2 なみ (*nami*) — a wave

Type the Japanese for 'a wave'.

44.3 つち (*tsuchi*) — *soil*

Type the Japanese for 'soil'.

44.4 たね (*tane*) — *a seed*

Type the Japanese for 'a seed'.

44.5 あめ (*ame*) — *rain; candy*

Type the Japanese for 'rain'.

Chapter 45

45.1 ねこ (*neko*) — *a cat*

Type the Japanese for 'a cat'.

45.2 うま (*uma*) — *a horse*

Type the Japanese for 'a horse'.

45.3 うし (*ushi*) — *a cow*

Type the Japanese for 'a cow'.

45.4 とり (*tori*) — *a bird*

Type the Japanese for 'a bird'.

45.5 くま (*kuma*) — *a bear*

Type the Japanese for 'a bear'.

Chapter 46

46.1 むし (*mushi*) — *an insect*

Type the Japanese for 'an insect'.

46.2 あり (*ari*) — *an ant*

Type the Japanese for 'an ant'.

46.3 はと (*hato*) — *a pigeon*

Type the Japanese for 'a pigeon'.

46.4 ひつじ (*hitsuji*) — *a sheep*

Type the Japanese for 'a sheep'.

46.5 しか (*shika*) — *a deer*

Type the Japanese for 'a deer'.

Chapter 47

47.1 かに (*kani*) — a crab

Type the Japanese for 'a crab'.

47.2 たこ (*tako*) — an octopus

Type the Japanese for 'an octopus'.

47.3 いか (*ika*) — a squid

Type the Japanese for 'a squid'.

47.4 かめ (*kame*) — a turtle

Type the Japanese for 'a turtle'.

47.5 おおかみ (*ookami*) — a wolf

Type the Japanese for 'a wolf'.

Chapter 48

48.1 にわとり (*niwatori*) — a chicken

Type the Japanese for 'a chicken'.

48.2 ちいさい (*chiisai*) — small

Type the Japanese for 'small'.

48.3 いい (*ii*) — good

Type the Japanese for 'good'.

48.4 ながい (*nagai*) — long

Type the Japanese for 'long'.

48.5 みじかい (*mijikai*) — short

Type the Japanese for 'short'.

Chapter 49

49.1 たかい (*takai*) — tall; expensive

Type the Japanese for 'tall'.

49.2 ひくい (*hikui*) — low

Type the Japanese for 'low'.

49.3 やすい (*yasui*) — cheap

Type the Japanese for 'cheap'.

49.4 はやい (*hayai*) — fast; early

Type the Japanese for 'fast'.

49.5 やさしい (*yasashii*) — *easy; kind*
Type the Japanese for 'easy'.

Chapter 50

50.1 あまい (*amai*) — *sweet*
Type the Japanese for 'sweet'.

50.2 にがい (*nigai*) — *bitter*
Type the Japanese for 'bitter'.

50.3 ひろい (*hiroii*) — *wide*
Type the Japanese for 'wide'.

50.4 せまい (*semai*) — *narrow*
Type the Japanese for 'narrow'.

50.5 おもい (*omoi*) — *heavy*
Type the Japanese for 'heavy'.

Chapter 51

51.1 つよい (*tsuyoi*) — *strong*
Type the Japanese for 'strong'.

51.2 よわい (*yowai*) — *weak*
Type the Japanese for 'weak'.

51.3 うつくしい (*utsukushii*) — *beautiful*
Type the Japanese for 'beautiful'.

51.4 あおい (*aoi*) — *blue*
Type the Japanese for 'blue'.

51.5 あかい (*akai*) — *red*
Type the Japanese for 'red'.

Chapter 52

52.1 しろい (*shiroi*) — *white*
Type the Japanese for 'white'.

52.2 くろい (*kuroi*) — *black*
Type the Japanese for 'black'.

52.3 みどり (*midori*) — green

Type the Japanese for 'green'.

52.4 ふとい (*futoi*) — thick

Type the Japanese for 'thick'.

52.5 あたたかい (*atatakai*) — warm

Type the Japanese for 'warm'.

Chapter 53

53.1 つめたい (*tsumetai*) — cold (to the touch)

Type the Japanese for 'cold (to the touch)'.

53.2 おいしい (*oishii*) — tasty

Type the Japanese for 'tasty'.

53.3 あつい (*atsui*) — hot

Type the Japanese for 'hot'.

53.4 さむい (*samui*) — cold (weather)

Type the Japanese for 'cold (weather)'.

53.5 あさ (*asa*) — morning

Type the Japanese for 'morning'.

Chapter 54

54.1 ゆうがた (*yuugata*) — evening

Type the Japanese for 'evening'.

54.2 あした (*ashita*) — tomorrow

Type the Japanese for 'tomorrow'.

54.3 いま (*ima*) — now

Type the Japanese for 'now'.

54.4 まいにち (*mainichi*) — every day

Type the Japanese for 'every day'.

54.5 とし (*toshi*) — a year; age

Type the Japanese for 'a year'.

54.6 Food and the home — a first pass

Type the Japanese for 'every day'.

54.7 School, nature and animals — a second pass

Type the Japanese for 'an insect'.

Chapter 55

55.1 ふん (*fun*) — a minute

Type the Japanese for 'a minute'.

55.2 なつ (*natsu*) — summer

Type the Japanese for 'summer'.

55.3 ふゆ (*fuyu*) — winter

Type the Japanese for 'winter'.

55.4 いつも (*itsumo*) — always

Type the Japanese for 'always'.

55.5 まだ (*mada*) — still, not yet

Type the Japanese for 'still, not yet'.

Chapter 56

56.1 あと (*ato*) — after, later

Type the Japanese for 'after, later'.

56.2 まえ (*mae*) — before; in front

Type the Japanese for 'before'.

56.3 うえ (*ue*) — above, on top

Type the Japanese for 'above, on top'.

56.4 なか (*naka*) — inside

Type the Japanese for 'inside'.

56.5 ひだり (*hidari*) — left

Type the Japanese for 'left'.

Chapter 57

57.1 ちかい (*chikai*) — near

Type the Japanese for 'near'.

57.2 とい (*tooi*) — far

Type the Japanese for 'far'.

57.3 まち (*machi*) — a town

Type the Japanese for 'a town'.

57.4 みち (*michi*) — a road

Type the Japanese for 'a road'.

57.5 みせ (*mise*) — *a shop*
Type the Japanese for 'a shop'.

Chapter 58

58.1 ちか (*chika*) — *underground*
Type the Japanese for 'underground'.

58.2 こうえん (*kouen*) — *a park*
Type the Japanese for 'a park'.

58.3 くに (*kuni*) — *a country*
Type the Japanese for 'a country'.

58.4 ふく (*fuku*) — *clothes*
Type the Japanese for 'clothes'.

58.5 くつ (*kutsu*) — *shoes*
Type the Japanese for 'shoes'.

Chapter 59

59.1 ぼうし (*boushi*) — *a hat*
Type the Japanese for 'a hat'.

59.2 くつした (*kutsushita*) — *socks*
Type the Japanese for 'socks'.

59.3 めがね (*megane*) — *glasses*
Type the Japanese for 'glasses'.

59.4 さんじゅう (*sanjuu*) — *thirty*
Type the Japanese for 'thirty'.

59.5 せん (*sen*) — *a thousand*
Type the Japanese for 'a thousand'.

Chapter 60

60.1 まん (*man*) — *ten thousand*
Type the Japanese for 'ten thousand'.

60.2 じゅうに (*juuni*) — *twelve*
Type the Japanese for 'twelve'.

60.3 なす (*nasu*) — *an aubergine*

Type the Japanese for 'an aubergine'.

60.4 うた (*uta*) — *a song*

Type the Japanese for 'a song'.

60.5 えだ (*eda*) — *a branch*

Type the Japanese for 'a branch'.

Chapter 61

61.1 いと (*ito*) — *a thread*

Type the Japanese for 'a thread'.

61.2 はり (*hari*) — *a needle*

Type the Japanese for 'a needle'.

61.3 くし (*kushi*) — *a comb*

Type the Japanese for 'a comb'.

61.4 ひも (*himo*) — *a string*

Type the Japanese for 'a string'.

61.5 つな (*tsuna*) — *a rope*

Type the Japanese for 'a rope'.

Chapter 62

62.1 にもつ (*nimotsu*) — *luggage*

Type the Japanese for 'luggage'.

62.2 ふね (*fune*) — *a ship*

Type the Japanese for 'a ship'.

62.3 おと (*oto*) — *a sound*

Type the Japanese for 'a sound'.

62.4 いろ (*iro*) — *a colour*

Type the Japanese for 'a colour'.

62.5 かたち (*katachi*) — *a shape*

Type the Japanese for 'a shape'.

Chapter 63

63.1 ゆめ (*yume*) — a dream

Type the Japanese for 'a dream'.

63.2 まつり (*matsuri*) — a festival

Type the Japanese for 'a festival'.

63.3 にし (*nishi*) — west

Type the Japanese for 'west'.

63.4 ひがし (*higashi*) — east

Type the Japanese for 'east'.

63.5 みなみ (*minami*) — south

Type the Japanese for 'south'.

Chapter 64

64.1 こな (*kona*) — powder, flour

Type the Japanese for 'powder, flour'.

64.2 ごま (*goma*) — sesame

Type the Japanese for 'sesame'.

64.3 うに (*uni*) — a sea urchin

Type the Japanese for 'a sea urchin'.

64.4 いわし (*iwashi*) — a sardine

Type the Japanese for 'a sardine'.

64.5 あじ (*aji*) — a flavour, a taste

Type the Japanese for 'a flavour, a taste'.

Chapter 65

65.1 こい (*koi*) — a carp

Type the Japanese for 'a carp'.

65.2 せみ (*semi*) — a cicada

Type the Japanese for 'a cicada'.

65.3 とんぼ (*tonbo*) — a dragonfly

Type the Japanese for 'a dragonfly'.

65.4 いも (*imo*) — a potato

Type the Japanese for 'a potato'.

65.5 ごぼう (*gobou*) — burdock root

Type the Japanese for 'burdock root'.

Chapter 66

66.1 かご (*kago*) — a basket

Type the Japanese for 'a basket'.

66.2 こま (*koma*) — a spinning top

Type the Japanese for 'a spinning top'.

66.3 いかだ (*ikada*) — a raft

Type the Japanese for 'a raft'.

66.4 ふえ (*fue*) — a flute

Type the Japanese for 'a flute'.

66.5 たいこ (*taiko*) — a drum

Type the Japanese for 'a drum'.

Chapter 67

67.1 うちわ (*uchiwa*) — a hand fan

Type the Japanese for 'a hand fan'.

67.2 せんす (*sensu*) — a folding fan

Type the Japanese for 'a folding fan'.

67.3 すみ (*sumi*) — charcoal; a corner

Type the Japanese for 'charcoal'.

67.4 いど (*ido*) — a well

Type the Japanese for 'a well'.

67.5 はま (*hama*) — a beach

Type the Japanese for 'a beach'.

Chapter 68

68.1 おか (*oka*) — a hill

Type the Japanese for 'a hill'.

68.2 たに (*tani*) — a valley

Type the Japanese for 'a valley'.

68.3 いなか (*inaka*) — *the countryside*

Type the Japanese for 'the countryside'.

68.4 みなと (*minato*) — *a harbour*

Type the Japanese for 'a harbour'.

68.5 ゆうひ (*yuuhi*) — *the setting sun*

Type the Japanese for 'the setting sun'.

Chapter 69

69.1 にじ (*niji*) — *a rainbow*

Type the Japanese for 'a rainbow'.

69.2 かみなり (*kaminari*) — *thunder*

Type the Japanese for 'thunder'.

69.3 しも (*shimo*) — *frost*

Type the Japanese for 'frost'.

69.4 こおり (*koori*) — *ice*

Type the Japanese for 'ice'.

69.5 なつやすみ (*natsuyasumi*) — *the summer holidays*

Type the Japanese for 'the summer holidays'.

Chapter 70

70.1 もち (*mochi*) — *a rice cake*

Type the Japanese for 'a rice cake'.

70.2 なっとう (*nattou*) — *natto, fermented soybeans*

Type the Japanese for 'natto, fermented soybeans'.

70.3 ちくわ (*chikuwa*) — *a fish-paste tube*

Type the Japanese for 'a fish-paste tube'.

70.4 ひよこ (*hiyoko*) — *a chick*

Type the Japanese for 'a chick'.

70.5 はね (*hane*) — *a wing; a feather*

Type the Japanese for 'a wing'.

Chapter 71

71.1 つの (*tsuno*) — a horn

Type the Japanese for 'a horn'.

71.2 あな (*ana*) — a hole

Type the Japanese for 'a hole'.

71.3 いね (*ine*) — a rice plant

Type the Japanese for 'a rice plant'.

71.4 おい (*oi*) — a nephew

Type the Japanese for 'a nephew'.

71.5 めい (*mei*) — a niece

Type the Japanese for 'a niece'.

71.6 Describing words and time — a first pass

Type the Japanese for 'a nephew'.

71.7 Places, clothes and more — a second pass

Type the Japanese for 'a dream'.

Answer Key

The first response is the canonical display answer. When a question accepts other authored forms, they appear underneath.

Chapter 1

1.1 い — *two strokes, one beat*

Answer: 2

Also accepted: two; 2 strokes; two strokes

1.2 は — *three strokes*

Answer: 3

Also accepted: three; 3 strokes; three strokes

1.3 Two signs, side by side — *and a word appears*

Answer: 2

Also accepted: two; 2 beats; two beats

1.4 え — *two strokes, and a second word for free*

Answer: え; 3

Also accepted: え; え, three; e; 3

1.5 はい — *yes, in two equal beats*

Answer: はい

Also accepted: hai; ha-i

1.6 いいえ — *no, and why the extra beat matters*

Answer: three

Also accepted: 3; three beats; three morae

Chapter 2

2.1 こ — *two strokes, and the greeting begins*

Answer: 2

Also accepted: two; 2 strokes; two strokes

2.2 ん — *one stroke, one beat, no vowel*

Answer: none

Also accepted: no vowel; not any; it has none; nothing

2.3 に — *three strokes, and a shape you half know*

Answer: no

Also accepted: none; it does not; nothing; no it does not

2.4 ち — *two strokes, four roman letters, one beat*

Answer: 1

Also accepted: one; one beat; 1 beat

2.5 わに (*wani*) — *a crocodile*

Answer: wani

2.6 わ — *the sign for wa, and the trap beside it*

Answer: ha

Also accepted: the ha sign; sign for ha; ha sign

2.7 *Five signs in a row — and the greeting is readable*

Answer: 5

Also accepted: five; 5 beats; five beats

2.8 こんにちは — *hello, and a sign that lies about its sound*

Answer: wa

Also accepted: as wa; わ; the topic particle wa

Chapter 3

3.1 あ — *three strokes, and the thank-you begins*

Answer: 3

Also accepted: three; 3 strokes; three strokes

3.2 り — *two strokes, and a tap rather than an r*

Answer: a single tap

Also accepted: a tap; tap; single tap; closer to a tap

3.3 か — *three strokes, and a shape you will reuse*

Answer: 3

Also accepted: three; 3 strokes; three strokes

3.4 “ — *two ticks, and every sign you know doubles*

Answer: they voice the consonant

Also accepted: voice it; voices the consonant; make it voiced; turn k into g; they make the consonant voiced

3.5 と — *two strokes, and they never meet*

Answer: no

Also accepted: they do not touch; no, they stay apart; separate; no they are separate

3.6 う — *two strokes, and a vowel that stretches***Answer:** it lengthens the o**Also accepted:** makes the o long; holds the o for another beat; lengthens the vowel; it makes it a long o**3.7 ありがとう** — *no new sign, and a whole word***Answer:** ga, which is ka**Also accepted:** が^ゝ, from か^ゝ; ga from ka; the third sign, ka; が^ゝ is か^ゝ plus the marks; ka**3.8 ありがとう** — *thanks, from “this hardly ever happens”***Answer:** か^ゝ**Also accepted:** ka; か^ゝ ka

Chapter 4

4.1 さ — *two strokes, and the ticks work here too***Answer:** za**Also accepted:** ざ^ゝ; it becomes za**4.2 ま** — *three strokes, and a loop you have drawn before***Answer:** 3**Also accepted:** three; 3 strokes; three strokes**4.3 す** — *two strokes, and a vowel you barely hear***Answer:** it is devoiced**Also accepted:** it goes quiet; devoiced; you barely hear it; the voice drops out; it is almost silent**4.4 ありがとうございます** — *politeness you cannot leave out***Answer:** ありがとうございます**Also accepted:** arigato gozaimasu; arigatou gozaimasu; arigatō gozaimasu; the polite one**4.5 Practice** — *the whole thank-you, off the page***Answer:** 3**Also accepted:** three; 3 signs; three signs; ga za and go; が ぞ ざ

Chapter 5

5.1 日 — *one sun, four strokes***Answer:** 日**Also accepted:** 日 (nichi); nichi**5.2 本** — *a tree with its root marked***Answer:** 本 — the final short horizontal stroke**Also accepted:** 本^ゝ; the last stroke; the short bottom line; final horizontal

5.3 言 — *build the speech side first*

Answer: 言

Also accepted: 言 (speech); the speech component

5.4 五 — *four strokes for the sound side*

Answer: 五

Also accepted: 五 (go); go; five

5.5 口 — *close a box in three strokes*

Answer: 口

Also accepted: 口 (mouth); the mouth box

5.6 語 — *assemble; do not memorise fourteen loose strokes*

Answer: 語 = 言 + 五 + 口

Also accepted: 語; 言 + 五 + 口; 言五口

5.7 日本語 — *three characters, and no single sound each*

Answer: ni

Also accepted: as ni; に; read ni

Chapter 6

6.1 コ — *same sound, a new script*

Answer: コ

Also accepted: コ (ko); katakana コ

6.2 コー — *one line, one extra beat*

Answer: コー

Also accepted: コー; kō; ko-o

6.3 ヒ — *two strokes complete the inventory*

Answer: コーヒ

Also accepted: ヒ; コー ヒ; katakana hi

6.4 コーヒー — *the third system, and a word that really is a cousin*

Answer: it holds the vowel for one more beat

Also accepted: lengthens the vowel; long vowel; it lengthens the previous vowel; adds a beat to the vowel

Chapter 7

7.1 Practice — *one daytime exchange, three scripts*

Answer: 日本語; こんにちは。はい。いいえ。

Also accepted: 日本語

Chapter 8

8.1 *Hear sayōnara — one way to say goodbye*

Answer: It says goodbye; five morae.

Also accepted: goodbye, five; farewell, five morae; goodbye; 5

8.2 よ — *the second sound gets a shape*

Answer: yo

Also accepted: よ is yo; yo, one mora

8.3 な — *one sign for na*

Answer: na

Also accepted: な is na; na, one mora

8.4 ら — *the last new shape*

Answer: ら

Also accepted: ら ra

8.5 さようなら — *assemble what the hand already knows*

Answer: さようなら

Also accepted: さようなら。

8.6 *Practice — meet, thank, then part*

Answer: さようなら。 ; sa | yo | o | na | ra

Also accepted: さようなら; さようなら。

Chapter 9

9.1 すみません — *open the repair gently*

Answer: すみません

Also accepted: sumimasen; すみません。

9.2 み — *one looped bridge*

Answer: み

Also accepted: hiragana mi

9.3 め — *cross, loop, release*

Answer: 2

Also accepted: two; 2 strokes; two strokes

9.4 よく — *how fully?*

Answer: how well or fully understanding happened

Also accepted: well; fully

9.5 く — *one angled stroke*

Answer: く

Also accepted: hiragana ku

9.6 わかりません — *I do not understand*

Answer: わかりません

Also accepted: wakarimasen; わかりません。

9.7 ど — *voice a sign you already own*

Answer: ど

Also accepted: hiragana do

9.8 もう — *one more time begins here*

Answer: again; two morae

Also accepted: one more; two morae; again, 2; again; 2

9.9 も — *two bars, then the curve*

Answer: the long curve

Also accepted: curve; long curve first; the curve

9.10 いちど — *one time, all known signs*

Answer: いちど

Also accepted: いちど。

9.11 おねがいします — *please, as a polite request*

Answer: おねがいします

Also accepted: onegaishimasu; おねがいします。

9.12 もういちど、おねがいします — *ask for one more pass*

Answer: もういちど、おねがいします。

Also accepted: もういちどおねがいします; mō ichido, onegai shimasu; mou ichido, onegaishimasu

Chapter 10

10.1 せ — *close the opener*

Answer: せ

Also accepted: hiragana se

10.2 お — *the respectful opening sign*

Answer: お

Also accepted: hiragana o

10.3 ね — *finish the polite request*

Answer: ね

Also accepted: hiragana ne

10.4 すこし — *ask for a small change*

Answer: すこし

Also accepted: sukoshi

10.5 し — *one falling curve*

Answer: し

Also accepted: hiragana shi

10.6 ゆっくり — *slowly, with a held beat*

Answer: yu | hold | ku | ri

Also accepted: yukkuri; yu-k-ku-ri

10.7 ゆ — *open yukkuri*

Answer: ゆ

Also accepted: hiragana yu

10.8 ってください — *please say it*

Answer: ってください

Also accepted: itte kudasai; ってください。

10.9 もうすこし — *a little more*

Answer: もうすこし

Also accepted: もうすこし。

10.10 わかりました — *the repair worked*

Answer: わかりました

Also accepted: wakarimashita; わかりました。

10.11 ここ — *here, with one known sign twice*

Answer: ここ

Also accepted: ここ。

10.12 もうすこし、ゆっくりってください — *slower, please*

Answer: もうすこし、ゆっくりってください。

Also accepted: mō sukoshi, yukkuri itte kudasai; mou sukoshi yukkuri itte kudasai;
もうすこしゆっくりってください

Chapter 11

11.1 つ — *one small held beat*

Answer: つ

Also accepted: small tsu

11.2 て — *close itte*

Answer: て

Also accepted: hiragana te

11.3 た — *close wakarimashita*

Answer: た

Also accepted: hiragana ta

11.4 だ — *voice the known base*

Answer: だ

Also accepted: hiragana da

11.5 て — *hand*

Answer: て

Also accepted: te

11.6 みみ — *ear*

Answer: みみ

Also accepted: mimi

11.7 くち — *mouth*

Answer: くち

Also accepted: kuchi

11.8 あし — *foot or leg*

Answer: あし

Also accepted: ashi

11.9 はな — *nose*

Answer: はな

Also accepted: hana

11.10 かお — *face*

Answer: かお

Also accepted: kao

11.11 め — *eye*

Answer: め

Also accepted: me

11.12 *Seven readable body words*

Answer: て、みみ、くち

Also accepted: て みみ くち; te mimi kuchi

Chapter 12

12.1 *Retrieval 1 — mora, politeness, and し*

Answer:

い・し・ありがとうございます・て・みみ・くち・あし・はな・かお・め;

mora; polite

Also accepted: い し ありがとうございます て みみ くち あし はな かお め mora
polite**12.2** あたま — *head*

Answer: あたま

Also accepted: atama

12.3 かみ — *hair*

Answer: かみ

Also accepted: kami

12.4 *Retrieval 2 — old signs, recent request*

Answer: え・五・口・いってください・かみ・め

Also accepted: え 五 口 いってください かみ め

12.5 は — *tooth*

Answer: は

Also accepted: ha

12.6 かた — *shoulder*

Answer: かた

Also accepted: kata

12.7 Retrieval 3 — keep the scripts apart

Answer: こ・コー・ここ・かた・あたま

Also accepted: こ コー ここ かた あたま

12.8 おなか — belly

Answer: おなか

Also accepted: onaka

12.9 せなか — back

Answer: せなか

Also accepted: senaka

12.10 Retrieval 4 — leave the body-word topic

Answer: ち・さようなら・て・せなか・は

Also accepted: ち さようなら て せなか は

12.11 こし — waist or lower back

Answer: こし

Also accepted: koshi

12.12 Retrieval 5 — enter, leave, voice

Answer: こんにちは・さようなら・だ・こし

Also accepted: こんにちは さようなら だ こし

12.13 Retrieval 6 — greet, repair, point

Answer: こんにちは・よくわかりません・て・おなか

Also accepted: こんにちは よくわかりません て おなか

12.14 Retrieval 7 — from あ to せなか

Answer: あ・ど・もう・みみ・せなか

Also accepted: あ どう もう みみ せなか

12.15 Retrieval 8 — り, も, いちど, くち

Answer: り・も・いちど・くち

Also accepted: り も いちど くち

12.16 Retrieval 9 — request, leg, waist

Answer: か・おねがいします・もういちどおねがいします・あし・こし

Also accepted: か おねがいします もういちどおねがいします あし こし

12.17 Retrieval 10 — mark, signs, nose

Answer: だ・せ・ね・はな

Also accepted: だ せ ね はな

12.18 Retrieval 11 — と, すこし, かお

Answer: と・すこし・かお

Also accepted: と すこし かお

12.19 Retrieval 12 — う and め

Answer: う・め

Also accepted: う め

12.20 Seven more body words, spaced on purpose

Answer: あたま・かみ・は・かた・おなか・せなか・こし

Also accepted: あたま かみ は かた おなか せなか こし

Chapter 13

13.1 つ — *one full-size curve*

Answer: つ

13.2 Full つ, small つ

Answer: つ・つ

Also accepted: つつ

13.3 ちち — *my father*

Answer: ちち

13.4 はは — *my mother*

Answer: はは

13.5 あに — *my elder brother*

Answer: あに

13.6 あね — *my elder sister*

Answer: あね

13.7 おとうと — *my younger brother*

Answer: おとうと

13.8 いもうと — *my younger sister*

Answer: いもうと

13.9 おっと — *my husband*

Answer: おっと

13.10 つま — *my wife*

Answer: つま

13.11 こども — *child*

Answer: こども

13.12 Family retrieval A

Answer: おとうと・こども

Also accepted: おとうと こども

13.13 Family retrieval B

Answer: いもうと・ちち・はは

Also accepted: いもうと ちち はは

13.14 Family retrieval C

Answer: おっと・あに・あね

Also accepted: おっと あに あね

13.15 Family retrieval D

Answer: つま・おっと

Also accepted: つま おっと

13.16 Nine family words — *reception check*

Answer: my father; my elder sister; my younger sister; my wife; child

13.17 *Nine family words — reception check*

Answer: my elder sister; my younger brother; my wife; my father; my younger sister

13.18 *Nine family words — production check*

Answer: はは・あに・おとうと・おっと・こども

Also accepted: はは あに おとうと おっと こども

13.19 *Nine family words — production check*

Answer:

ちち・はは・あに・あね・おとうと・いもうと・おっと・つま・こども

Also accepted: ちち はは あに あね おとうと いもうと おっと つま こども

Chapter 14

14.1 いち — *one, taken out of a word you already say*

Answer: ichi, and it is one

Also accepted: ichi — one; the ichi, one

14.2 ご — *five, and the sign that was holding it*

Answer: 五, and it is five

Also accepted: 五 — five; the four-stroke one, five

14.3 に — *two, one mora long*

Answer: いち・に・ご

Also accepted: いち に ご; ichi ni go

14.4 さん — *three, on two old signs*

Answer: two beats; the second is the nasal ん on its own

Also accepted: two, the n; 2 beats, ん

14.5 よん — *four, and where the two systems meet*

Answer: shi is the borrowed reading; yon is the native word

Also accepted: shi borrowed, yon native; shi is on'yomi and yon is kun'yomi

14.6 *One to five, in order at last*

Answer: いち・に・さん・よん・ご

Also accepted: いち に さん よん ご; ichi ni san yon go

14.7 *One to five, in order at last*

Answer: ichi, inside ichido in chapter nine; go, as the kanji 五 in chapter five

Also accepted: ichi in ichido and go as 五; one from mouichido, five from the kanji

Chapter 15

15.1 なな — *seven, and the pattern from four holding*

Answer: four and seven

Also accepted: 4 and 7; yon and nana

15.2 はち — *eight, with nothing standing beside it***Answer:** no**Also accepted:** no, only one reading; it does not**15.3 く** — *nine, and the exception to the seam***Answer:** no — the readings box calls both of them borrowed**Also accepted:** no; neither, both are borrowed**15.4 ろ** — *one turn, and the r you already make***Answer:** ろ**Also accepted:** ro**15.5 ろく** — *six, and the hole closes***Answer:** it is the number nine on its own, and the second beat of roku, six**Also accepted:** nine, and the ku in roku; nine and the second beat of six**15.6 っ** — *a small sign that joins forward***Answer:** っ is one beat; っ is two**Also accepted:** one and two; 1, 2**15.7 じゅう** — *ten, and what ten does***Answer:** nijuu is twenty and juuni is twelve; a number before juu multiplies it and a number after it is added**Also accepted:** 20 and 12; before multiplies, after adds; nijuu 20, juuni 12**15.8 One to ten, and what the run cost****Answer:** ろく・なな・はち・く・じゅう**Also accepted:** ろく なな はち く じゅう; roku nana hachi ku juu**15.9 One to ten, and what the run cost****Answer:** juusan is thirteen and sanjuu is thirty; the number after juu is added and the number before it multiplies**Also accepted:** juusan 13, sanjuu 30; 13 juusan, 30 sanjuu

Chapter 16

16.1 ひ — *one stroke, and a second count begins***Answer:** ひ**Also accepted:** hi**16.2 ひとつ** — *one thing***Answer:** hitotsu**Also accepted:** ひとつ; hitotsu, because it is a thing**16.3 ふ** — *four strokes, and a counter you already own***Answer:** ふ, four strokes**Also accepted:** fu, four; ふ**16.4 ふたつ** — *two things***Answer:** hitotsu, futatsu — they share tsu**Also accepted:** hitotsu futatsu, tsu; ひとつ ふたつ

16.5 みつつ — *three things, for nothing***Answer:** みつつ — the small tsu holds the mouth shut for one beat**Also accepted:** mittsu, it doubles the consonant; みつつ**16.6 よつつ** — *four things, and the seam opens***Answer:** yon is the native word inside the borrowed count; yottsu is it in its own count**Also accepted:** yon, and yottsu; yon — yottsu**16.7 いくつか** — *five things***Answer:** go**Also accepted:** ご; go, five**16.8 Five things, and five numbers****Answer:** hitotsu futatsu mittsu yottsu itsutsu**Also accepted:** ひとつ ふたつ みつつ よつつ いくつか**16.9 Five things, and five numbers****Answer:** ichi ni san yon go; hitotsu futatsu mittsu yottsu itsutsu — four, yon and yottsu**Also accepted:** four; yon and yottsu

Chapter 17

17.1 む — *three strokes, one of them a dot***Answer:** む — the small separate mark on the right**Also accepted:** mu, the right-hand mark; む**17.2 むつつ** — *six things***Answer:** roku and muttsu; muttsu for six things**Also accepted:** roku, muttsu — muttsu; ろく むつつ**17.3 ななつ** — *seven things, and the seam again***Answer:** four and seven**Also accepted:** yon and nana; 4 and 7**17.4 や** — *the long stroke goes first***Answer:** や — the long sweep across the middle comes first**Also accepted:** ya, the sweep; や**17.5 やつつ** — *eight things***Answer:** hachi and yattsu; neither crosses over**Also accepted:** hachi, yattsu, no; はち やつつ**17.6 の** — *one stroke, and the last sign of the chapter***Answer:** の, one stroke**Also accepted:** no, one; の**17.7 ここのつ** — *nine things***Answer:** none — the resemblance is an accident**Also accepted:** no relationship; they are unrelated

17.8 とお — *ten things, and the end of the run***Answer:** too — the count ends at ten**Also accepted:** とお; too, the series stops there**17.9 The other ten, in order at last****Answer:** hitotsu futatsu mittsu yottsu itsutsu muttsu nanatsu yattsu kokonotsu tō**Also accepted:** ひとつ ふたつ みつつ よつつ いつつ むつつ ななつ やつつ このつ とお**17.10 The other ten, in order at last****Answer:** four — yon and yottsu; seven — nana and nanatsu**Also accepted:** four and seven: yon/yottsu, nana/nanatsu

Chapter 18

18.1 What the つ was doing**Answer:** tsu, which counts things in general, and do in ichido, which counts occurrences**Also accepted:** tsu and do; the tsu series and the do of ichido**18.2 にん** — *counting people***Answer:** no — people take nin; sannin**Also accepted:** no, sannin; people need nin, sannin**18.3 ひとり・ふたり** — *one person, two people***Answer:** hitori futari sannin yonin**Also accepted:** ひとり ふたり さんにん よにん**18.4 Counting your own face****Answer:** me futatsu, mimi futatsu, hana hitotsu, kuchi hitotsu**Also accepted:** め ふたつ みみ ふたつ はな ひとつ くち ひとつ**18.5 Counting your own face****Answer:** futari — people never take the tsu series**Also accepted:** ふたり; futari, people take nin**18.6 ほ** — は *with one more bar***Answer:** ほ — one extra horizontal, drawn above ha's**Also accepted:** ho, an extra bar; ほ**18.7 ほん** — *counting long thin things***Answer:** nihon, yonhon**Also accepted:** にほん よんほん**18.8 °** — *the other mark***Answer:** ほ ぼ ぽ — ho, bo, po**Also accepted:** ho bo po; ほ ぼ ぽ**18.9 いっぽん** — *and the four that bend***Answer:** one, six, eight and ten — they all end in a held beat**Also accepted:** 1 6 8 10, the small tsu; one six eight ten

18.10 *Three counters, and how to choose*

Answer: hitotsu, hitori, ippon

Also accepted: ひとつ ひとり いっぽん

18.11 *Three counters, and how to choose*

Answer: me futatsu, ashi nihon, futari, kami nihon

Also accepted: futatsu, nihon, futari, nihon

Chapter 19

19.1 (*reading*) — *six words, nothing said first*

Answer: me

Also accepted: め

19.2 (*reading*) — *the doorway words, on the page*

Answer: arigatou

Also accepted: ありがとう; arigatō; thank you

19.3 (*reading*) — *the cues you have only ever heard*

Answer: wakarimasen

Also accepted: わかりません

Chapter 20

20.1 つめ (*tsume*) — *a nail (finger or toe)*

Answer: つめ

Also accepted: tsume

20.2 ひじ (*hiji*) — *an elbow*

Answer: ひじ

Also accepted: hiji

20.3 ひざ (*hiza*) — *a knee*

Answer: ひざ

Also accepted: hiza

20.4 のど (*nodo*) — *the throat*

Answer: のど

Also accepted: nodo

20.5 むね (*mune*) — *the chest*

Answer: むね

Also accepted: mune

Chapter 21

21.1 ほね (*hone*) — a bone

Answer: ほね

Also accepted: hone

21.2 あご (*ago*) — the chin

Answer: あご

Also accepted: ago

21.3 ほお (*hoo*) — a cheek

Answer: ほお

Also accepted: hoo

21.4 まゆ (*mayu*) — an eyebrow

Answer: まゆ

Also accepted: mayu

21.5 はだ (*hada*) — skin

Answer: はだ

Also accepted: hada

Chapter 22

22.1 あせ (*ase*) — sweat

Answer: あせ

Also accepted: ase

22.2 なみだ (*namida*) — tears

Answer: なみだ

Also accepted: namida

22.3 こえ (*koe*) — a voice

Answer: こえ

Also accepted: koe

22.4 ねつ (*netsu*) — a fever

Answer: ねつ

Also accepted: netsu

22.5 いたい (*itai*) — painful, it hurts

Answer: いたい

Also accepted: itai

Chapter 23

23.1 くすり (*kusuri*) — medicine

Answer: くすり

Also accepted: kusuri

23.2 ねむい (*nemui*) — *sleepy*

Answer: ねむい

Also accepted: nemui

23.3 かなしい (*kanashii*) — *sad*

Answer: かなしい

Also accepted: kanashii

23.4 たのしい (*tanoshii*) — *fun, enjoyable*

Answer: たのしい

Also accepted: tanoshii

23.5 こわい (*kowai*) — *scary*

Answer: こわい

Also accepted: kowai

Chapter 24

24.1 いたみ (*itami*) — *pain*

Answer: いたみ

Also accepted: itami

24.2 おじいさん (*ojiisan*) — *a grandfather*

Answer: おじいさん

Also accepted: ojiisan

24.3 おじさん (*ojisan*) — *an uncle*

Answer: おじさん

Also accepted: ojisan

24.4 むすこ (*musuko*) — *a son*

Answer: むすこ

Also accepted: musuko

24.5 むすめ (*musume*) — *a daughter*

Answer: むすめ

Also accepted: musume

Chapter 25

25.1 ともだち (*tomodachi*) — *a friend*

Answer: ともだち

Also accepted: tomodachi

25.2 おとな (*otona*) — *an adult*

Answer: おとな

Also accepted: onona

25.3 おとこ (*otoko*) — a man

Answer: おとこ

Also accepted: otoko

25.4 おんな (*onna*) — a woman

Answer: おんな

Also accepted: onna

25.5 せんせい (*sensei*) — a teacher

Answer: せんせい

Also accepted: sensei

Chapter 26

26.1 となり (*tonari*) — next door; a neighbour

Answer: となり

Also accepted: tonari

26.2 なかま (*nakama*) — a companion

Answer: なかま

Also accepted: nakama

26.3 いく (*iku*) — to go

Answer: いく

Also accepted: iku

26.4 かう (*kau*) — to buy

Answer: かう

Also accepted: kau

26.5 のむ (*nomu*) — to drink

Answer: のむ

Also accepted: nomu

Chapter 27

27.1 よむ (*yomu*) — to read

Answer: よむ

Also accepted: yomu

27.2 かく (*kaku*) — to write

Answer: かく

Also accepted: kaku

27.3 はなす (*hanasu*) — to speak

Answer: はなす

Also accepted: hanasu

27.4 まつ (*matsu*) — *to wait*

Answer: まつ

Also accepted: matsu

27.5 あう (*au*) — *to meet*

Answer: あう

Also accepted: au

Chapter 28

28.1 つかう (*tsukau*) — *to use*

Answer: つかう

Also accepted: tsukau

28.2 うたう (*utau*) — *to sing*

Answer: うたう

Also accepted: utau

28.3 いう (*iu*) — *to say*

Answer: いう

Also accepted: iu

28.4 おもう (*omou*) — *to think*

Answer: おもう

Also accepted: omou

28.5 もつ (*motsu*) — *to hold*

Answer: もつ

Also accepted: motsu

Chapter 29

29.1 たつ (*tatsu*) — *to stand*

Answer: たつ

Also accepted: tatsu

29.2 なく (*naku*) — *to cry*

Answer: なく

Also accepted: naku

29.3 すむ (*sumu*) — *to live (somewhere)*

Answer: すむ

Also accepted: sumu

29.4 やすむ (*yasumu*) — *to rest*

Answer: やすむ

Also accepted: yasumu

29.5 たのしむ (*tanoshimu*) — to enjoy**Answer:** たのしむ**Also accepted:** tanoshimu

Chapter 30

30.1 おす (*osu*) — to push**Answer:** おす**Also accepted:** osu**30.2 ひく (*hiku*) — to pull****Answer:** ひく**Also accepted:** hiku**30.3 さがす (*sagasu*) — to look for****Answer:** さがす**Also accepted:** sagasu**30.4 かす (*kasu*) — to lend****Answer:** かす**Also accepted:** kasu**30.5 かえす (*kaesu*) — to give back****Answer:** かえす**Also accepted:** kaesu

Chapter 31

31.1 だす (*dasu*) — to take out**Answer:** だす**Also accepted:** dasu**31.2 おとす (*otosu*) — to drop****Answer:** おとす**Also accepted:** otosu**31.3 なおす (*naosu*) — to fix****Answer:** なおす**Also accepted:** naosu**31.4 うごく (*ugoku*) — to move****Answer:** うごく**Also accepted:** ugoku**31.5 ごはん (*gohan*) — rice; a meal****Answer:** ごはん**Also accepted:** gohan

Chapter 32

32.1 さかな (*sakana*) — a fish

Answer: さかな

Also accepted: sakana

32.2 にく (*niku*) — meat

Answer: にく

Also accepted: niku

32.3 たまご (*tamago*) — an egg

Answer: たまご

Also accepted: tamago

32.4 やさい (*yasai*) — vegetables

Answer: やさい

Also accepted: yasai

32.5 くだもの (*kudamono*) — fruit

Answer: くだもの

Also accepted: kudamono

Chapter 33

33.1 りんご (*ringo*) — an apple

Answer: りんご

Also accepted: ringo

33.2 みかん (*mikan*) — a mandarin orange

Answer: みかん

Also accepted: mikan

33.3 いちご (*ichigo*) — a strawberry

Answer: いちご

Also accepted: ichigo

33.4 もも (*momo*) — a peach

Answer: もも

Also accepted: momo

33.5 なし (*nashi*) — a pear

Answer: なし

Also accepted: nashi

Chapter 34

34.1 すいか (*suika*) — a watermelon

Answer: すいか

Also accepted: suika

34.2 дайこん (*daikon*) — a white radish

Answer: дайこん

Also accepted: daikon

34.3 にんじん (*ninjin*) — a carrot

Answer: にんじん

Also accepted: ninjin

34.4 とうふ (*toufu*) — tofu

Answer: とうふ

Also accepted: toufu

34.5 しお (*shio*) — salt

Answer: しお

Also accepted: shio

Chapter 35

35.1 さとう (*satou*) — sugar

Answer: さとう

Also accepted: satou

35.2 うどん (*udon*) — udon noodles

Answer: うどん

Also accepted: udon

35.3 すし (*sushi*) — sushi

Answer: すし

Also accepted: sushi

35.4 あさごはん (*asagohan*) — breakfast

Answer: あさごはん

Also accepted: asagohan

35.5 おかし (*okashi*) — sweets, snacks

Answer: おかし

Also accepted: okashi

Chapter 36

36.1 のり (*nori*) — seaweed

Answer: のり

Also accepted: nori

36.2 うめ (*ume*) — a Japanese plum

Answer: うめ

Also accepted: ume

36.3 くり (*kuri*) — a chestnut

Answer: くり

Also accepted: kuri

36.4 まめ (*mame*) — beans

Answer: まめ

Also accepted: mame

36.5 こめ (*kome*) — uncooked rice

Answer: こめ

Also accepted: kome

Chapter 37

37.1 うち (*uchi*) — home

Answer: うち

Also accepted: uchi

37.2 まど (*mado*) — a window

Answer: まど

Also accepted: mado

37.3 いす (*isu*) — a chair

Answer: いす

Also accepted: isu

37.4 つくえ (*tsukue*) — a desk

Answer: つくえ

Also accepted: tsukue

37.5 やね (*yane*) — a roof

Answer: やね

Also accepted: yane

37.6 *The body, health and family — a first pass*

Answer: つくえ

Also accepted: tsukue

37.7 *Verbs — a second pass*

Answer: たつ

Also accepted: tatsu

Chapter 38

38.1 ゆか (*yuka*) — the floor

Answer: ゆか

Also accepted: yuka

38.2 かがみ (*kagami*) — a mirror

Answer: かがみ

Also accepted: kagami

38.3 ふとん (*futon*) — a futon

Answer: ふとん

Also accepted: futon

38.4 はし (*hashi*) — chopsticks

Answer: はし

Also accepted: hashi

38.5 だいどころ (*daidokoro*) — a kitchen

Answer: だいどころ

Also accepted: daidokoro

Chapter 39

39.1 にわ (*niwa*) — a garden

Answer: にわ

Also accepted: niwa

39.2 おふろ (*ofuro*) — a bath

Answer: おふろ

Also accepted: ofuro

39.3 たたみ (*tatami*) — a tatami mat

Answer: たたみ

Also accepted: tatami

39.4 たな (*tana*) — a shelf

Answer: たな

Also accepted: tana

39.5 はこ (*hako*) — a box

Answer: はこ

Also accepted: hako

Chapter 40

40.1 かさ (*kasa*) — an umbrella

Answer: かさ

Also accepted: kasa

40.2 がっこう (*gakkou*) — a school

Answer: がっこう

Also accepted: gakkou

40.3 しゅくだい (*shukudai*) — *homework*

Answer: しゅくだい

Also accepted: shukudai

40.4 もんだい (*mondai*) — *a problem, a question*

Answer: もんだい

Also accepted: mondai

40.5 こたえ (*kotae*) — *an answer*

Answer: こたえ

Also accepted: kotae

Chapter 41

41.1 てがみ (*tegami*) — *a letter (post)*

Answer: てがみ

Also accepted: tegami

41.2 じかん (*jikan*) — *time; an hour*

Answer: じかん

Also accepted: jikan

41.3 なまえ (*namae*) — *a name*

Answer: なまえ

Also accepted: namae

41.4 おかね (*okane*) — *money*

Answer: おかね

Also accepted: okane

41.5 やま (*yama*) — *a mountain*

Answer: やま

Also accepted: yama

Chapter 42

42.1 かわ (*kawa*) — *a river*

Answer: かわ

Also accepted: kawa

42.2 うみ (*umi*) — *the sea*

Answer: うみ

Also accepted: umi

42.3 くさ (*kusa*) — *grass*

Answer: くさ

Also accepted: kusa

42.4 もり (*mori*) — a forest

Answer: もり

Also accepted: mori

42.5 いし (*ishi*) — a stone

Answer: いし

Also accepted: ishi

Chapter 43

43.1 すな (*sunā*) — sand

Answer: すな

Also accepted: suna

43.2 たんぼ (*tanbo*) — a rice field

Answer: たんぼ

Also accepted: tanbo

43.3 ほし (*hoshi*) — a star

Answer: ほし

Also accepted: hoshi

43.4 くも (*kumo*) — a cloud; a spider

Answer: くも

Also accepted: kumo

43.5 たいよう (*taiyou*) — the sun

Answer: たいよう

Also accepted: taiyou

Chapter 44

44.1 しま (*shima*) — an island

Answer: しま

Also accepted: shima

44.2 なみ (*nami*) — a wave

Answer: なみ

Also accepted: nami

44.3 つち (*tsuchi*) — soil

Answer: つち

Also accepted: tsuchi

44.4 たね (*tane*) — a seed

Answer: たね

Also accepted: tane

44.5 あめ (*ame*) — *rain; candy*

Answer: あめ

Also accepted: ame

Chapter 45

45.1 ねこ (*neko*) — *a cat*

Answer: ねこ

Also accepted: neko

45.2 うま (*uma*) — *a horse*

Answer: うま

Also accepted: uma

45.3 うし (*ushi*) — *a cow*

Answer: うし

Also accepted: ushi

45.4 とり (*tori*) — *a bird*

Answer: とり

Also accepted: tori

45.5 くま (*kuma*) — *a bear*

Answer: くま

Also accepted: kuma

Chapter 46

46.1 むし (*mushi*) — *an insect*

Answer: むし

Also accepted: mushi

46.2 あり (*ari*) — *an ant*

Answer: あり

Also accepted: ari

46.3 はと (*hato*) — *a pigeon*

Answer: はと

Also accepted: hato

46.4 ひつじ (*hitsuji*) — *a sheep*

Answer: ひつじ

Also accepted: hitsuji

46.5 しか (*shika*) — *a deer*

Answer: しか

Also accepted: shika

Chapter 47

47.1 かに (*kani*) — a crab

Answer: かに

Also accepted: kani

47.2 たこ (*tako*) — an octopus

Answer: たこ

Also accepted: tako

47.3 いか (*ika*) — a squid

Answer: いか

Also accepted: ika

47.4 かめ (*kame*) — a turtle

Answer: かめ

Also accepted: kame

47.5 おおかみ (*ookami*) — a wolf

Answer: おおかみ

Also accepted: ookami

Chapter 48

48.1 にわとり (*niwatori*) — a chicken

Answer: にわとり

Also accepted: niwatori

48.2 ちいさい (*chiisai*) — small

Answer: ちいさい

Also accepted: chiisai

48.3 いい (*ii*) — good

Answer: いい

Also accepted: ii

48.4 ながい (*nagai*) — long

Answer: ながい

Also accepted: nagai

48.5 みじかい (*mijikai*) — short

Answer: みじかい

Also accepted: mijikai

Chapter 49

49.1 たかい (*takai*) — tall; expensive

Answer: たかい

Also accepted: takai

49.2 ひくい (*hikui*) — *low*

Answer: ひくい

Also accepted: hikui

49.3 やすい (*yasui*) — *cheap*

Answer: やすい

Also accepted: yasui

49.4 はやい (*hayai*) — *fast; early*

Answer: はやい

Also accepted: hayai

49.5 やさしい (*yasashii*) — *easy; kind*

Answer: やさしい

Also accepted: yasashii

Chapter 50

50.1 あまい (*amai*) — *sweet*

Answer: あまい

Also accepted: amai

50.2 にがい (*nigai*) — *bitter*

Answer: にがい

Also accepted: nigai

50.3 ひろい (*hiro*) — *wide*

Answer: ひろい

Also accepted: hiroi

50.4 せまい (*semai*) — *narrow*

Answer: せまい

Also accepted: semai

50.5 おもい (*omoi*) — *heavy*

Answer: おもい

Also accepted: omoi

Chapter 51

51.1 つよい (*tsuyoi*) — *strong*

Answer: つよい

Also accepted: tsuyoi

51.2 よわい (*yowai*) — *weak*

Answer: よわい

Also accepted: yowai

51.3 うつくしい (*utsukushii*) — *beautiful*

Answer: うつくしい

Also accepted: utsukushii

51.4 あおい (*aoi*) — *blue*

Answer: あおい

Also accepted: aoi

51.5 あかい (*akai*) — *red*

Answer: あかい

Also accepted: akai

Chapter 52

52.1 しろい (*shiroi*) — *white*

Answer: しろい

Also accepted: shiroi

52.2 くろい (*kuroi*) — *black*

Answer: くろい

Also accepted: kuroi

52.3 みどり (*midori*) — *green*

Answer: みどり

Also accepted: midori

52.4 ふとい (*futoi*) — *thick*

Answer: ふとい

Also accepted: futoi

52.5 あたたかい (*ataakai*) — *warm*

Answer: あたたかい

Also accepted: atataakai

Chapter 53

53.1 つめたい (*tsumetai*) — *cold (to the touch)*

Answer: つめたい

Also accepted: tsumetai

53.2 おいしい (*oishii*) — *tasty*

Answer: おいしい

Also accepted: oishii

53.3 あつい (*atsui*) — *hot*

Answer: あつい

Also accepted: atsui

53.4 さむい (*samui*) — *cold (weather)*

Answer: さむい

Also accepted: samui

53.5 あさ (*asa*) — *morning*

Answer: あさ

Also accepted: asa

Chapter 54

54.1 ゆうがた (*yuugata*) — *evening*

Answer: ゆうがた

Also accepted: yuugata

54.2 あした (*ashita*) — *tomorrow*

Answer: あした

Also accepted: ashita

54.3 いま (*ima*) — *now*

Answer: いま

Also accepted: ima

54.4 まいにち (*mainichi*) — *every day*

Answer: まいにち

Also accepted: mainichi

54.5 とし (*toshi*) — *a year; age*

Answer: とし

Also accepted: toshi

54.6 *Food and the home* — *a first pass*

Answer: まいにち

Also accepted: mainichi

54.7 *School, nature and animals* — *a second pass*

Answer: むし

Also accepted: mushi

Chapter 55

55.1 ふん (*fun*) — *a minute*

Answer: ふん

Also accepted: fun

55.2 なつ (*natsu*) — *summer*

Answer: なつ

Also accepted: natsu

55.3 ふゆ (*fuyu*) — *winter*

Answer: ふゆ

Also accepted: fuyu

55.4 いつも (*itsumo*) — *always*

Answer: いつも

Also accepted: itsumo

55.5 まだ (*mada*) — *still, not yet*

Answer: まだ

Also accepted: mada

Chapter 56

56.1 あと (*ato*) — *after, later*

Answer: あと

Also accepted: ato

56.2 まえ (*mae*) — *before; in front*

Answer: まえ

Also accepted: mae

56.3 うえ (*ue*) — *above, on top*

Answer: うえ

Also accepted: ue

56.4 なか (*naka*) — *inside*

Answer: なか

Also accepted: naka

56.5 ひだり (*hidari*) — *left*

Answer: ひだり

Also accepted: hidari

Chapter 57

57.1 ちかい (*chikai*) — *near*

Answer: ちかい

Also accepted: chikai

57.2 とい (*tooi*) — *far*

Answer: とい

Also accepted: tooi

57.3 まち (*machi*) — *a town*

Answer: まち

Also accepted: machi

57.4 みち (*michi*) — a road

Answer: みち

Also accepted: michi

57.5 みせ (*mise*) — a shop

Answer: みせ

Also accepted: mise

Chapter 58

58.1 ちか (*chika*) — underground

Answer: ちか

Also accepted: chika

58.2 こうえん (*kouen*) — a park

Answer: こうえん

Also accepted: kouen

58.3 くに (*kuni*) — a country

Answer: くに

Also accepted: kuni

58.4 ふく (*fuku*) — clothes

Answer: ふく

Also accepted: fuku

58.5 くつ (*kutsu*) — shoes

Answer: くつ

Also accepted: kutsu

Chapter 59

59.1 ぼうし (*boushi*) — a hat

Answer: ぼうし

Also accepted: boushi

59.2 くつした (*kutsushita*) — socks

Answer: くつした

Also accepted: kutsushita

59.3 めがね (*megane*) — glasses

Answer: めがね

Also accepted: megane

59.4 さんじゅう (*sanjuu*) — thirty

Answer: さんじゅう

Also accepted: sanjuu

59.5 せん (*sen*) — a thousand

Answer: せん

Also accepted: sen

Chapter 60

60.1 まん (*man*) — ten thousand

Answer: まん

Also accepted: man

60.2 じゅうに (*juuni*) — twelve

Answer: じゅうに

Also accepted: juuni

60.3 なす (*nasu*) — an aubergine

Answer: なす

Also accepted: nasu

60.4 うた (*uta*) — a song

Answer: うた

Also accepted: uta

60.5 えだ (*eda*) — a branch

Answer: えだ

Also accepted: eda

Chapter 61

61.1 いと (*ito*) — a thread

Answer: いと

Also accepted: ito

61.2 はり (*hari*) — a needle

Answer: はり

Also accepted: hari

61.3 くし (*kushi*) — a comb

Answer: くし

Also accepted: kushi

61.4 ひも (*himo*) — a string

Answer: ひも

Also accepted: himo

61.5 つな (*tsuna*) — a rope

Answer: つな

Also accepted: tsuna

Chapter 62

62.1 にもつ (*nimotsu*) — *luggage*

Answer: にもつ

Also accepted: nimotsu

62.2 ふね (*fune*) — *a ship*

Answer: ふね

Also accepted: fune

62.3 おと (*oto*) — *a sound*

Answer: おと

Also accepted: oto

62.4 いろ (*iro*) — *a colour*

Answer: いろ

Also accepted: iro

62.5 かたち (*katachi*) — *a shape*

Answer: かたち

Also accepted: katachi

Chapter 63

63.1 ゆめ (*yume*) — *a dream*

Answer: ゆめ

Also accepted: yume

63.2 まつり (*matsuri*) — *a festival*

Answer: まつり

Also accepted: matsuri

63.3 にし (*nishi*) — *west*

Answer: にし

Also accepted: nishi

63.4 ひがし (*higashi*) — *east*

Answer: ひがし

Also accepted: higashi

63.5 みなみ (*minami*) — *south*

Answer: みなみ

Also accepted: minami

Chapter 64

64.1 こな (*kona*) — *powder, flour*

Answer: こな

Also accepted: kona

64.2 ごま (*goma*) — *sesame*

Answer: ごま

Also accepted: goma

64.3 うに (*uni*) — *a sea urchin*

Answer: うに

Also accepted: uni

64.4 いわし (*iwashi*) — *a sardine*

Answer: いわし

Also accepted: iwashi

64.5 あじ (*aji*) — *a flavour, a taste*

Answer: あじ

Also accepted: aji

Chapter 65

65.1 こい (*koi*) — *a carp*

Answer: こい

Also accepted: koi

65.2 せみ (*semi*) — *a cicada*

Answer: せみ

Also accepted: semi

65.3 とんぼ (*tonbo*) — *a dragonfly*

Answer: とんぼ

Also accepted: tonbo

65.4 いも (*imo*) — *a potato*

Answer: いも

Also accepted: imo

65.5 ごぼう (*gobou*) — *burdock root*

Answer: ごぼう

Also accepted: gobou

Chapter 66

66.1 かご (*kago*) — *a basket*

Answer: かご

Also accepted: kago

66.2 こま (*koma*) — *a spinning top*

Answer: こま

Also accepted: koma

66.3 いかだ (*ikada*) — a raft

Answer: いかだ

Also accepted: ikada

66.4 ふえ (*fue*) — a flute

Answer: ふえ

Also accepted: fue

66.5 たいこ (*taiko*) — a drum

Answer: たいこ

Also accepted: taiko

Chapter 67

67.1 うちわ (*uchiwa*) — a hand fan

Answer: うちわ

Also accepted: uchiwa

67.2 せんす (*sensu*) — a folding fan

Answer: せんす

Also accepted: sensu

67.3 すみ (*sumi*) — charcoal; a corner

Answer: すみ

Also accepted: sumi

67.4 いど (*ido*) — a well

Answer: いど

Also accepted: ido

67.5 はま (*hama*) — a beach

Answer: はま

Also accepted: hama

Chapter 68

68.1 おか (*oka*) — a hill

Answer: おか

Also accepted: oka

68.2 たに (*tani*) — a valley

Answer: たに

Also accepted: tani

68.3 いなか (*inaka*) — the countryside

Answer: いなか

Also accepted: inaka

68.4 みなと (*minato*) — a harbour

Answer: みなと

Also accepted: minato

68.5 ゆうひ (*yuuhi*) — the setting sun

Answer: ゆうひ

Also accepted: yuuhi

Chapter 69

69.1 にじ (*niji*) — a rainbow

Answer: にじ

Also accepted: niji

69.2 かみなり (*kaminari*) — thunder

Answer: かみなり

Also accepted: kaminari

69.3 しも (*shimo*) — frost

Answer: しも

Also accepted: shimo

69.4 こおり (*koori*) — ice

Answer: こおり

Also accepted: koori

69.5 なつやすみ (*natsuyasumi*) — the summer holidays

Answer: なつやすみ

Also accepted: natsuyasumi

Chapter 70

70.1 もち (*mochi*) — a rice cake

Answer: もち

Also accepted: mochi

70.2 なっとう (*nattou*) — natto, fermented soybeans

Answer: なっとう

Also accepted: nattou

70.3 ちくわ (*chikuwa*) — a fish-paste tube

Answer: ちくわ

Also accepted: chikuwa

70.4 ひよこ (*hiyoko*) — a chick

Answer: ひよこ

Also accepted: hiyoko

70.5 はね (*hane*) — a wing; a feather

Answer: はね

Also accepted: hane

Chapter 71

71.1 つの (*tsuno*) — a horn

Answer: つの

Also accepted: tsuno

71.2 あな (*ana*) — a hole

Answer: あな

Also accepted: ana

71.3 いね (*ine*) — a rice plant

Answer: いね

Also accepted: ine

71.4 おい (*oi*) — a nephew

Answer: おい

Also accepted: oi

71.5 めい (*mei*) — a niece

Answer: めい

Also accepted: mei

71.6 Describing words and time — a first pass

Answer: おい

Also accepted: oi

71.7 Places, clothes and more — a second pass

Answer: ゆめ

Also accepted: yume

Sources for this starter edition

Word histories follow Wiktionary’s Japanese entries for hai, konnichiwa, arigatou, and コーヒー. The farewell chapter follows the Japan Foundation’s Marugoto A1 vocabulary entry and the context-sensitive Starter treatment in Irodori lesson 1. The companion Markdown lessons carry the per-lesson citations and are the canonical short-practice source for this edition; the chapter that follows is generated from them, so the two cannot drift apart.

Index

Look up an English meaning, a dedicated language topic, or a chapter topic. Each linked reference opens the chapter where the material is introduced; the focus labels name only explicitly typed lesson sections.

A

a basket かご (kago)

Chapter 66, p. 349

a bath おふろ (ofuro)

Chapter 39, p. 239

a beach はま (hama)

Chapter 67, p. 353

a bear くま (kuma)

Chapter 45, p. 263

a bird とり (tori)

Chapter 45, p. 263

a bone ほね (hone)

Chapter 21, p. 165

a box はこ (hako)

Chapter 39, p. 239

a branch えだ (eda)

Chapter 60, p. 325

a carp こい (koi)

Chapter 65, p. 345

a carrot にんじん (ninjin)

Chapter 34, p. 217

a cat ねこ (neko)

Chapter 45, p. 263

a chair いす (isu)

Chapter 37, p. 229

a cheek ほお (hoo)

Chapter 21, p. 165

- a chestnut** くり (kuri)
Chapter 36, p. 225
- a chick** ひよこ (hiyoko)
Chapter 70, p. 365
- a chicken** にわとり (niwatori)
Chapter 48, p. 275
- a cicada** せみ (semi)
Chapter 65, p. 345
- a cloud; a spider** くも (kumo)
Chapter 43, p. 255
- a colour** いろ (iro)
Chapter 62, p. 333
- a comb** くし (kushi)
Chapter 61, p. 329
- a companion** なかま (nakama)
Chapter 26, p. 185
- A Counter for the Shape of the Thing**
chapter topic; Chapter 18, p. 145
- a country** くに (kuni)
Chapter 58, p. 317
- a cow** うし (ushi)
Chapter 45, p. 263
- a crab** かに (kani)
Chapter 47, p. 271
- a crocodile** わに (wani)
Chapter 2, p. 9
- a daughter** むすめ (musume)
Chapter 24, p. 177
- A Daytime Greeting, One Sign at a Time**
chapter topic; Chapter 2, p. 9
- a deer** しか (shika)
Chapter 46, p. 267
- a desk** つくえ (tsukue)
Chapter 37, p. 229
- a dragonfly** とんぼ (tonbo)
Chapter 65, p. 345
- a dream** ゆめ (yume)
Chapter 63, p. 337
- a drum** たいこ (taiko)
Chapter 66, p. 349
- a festival** まつり (matsuri)
Chapter 63, p. 337
- a fever** ねつ (netsu)
Chapter 22, p. 169

a fish さかな (sakana)

Chapter 32, p. 209

a fish-paste tube ちくわ (chikuwa)

Chapter 70, p. 365

a flavour, a taste あじ (aji)

Chapter 64, p. 341

a flute ふえ (fue)

Chapter 66, p. 349

a folding fan せんす (sensu)

Chapter 67, p. 353

a forest もり (mori)

Chapter 42, p. 251

a friend ともだち (tomodachi)

Chapter 25, p. 181

a futon ふとん (futon)

Chapter 38, p. 235

a garden にわ (niwa)

Chapter 39, p. 239

a grandfather おじいさん (ojiisan)

Chapter 24, p. 177

a hand fan うちわ (uchiwa)

Chapter 67, p. 353

a harbour みなと (minato)

Chapter 68, p. 357

a hat ぼうし (boushi)

Chapter 59, p. 321

a hill おか (oka)

Chapter 68, p. 357

a hole あな (ana)

Chapter 71, p. 369

a horn つの (tsuno)

Chapter 71, p. 369

a horse うま (uma)

Chapter 45, p. 263

a Japanese plum うめ (ume)

Chapter 36, p. 225

a kitchen だいどころ (daidokoro)

Chapter 38, p. 235

a knee ひざ (hiza)

Chapter 20, p. 161

a letter (post) てがみ (tegami)

Chapter 41, p. 247

a little; a small amount すこし (sukoshi)

Chapter 10, p. 71

a little more もうすこし (mō sukoshi)

Chapter 10, p. 71

A Little More Slowly

chapter topic; Chapter 10, p. 71

a man おとこ (otoko)

Chapter 25, p. 181

a mandarin orange みかん (mikan)

Chapter 33, p. 213

a minute ふん (fun)

Chapter 55, p. 305

a mirror かがみ (kagami)

Chapter 38, p. 235

a mountain やま (yama)

Chapter 41, p. 247

a nail (finger or toe) つめ (tsume)

Chapter 20, p. 161

a name なまえ (namae)

Chapter 41, p. 247

a needle はり (hari)

Chapter 61, p. 329

a nephew おい (oi)

Chapter 71, p. 369

a niece めい (mei)

Chapter 71, p. 369

a park こうえん (kouen)

Chapter 58, p. 317

a peach もも (momo)

Chapter 33, p. 213

a pear なし (nashi)

Chapter 33, p. 213

a pigeon はと (hato)

Chapter 46, p. 267

a potato いも (imo)

Chapter 65, p. 345

a problem, a question もんだい (mondai)

Chapter 40, p. 243

a raft いかだ (ikada)

Chapter 66, p. 349

a rainbow にじ (niji)

Chapter 69, p. 361

- a rice cake** もち (mochi)
Chapter 70, p. 365
- a rice field** たんぼ (tanbo)
Chapter 43, p. 255
- a rice plant** いね (ine)
Chapter 71, p. 369
- a river** かわ (kawa)
Chapter 42, p. 251
- a road** みち (michi)
Chapter 57, p. 313
- a roof** やね (yane)
Chapter 37, p. 229
- a rope** つな (tsuna)
Chapter 61, p. 329
- a sardine** いわし (iwashi)
Chapter 64, p. 341
- a school** がっこう (gakkou)
Chapter 40, p. 243
- a sea urchin** うに (uni)
Chapter 64, p. 341
- a seed** たね (tane)
Chapter 44, p. 259
- a shape** かたち (katachi)
Chapter 62, p. 333
- a sheep** ひつじ (hitsuji)
Chapter 46, p. 267
- a shelf** たな (tana)
Chapter 39, p. 239
- a ship** ふね (fune)
Chapter 62, p. 333
- a shop** みせ (mise)
Chapter 57, p. 313
- a son** むすこ (musuko)
Chapter 24, p. 177
- a song** うた (uta)
Chapter 60, p. 325
- a sound** おと (oto)
Chapter 62, p. 333
- a spinning top** こま (koma)
Chapter 66, p. 349
- a squid** いか (ika)
Chapter 47, p. 271

- a star** ほし (hoshi)
Chapter 43, p. 255
- a stone** いし (ishi)
Chapter 42, p. 251
- a strawberry** いちご (ichigo)
Chapter 33, p. 213
- a string** ひも (himo)
Chapter 61, p. 329
- a tatami mat** たたみ (tatami)
Chapter 39, p. 239
- a teacher** せんせい (sensei)
Chapter 25, p. 181
- a thousand** せん (sen)
Chapter 59, p. 321
- a thread** いと (ito)
Chapter 61, p. 329
- a town** まち (machi)
Chapter 57, p. 313
- a turtle** かめ (kame)
Chapter 47, p. 271
- a valley** たに (tani)
Chapter 68, p. 357
- a voice** こえ (koe)
Chapter 22, p. 169
- a watermelon** すいか (suika)
Chapter 34, p. 217
- a wave** なみ (nami)
Chapter 44, p. 259
- a well** いど (ido)
Chapter 67, p. 353
- a white radish** だいこん (daikon)
Chapter 34, p. 217
- a window** まど (mado)
Chapter 37, p. 229
- a wing; a feather** はね (hane)
Chapter 70, p. 365
- a wolf** おおかみ (ookami)
Chapter 47, p. 271
- a woman** おんな (onna)
Chapter 25, p. 181
- a year; age** とし (toshi)
Chapter 54, p. 299

above, on top うえ (ue)

Chapter 56, p. 309

After, Before, Above, Inside, Left

chapter topic; Chapter 56, p. 309

after, later あと (ato)

Chapter 56, p. 309

again; one more, in a request もう (mō)

Chapter 9, p. 59

always いつも (itsumo)

Chapter 55, p. 305

an adult おとな (otona)

Chapter 25, p. 181

an answer こたえ (kotae)

Chapter 40, p. 243

an ant あり (ari)

Chapter 46, p. 267

an apple りんご (ringo)

Chapter 33, p. 213

an aubergine なす (nasu)

Chapter 60, p. 325

an egg たまご (tamago)

Chapter 32, p. 209

an elbow ひじ (hiji)

Chapter 20, p. 161

an eyebrow まゆ (mayu)

Chapter 21, p. 165

an insect むし (mushi)

Chapter 46, p. 267

an island しま (shima)

Chapter 44, p. 259

an octopus たこ (tako)

Chapter 47, p. 271

an umbrella かさ (kasa)

Chapter 40, p. 243

an uncle おじさん (ojisan)

Chapter 24, p. 177

Apple, Mandarin orange, Strawberry, Peach, Pear

chapter topic; Chapter 33, p. 213

B

back せなか (senaka)

Chapter 12, p. 91

Basket, Spinning top, Raft, Flute, Drum

chapter topic; Chapter 66, p. 349

beans まめ (mame)

Chapter 36, p. 225

beautiful うつくしい (utsukushii)

Chapter 51, p. 287

before; in front まえ (mae)

Chapter 56, p. 309

belly; stomach area おなか (onaka)

Chapter 12, p. 91

bitter にがい (nigai)

Chapter 50, p. 283

black くろい (kuroi)

Chapter 52, p. 291

blue あおい (aoi)

Chapter 51, p. 287

Bone, Chin, Cheek, Eyebrow, Skin

chapter topic; Chapter 21, p. 165

breakfast あさごはん (asagohan)

Chapter 35, p. 221

burdock root ごぼう (gobou)

Chapter 65, p. 345

C**Carp, Cicada, Dragonfly, Potato, Burdock root**

chapter topic; Chapter 65, p. 345

Cat, Horse, Cow, Bird, Bear

chapter topic; Chapter 45, p. 263

charcoal; a corner すみ (sumi)

Chapter 67, p. 353

cheap やすい (yasui)

Chapter 49, p. 279

Chicken, Small, Good, Long, Short

chapter topic; Chapter 48, p. 275

child こども (kodomo)

Chapter 13, p. 99

chopsticks はし (hashi)

Chapter 38, p. 235

clothes ふく (fuku)

Chapter 58, p. 317

coffee コーヒー (kōhī)

explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 6, p. 45

Coffee in Katakana, Three Shapes

chapter topic; Chapter 6, p. 45

Cold, Tasty, Hot, Cold, Morning

chapter topic; Chapter 53, p. 295

cold (to the touch) つめたい (tsumetai)

Chapter 53, p. 295

cold (weather) さむい (samui)

Chapter 53, p. 295

Crab, Octopus, Squid, Turtle, Wolf

chapter topic; Chapter 47, p. 271

D**Dream, Festival, West, East, South**

chapter topic; Chapter 63, p. 337

E**ear; ears みみ (mimi)**

Chapter 11, p. 81

east ひがし (higashi)

Chapter 63, p. 337

easy; kind やさしい (yasashii)

Chapter 49, p. 279

**eight — one reading, no native word beside it, and the plain case
the pattern needed はち (hachi)**

Chapter 15, p. 115

**eight things — and the last of the count that a borrowed number
could be mistaken for やつつ (yattsu)**

Chapter 17, p. 135

evening ゆうがた (yuugata)

Chapter 54, p. 299

Evening, Tomorrow, Now, Every day, Year

chapter topic; Chapter 54, p. 299

every day まいにち (mainichi)

Chapter 54, p. 299

excuse me; I am sorry すみません (sumimasen)

Chapter 9, p. 59

eye; eyes め (me)

Chapter 11, p. 81

F

face かお (kao)

Chapter 11, p. 81

far とおい (tooi)

Chapter 57, p. 313

fast; early はやい (hayai)

Chapter 49, p. 279

Fish, Meat, Egg, Vegetables, Fruit

chapter topic; Chapter 32, p. 209

Five Numbers, No New Signs

chapter topic; Chapter 14, p. 109

Five signs in a row — and the greeting is readable

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 2, p. 9

five — the second job of a kanji you have been writing since

chapter five ご (go)

Chapter 14, p. 109

five things — three signs, two of them the same, and none of

them new いつつ (itsutsu)

Chapter 16, p. 125

Floor, Mirror, Futon, Chopsticks, Kitchen

chapter topic; Chapter 38, p. 235

foot; leg あし (ashi)

Chapter 11, p. 81

four — the first place in the count where a native Japanese word

is standing in a borrowed series よん (yon)

explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 14, p. 109

four things — and the seam the last chapter promised would

come back よつつ (yottsutsu)

explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 16, p. 125

Friend, Adult, Man, Woman, Teacher

chapter topic; Chapter 25, p. 181

frost しも (shimo)

Chapter 69, p. 361

fruit くだもの (kudamono)

Chapter 32, p. 209

fun, enjoyable たのしい (tanoshii)

Chapter 23, p. 173

G

Garden, Bath, Tatami mat, Shelf, Box

chapter topic; Chapter 39, p. 239

glasses めがね (megane)

Chapter 59, p. 321

good いい (ii)

Chapter 48, p. 275

grass くさ (kusa)

Chapter 42, p. 251

green みどり (midori)

Chapter 52, p. 291

H

hair かみ (kami)

Chapter 12, p. 91

hand て (te)

Chapter 11, p. 81

Hand fan, Folding fan, Charcoal, Well, Beach

chapter topic; Chapter 67, p. 353

Hat, Socks, Glasses, Thirty, Thousand

chapter topic; Chapter 59, p. 321

head あたま (atama)

Chapter 12, p. 91

heavy おもい (omoi)

Chapter 50, p. 283

hello (daytime greeting) こんにちは (konnichiwa)

explicit focus: script, grammar, usage and culture; Chapter 2, p. 9

here; this place ここ (koko)

Chapter 10, p. 71

Hill, Valley, Countryside, Harbour, Setting sun

chapter topic; Chapter 68, p. 357

home うち (uchi)

Chapter 37, p. 229

Home, Window, Chair, Desk, Roof

chapter topic; Chapter 37, p. 229

homework しゅくだい (shukudai)

Chapter 40, p. 243

Horn, Hole, Rice plant, Nephew, Niece

chapter topic; Chapter 71, p. 369

hot あつい (atsui)

Chapter 53, p. 295

I

I do not understand わかりません (wakarimasen)

Chapter 9, p. 59

I understand; understood わかりました (wakarimashita)

Chapter 10, p. 71

ice こおり (kooori)

Chapter 69, p. 361

Insect, Ant, Pigeon, Sheep, Deer

chapter topic; Chapter 46, p. 267

inside なか (naka)

Chapter 56, p. 309

Island, Wave, Soil, Seed, Rain

chapter topic; Chapter 44, p. 259

L

left ひだり (hidari)

Chapter 56, p. 309

Letter, Time, Name, Money, Mountain

chapter topic; Chapter 41, p. 247

long ながい (nagai)

Chapter 48, p. 275

low ひくい (hikui)

Chapter 49, p. 279

luggage にもつ (nimotsu)

Chapter 62, p. 333

Luggage, Ship, Sound, Colour, Shape

chapter topic; Chapter 62, p. 333

M

meat にく (niku)

Chapter 32, p. 209

medicine くすり (kusuri)

Chapter 23, p. 173

Medicine, Sleepy, Sad, Fun, Scary

chapter topic; Chapter 23, p. 173

Minute, Summer, Winter, Always, Still

chapter topic; Chapter 55, p. 305

money おかね (okane)

Chapter 41, p. 247

morning あさ (asa)

Chapter 53, p. 295

mouth ぐち (kuchi)

Chapter 11, p. 81

my elder brother あに (ani)

Chapter 13, p. 99

my elder sister あね (ane)

Chapter 13, p. 99

my father ちち (chichi)

Chapter 13, p. 99

my husband おっと (otto)

Chapter 13, p. 99

my mother はは (haha)

Chapter 13, p. 99

my wife つま (tsuma)

Chapter 13, p. 99

my younger brother おとうと (otooto)

Chapter 13, p. 99

my younger sister いもうと (imooto)

Chapter 13, p. 99

N

Nail, Elbow, Knee, Throat, Chest

chapter topic; Chapter 20, p. 161

narrow せまい (semai)

Chapter 50, p. 283

natto, fermented soybeans なっとう (nattou)

Chapter 70, p. 365

near ちかい (chikai)

Chapter 57, p. 313

Near, Far, Town, Road, Shop

chapter topic; Chapter 57, p. 313

next door; a neighbour となり (tonari)

Chapter 26, p. 185

Next door, Companion, To go, To buy, To drink

chapter topic; Chapter 26, p. 185

Nihongo, Built in Small Blocks

chapter topic; Chapter 5, p. 37

nine — a second reading that is not the native one, which is the exception the pattern needed く (ku)

Chapter 15, p. 115

Nine Family Words Through One New Kana

chapter topic; Chapter 13, p. 99

nine things — four beats, and the first two sound like a word you already have ここのつ (kokonotsu)

Chapter 17, p. 135

no; not at all いいえ (iie)

explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 1, p. 1

nose はな (hana)

Chapter 11, p. 81

now いま (ima)

Chapter 54, p. 299

O**One Goodbye, Sign by Sign**

chapter topic; Chapter 8, p. 53

one long thin thing — and the four numbers that bend the counter furthest いっぽん (ippon)

Chapter 18, p. 145

One More Time, Please

chapter topic; Chapter 9, p. 59

one more time, please もういちど、おねがいします (mō ichido, onegai shimasu)

Chapter 9, p. 59

one person, two people — the native count reaching into a borrowed counter ひとり ふたり (hitori futari)

explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 18, p. 145

one — the number you have been saying since chapter nine, standing on its own at last いち (ichi)

Chapter 14, p. 109

one thing — the first word of the count Japanese kept when it borrowed another one ひとつ (hitotsu)

Chapter 16, p. 125

one time; once いちど (ichido)

Chapter 9, p. 59

P**pain** いたみ (itami)

Chapter 24, p. 177

Pain, Grandfather, Uncle, Son, Daughter

chapter topic; Chapter 24, p. 177

painful, it hurts いたい (itai)

Chapter 22, p. 169

Plain Thanks, One Sign at a Time

chapter topic; Chapter 3, p. 19

please; I request it おねがいします (onagai shimasu)

Chapter 9, p. 59

please say it ってください (itte kudasai)

Chapter 10, p. 71

please say it a little more

slowly もうすこし、ゆっくりってください (mō sukoshi, yukkuri itte kudasai)

Chapter 10, p. 71

Polite Thanks, Three More Signs

chapter topic; Chapter 4, p. 29

powder, flour こな (kona)

Chapter 64, p. 341

Powder, Sesame, Sea urchin, Sardine, Flavour

chapter topic; Chapter 64, p. 341

R

rain; candy あめ (ame)

Chapter 44, p. 259

Rainbow, Thunder, Frost, Ice, Summer holidays

chapter topic; Chapter 69, p. 361

Reading — Words, Greetings, and the Cues You Have Only Heard

chapter topic; Chapter 19, p. 157

red あかい (akai)

Chapter 51, p. 287

rice; a meal ごはん (gohan)

Chapter 31, p. 205

Rice cake, Natto, Fish-paste tube, Chick, Wing

chapter topic; Chapter 70, p. 365

River, Sea, Grass, Forest, Stone

chapter topic; Chapter 42, p. 251

S

sad かなしい (kanashii)

Chapter 23, p. 173

salt しお (shio)

Chapter 34, p. 217

sand すな (suna)

Chapter 43, p. 255

Sand, Rice field, Star, Cloud, Sun

chapter topic; Chapter 43, p. 255

scary こわい (kawai)

Chapter 23, p. 173

seaweed のり (nori)

Chapter 36, p. 225

Seaweed, Japanese plum, Chestnut, Beans, Uncooked rice

chapter topic; Chapter 36, p. 225

sesame ごま (goma)

Chapter 64, p. 341

Seven Body Words, No New Guessing

chapter topic; Chapter 11, p. 81

Seven More Body Words, Spaced on Purpose

chapter topic; Chapter 12, p. 91

**seven — the second place the native word stands inside the
borrowed count, which is what makes it a pattern** なな (nana)

Chapter 15, p. 115

seven things — the one word in this chapter the borrowed count

already gave you ななつ (nanatsu)

explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 17, p. 135

shoes くつ (kutsu)

Chapter 58, p. 317

short みじかい (mijikai)

Chapter 48, p. 275

shoulder かた (kata)

Chapter 12, p. 91

six — the hole the chapter left open, and the reason it was

left ろく (roku)

Chapter 15, p. 115

six things — and the second count's six, unlike the first one's, is

native むつつ (muttsu)

Chapter 17, p. 135

skin はだ (hada)

Chapter 21, p. 165

sleepy ねむい (nemui)

Chapter 23, p. 173

slowly; without rushing ゆっくり (yukkuri)

Chapter 10, p. 71

small ちいさい (chiisai)

Chapter 48, p. 275

socks くつした (kutsushita)

Chapter 59, p. 321

soil つち (tsuchi)

Chapter 44, p. 259

south みなみ (minami)

Chapter 63, p. 337

still, not yet まだ (mada)

Chapter 55, p. 305

strong つよい (tsuyoi)

Chapter 51, p. 287

Strong, Weak, Beautiful, Blue, Red

chapter topic; Chapter 51, p. 287

sugar さとう (satou)

Chapter 35, p. 221

Sugar, Udon noodles, Sushi, Breakfast, Sweets

chapter topic; Chapter 35, p. 221

summer なつ (natsu)

Chapter 55, p. 305

sushi すし (sushi)

Chapter 35, p. 221

sweat あせ (ase)

Chapter 22, p. 169

Sweat, Tears, Voice, Fever, Painful

chapter topic; Chapter 22, p. 169

sweet あまい (amai)

Chapter 50, p. 283

Sweet, Bitter, Wide, Narrow, Heavy

chapter topic; Chapter 50, p. 283

sweets, snacks おかし (okashi)

Chapter 35, p. 221

T

tall; expensive たかい (takai)

Chapter 49, p. 279

Tall, Low, Cheap, Fast, Easy

chapter topic; Chapter 49, p. 279

tasty おいしい (oishii)

Chapter 53, p. 295

tears なみだ (namida)

Chapter 22, p. 169

ten — the last number of the run, and the one that turns nine

words into ninety-nine じゅう (jū)

explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 15, p. 115

ten things — the one word in the count that drops the counting

piece とお (tō)

Chapter 17, p. 135

ten thousand まん (man)

Chapter 60, p. 325

Ten thousand, Twelve, Aubergine, Song, Branch

chapter topic; Chapter 60, p. 325

thank you (plain) ありがとう (arigatō)

explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 3, p. 19

thank you (polite) ありがとうございます (arigatō gozaimasu)

explicit focus: script, grammar; Chapter 4, p. 29

the chest むね (mune)

Chapter 20, p. 161

the chin あご (ago)

Chapter 21, p. 165

the counter for long thin things — and a kanji you have been

writing since chapter five ほん (-hon)

explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 18, p. 145

the counter for people — and the first place the tsu rule stops

working にん (-nin)

explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 18, p. 145

the counter you already own — what the tsu was doing all

along ...つ (-tsu)

explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 18, p. 145

the countryside いなか (inaka)

Chapter 68, p. 357

The Doorway Exchange

chapter topic; Chapter 7, p. 51

the floor ゆか (yuka)

Chapter 38, p. 235

the Japanese language 日本語 (nihongo)

explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 5, p. 37

The Other Five, and Where the Count Stops

chapter topic; Chapter 17, p. 135

° — **the other mark**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 18, p. 145

The Other Way to Count

chapter topic; Chapter 16, p. 125

the sea うみ (umi)

Chapter 42, p. 251

the setting sun ゆうひ (yuuhi)

Chapter 68, p. 357

the summer holidays なつやすみ (natsuyasumi)

Chapter 69, p. 361

the sun たいよう (taiyou)

Chapter 43, p. 255

the throat のど (nodo)

Chapter 20, p. 161

The Two Signs the Rest of the Run Cost

chapter topic; Chapter 15, p. 115

thick ふとい (futoi)

Chapter 52, p. 291

thirty さんじゅう (sanjuu)

Chapter 59, p. 321

Thread, Needle, Comb, String, Rope

chapter topic; Chapter 61, p. 329

three — and the moraic ん you have been closing words with

since こんにちは さん (san)

Chapter 14, p. 109

three things — the first word in the chapter that costs nothing

at all みつつ (mittsu)

Chapter 16, p. 125

thunder かみなり (kaminari)

Chapter 69, p. 361

time; an hour じかん (jikan)

Chapter 41, p. 247

to buy かう (kau)

Chapter 26, p. 185

to cry なく (naku)

Chapter 29, p. 197

to drink のむ (nomu)

Chapter 26, p. 185

to drop おとす (otosu)

Chapter 31, p. 205

to enjoy たのしむ (tanoshimu)

Chapter 29, p. 197

to fix なおす (naosu)

Chapter 31, p. 205

to give back かえす (kaesu)

Chapter 30, p. 201

to go いく (iku)

Chapter 26, p. 185

to hold もつ (motsu)

Chapter 28, p. 193

to lend かす (kasu)

Chapter 30, p. 201

to live (somewhere) すむ (sumu)

Chapter 29, p. 197

to look for さがす (sagasu)

Chapter 30, p. 201

to meet あう (au)

Chapter 27, p. 189

to move うごく (ugoku)

Chapter 31, p. 205

to pull ひく (hiku)

Chapter 30, p. 201

to push おす (osu)

Chapter 30, p. 201

To push, To pull, To look for, To lend, To give back

chapter topic; Chapter 30, p. 201

to read よむ (yomu)

Chapter 27, p. 189

To read, To write, To speak, To wait, To meet

chapter topic; Chapter 27, p. 189

to rest やすむ (yasumu)

Chapter 29, p. 197

to say いう (iu)

Chapter 28, p. 193

to sing うたう (utau)

Chapter 28, p. 193

to speak はなす (hanasu)

Chapter 27, p. 189

to stand たつ (tatsu)

Chapter 29, p. 197

To stand, To cry, To live, To rest, To enjoy

chapter topic; Chapter 29, p. 197

to take out だす (dasu)

Chapter 31, p. 205

To take out, To drop, To fix, To move, Rice

chapter topic; Chapter 31, p. 205

to think おもう (omou)

Chapter 28, p. 193

to use つかう (tsukau)

Chapter 28, p. 193

To use, To sing, To say, To think, To hold

chapter topic; Chapter 28, p. 193

to wait まつ (matsu)

Chapter 27, p. 189

to write かく (kaku)

Chapter 27, p. 189

tofu とうふ (toufu)

Chapter 34, p. 217

tomorrow あした (ashita)

Chapter 54, p. 299

tooth; teeth は (ha)

Chapter 12, p. 91

twelve じゅうに (juuni)

Chapter 60, p. 325

Two Answers, Sign by Sign

chapter topic; Chapter 1, p. 1

two — one mora, one sign, and the sign has been yours since

chapter two に (ni)

Chapter 14, p. 109

Two signs, side by side — and a word appears

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 1, p. 1

two things — and the beat that ties this count to a word you

already say ふたつ (futatsu)

Chapter 16, p. 125

ゝ — two ticks, and every sign you know doubles

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 3, p. 19

U

udon noodles うどん (udon)

Chapter 35, p. 221

Umbrella, School, Homework, Problem, Answer

chapter topic; Chapter 40, p. 243

uncooked rice こめ (kome)

Chapter 36, p. 225

underground ちか (chika)

Chapter 58, p. 317

Underground, Park, Country, Clothes, Shoes

chapter topic; Chapter 58, p. 317

V

vegetables やさい (yasai)

Chapter 32, p. 209

W

waist; lower back こし (koshi)

Chapter 12, p. 91

warm あたたかい (atatakai)

Chapter 52, p. 291

Watermelon, White radish, Carrot, Tofu, Salt

chapter topic; Chapter 34, p. 217

weak よわい (yowai)

Chapter 51, p. 287

well; fully, as an adverb よく (yoku)

Chapter 9, p. 59

west にし (nishi)

Chapter 63, p. 337

white しろい (shiroi)

Chapter 52, p. 291

White, Black, Green, Thick, Warm

chapter topic; Chapter 52, p. 291

wide ひろい (hiroai)

Chapter 50, p. 283

winter ふゆ (fuyu)

Chapter 55, p. 305

Y

yes はい (hai)

explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 1, p. 1

Other

あ — three strokes, and the thank-you begins

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 3, p. 19

ありがとう — no new sign, and a whole word

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 3, p. 19

い — two strokes, one beat

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 1, p. 1

う — two strokes, and a vowel that stretches

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 3, p. 19

え — two strokes, and a second word for free

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 1, p. 1

お — the respectful opening sign

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 10, p. 71

か — **three strokes, and a shape you will reuse**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 3, p. 19

く — **one angled stroke**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 9, p. 59

こ — **two strokes, and the greeting begins**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 2, p. 9

さ — **two strokes, and the ticks work here too**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 4, p. 29

さようなら — **assemble what the hand already knows**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 8, p. 53

し — **one falling curve**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 10, p. 71

す — **two strokes, and a vowel you barely hear**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, usage and culture; Chapter 4, p. 29

せ — **close the opener**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 10, p. 71

た — **close *wakarimashita***

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 11, p. 81

だ — **voice the known base**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 11, p. 81

ち — **two strokes, four roman letters, one beat**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 2, p. 9

っ — **one small held beat**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 11, p. 81

つ — **one full-size curve**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 13, p. 99

て — **close *itte***

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 11, p. 81

と — **two strokes, and they never meet**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 3, p. 19

ど — **voice a sign you already own**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 9, p. 59

な — **one sign for *na***

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 8, p. 53

に — **three strokes, and a shape you half know**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 2, p. 9

ね — **finish the polite request**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 10, p. 71

の — **one stroke, and the last sign of the chapter**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 17, p. 135

は — **three strokes**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 1, p. 1

ひ — **one stroke, and a second count begins**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 16, p. 125

ふ — **four strokes, and a counter you already own**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 16, p. 125

ほ — **は with one more bar**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 18, p. 145

ま — **three strokes, and a loop you have drawn before**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 4, p. 29

み — **one looped bridge**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 9, p. 59

む — **three strokes, one of them a dot**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 17, p. 135

め — **cross, loop, release**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 9, p. 59

も — **two bars, then the curve**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 9, p. 59

や — **the long stroke goes first**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 17, p. 135

ゆ — **a small sign that joins forward**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 15, p. 115

ゆ — **open yukkuri**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 10, p. 71

よ — **the second sound gets a shape**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 8, p. 53

ら — **the last new shape**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 8, p. 53

り — **two strokes, and a tap rather than an r**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 3, p. 19

ろ — **one turn, and the r you already make**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 15, p. 115

わ — **the sign for *wa*, and the trap beside it**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 2, p. 9

ん — **one stroke, one beat, no vowel**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 2, p. 9

コ — **same sound, a new script**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 6, p. 45

ヒ — **two strokes complete the inventory**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 6, p. 45

一 — **one line, one extra beat**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 6, p. 45

五 — **four strokes for the sound side**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 5, p. 37

□ — **close a box in three strokes**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 5, p. 37

日 — **one sun, four strokes**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 5, p. 37

本 — a tree with its root marked

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 5, p. 37

言 — build the speech side first

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 5, p. 37

語 — assemble; do not memorise fourteen loose strokes

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 5, p. 37